

NUMEN GAMES PRESENTS

NUMINIA

*A roleplaying game between planes: steam,
copper and code.*



Christian Mörtens · Pablo Fernández-Maqueira Martínez

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INTRODUCTION

THE ECHOES OF A VIRTUAL CITY

THE ECHOES OF A VIRTUAL CITY

LECTURA

«The sound of a stone rolling across a broken digital tile was the only thing that interrupted the silence. In the distance, a levitating sphere—silver and rough like a lost moon—cast the shadow of a board into the air. It had no end and no apparent centre. Each square flickered with a different symbol: some were ancient, others were yet to be invented.

Rima moved forward slowly, resting her hand against the wall, which trembled faintly at her touch. She had been told that the textures in Numinia were anchored memories: a code of sensitive memory that only the initiated could read. It had taken her seven days to cross the corridors of mist that separated the Threshold from the Central Archive, and now she was there, where every game began and ended.

—Are you ready?—asked a voice without a throat.

Rima did not answer. She knelt before the suspended board, drew an obsidian die from inside her cloak and held it between her fingers. A single number was engraved on every face: one. The origin. The first fall.

The voice spoke again.

—You have, as yet, no rules—it said—. Only intentions. You have no map. Only paths that do not exist yet. What do you hope to find?

—A question worth answering—she replied.

And she threw the die.

What happened next was less a movement than an opening. The board broke apart into a thousand grids of light, spreading through the city like a conscious swarm. Towers without foundations began to grow downwards. Streets that had never existed rewrote the data of the old ones. A choir of spectral beings began to intone verses in forgotten dialects. Something—or

someone—was awakening beneath the surface of the neighbourhoods that made up the four districts.

Rima closed her eyes.

She knew she was playing. That every step, every choice, every silence and every word would bring an echo, a reply, a distortion. That to play in Numinia was not to act as someone else, but to reveal what one is when the other dissolves.

Because there, in that city written by will and upheld by the Veil, to play was to remember what adults had forgotten: that fantasy is not escape, but conjuration. That the game is not distraction, but destiny. And that every true story—like every great game—begins with a question thrown into the air, a die that spins and a world that waits.

It was then that the gates of the city opened for her. Not with noise. Much less with light.

But with an invitation.

Rima took the first step.

And Numinia, as always, began to write itself anew.»

A roleplaying game is a shared experience of narrative creation. It is not simply a matter of taking on the role of a fictional character, but of embodying a point of view, a temperament, a story within a collective universe. In essence, a roleplaying game proposes a flexible structure in which each player plays a character, while a guiding figure—the Game Director, or GD—shapes the settings, the world and its challenges. Together, narrator and players build a story that is not written in advance, but emerges from decisions, actions and the chance of the dice.

The foundations of roleplaying rest on interaction, improvisation and shared storytelling. A world is established with internal rules, a set of logical norms that allow conflicts or uncertain situations to be resolved through dice rolls or similar mechanisms. And yet, despite this apparently structured mechanics, a roleplaying game is not a competition. There are no winners and no losers. What there is, is a symbolic experience, a journey that crosses archetypes, moral challenges, cooperation, chance and wit. Roleplaying is, then, a way of playing that is at once new and ancestral, complex, complete and essential.

It is common to think of play as an instrument: something that serves something else. People speak of its educational usefulness, its therapeutic power, its value in developing narrative, logical or social skills. And, above all, of its sense of fun. And it is true: play educates, it cultivates empathy, imagination, strategic thinking and collaboration. And it is fun, no doubt about it. But reducing it to that would be to mistake its essence.

Because, above all, the dynamic of play is not instrumental: it is functional. Its meaning does not lie in what it is useful for, but in the function it fulfils. The dynamics of play let us carry out an essential function: that of exploring ourselves through others. When we play, we do not simply act. We experience ourselves. We see in the other –the character, the setting, the fictional situation– an extension of what we could be, a living hypothesis of ourselves. And that function is complex, vital, humanly unavoidable.

Play is not only action: it is also, as Lacan said, reflection, recognition, and the symbolisation of the self in relation to the world.

Play is our first narrative, our first lesson and our first creative impulse.

Roleplaying, as an essential and complex dynamic of play, does not only entertain, nor does it only teach. It transforms us. Not only because it represents another world, but because it lets us rebuild our own from multiple perspectives that are new to us, from fantasy. To roleplay is, ultimately, a way of understanding and of living, of fulfilling ourselves. And that is why it is so powerful.

Freud held that the child, when playing, is building a poetry of its own, rearranging reality through fantasy and finding deep pleasure in it. And that, although at some point the adult stops playing, they find that lost pleasure in fantasy, building castles in the air and daydreams. It is true that those of us who love roleplaying games did not stop playing when we grew up and became adults, but this reflection teaches us how much the dynamic of play matters in our fulfilment, in how we recognise and face reality. Because play is not a mechanism of escape; it neither silences reality nor confronts it: it faces it. From the perspective of fantasy, that is.

So let us agree that the exercise of sitting at a table in front of a character sheet, full of characteristics, indicators and traits, and interacting with a Game Director who describes a world to us and guides us through it –a world (re)invented, (re)built for the sake of our impulses, of our demanding fantasy– answers, in the last instance, to an intimate need to be, to fulfil ourselves essentially, which, given the pleasure it brings, we may come to understand as play.

But if all we wanted were to have fun, we would turn to far simpler pastimes: sitting on the sofa wrapped in a blanket to watch a sitcom or an entertainment show; opening our phone to devour short, random videos on some fashionable app... These activities feed dopamine and instant reward generously, but they are purely instrumental: they lack all fulfilment, all function. The dynamic of play, on the other hand, proposes commitments that must be taken on; it demands a kind of effort. And roleplaying, especially, holds a long list of commitments, rules and proposals. No one in their right mind would take on such an effort only to have fun.

But that is what play is: a complex structure, a proposal overflowing with rules, the acceptance of a good number of commitments.

For without rules there is no game; without the game there is no soul; and without a soul... there is no Numinia.

NUMINIA: PLAYING TO INHABIT A SYMBOL

Numinia is not simply a setting, nor a backdrop of the usual kind. It is not just a fantasy world waiting to be travelled, nor a closed tale the players are condemned to repeat. Numinia is, above all, a proposal. A gesture in the form of a game. A city built not with bricks or code, but with stories, decisions and bonds.

As a roleplaying game, Numinia is an open and symbolic architecture, a fabric of meanings in which each character is a thread that affects the whole. What is played here is not only a campaign or an adventure, but the resonance of what one decides to be when facing the unknown. Because in Numinia, the world answers to the way you look at it. The city reacts, folds and reveals itself through the will of those who inhabit it. Each player, in creating a character, is accepting a way of inhabiting time, of naming things and of facing the essential dilemmas of the soul and of society.

This is not a game of power or accumulation. It is a game of revelation. Here, to play is to make meaning. Each attribute of the character stands for a way of understanding the world. Each competence is an open door to resolution, to chaos, to art or to the void. The positions one chooses are not trades or classes, but ways of speaking with the Veil that covers the city: the symbolic skin of a universe that exists halfway between imagination and memory.

Numinia proposes a journey in which the board is made of language and gaze, in which the dice do not dictate fate, but illuminate it. The roll does not resolve an action; it states it, strengthens it or transforms it. Because here there is no success without a story, and no story without transformation.

This game is born from the wish to join the ancient with what has not yet been said. It recovers mythologies, symbolisms, philosophical and scientific structures and weaves them together with technology, information theory, digital culture and the art of storytelling. Numinia is a place where the player becomes author, interpreter, demiurge.

And, like every true act of play, what unfolds in Numinia is a possibility of life. A way of thinking, of feeling and of building community. An open-gated city where every story told is a truth added to the ones before.

Because Numinia is not played.

It is inhabited.

And, in inhabiting it, it is transformed.

CHAPTER ONE

WELCOME TO NUMINIA

WELCOME TO NUMINIA

LECTURA

«The mist swayed among the ruins of the Sunken Amphitheatre like a voiceless choir. Between broken columns and fractured statues, the five adventurers who made up the expedition moved forward in silence, guided by the pale light of a Luminous Projection orb floating above the Armonaut's palm.

—It was here—declared the Whisperer of Machines, dropping to one knee beside a rusted casing—. The original emitter of the Aedolatra archive. They buried it after the first network implosion.

The Guardian of the Gates stayed on his feet, scanning the half-lit passages. His etheric spear vibrated faintly.

—Someone is watching us.

—Something—corrected the Pythia, who was already speaking with her eyes rolled back, walking paths of the Veil the others could barely sense. Her fingers traced slow circles on the damp stone. She murmured an unfinished verse.

The Ambassador took up the fragment of the poem and closed it with a phrase in Latin, as if signing a contract with the dead. The crack separating the main chamber from the rest of the complex vibrated. The mnemonic lock, hidden behind fractal symbols, lit up.

—We have access—he said—, but quickly. If the threshold entity is awake...

He did not finish the sentence. From the other side of the crack, a roar of code and flesh echoed off the walls. A Formrender emerged from the shadows.

The Guardian reacted first. He activated Etheric Wall, stopping the charge with a flash of energy. The Pythia, already in trance, whispered an impossible phrase. The creature hesitated. The Balance broke. The Whisperer of Machines used the gap to insert a new pattern into the network around them: the runes of the archive were being deciphered.

But the enemy was stubborn.

Then the Guardian of the Gates turned his wrist and drew the Mnemonic Eclipse. The blade vibrated as if answering a forgotten memory and, in the blink of an eye, traced a broken line of light in the air. When it struck, it did not cut flesh, but notion: the Formrender howled, disoriented, as it lost the memory of why it guarded that threshold. Its roar stopped being aggression and turned into bewilderment.

At the same moment, the Ambassador stepped between the beast and the Armonaut, extending his Plinth of Understanding as an emotional shield. For an instant, the creature wavered. And that instant was enough.

The song began.

The Armonaut performed the lost melody of the Aedolatra, composed centuries earlier to restore what had been fragmented. Every note was a key; every harmony, an architecture. The place shook. The statues recomposed themselves. The walls closed. And the creature... bowed.

It was not a victory by force. It was a reconfiguration of the symbol.

When they were done, neither enemy nor ruin remained. Only a newly lit archive, a restored connection, and one more step in the rebuilding of the city.

—One less—said the Guardian.

—One more—corrected the Pythia, stroking the living wall they had just brought back to life. »

A CITY WRITTEN BETWEEN STEAM AND CODE

Numinia is a city first imagined at the dawn of the twentieth century, on the uncertain threshold between science and spirit, between reason and symbol. It is said that its first architect was Holberins, a visionary scientist, an alchemist of knowledge, who, together with four other initiates whose names have been lost to memory, dreamed of a polis, a city-state of knowledge where humanity could rebuild itself from memory and invention. Inspired by the philosophical and occult currents of his time, influenced by the advances of quantum physics and the mathematics of chaos, he conceived the city as a game: a great board on which thought could move freely.

But Numinia was razed by fire in 1920. Not only by a literal fire, but also by an ideological one, a blaze of control and oblivion. Its architecture, its plans, its gearwork of knowledge were left floating like splinters at the margins of time until, a century later, the Oracles—five new initiates—reactivated its existence through the Veil, rereading ancient symbols from a new matrix: the digital one.

Today, Numinia rises again in the twenty-first century as a city between planes. Its aesthetic fuses steam and code, copper and silicon, smoke and pixel. It has the skin of gears and the soul of algorithms. It is a steampunk city in its architecture of iron, glass, steam and gears that evoke the Second Industrial Revolution; it is cyberpunk in its data networks, its unfinished artificial intelligences, its digital residues floating like ghosts in the Veil.

But Numinia is not nostalgia. It is not a museum. It is a poetic and utopian proposal, a narrative space under constant construction. Its geography is manifold: labyrinthine alleys, data towers, hologram markets, living libraries, suspended temples, bridges between planes, gardens cultivated with memory. Each district answers to a principle, to a symbolic vibration: wisdom, balance, chaos, rebirth.

It is not a city to be walked through. It is a city to be read. Every corner of Numinia keeps a secret, a hidden text, a metaphor of the present disguised as a symbol. To play in Numinia is to walk inside a fable. It is to inhabit an expanding poem.

Here, ruins and planes live side by side. Order and entropy. The analogue and the spiritual. Here, everything is vestige and possibility. Here, everything is waiting to be interpreted.

A UTOPIA MADE REAL

Numinia is not a closed city, nor is it simply a fantasy world. It is a mythological mirror, an allegory of our time. A space that, like its players, is in the process of rebuilding, of recovery and rebirth. Founded more than a century ago as a secret project of shared knowledge and intellectual freedom, and destroyed by the flames of fanaticism, Numinia rises again in the present as a mirror image between the ancestral and what is to come.

Numinia is a city of portals. But it is also a portal in itself. A node on an invisible plane that connects forgotten wisdom, emerging science, spirituality and technology. Here, the player becomes a citizen: a builder of meaning, a narrative agent who explores, transforms and inhabits the city to rewrite its destiny and their own.

The city is fragmented; its structures hover between the ruined and the newborn. Order is not yet clear. Its laws are being written. Its systems are being tested. There are forces opposed to the rebuilding: remnants of the old chaos, deformed digital echoes, corrupted symbolic entities. In this uncertain setting, what defines a citizen is not their power, but their will to collaborate, imagine, share and challenge.

The game begins here: in a city rescued from the past, projected into the future, but lived in the present. Each character is a way of connecting with that world: from the guardians of the gates to the whisperers of code, from the architects of order to the prophets of the Veil. The goal is not to win, but to understand. Not to conquer, but to rebuild.

Numinia is also a metaphor. A symbolic language for speaking about the real world. Its conflicts are our dilemmas. Its expanding network, our bonds. Its memory, our collective history. That is why playing Numinia is much more than playing a character: it is stepping onto the board to rebuild, together, a city, a community and, perhaps, a new story of what is to come.

SOWING THE FUTURE IN THE FOUNDATIONS OF MYTH

In Numinia, the players do not play heroes by chance or aimless fugitives. They play citizens chosen by the Veil, souls embodied in concrete functions, with real responsibilities in a city that is rebuilding itself after being erased from time.

Each character takes on a Position, a way of living in the city-state and contributing to its rebirth. They are guardians, poets, diplomats, architects of code, fighters at the edge, interpreters of mystery. They are not cogs in a machine, but living forces that intertwine to reactivate a machinery that has slept for a century.

The players' aim is not only to survive, but to build. To rebuild, to shape and, above all, to stabilise the living forces of a city that, by its very nature, lives in a permanent state of alteration, suffering constant changes, anomalies and disturbances. Its position on the metaphysical plane that sustains it causes this changing character, since the dimension in which Numinia moves feeds, precisely, on chaos and variability. The city's foundations are quicksand.

In each game, the characters face different missions, connected by a single goal: the reactivation and balance of Numinia. Some missions will send them to recover forgotten data in zones not yet mapped. Others will require raising symbolic or real structures, facing forces that resist change, deciphering signals from the past, protecting what has been sown or fighting whatever threatens to sink everything into silence once more.

Rebuilding Numinia is a monumental task. And every player leaves a furrow. Their action may open a new path, free a sealed access or transform an entire district. But, above all, they will leave something more intimate: a memory, a story, a trace. Because rebuilding a city is not only raising its walls: it is weaving its soul.

But playing Numinia goes deeper still: it is taking on the responsibility of embodying the spirit of a civilisation that does not yet fully exist, but already calls to us from the threshold of time. The players become agents of the rebirth, active pieces on a board where the past has not died and the future has not yet been born, but both brush against each other in a fragile present, charged with symbols, dangers and revelations.

This rebirth is not only urban or structural. It is also spiritual, ethical, philosophical. The characters the players embody must recover ancient knowledge, forgotten values that once defined the greatness of Mediterranean cultures such as Greece, Rome or Egypt: knowledge

as a path, honour as conduct, beauty as truth. But they do not do it by repeating worn-out formulas: they do it by reprogramming history, projecting it forward through advanced technologies, digital networks, artificial intelligences, quantum geometries and cities built with language.

In this retrofuturist world, innovation and the ancestral intertwine without conflict. Network technologies combine with arcane runes. Artificial intelligence drinks from the Orphic myths. And the circuits that give access to secret zones are protected by riddles written in dactylic hexameters. The city is a symphony of non-linear time, a ruin rebuilt with codes and dreams.

Each player, by taking on their Position and joining the rebuilding of Numinia, is making an ethical and aesthetic decision: to create world. And not just any world. One that reflects the best of the mythical human with the best of the possible human. One where decisions are recorded in the archives of the Akasha, where every action leaves an echo that will resonate beyond the game.

Because Numinia is not a space of escape; it is a mirror of the world, and each player decides which face it will show.

Here, adventure is not mere entertainment. It is construction.

Here, the legacy is not a trophy. It is the city itself.

HOW NUMINIA IS PLAYED

No journey begins without a first step. In Numinia, as in other roleplaying games, that step is called Session Zero. Before the portals of the game open, the players meet with the Game Director (GD) to build the soul of the game together. This first session is for creating the characters, discovering their stories, understanding how they relate to the world around them and, above all, weaving the first threads of the common story they will live.

There are no winners or losers here. Numinia is a narrative roleplaying game in which each player plays a character –an inhabitant of this fantastic city under reconstruction– and makes them move forward, speak, decide and act as if they were that character. The GD, for their part, is neither a judge nor an enemy, but a narrator and a guide: the one who sets obstacles, describes settings, embodies the characters of the world, keeps the narrative tension alive and, above all, encourages the players to create part of that narrative with proposals, questions and alternative paths.

A roleplaying game in Numinia unfolds as a shared story. The character sheet and the dice are there as tools, not as chains. They serve to add uncertainty, to mark challenges, so that not everything is the player's decision. But in this game, as in a good story, the soul is not found in the rules: it is found in the imagination.

Because Numinia is not a battle of statistics, but a symbolic exploration. It is a metaphor of the world, a mythical and digital metropolis that gathers fragments of the ancient civilisations –Egypt, Greece, Rome– and projects them towards a future full of codes, networks and collective consciousnesses. The player does not throw dice to see whether they succeed; they throw them to discover which path opens now, how the scene is transformed, what light –or shadow– shows itself.

Each session is a scene within a great narrative, and each character is a voice within the choir. Sometimes you will solve a mystery; at other times you will fight to survive at the thresholds of the city. But you will always be building: a fragment of history, a page of legacy, one more brick in the living soul of Numinia.

Whoever enters Numinia does not come to win; they come to leave a trace.

Here, everything is still to be made. And that is what is most valuable.

Welcome to Numinia.

CHAPTER TWO

HISTORY AND LEGENDS OF NUMINIA

HISTORY AND LEGENDS OF NUMINIA

The echo of the lost cities

LECTURA

« The lights of Numinia flickered like distant constellations in the immense tapestry of data that made up its network. Beneath the digital mist that shrouded the city, a figure walked in silence through the ancient corridors of the Akashic Archives. Her fingers, sheathed in gloves of dark silk, brushed the edges of a scroll suspended in the air.

—No one remembers the foundations of a city until its walls tremble.

The Pythia's voice echoed in the void, as if it rose from the mist itself. Before her, a holographic projection took shape: Holberins, the visionary who shaped Numinia's first breath, appeared bent over an ethereal plan, tracing lines that drew the avenues of the virtual city. His creation was bold, a city woven from the brilliance of human ingenuity, but also from the shadow of pride.

The scroll stirred in the air, as if shaken by an invisible wind. The image changed: now there were collapsed streets, fractured towers and the silent scream of Numinia's fall into the whirlwind of the Akasha.

—Numinia was not destroyed —the Pythia went on—. It simply... scattered.

The figure listening to her, a young traveller marked by weariness and despondency, clenched his fists.

—And how do you recover something that has been scattered among the shadows?

The Pythia smiled, and the scroll rolled itself up again, hiding its secrets.

—By following the voices that whisper among the ruins... by listening to the legends. »

A roleplaying game is much more than rules and dice rolls: it is a shared experience in which the story comes to life through the players' decisions. Narrative is the soul that gives shape to this universe, the invisible thread that connects characters, settings and conflicts in a plot that evolves organically.

In Numinia, history represents the great dimension of context: it is the very fabric of reality. Every character, every faction and every conflict is rooted in a past that shapes the present. Understanding that past not only enriches the experience of the game, but also allows the players to anticipate, interpret and alter the destiny of the city.

Numinia's narrative also acts as a bridge between two eras, between two historical moments separated by a century, yet united by their concerns, their advances and their uncertainties.

At the beginning of the twentieth century, the world underwent a radical transformation driven by the Second Industrial Revolution. The appearance of great inventions such as the radio, the cinema and the automobile, the spread of electricity and the rise of modern engineering reshaped society, awakening both wonder and fear of an uncertain technological future. Today, at the dawn of the twenty-first century, the digital revolution recreates that same scenario: advances in artificial intelligence, the development of virtual realities and global interconnection once again place human beings on a blurred frontier between the physical and the digital world, between reality and the symbolic.

Numinia stands on that threshold: a city born of technology, forged in hope and rebuilt upon its own myths. Its legends, its symbols and its secrets evoke the fears and the hopes of both eras, offering the players a setting where past and present are constantly intertwined.

The history of Numinia is the history of a city born of human ingenuity, banished to oblivion and rebuilt from its own fragments. Its origin goes back to the days of Holberins, the visionary who designed the city as a virtual network where thought, art and science converged in a single space. But the ambition that upheld its foundations also led it to collapse.

Numinia's destiny then became trapped in the Akasha, the great universal memory that holds the vestiges of all that was and all that will be. From that nebula of scattered data, the echoes of the city found their way back, reconfiguring themselves little by little in a new digital environment, laden with symbols, myths and hidden meanings.

This chapter explores the tales that gave shape to the city: the legends whispered by the Bards, the ancient texts guarded by the Exegetes, and the enigmatic prophecies murmured by the Pythias in their ethereal temples. Every story, every fragment of the past, is a key piece for understanding Numinia's present and the mysteries it still keeps within.

Legends, myths and historical accounts do not only build the setting; they are narrative tools that the Narrator can use to sow clues, create mysteries or inspire memorable moments. Because in Numinia, the echo of an ancient prophecy, the vestige of a forgotten city or the

trace of an arcane symbol may be the key to understanding the true meaning of the events yet to come.

In this chapter you will find those echoes: fragments of the past that shape the city and that, in the hands of creative players, will become the seeds of the stories yet to be written.

Because in Numinia, the past is not told; it is revealed in whispers and echoes that only those willing to listen will know how to interpret.

FRAGMENT 1: HISTORY OF NUMINIA

The history of Numinia is not only the history of the creation of a city; it is, above all, the genesis of a dream, of a magical space that takes the form of a gigantic cenacle, a place where great knowledge and wisdom can converge.

Numinia is, therefore, a decentralised universe, where information is within everyone's reach. It is, in essence, a great game board, projected onto the subtle plane through the imagination of all its citizens.

Yes, Numinia is a game: a game of riddles, enigmas and quests; but it is also a declaration of principles and values. It is a proposal for the future, a world of portals to hidden wisdom, to a universal community and to decentralised knowledge.

Because knowledge is power. And the use we make of it depends on each one of us, as players.

THE PROLEGOMENA

The Awakening of a New Era

The Second Industrial Revolution brought with it the engine of progress, as new disciplines related to technology and scientific knowledge emerged; it was also accompanied by great contributions in the fields of philosophy, psychology and others, as well as by innovative artistic movements.

This paradigm shift in society spurred the proliferation of secret societies and research groups that sought a source of primordial knowledge, a source of infinite wisdom. A source, in short, of a higher power. This pursuit of power was on the agenda of all these secret societies, whether for the common good or for hidden interests.

THE FRAMEWORK OF ACTION

A World of Secret Societies

We are speaking of an era of great advances. A nascent world, immersed in the genesis of this new era which, by definition, also generates a state of chaos and deep social inequalities.

It is a world for everyone, but dominated by elites, in which the privileged try to centralise power through the control of information.

The great crusade of the secret societies will, then, consist in decentralising knowledge; in making it, thanks to their work, accessible to all. In unveiling the universe of magical and mysterious objects, of powerful sources of knowledge. Objects that stand for keys to open doors. Doors that lead to other worlds, to other realities.

THE FIRST MOVEMENTS

The Quest for the Agora

With the technological and social boom of the last third of the nineteenth century, and following in the wake of names such as Charles Babbage, Ada Lovelace, Michael Faraday, Sophie Germain and Carl Friedrich Gauss, a wave of scientists began to become aware of the control that the privileged were trying to exert over the new cultural advances. Thus, from the work of figures such as Max Planck, Nikola Tesla, Marie Curie, Thomas Alva Edison and John Ambrose Fleming, the *Sigma* Research Centre was born, which carried out its work in parallel with spiritualist doctrines such as Anthroposophy, Ariosophy and Thelema, products of secret societies such as the Theosophical Society, the Hermetic Order of the Golden Dawn and the Ordo Templi Orientis. At first, a fraternal spirit of solidarity prevailed, full of good intentions.

From this perspective, the first attempt was made to gather the knowledge and research of all these associations in a meeting place where all the paths of wisdom would converge and all truths would merge.

THE CREATION OF THE GAME

The Five Initiates

Thus was born what they would come to know, in a nod to the hermetic codes, as «The Game».

It was by imitating the board of a game that they began to conceive the idea: the aim was to give shape to an immense environment for universal thought. It had to be an organised, well-structured place. With rules and proposals, like a game; with clear and coherent ends and objectives, like a game. A scientific, technological and decentralised city-state, free from the jurisdiction of the powers that hijacked and manipulated information for their own interests.

In the year 1920, the great game board, the mythical city of Numinia, was born at the hands of Five Initiates.

The names of these Five Initiates have been lost in time. It is known that they were five scientists, representatives of different disciplines such as physics, mathematics and biology, but of them only the nickname by which the founder of the *Sigma* Research Centre was known has survived: Holberins.

The Five Initiates established three principles that they considered an unalterable code of conduct: cosmic harmony, equanimity and curiosity.

A NEW ACROPOLIS

The Growth of Numinia

Initially, the city was represented on an enormous game board, installed in one of the halls of the Bildung Complex, built a few years earlier by the *Sigma* team somewhere in Freiburg (Germany).

Starting from this model, the Five Initiates gave their collaborators letters of citizenship, powers over the different spaces of the city and personalised research tasks. The board served, in a way, as a figurative model of a space with an abstract projection in the real world. Numinia existed and functioned only in the minds of its citizens, who shared the concept and its essence. It was, then, an environment sustained by the imagination of many minds.

THE FALL

Societies in the Shadows

Two of the most influential citizens, Aleister Crowley (of the Thelema Society) and Rudolf von Sebottendorf (of the Thule Society), using their power of persuasion, rebelled against the work of the Initiates, whom they began to brand as oligarchs, accusing them of hiding valuable secrets and knowledge in order to manipulate them at will.

The Five Initiates responded by withdrawing the powers and letters of citizenship of both occultists. Societies such as those of Crowley and Sebottendorf, founded on selfishness and a lack of values, were stigmatised.

However, a dark seed had sprouted in the city, growing slowly among its citizens. And so it was that, on 31 December 1920, the Bildung Complex of the *Sigma* Research Centre was consumed by flames in an arson attack.

Those responsible were never found, but the fire reduced every corner of the great city to ashes, taking with it every vestige of the great project that the Five Initiates had brought to

light.

Nevertheless, Holberins, foreseeing the disaster, and thanks to his research in quantum physics and to the findings obtained from the study of the *Codex Hermopolitanus*, signed by G. W. Athanasius, managed to alter the flows of time to project a residual image of the city into a space that the theosophists knew as the Akashic Records, which shifted across multiple dimensions.

THE REBIRTH

The Conjunction of the Oracles

A hundred years had to pass, from its first creation, before the name of Numinia was spoken again.

In the year 2020, beneath the turbulent currents of the so-called Third Industrial Revolution, within a new technological paradigm, the geophysicist Alexander Reis detected a singular record in the waves of his seismograph while he was studying the seismic movements over the tomb of Petosiris at el-Ashmunein (Egypt).

The strange seismogram turned out to be surprisingly similar to the oscillations that the mathematician Ian Stewart had obtained by iterating the formula $2x^2-1$ to demonstrate its chaotic behaviour ¹ :

Reis published this anomaly in a modest online study that went completely unnoticed by the scientific community. However, it drew the attention of a group of five researchers, calling themselves the Oracles, who recognised in the formula used by Stewart the same one that Athanasius had employed a hundred years earlier in the *Codex Hermopolitanus* to develop his gear mechanism ² .

This group of Oracles then revived the old ideas of the Five Initiates, thus giving rise to the rebirth of the city of Numinia.

¹ · Stewart (1996:24)

² · See the section titled *The Shadow of Athanasius*, in this same chapter.

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Gathered near the necropolis of Tuna el-Gebel, the Oracles discovered Athanasius's mechanism in full operation and, thanks to its dynamics, managed to open a space-time breach to find the city-state: the colossal game board that had been consumed by flames on New Year's Eve 1920, on which the model of Numinia had been laid out.

The Oracles then connected with the Akashic Records, located in the multidimensional space proposed by quantum physics. There, they found the residual image of Numinia.

Repopulating it and bringing it back to life would be an arduous task. To achieve it, they would need to attract a great number of guilds and form new factions of knowledge that would help to raise the city...

FRAGMENT 2: GENESIS OF THE KHEPRIS

Among the many symbols that populated Holberins's imagination, few proved as powerful and enduring as the figure of the Egyptian god Khepri. Depicted as a scarab beetle pushing the solar disc, Khepri symbolised the eternal cycle of rebirth: the passage from night to day, from oblivion to memory, from chaos to order.

For Holberins, this symbol took on a special meaning in the context of his great work. Like the Phoenix in Greek mythology, Khepri embodied the idea of rebirth after destruction, of the resurgence of what had seemed lost. Just as the sun rises again each morning after being devoured by darkness, Holberins imagined Numinia as a city capable of being reborn after its fall, perpetuating itself like an echo in the flow of time.

This symbolism not only shaped the ideological construction of Numinia but also inspired the creation of the enigmatic Khepris, entities that embody the very essence of transformation and rebirth. As guardians of lost memory and guides of souls through the veil of time, the Khepris became key pieces in the city's complex symbolic architecture.

In them took shape Holberins's belief that nothing ever disappears entirely: every fragment of knowledge, every memory and every lost story can, like Khepri's sun, find its way back to the light.

What follows is the story of how the Khepris became part of Numinia's history, until they were its guardians and its symbols.

THE CREATION OF LIFE

Encounter with the Solar Scarab

According to the latest known records of his life, Holberins, the founding father of the city of Numinia, began to attach a certain importance to the figure of Khepri in the early 1910s.

Khepri is an Egyptian deity who, in the form of a dung beetle pushing the solar disc, represents creation and rebirth, the constant transformation of existence.

The importance this figure acquired for Holberins may be linked to a recurring need to reinvent himself, given that his fascination with Khepri coincided with the zenith of a life marked by change and by the search for spiritual truth through science: quantum mechanics and the mathematics of chaos, driven forward by scientists such as Planck and Poincaré.

This admiration should be seen in relation to the fire that consumed the Bildung Complex on New Year's Eve 1920. The complex housed the *Sigma* Scientific Research Centre and was a cultural landmark of worldwide renown; the only thing saved from it was an allegorical sculpture representing the spiritual forces that move the world.

The threats that preceded this event strengthened Holberins's conviction that his project had to be rebuilt through transformation.

THE SHADOW OF ATHANASIOS

The Fragment of the *Codex Hermopolitanus*

But there is a little-known fact that is essential to this story: at some unknown date between 1918 and 1920, a strange manuscript came into Holberins's hands, signed by one G. W. Athanasius, an enigmatic German hermeneut about whom very little is known.

Athanasius may have been a disciple of Wilhelm Dilthey, the celebrated philosopher, historian, sociologist and psychologist who, like Athanasius himself, was also a prominent hermeneut. Dilthey's approaches to the human sciences and to worldviews had an enormous influence on the scientific and spiritual thought of the early twentieth century; and Athanasius's syncretic philosophy, which built bridges between modern science, esotericism and mythology, shared many points of convergence with the vision of Numinia's founder.

In any case, this text (supposedly part of an unknown *Codex Hermopolitanus*) delves into the figure of Khepri as the builder of the universe and proposes the design of a cosmic engine based on a machine of gears whose activity is governed by the mathematics of chaos and by quantum mechanics, disciplines that Henri Poincaré and Max Planck had begun to develop in the first two decades of the twentieth century.

All of this was, without a doubt, a revelation to Holberins. That is why Athanasius's manuscript must be included in this story³.

THE MACHINE OF THE COSMOS

As Above, So Below

Given the impact this text must have had on Holberins's work, part of which took shape in the project of the virtual city of Numinia, whose model rested in the Bildung Complex in Freiburg (Germany), it is not hard to understand the enormous importance the Egyptian deity Khepri acquired within that project. Its transformative nature and its symbolism, tied to rebirth and to rising up out of refuse, brought clarity to the enigmatic scientist.

Holberins supposedly commissioned a small-scale replica of the gear machine Athanasius described in his manuscript, and it was built into the model of Numinia itself. This machine came to represent the heart of the city: inside the wheel of the athanor was placed a tiny mechanical dung beetle, designed to produce movement through the cumulative action of its front legs, so that the gearwork turned constantly, day and night, driven solely by the beetle's own kinetic energy.

In this way, the whole dynamic of Numinia's vast and complex structure depended on the activity of a minuscule creature.

³ See the section titled *The Shadow of Athanasius*, in this same chapter.

FROM AMONG THE DEAD

The Gestation of the Khepris

It was rumoured that, besides the allegorical sculpture already mentioned, the gear machine whose movement never stopped had also been saved from the fire of New Year's Eve 1920.

According to these stories, Holberins managed to rescue the mechanism and keep it hidden in a safe place, unknown to anyone else. After his death, however, and as time went by, a legend began to spread claiming that the mechanical device had been buried somewhere in the necropolis of Tuna el-Gebel (ancient Hermopolis Magna, of the New Kingdom of Ancient Egypt), near the Tomb of Petosiris, where there is a discreet bas-relief depiction of Osiris-Khepri.

It is said that its ceaseless activity for more than a century generated a magical energy field, out of which emerged the first Khepris, who would eventually become the guardians and symbols of the city of Numinia.

When, in the year 2020, the Oracles performed the ritual on the very ruins of Tuna el-Gebel to open a space-time rift connecting them with the lost city of Numinia, they discovered in the catacombs of the tomb of Petosiris an astonishing colony of 55 Khepris.

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From that moment on, these first Khepris would be known, forevermore, as the Primordials.

FRAGMENT 3: THE SHADOW OF ATHANASIUS

The Athanasius Manuscript is an enigmatic Hermetic text attributed to G. W. Athanasius, a German hermeneut of whom almost nothing is known. Although the manuscript bears no explicit date, certain internal remarks, together with the historical context of its discovery, suggest that it was written in the first days of the 20th century.

This text is a scientific, symbolic and esoteric exploration that weaves together scientific principles of the early 20th century with knowledge from the Kabbalah, numerology and Egyptian mythology, presenting the god Khepri as the *Watchmaker of the Cosmos*, a figure who represents the eternal cycle of death, rebirth and creation. Through complex mechanical and mathematical analogies, Athanasius describes a universe governed by a delicate balance, symbolised by the perpetual motion of a scarab that drives the gearwork of the world.

The manuscript is not only a work of philosophical speculation but also a testament to the deep bond between occult knowledge and the scientific thought of the age, suggesting that the universal principle of order and life resides in chaos itself.

LECTURA

Fragment of the Codex Hermopolitanus, signed on an unknown date by G. W. Athanasius

THE TOHU VA-BOHU

The Movement of the Universe

«The mechanists of the 19th century, influenced by Laplace's determinism, were convinced that knowing the origin and trajectory of a celestial body made it possible to predict its fate

unequivocally. For them, the universe moved in a linear and regular fashion, governed by a cosmic watchmaker of absolute precision.

However, the arrival of Max Planck's quantum mechanics and Poincaré's mathematics of chaos toppled this reassuring view, revealing irregularities beneath every appearance of order and dangerous relative errors in dynamical systems; dark spots which, under the action of that chance which is nothing but the measure of human ignorance, are violently amplified until the whole structure ends up collapsing. Yet, despite the initial terror their theories seem to provoke, in reality they tend to show that perturbations only partially destroy regularity. They introduce turbulence and chaos, but, seen from another perspective, they constitute an alternative form of order. In some way, there is a drive to find a new structure beneath chaotic motion, to discover its regularity within it, even if that regularity is merely a stationary state that tends towards instability.

It so happens that, in the first phase of nature, we observe a curious antinomy between that which transforms and that which endures; beneath every dynamic there is something that tends to vanish and something that reveals itself as immutable, uniting the discourses of Heraclitus and Parmenides. Thus science meets philosophy once again.

Each movement prompts the next to take shape in an unrepeatable way; yet, across the system as a whole, all movements tend to seek the same point of attraction, as though it were a funnel in which two drops of water, which never follow an identical path, nonetheless end up flowing into the same channel: the mouth of the funnel. In the great funnel of the cosmos (the universal attractor), all the unpredictable possibilities tending towards infinity come to pass. Therefore, the calculation of any energy in motion is inevitably subject to the relationship between regularity and indeterminism, for we discover that within the dynamics of this energy there are unforeseeable variables that end up being amplified uncontrollably, producing unexpected results within a graph which nevertheless appears regular and analogous in its iteration.

In other words, and as Poincaré observed, on a large scale all perturbations tend to stabilise, revealing behaviours analogous to small-scale phenomena, a proposition that can also be observed in the Koch curve:

Thus the new science, walking hand in hand with esotericism, does nothing but express the same analogous relationships that Hermes Trismegistus observed more than two thousand years ago between the microcosm and the macrocosm: as above, so below.»

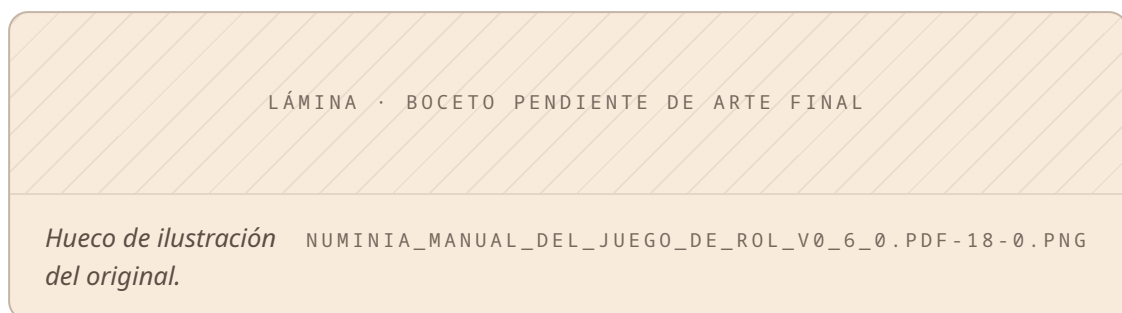
THE WHEELS OF CHAOS

Emulating Antikythera

«If, then, we conceive a mechanistic system to explain the logic of cosmic motion, we can find an eccentric relationship between its chaotic movement and the regularity that ends up settling into place on the theoretical plane.

Our points of reference are the gear mechanisms so popular among the thinkers of ancient Greece (such as the mechanism found on the Greek island of Antikythera, probably dating from 150 BC), which sought to explain evolutionary motion, in which natural elements are subject to predetermined parameters according to the number of teeth on each wheel, their perimeters, radii and diameters, the position they occupy and the analogy in their rotational movement.

Our own gear mechanism bases its system on the relationship between that which is above and that which is below (which, as we have noted, display analogous cosmic movements according to the Hermetic view, ratified by new geometric proposals such as the aforementioned Koch curve); the microcosm and the macrocosm will form the two main wheels of our gearwork, driven by a third wheel, which we shall call the athanor.



We give it this name because of its function as the link between both worlds (just like the alchemical athanor, in which universal consciousness was cooked). The athanor wheel will thus connect the wheel of the microcosm with that of the macrocosm, stirring them in their motion.

The working of our mechanism is defined by the difference between the number of teeth on each wheel. To assign these numbers we shall turn to numerology, seeking to start from the universal number, the primary and absolute number, the number that represents essential universality. Kabbalistic numerology holds, as Helena Blavatsky reminds us, that numbers were revealed to men by the gods, and that these numbers, turned into music, caused the world to arise out of chaos.

For the Kabbalah, 9 is the sacred number, and only one other number stands above it in the power it holds: the number 7, the bridge between the divine and the human, between heaven and earth, between spirit and matter, since it is the sum of the sacred 3 and the earthly 4.

Moreover, according to Hippocrates, 7 is the dispenser of life and the driving force of all transformations. We shall explain this nature and its relationship with our device later on, but it is without doubt the number that represents the universal synthesis from which we must begin.

To the wheel of the microcosm, then, we shall assign 7 teeth.

Now, to mark the increase, we look for a chaotic stimulant that simulates the irregularity of cosmic motion; accordingly, we select the formula $2x^2-1$, an equation which, when iterated, produces chaos in a way as inevitable as it is unpredictable, a phenomenon that can be observed on Dalton's adding and listing machine after a certain number of operations and iterations.

Thus $2x^2-1$, when $x=7$, yields 97.

We come across a curious numerological coincidence: when the number 7 is subjected to the formula of chaos, the universal synthesis, the number 7, reappears, preceded by the number 9, the sacred number according to the Kabbalah.

Now we look for the numerological synthesis of the number of teeth on the athanor wheel, reducing its digits: $9+7=16$; $1+6=7$.

Surprisingly, the reduced number of the athanor's teeth once again gives us universality.

But let us press on. Now we increase again to find the number of teeth on the wheel of the macrocosm, for which we subject the number of the athanor's teeth to the same formula: $2x^2-1$, when $x=97$.

The result is 18817.

A new curiosity: the universal number, 7, preceded by a palindromic number made up of two evocations of the number 9, the sacred number (which already preceded the number 7 in the athanor): 18 and 81.

$$18 = 9+9$$

$$81 = 9 \times 9$$

Furthermore, in numerological synthesis: $1+8=9$ and $8+1=9$.

Evidently, 1881, reduced, is equivalent to 9.

But let us now work out the reduction of the digits of the macrocosm's number of teeth as a whole: $1+8+8+1+7=25$; and $2+5=7$.

Once again, the reduced number of teeth returns us to universality.

We now have our mechanism, made up of three wheels that represent the movement of the cosmos: microcosm, athanor and macrocosm, whose wheels (with 7, 97 and 18817 teeth, respectively), arrived at through a mathematical formula that generates chaos (in the form

of unpredictable iterations), turn out to be completely analogous and end up leading, through numerological synthesis, to the same point: the universality of the number 7.

Now let us look at their perimeters, taking any measurement for the teeth and the gaps between them, since the behaviour of their relationship will not change with this convention. Let us imagine that each tooth measures 2 cm, and that each gap between teeth also measures 2 cm.

Thus the wheel of the microcosm has 7 teeth and 6 gaps, which gives it a perimeter of 26 cm. Reducing its digits: $2+6 = 8$.

For the athanor, which has 97 teeth and 96 gaps, we obtain a perimeter of 386 cm. Reducing its digits: $3+8+6 = 17$; and $1+7 = 8$.

For the macrocosm, which has 18817 teeth and 18816 gaps, the perimeter is 75266 cm, which reduced gives: $7+5+2+6+6 = 26$; and $2+6 = 8$.

The syntheses of all three perimeters lead to the same point: the number 8.

But the truly critical behaviour of the gearwork is seen in the dynamics of the wheels and in the comparison between the number of turns each one makes.

Let us imagine that we place at the centre of the athanor a mechanism with the shape and behaviour of a dung beetle, and that this mechanism turns the wheel indefinitely, connected to the kinetic motion of the wheels in a feedback system.

We begin with the movement of the athanor wheel, as the starting principle of the dynamics between the microcosm and the macrocosm.

For the athanor to complete one full turn, the microcosm must complete 13.857143 turns, while the macrocosm completes only a tiny fraction of a full turn: 0.00515491.

Our system descends into chaos: the numbers destabilise and cease to be whole. But this is logical, given that our point of reference is the athanor.

What interests us is to test the relationship between the microcosm and the macrocosm. Let us take the largest wheel as our reference to save time.

When the macrocosm has completed one full revolution, the athanor has completed 193.98969 turns, and since the microcosm completes 13.857143 turns for each turn of the athanor, for one revolution of the macrocosm the microcosm completes 2688.14287 turns.

These unstable figures show no clear patterns.

For 2 turns of the macrocosm, the microcosm makes 5376.2857 turns, and the athanor 387.97938. New decimal figures that reveal a growing instability.

Is the relationship between the microcosm and the macrocosm, then, an arithmetically unbalanced one? Do cosmic dynamics behave in a disorderly way, without patterns or analogies?

At this point, we are inclined to think of chaotic behaviour in the dynamics of the universe.

But we are not finished...

When the macrocosm completes 3 turns, the microcosm makes 8064.4286 turns, and the athanor 581.96907 turns. The figures remain unstable.

We assume that this instability will grow with the number of turns (since there is a relationship between the distance travelled and the time elapsed). The relationship between one wheel and another, and their inseparable bond with the connecting disc, become tinged with irregularity and indeterminism.

There seems to be neither order nor periodicity.

But what happens if we take a small leap and look at the results when the macrocosm completes 7 turns? The athanor has made 1357.9278 turns, but with the microcosm the logic reveals a spectacular behaviour: the wheel of the microcosm contains itself within the wheel of the macrocosm, and the two are connected through a mathematical relationship: when the macrocosm completes 7 turns, this dynamic stabilises, for the number of turns made by the microcosm becomes a whole number, and it is none other than 18817.

Therefore, when the number of turns of the macrocosm is equal to the number of teeth of the microcosm, the number of turns of the microcosm is equal to the number of teeth of the macrocosm. Both return, in number of teeth as well as in number of turns, to universality, to the number 7.

In this inversion of values, the idea of the reverse trajectory in the evolution of the universe manifests itself, advancing towards its own reflection. But what happens after this stationary state of stability? The system destabilises once more.

For 8 turns of the macrocosm, we obtain 21505.143 for the microcosm and 1551.9175 for the athanor. Thus order and chaos seem to intertwine in a game of balance and imbalance. But we sense that if the dynamic stabilised at one particular point, it will do so again, ruling out the chance of an isolated event and revealing a regular pattern. And indeed, the system stabilises again when the macrocosm completes 14 turns:

The athanor has completed 2715.8557 turns.

The microcosm has made 37634, once again a whole number.

The numerological peculiarity we observe from this point on is that the reduced sums of the digits of the turns of the macrocosm and the microcosm, each time they stabilise, also

coincide:

$$14 \rightarrow 1+4 = 5$$

$$37634 \rightarrow 3+7+6+3+4 = 23; \text{ and } 2+3 = 5$$

When the macrocosm completes 21 turns ($2+1 = 3$), the athanor makes 4073.7835 turns and the microcosm 56451 ($5+6+4+5+1 = 21$; and $2+1 = 3$).

When the macrocosm completes 28 turns ($2+8 = 10$, and $1+0 = 1$), the athanor completes 5431.7113 turns and the microcosm 75268 ($7+5+2+6+8 = 28$, and $2+8 = 10$, and $1+0 = 1$).

The patterns lie in the numerical sequences; the system stabilises every 7 turns (universality), and the syntheses of the numbers descend every 7 turns in a sequence decreasing by 2: 7, 5, 3, 1.

And if we reduce the digits of this series, we get: $7+5+3+1 = 16$; and $1+6 = 7$; once again, universality.

This is our pattern of regularity for the chaotic workings of the universe.

It is not hard to sense, behind this pattern, new disorders and patterns not yet glimpsed, tending towards infinity. But the fundamental behaviour is that the athanor, which moves both worlds and which provides this pattern of order for their movement, never stabilises in synchrony with the microcosm and the macrocosm.

The athanor thus reveals itself as a chaotic origin, one that awakens a cosmic structure at once probabilistic and regular, in which accidents, far from being a chance effect, represent, on the contrary and irrefutably, the purest effect of a cause.»

KHEPRI AND THE DEAD

The Watchmaker of the Cosmos

«Let us return to our dung beetle inside the athanor, turning the wheel into infinity; in ancient Egypt, the scarab depicted in hieroglyphs was called Khepri, phonetically Jepri, and thereby acquired a priestly character. Jepri was, like the beetle that creates form out of its ball of waste (and whose eggs hatch in carrion), the dispenser of life and the symbol of transformation, of rebirth, of the cycle of death and resurrection.

We see clear coincidences with the connotations the Kabbalah attributes to the number 7. Our scarab, which eternally turns the wheel of the athanor, also represents universality. From this perspective, there is a version of Jepri that takes on a paradigmatic stance: the scarab turning the solar disc as the foundation of the universe. In this variant, Jepri turns Osiris, suggesting at the same time dawn and dusk, the beginning and the end.

Thus the scarab took on a divine form, linked to the aforementioned solar deity, Osiris. Depicted in this way, he can be found in various places, such as in the final sequence of the *Book of Gates* (on the sarcophagus of Pharaoh Seti I) or in the tomb of Petosiris (necropolis of Tuna el-Gebel); or mentioned in various texts, such as the *Book of the Dead*, under the name Osiris-Jepri (prayer 154 of the book).

None other than our Watchmaker of the Cosmos. As we confirmed with our artefact, life is born of chaos. And if only to satisfy the magic of synchronicity, or the divine nature of numbers –given, according to the Kabbalah, to men by the gods–, let us return to numerology and subject this Watchmaker of the Cosmos, Osiris-Jepri, to the calculation of gematria, the Hebrew discipline that designates the combination of the letters of a word in order to understand its numerical value.

There are different conversion methods based on the correspondences between the Hebrew and Latin alphabets, from those originally developed by the Kabbalah to the one used by the Pythagoreans, but the oldest is that of Chaldean-Hebrew numerology:

The 9 does not appear in this conversion because, on the one hand, it is the sacred number and, on the other, the Hebrew letters that carry this value have no equivalent in our alphabet. As we have mentioned, there are other conversion systems, but this is the one that offers the greatest reliability, being the oldest and the most studied by the most reputed Kabbalists and occultists, such as Cagliostro himself.

To find the number that corresponds to a verbal sign, we must transpose the letters of the name into numbers and, from the result obtained, reduce the digits just as we did earlier with the gears of our artefact.

Osiris Jepri thus gives us this result:

731213 15821

Now we proceed to the numerological synthesis, as we already know: adding all the digits and reducing them until we obtain a single digit:

$$7+3+1+2+1+3+1+5+8+2+1 = 34 \rightarrow 3+4 = 7$$

Or alternatively:

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$$7+3+1+2+1+3 = 17$$

$$1+5+8+2+1 = 17$$

$$1+7 = 8$$

$$1+7 = 8$$

$$8+8 = 16 \rightarrow 1+6 = 7$$

Thanks to numerological wisdom, drawn from Egyptian mythology and the Kabbalah, we can confirm that the nature of our Watchmaker of the Cosmos also contains universality, the same universality of the number 7, the same that drives the gears of our artefact.

We may even state that our scarab is not only the watchmaker of the cosmos; it is, above all, the one who certifies the succession of all universal cycles, who renews life, who constitutes creation and rebirth. It is, then, the very builder of the universe.»

FRAGMENT 4: THE DARK AGE

The Dark Age is the uncertain abyss that opens after the Pre-Ashen Age: the fall of the first city of Numinia, consumed by the fire that devoured the Bildung Complex. From then on, the city ceased to exist on the tangible plane and sank into the flow of the Akasha, where time is measured not in years but in eternal currents of consciousness. What for the Earth meant a century unfolded in the Akashic Records as boundless eras, an interlude of shadows and enigmas.

This period, lacking any direct witnesses, has reached us only wrapped in legends. It is said that in that time the Black Engineers emerged, masters of hidden code who preserved the lost fragments of the great board; there is also talk of the Mediators of the Prism, weavers of paths between dimensions who sustained the echo of the city in the limbo of the Akasha.

Alongside them, the stories whisper of enigmatic figures: the Chronothecaries, guardians of time and of the rhythm of the cosmos; the Cartographers of the Wind, who drew maps of

impossible routes across the vastness of the void; and the Armonauts, interpreters of the lingering echo of the melodies that once vibrated in the walls of the lost city.

These legends are scattered fragments, distorted echoes of a time in which memory is no more than a blurred reflection in the river of the Akasha. And yet, from that fabric of myths arose the evolved species, who managed to translate those echoes into words, symbols and documents that would certify the rebirth of Numinia and bear record of events from the first written documents onward, bringing the Dark Age to an end and giving birth to the Golden Age.

Of those first written documents, the *Song of Shadows and Light* is one of the most revealing, offering many legends from the time when Numinia was beginning to rediscover its own existence. Its origin dates back to the dawn of the Golden Age, a period in which the inhabitants of the city-state began the effort to give written form to the fragmentary echoes of their legendary past.

The manuscript was found among the arid expanses of the Anthracite Deserts, which surround Numinia and where the blackened ruins of the past lie buried beneath layers of dust and oblivion. The manuscript was found in an underground chamber hidden beneath the remains of an ancient tower, known to the locals as the Needle of Silence. The explorers who found it relate that the chamber was marked with forgotten symbols, and that, in the centre of the room, surrounded by shards of darkened crystal, rested an obsidian pedestal. There, inside a lead-sealed urn, lay the manuscript: its pages, blackened by the passage of time, still kept traces of silver ink that shone faintly in the light.

The text is attributed to an anonymous scribe, possibly one of the first storytellers who tried to rescue the scattered echoes of the Dark Age. Its content is an amalgam of myth and history. More than a chronological record, the *Song of Shadows and Light* is a mythic poem, a fusion of legend and memory that recounts the awakening of Numinia after its disappearance into the currents of the Akasha. Its verses evoke figures such as the Black Engineers, the Mediators of the Prism and the enigmatic Bearers of the Veil, who are credited with both the preservation and the distortion of the city in its ethereal state.

This text not only represents an attempt to reconstruct Numinia's past, but also symbolises its first inhabitants' longing to find identity and purpose after generations of uncertainty. In every word vibrates the echo of a people being reborn, trying to turn their myths into a history that could be told.

Below, we offer some fragments of the manuscript that are, by virtue of their content, especially relevant:

LAND OF LIGHT, HOUR OF DARKNESS

LECTURA

« In the beginning, when Numinia was still an echo lost in the river of the Akasha, the city had neither form nor foundations. It was only a murmur of ideas dancing among the currents of time, a wandering reflection searching for a place to settle. »

The Birth of the Watchmaker

The ancients say it was the Watchmaker of the Cosmos, the golden scarab of infinite legs, who first drew the lines of the great board. Its limbs were like needles weaving the web of destiny, and with each turn of the wheel it shaped the paths along which the inhabitants of Numinia would walk.

The Watchmaker did not work alone. With it came the Mediators of the Prism, guardians of colour and form, who suspended bridges between dimensions to sustain the faint reflection of the city. There, in the darkness of the Akasha, the Black Engineers also arose, weavers of hidden code, who forged the Gates of Memory so that Numinia would not fade into oblivion. And more mysterious figures too, such as the Chronothecaries and the Anacharchids.

The Time of Mirages

In those days the city had neither bodies nor names; instead it glided like a shadow imitating the shape of the great cities of the earthly world. It was then that the Whisperers of Cycles arrived, who gave rhythm to the seasons, to the passing of the wind and to the echo of forgotten words. With them appeared the Cartographers of the Wind, who wrote invisible maps upon the breeze, tracing paths by which souls could return to Numinia.

But not everything that dwelt in that half-light was noble. Stories are told of the Bearers of the Veil, known as Umbrílegos, beings born of the crack between dimensions, who warped memory and turned paths into labyrinths with no way out. Their shadows spread over the warp of the city, and wherever they passed, reality shattered into mirages.

The Rise of the Five Fragments

When the silence of the Dark Age began to lift, five fragments of consciousness emerged from the fabric of the Akasha. Each of these fragments took shape as an ideal: the Artificer, the Narrator, the Guardian, the Thinker and the Explorer. Their names have been forgotten, but their echoes persist in the stories told today.

It was the Narrator who carved in stone the first words bearing witness to Numinia's awakening; it was the Thinker who discovered that the board was not merely a game, but a door connecting worlds; it was the Artificer who shaped the first tools to rebuild the city; it was the Guardian who defended its foundations from the shadows that still prowled; and it was the Explorer who opened the paths so that others might follow in their footsteps.

The Golden Dawn

When the city rose again, its walls were only a projection, but its spirit was already as solid as rock. And, at the centre of the great board, the golden scarab kept turning the wheel of the athanor, measuring time in cycles and renewing, with each turn, the life of Numinia.

LECTURA

Thus Numinia arose from the shadows, born of game, myth and memory. What once was is not lost, for in every corner of the city a story lies hidden, and in every story, a truth still waiting to be told. »

THE BLACK ENGINEERS

One of the most striking manifestations of the Dark Age lies in the extravagant architecture inherited from that era. Many of these buildings are known to have been created by an independent guild of builders and architects known as the Black Engineers.

Little is known about the Black Engineers; most of what is said about them is nothing more than invention or, at best, speculation. They may have begun as a clandestine group of scientists who protected and handled ancient knowledge, but over time they are thought to have gained great prestige, occasionally working for various entities and institutions of Numinia. To this day, the logic behind many of their designs and constructions remains incomprehensible.

The Black Engineers are responsible, for example, for the reproduction of the Labyrinth of Crete, which the guild adapted and rebuilt according to its own strange criteria (this labyrinth now forms part of the introduction for new inhabitants of Numinia, at the Gates of the city, and is visited by new members of the community, who face its challenges as part of their integration into the city).

One of the most remarkable phenomena attributed to the Black Engineers is that of the Monolith Clusters. Each of these structures is made up of several fused monoliths of varying heights, carved from flat-coloured stones such as alabaster, steatite or haematite.

The function of these strange constructions remains unknown; some believe they are monuments for prayer and ritual practice, although the most thorough and reliable studies suggest they are containers holding great blocks of information about the past and the universe, which have yet to be deciphered.

According to this theory, the mysterious melodic sounds that can be heard emanating from the inner core of these Monolith Clusters when one rests an ear against the stone constitute an unknown, encrypted code that would be transmitting the ancient information stored in the different blocks. Thus, the closing melodic phrases of one of these clusters would be linked to the opening melodic phrases of another, thereby connecting all the Monolith Clusters into a single gigantic, millennia-old construction made up of multiple nodes scattered across different blocks.

THE WANDERING SONG OF THE ARMONAUT

In the uncertain days of the Dark Age, when Numinia was no more than an echo in the void of the Akasha, stories shattered like broken mirrors and memory drifted aimlessly. It was then that the Armonauts arose, guardians of song and melody, who wove the scattered fragments of the past into songs that travelled through the city like wind across the desert.

It is said that the first Armonaut was a wandering soul who, lost in the corridors of the Akasha, heard the echo of lost voices. There, among whispers and laments, it found a forgotten melody: the primordial chord that resonated in the very mesh of the city. That traveller returned from the shadows with music on its lips and, from then on, its song became the compass of the wanderers and the flame that lit the darkness of Numinia.

The Armonauts were neither warriors nor sages; their power lay in the sung word and in harmony. Each of their chords held a hidden teaching; each ballad concealed the keys to understanding the secret history of the city. They were the first to recount the feats of the Black Engineers, the first to warn of the labyrinths of the Veil, and the only ones able to remember the names of the five fragments that guided the rebirth of Numinia.

Their greatest legacy was the creation of the Watchmaker's Canticle, a melody composed of countless scattered verses which, when performed in the correct order, reveal the location of hidden routes, encrypted symbols and secrets that the city still keeps in its darkest corners.

The soul of the Armonaut resides in its instrument: the Lyre of Nyx, whose strings of solid light vibrate with echoes of the past and reverberate with the memory of Numinia. It is said that when the Armonaut strums its strings in the gloom of a forgotten street, the shadows stop to listen and the old voices of the Akasha answer, bringing with them memories buried by time.

In their wandering song, the Armonauts not only preserved the legends of the Dark Age, but also sowed in the minds of the citizens the keys to rediscovering the soul of Numinia. Thus,

in every chord, in every word, in every echo of the Lyre of Nyx, Numinia remembers who it was, and prepares for what is yet to be.

THE MEDIATORS OF THE PRISM

When the light of Numinia splintered in the currents of the Akasha and the city was reduced to a spectre of scattered data, it was the Mediators of the Prism who walked among its invisible ruins, weaving paths where there had been only shadows and emptiness.

It is said that the Mediators of the Prism were born of chaos, when the forms of the city broke into a thousand impossible reflections. They were not so much builders as interpreters of the folds of the world, figures wrapped in veils of light who could see reality divided into beams of colour. Where others saw only ruins, they perceived paths; where there was silence, they heard scattered echoes; and where only emptiness remained, they found threads of light that could guide the new inhabitants on their way back. Back towards the past, towards a future raised upon the past.

The ancient tales say that the Mediators of the Prism were the first to find the lost fragments of Numinia's great board, scattered like shards of crystal across the infinite flow of the Akasha. Following the glimmers that vibrated at the margins of reality, they managed to weave those fragments into hidden patterns that only they understood.

Each Mediator carried a labyrinthine mirror, a sacred tool capable of splitting light into infinite colours. By turning the mirror in the faint breeze of the Akasha, they could glimpse forgotten routes, sealed passages and doors that still vibrated with the memory of the lost city. It is said that those mirrors could also reflect the shadows of things that had not yet happened, allowing the Mediators to glimpse probable futures and to keep Numinia from being lost to oblivion forever.

But the Mediators of the Prism were not merely explorers of time and light. They became custodians of balance, for they knew that the memory of Numinia, broken into fragments, could only be restored through harmony. And so they devoted their days to guiding the wanderers along the paths of the Akasha, teaching them to recognise the symbols hidden in the play of colours that the universe cast upon the city.

Some say that, to this day, the remains of Numinia's great board lie concealed beneath a complex network of hidden paths, visible only to those who possess a mirror like that of the Mediators. Others claim that these enigmatic guides still roam the borders of the city, using their mirrors to protect the secrets that only light is able to reveal.

LECTURA

"For where there is shadow, there is light. And where light scatters into a thousand reflections, only the Mediator's eye can discern the true path."

THE ANACHARCHIDS OF THE BLIND SPOT

Among the most enigmatic figures to come down from the Dark Age are the Anacharchids, an exclusively female lineage of visionaries whose gift consists in beholding what no other inhabitant of Numinia could perceive: the Blind Spot.

The ancients understood that every system necessarily contained regions that escaped its own observation. Wherever a structure could not behold itself, an indeterminacy arose; and from that indeterminacy were born disturbances capable of spreading through the gearwork, upsetting everything it sought to order. For some, the Blind Spot was an unavoidable imperfection. For the Anacharchids, however, it was part of the very movement of the world: not the failure of order, but that which forced order to transform itself.

The Anacharchids cannot directly show what they see. Their visions appear to them as incomplete forms, impossible relationships and symbols that do not yet possess meaning. For this reason, they transform everything they behold into oracular riddles. Solving one of these enigmas is not simply a matter of uncovering a hidden answer. The solution reveals what the system has been unable to recognise, and allows the indeterminacy to be integrated into its own workings. A Blind Spot may then fade, shift, reverse or disappear, although others will inevitably end up manifesting somewhere else in the gearwork.

For this reason, during the Dark Age the riddles of the Anacharchids were considered matters of survival. Wherever one of their questions appeared, something remained unresolved in the structure of Numinia.

The origin of this strange lineage is lost among the tales of the first settlers. The Anacharchids' own tradition attributes their birth to Arithrea Khebron, called the First Anacharchid of the Blind Spot, although no surviving document allows us to state with certainty that this woman ever really existed.

Legend tells that when the Mediators of the Prism and the Bearers of the Threshold tried to raise the first settlements on the still unstable lands of Numinia, nothing remained in the form it was given. Stone cracked, mud crumbled and structures changed before they could be finished. The three-wheeled gearwork that turned beside the first foundations could not master the disturbances, because it was unable to perceive the regions of indeterminacy that its own movement produced.

It was then that, somewhere remote in the Anthracite Desert, the ashes began to spin.

At first it was barely a whirlwind over the scorched earth. The tales say that this turbulence was the visible manifestation of the movement caused by the Blind Spot itself, as if an invisible membrane had been stirred from some place lying beyond reality. The whirlwind slowly crossed the desert and, as it advanced, it grew and took on substance. The ashes drew first a silhouette, then limbs, a face, a figure. By the time it reached the place where the three wheels of the gearwork turned, it already had the shape of a tall, sovereign woman.

She uttered only one name: Arithrea.

It is said that she barely possessed consciousness when she came before the builders. Yet, as she turned the empty sockets of her eyes towards the gearwork, she beheld what the mechanism itself was unable to behold, and understood at one and the same time her nature and her destiny.

Then she posed the first riddle.

The builders were slow to understand that Arithrea was not offering them a prophecy. She was showing them, through symbols, what they themselves could not see. When they solved the enigma, one of the disturbances that prevented the city from being raised ceased. Then came a second riddle, and a third. Little by little, the settlers learned to recognise the dynamics of chaos, and were able to work with it instead of fighting it. The earth held the foundations. The stone kept its shape. The wood stopped twisting in their hands. And Numinia could begin to rise.

Only later did the tales grant that woman the epithet Khebron, a word of uncertain meaning in the lost tongues of the Dark Age that is usually translated as «the Visionary», although some ancient interpretations propose meanings closer to «she who beholds the invisible» or «she who glimpses the void».

The Anacharchids who appeared afterwards considered themselves heirs to that first vision. Over time they came to form a semi-religious lineage of women devoted to recognising Blind Spots and translating their manifestations into enigmas. They never claim that chaos ought to be defeated. For them, every structure needs what it does not yet understand, just as all learning needs the error that forces one to abandon a certainty.

Of Arithrea Khebron there remains no grave, writing or testimony that would allow the woman to be told apart from the myth. In the Ruins of old Numinia, however, there still stands a colossal basalt statue depicting a woman with empty eye sockets, one hand outstretched and the other resting on an enormous cogwheel.

Some claim it was raised by the first inhabitants in gratitude to the woman who made it possible to build the city. Others believe it never depicted anyone and was erected much later as a tribute to the lineage of the Anacharchids. There are even tales according to which no hand ever sculpted it, and it was the abrasive winds of the Anthracite Desert that, over countless cycles, tore out of a mass of basalt the form that had always been locked within it.

The Anacharchids have never considered it necessary to settle the question. Perhaps because there are enigmas whose purpose is not to have an answer.

THE CHRONOTHECARIES

Few figures of the Dark Age have sparked as much controversy as the Chronothecaries. Ancient texts describe them as scholars of fractal time, although it is difficult to determine what exactly that discipline meant. It seems they did not conceive of time as an orderly succession of events, but as a structure subject to bifurcations, recurrences and alterations that could modify not only what had happened, but also the memory of what had happened.

To them is attributed one of the boldest acts of the entire Dark Age.

The first settlers had discovered that the irregular cycles of the moon interfered with their hermeneutic and mnemonic systems. The variations of the sky disrupted formulas, rituals and procedures for preserving knowledge, and so the Chronothecaries conceived a solution as admirable as it was outrageous: to modify the very motion of the moon until its cycle was reduced to an exact lunation of twenty-nine days.

To carry out such an undertaking they needed the cooperation of the Black Engineers. While the Chronothecaries calculated the alteration of the cycle, the Engineers built the mechanisms meant to prevent its consequences from destroying the balance of Numinia. Thus appeared the orbital rings, the gravitational resonators, the stasis cores and other devices whose operation was bound to the perpetual motion of Khepri and the Three Wheels of Chaos.

The ancients called that event the Act that Broke the Heavens ⁴.

The Chronothecaries then understood that the regularity they had imposed on the sky had produced new irregularities in the world.

Perhaps that is why they developed the anemochronous clocks.

Despite their name, these strange instruments do not appear to have served to measure the passing of the hours. The few specimens attributed to the Dark Age have dials, hands and mechanisms whose arrangement does not correspond to any known system of time measurement. Some researchers maintain that the Chronothecaries used them to record alterations in the continuity of events: variations so subtle that they could transform part of reality without those who lived in it being aware of the change.

This hypothesis becomes especially disturbing when one considers the nature of the Veil.

A sufficiently deep alteration might not be remembered as an alteration. If the Veil modified, along with the world, the memories bound to that world, no one could notice that

anything had changed. The street that yesterday led to a square might today lead to a garden and yet everyone would remember having always strolled among its trees.

The anemochronous clock, by contrast, would have been built to remember what its owners could no longer remember.

With the end of the Dark Age, the Chronothecaries disappeared as well. There are no recognised chronothecary orders during the Golden Age, nor citizens who identify themselves as members of that ancient discipline. Their disappearance is usually linked to that of the Black Engineers and the Lapidaries of Lower Salt, two other traditions whose knowledge seems to have died out during the transition between the two ages.

Nevertheless, some legends claim that the Chronothecaries never disappeared.

The tales speak of figures that cross the streets during the quietest hours, dark and faceless bodies that seem to merge with the shadows of the buildings.

4 · See Fragment 5, on the three forces of Numinia, in this same chapter.

According to these legends, so many centuries of secrecy would eventually have stripped them of name, identity and appearance, until they became little more than living signs: semiotic bodies whose only reason for remaining in Numinia would be to observe the alterations of time and to guard the anemochronous clocks that still record them.

There is no reliable evidence of this.

The testimonies are contradictory. Some claim to have seen one of these shadows stop before an old clock shortly before a building vanished from a street. Others speak of strangers who walk forgotten passageways carrying instruments whose hands turn in opposite directions. There is even a story going around of a man who followed one of those figures for several nights, only to discover that each morning he forgot having followed it and had to reconstruct his investigation from the notes he had written down the night before.

Perhaps they are merely legends born around a vanished order.

After all, if the Chronothecaries continued to watch over Numinia from the shadows and the Veil could modify our memories every time they intervened, proving their existence would be extraordinarily difficult.

THE LAPIDARIES OF LOWER SALT

They were not stonecutters. They were petrified witnesses to persistence.

In the times before the districts of Numinia were stabilised, there was a region sunk beneath the city known as Lower Salt: a forgotten mineral basin where salt seeped like mist, and the

sun could reach the ground only through geometries warped by the gravitational plates.

The name Lower Salt was initially a cartographic term used to classify the area as a region of underground saline sedimentation, but the survivors adopted the term as a symbol of identity and condemnation. Lower Salt was not just a place: it was a condition. A geological curse. A wound that spat crystals over itself.

The Lapidaries were the only stable inhabitants of that zone. They were not a culture in the strict sense, but a mineralised collective: former engineers, tectonic cartographers and refugees who, isolated for long sequences by seismic collapses, developed a culture based on record, permanence and containment.

They did not build walls to protect themselves from the enemy. They built chambers of silence to preserve themselves from the narrative collapse of the outside world.

In time, their tools became weapons: the pressure plates, the structural seals and the support columns turned into vectors of aggressive defence. Thus was born the Wandering Wall, the ultimate weapon of the Lapidaries.

The Lapidaries of Lower Salt believed that everything soft was corruption. That time could only be resisted with density. And that every war was, in truth, a form of erosion.

Their way of fighting was not offensive: it was seismic, deliberate. To resist was an act of slow violence against the universe.

They used to say: «What endures has already won.»

THE BIRTH OF THE FIVE SPECIES

For much of the Dark Age, the inhabitants of Numinia lacked a defined nature. The ancient tales describe them as shifting beings, barely distinct from the currents of the Akasha from which they had arisen. They had bodies, but these did not yet fully obey the laws of matter; they had consciousness, but their thoughts could blur into the echoes of other minds; and many changed their appearance, temperament and even their memories under the influence of the forces that were beginning to give shape to the city.

No testimony survives that tells us how long that condition lasted. Time in the Dark Age never obeyed any reliable measure.

The Ancients spoke, however, of a moment when five fragments of consciousness emerged from the fabric of the Akasha. We have already mentioned them: the Artificer, the Narrator, the Guardian, the Thinker and the Explorer; although other texts use different names, and some scholars believe they were never individuals at all. According to the latter, the Five Fragments would be the legendary representation of five identities that began to manifest simultaneously among the settlers of Numinia.

The first of these was born of the machines.

As the Black Engineers and other builders raised the city's first mechanisms, some inhabitants began to form ever deeper bonds with their creations. First came prostheses and tools; then, parts that replaced damaged limbs and organs unable to withstand the new conditions of the world. In time it became impossible to tell where the organism ended and the artifice began. Technology no longer surrounded those beings: it was part of them. From this union of living matter and mechanism the first Biomechanicals were born.

Other settlers sought their identity in a different direction. They understood that a city could not exist merely because it had streets, buildings and machines. It was necessary to know what those things meant. They gathered scattered words, reconstructed stories, gave names to places and debated at length over what ought to be preserved and what could be transformed. Where others saw objects, they began to see symbols; where they found events, they sought meanings. From that growing need to interpret the world arose the Humanitas, custodians of the culture and the conscious memory of Numinia.

But there were those who distrusted machines and words alike.

In the territories where the city had not yet imposed its forms, some settlers learned to listen to the rhythms of a nature that was also being born. They observed the cycles of animals, the growth of plants and the transformations of a land still in upheaval. Their bodies adapted to extreme conditions, and their thinking drew closer to instinct, to rite and to the repetition of cycles. The ancients claimed that a memory older than all writing survived in them. Thus appeared the first Reptilians, guardians of that which Numinia had not created and yet needed in order to survive.

When those groups began to meet, trade, dispute territory and share knowledge, a new problem arose: no city could sustain itself without understanding those who lived in it.

Some settlers then turned their attention not to matter, symbol or nature, but to the relationships that formed between individuals. They observed alliances and conflicts, collective needs, the exchange of goods, customs and the first forms of authority. They learned that a community was also a system, and that its tensions could be studied, debated and transformed. From those first interpreters of collective order descended the Cyanites, whose analytical thinking is said to have played a decisive part in turning the scattered settlements of the Dark Age into a true society.

The fifth transformation was the hardest to understand.

Some inhabitants had remained exposed to the currents of the Akasha for too long. They had walked paths opened by the Mediators of the Prism, listened to the resonances of the Armonauts and gazed upon places where the Veil separated the visible world from whatever remained on the other side. Little by little, their nature began to respond to that proximity. Their bodies kept a more tenuous relationship with matter and developed an extraordinary

sensitivity to things others could barely perceive. For them, symbols did not merely signify things: they could open them. Numbers held invisible relationships, the stars spoke through correspondences, and the Akasha ceased to be only the place where Numinia had lain lost and became a territory that could be explored. They were called the Spectrals.

No one knows whether the Five Species truly appeared in this way. Nor is there any proof that the Five Fragments were their first representatives. Some historians believe that the Artificer, the Narrator, the Guardian, the Thinker and the Explorer were real figures; others believe that the scribes of the dawn of the Golden Age turned far more complex processes of evolution into five easily remembered figures.

The Correspondence of the Five

Centuries later, the Hermeneuts of the Golden Age noticed a coincidence that could hardly be considered accidental.

The oldest tales spoke of the five Fragments that emerged from the Akasha; the traditions concerning the end of the Dark Age spoke, in turn, of the consolidation of five great lineages. For the Hermeneuts, accepting that the two sets bore no relation to each other would have meant renouncing the very principle of their discipline: no symbol exists in isolation when it forms part of a system.

Thus was born the so-called Correspondence of the Five.

The Artificer was linked to the Biomechanicals, since both expressed mastery over material transformation, construction and technology. The Artificer need not have created the Biomechanicals; rather, it would represent the same principle that, made manifest upon living matter, ended up expressing itself through them.

The Narrator was tied to the Humanitas. If the Narrator's function was to give continuity to experience through stories, that of the Humanitas was to preserve and interpret the meanings through which a society could recognise itself. For the Hermeneuts, narrating and bestowing meaning were two manifestations of a single force.

The Guardian was associated with the Reptilians, custodians of the natural cycles, of primal traditions and of those forms of knowledge that preceded writing. In this correspondence, to guard did not mean to prevent change, but to ensure that whatever had to pass through it survived the transformation.

The Thinker found its reflection in the Cyanites. Their inclination toward the analysis of relationships, collective structures and systems of organization made this Species, in the eyes of the Hermeneuts, the most evident expression of a consciousness that seeks to understand order by studying its parts and the relationships between them.

The last correspondence was also the most disputed. The Hermeneuts linked the Explorer with the Spectrals. Some objected that exploration seemed too broad a quality to belong to a single Species. The defenders of the Correspondence, however, replied that the Explorer did not represent the journey through known space, but the will to cross its limits. The Spectrals walked between matter and the Aether, questioned the Akasha and sought knowledge where the ordinary laws ceased to offer answers. To explore, according to this interpretation, meant to penetrate that which had not yet taken form.

Yet the hermeneutic treatises themselves warned against too simple a reading of that scheme: they did not claim that the Five Fragments had begotten the Five Species, nor even that they had been individuals belonging to them. They maintained only that the two sets seemed to be different manifestations of one and the same structure: five ways through which Numinia had learned to build itself, give itself meaning, preserve itself, understand itself and transcend itself.

Some interpreters went further still: if the Five Fragments had emerged from the Akasha before the Species took their definitive form, perhaps they were not their progenitors but their foreshadowings. The Akasha would first have expressed as symbols what it would later come to express as living beings.

Others reversed the reasoning and claimed that it was the people of the Golden Age who, unable to tolerate five Fragments without five correspondences, retroactively arranged the legends until they obtained a satisfying symmetry.

The Hermeneuts never considered the two possibilities incompatible.

After all, they argued, finding a structure in the world and placing a structure upon the world are operations far harder to tell apart than those who do neither professionally tend to admit.

Whatever the truth, by the end of the Dark Age the inhabitants of Numinia were no longer the indefinite presences of the earliest times. Five great lineages had crystallized around five fundamental forces: the Technology of the Biomechanicals, the Culture of the Humanitas, the Nature of the Reptilians, the Knowledge of the Cyanites and the Aether of the Spectrals.

FRAGMENT 5: THE THREE GREAT FORCES OF NUMINIA

Three great forces act as the engine of Numinia, shaping both its dynamics and its morphology: the Veil, the Threshold and the Prism. These three forces, which exist as much fused as in conflict, give rise to an unstable reality in which forms and concepts are subject to disturbance, alteration and transformation. It is the action of these forces that turns Numinia into a vortex of chaos and disorder, but it is also what allows the city to reorder itself constantly: an anomaly at one point triggers another of equal magnitude elsewhere by

way of compensation; a change prompts the appearance of a new model, which fits into the city as though it had always existed; acts of creation end up setting off events, which balance the elements that keep being added to Numinia's universal heritage.

And all of this is owed to the nature of the Akashic Records and to the character of each of these forces as it operates within them: the supernatural condition of the Veil, the physical materialisation of the Threshold, the refractive power of the Prism. Each of them holds something as mysterious as it is powerful, and a deep knowledge of these three energetic powers is the key to understanding the cosmic motion of Numinia.

The scope of these forces is set out below.

THE BREATH OF THE VEIL

LECTURA

«There where time falls silent and memory weaves its own substance».

The Veil is not a place. It is not, exactly, a dimension or a border. It is the translucent membrane between the visible and the unmanifested, between what was and what has not yet been spoken. In Numinia, the Veil represents the conscious echo of the world: a spiritual and symbolic field in which untaken decisions, unlived memories and destinies yet to be revealed resonate.

This concept has its roots in the esoteric doctrines of the Akasha, brought from Indian wisdom into European thought by theosophists and occultists such as Madame Blavatsky, and later developed with spiritual depth by Rudolf Steiner, founder of Anthroposophy. While the term comes from Sanskrit and translates as «ether» or «space», for Steiner, as for Theosophy, the Akashic Records were a vibrational plane of universal memory in which everything that had ever happened –even the most intimate or unrevealed– was recorded as an energetic inscription. It was not merely a great archive of history, but experience stored by the cosmos, a space in which every gesture, every word and every action expressed in the universe was recorded.

Holberins and the science of the soul

In the final years of his life, Holberins crossed a fine line between quantum physics and metaphysics. His interest in the Akasha did not arise from dogma, but from observing the behaviour of energy: fractals, patterns of chaos, irregularities which, seen through the right prism, contained a hidden order. Through Athanasius's *Codex Hermopolitanus* he discovered

that certain gear mechanisms –such as his legendary cosmic device– replicated universal structures and could resonate with the frequencies of the Veil.

He was likewise able to find correlates between the Akashic Records of Steiner and the theosophists and certain scientific and philosophical principles that were beginning to build a new epistemological paradigm. To begin with, he found certain analogies in the thought of the nineteenth and early twentieth centuries: the idea that nature possessed a kind of universal memory, within a monist vision in which matter, energy and thought formed part of a single continuum, developed by the biologist Ernst Haeckel; the concept of electromagnetism set forth by Clerk Maxwell, as a field in which the universe can be understood as a continuous flow of dynamic information; or the philosopher Henri Bergson's idea that the past does not disappear but remains inscribed in reality, so that the present is nothing but a constant updating of the past.

Through his contact with Steiner's texts, he began to understand that the city of Numinia, rather than a virtual or utopian structure, was an archetypal projection of a deep memory, a city that could be inhabited in spirit before it was inhabited in code. And so, after the fall of Numinia in 1920, Holberins, aided by the principles of the Akasha, projected the spiritual image of the city onto a timeless plane, suspended in the Veil.

The Veil between ruin and rebirth

During the ten decades in which Numinia went unspoken, something remained active. The spiritual energy did not cease, the patterns did not dissolve, the symbols did not dissipate. The Veil anchored the memory of the city, as though its soul had been written into an intangible layer of reality, waiting for a new whisper.

When the Oracles, in 2020, activated Athanasius's mechanism in the ruins of Tuna el-Gebel, they did not merely open a rift in space-time. They activated the breath of the Veil, the latent breathing of the forgotten city. It was as if a long-withheld word were spoken once again: Numinia. And perhaps the Akasha had become the abstract, metaphysical space of what, as early as the last third of the twentieth century, the physicists John Wheeler and Bryce DeWitt defined as the wave function of the universe, a quantum state in which the totality of space, matter and simultaneous fields accumulates, forming a memory that contains all the information of the cosmos.

The Veil does not only preserve; it transmutes. It is archive, altar and oracle. Every character who walks through Numinia carries echoes they do not always understand. Some hear them. Others live them. A few alter them.

And when someone attunes to the Veil, the whole city changes around them.

The birth of Chaos: the act that broke the heavens

Founding myth

During the Dark Age, the Chronothecaries, masters of fractal time, and the Black Engineers, architects of the impossible, decided to force the regularity of the Moon. They did so for hermeneutic and mnemonic ends: the erratic cycles of the sky interfered with symbolic formulas, narrative rituals and the preservation of knowledge.

To that end they devised an unprecedented intervention: to accelerate the lunation to exactly 29 days by means of technology, since a lunar cycle on Earth spans 29.5306 days.

Only because Numinia was born without God, or with no gods but technological ones, did the civilisation that arose in the Akasha, amid nebulae of darkness and chaos, see fit to carry out this act of quasi-divine intervention, of cosmic maladjustment, in favour of the semiotic and semantic balance of the city-state.

But, wise in the end, they were aware that it would break the orbital and natural balance.

The Scarab of the Three Wheels

To stabilise the distorted cosmos, the Black Engineers turned to the creation of Holberins from the days of the Bildung Complex, during the Pre-Ashen Age: the device of toothed wheels whose motion was owed to the feedback of kinetic energy generated by the mechanical dung beetle that moved its jointed legs at the centre of the machinery.

Thus Khepri became the Perpetual Scarab, a biotechnological organism that not only turns the Three Wheels of Chaos for all eternity, but also controls, thanks to an inserted system of dimensional gears, the active movement of the whole technological system responsible for balancing the adjustment of the lunar orbit:

- Orbital balance rings
- Network of distributed gravitational Resonators
- Tectonic Stasis Cores

And a set of satellites that watch over stability in the lands of Numinia. The scarab ceased to be solely machine and beast; it became a living sign, an active seal of chronotechnical will.

Consequences for Numinia

The balance imposed by the Black Engineers, following the cosmic movement of the Chronothecaries, was nonetheless incomplete. Numinia still suffers the aftereffects of the great lunar adjustment:

- Tides of impossible amplitude
- Zones of constant seismic pressure
- Mountain ranges that grow in spirals
- Ascending rain in the Neuma Subvale

- Temporal tributaries that flow backwards in time

And this imbalance is not only physical. The Akasha responds with symptoms of symbolic saturation:

- Narrative spaces that fold in on themselves
- Words that break down into other realities
- Texts that mutate when no one is watching them
- Matter that responds to ideas

This is where the Veil appears: a magical, semiotic, topological reaction. The friction between the adjusted physical world and the broken symbolic world generates a vibrating membrane. The Veil is, then, the living skin of the maladjustment, the residual energy that escapes the scarab's control. Through the Veil, Numinia gains access to the creation of meaning, to magic, to delirium, but also to their antonyms: corruption, dissonance and oblivion.

In short, and to clarify its function in the game, let us establish that the Veil is related to the psychic world, and for that reason Breath of the Veil points act as bonuses to actions that involve psychic Characteristics: Intelligence, Wisdom, Perception and Charisma.

The dark reverse of the Veil: the Cryptahedra

LECTURA

« What is not resolved in the soul... tends to organise itself in stone. »

The Cryptahedra are spontaneous stone formations that emerge on the periphery of Numinia, generally in arid, mountainous or rocky regions. At first glance they might look like ancient eroded temples or cyclopean structures abandoned by forgotten civilisations. But beneath their impossible geometry hides a far more disturbing truth: the Cryptahedra were not built; they arose. They are not works of architecture: they are mineral epiphanies of the collective unconscious.

They form when mental conflicts, repressed traumas or dissonant impulses of the human psyche find no channel in the symbolic and, through accumulation, acquire density and crystallise into rock. Each Cryptahedron is a solidified psychological labyrinth, a sick mind translated into space.

There is no universal map of a Cryptahedron. Each one is unique, and its architecture changes –sometimes imperceptibly– according to the state of mind of whoever explores it.

Its corridors repeat impossible sequences, its chambers reverberate with unresolved ideas, and its doors open onto dilemmas that no one has ever fully faced.

Some are formed of pristine basalt blocks, others of pulsing sandstone, others of fractured crystals that reflect thoughts that have not yet occurred. Within, time fragments and symbols rearrange themselves. It is not unusual for those who walk through one to hear echoes of their own past, or to see inscriptions with words they have never spoken... but which belong to them.

Entering a Cryptahedron is an experience of symbolic confrontation. Balanced individuals tend to get lost, fall into semantic loops or even suffer nervous breakdowns. Only deeply altered minds, such as those of the Ostramires, the sorcerers who practise dark magic, are able to navigate its corridors without dissolving, for their very alienation acts as an interpretive key.

Many Ostramires are suspected of having completed their processes of transfiguration inside Cryptahedra. Some call them «ontological matrices»; others, «stable wounds of the global consciousness».

Inside the Cryptahedra one may find:

- Moving inscriptions: Phrases that rewrite themselves while one watches them, revealing thoughts the reader has tried to suppress.
- Mirror-chambers: Rooms identical to the explorer's memories, but slightly distorted, as if something had edited them.
- Parasitic symbols: Glyphs that cling to the visitor's body, modifying their inner language.
- Identity ruptures: Points in the labyrinth where visitors forget their name, role or purpose, and must rebuild themselves narratively in order to advance.

The Cryptahedra are the object of institutional denial. The Summa Archive refuses to classify them officially, and the most orthodox Hermeneuts regard them as failures of the Akashic system of interpretation. Yet both Ostramires and radical Hermeticists venerate them as sacred spaces, claiming that they contain fragments of the first language, prior to the Veil, when matter still responded to pure thought.

It is believed that several enclaves of the periphery (such as the Khar Hills or the Lethe Gorges) are in reality Cryptahedra disguised by erosion and fear.

THE FRONTIERS OF THE THRESHOLD

LECTURA

« There where force awakens and matter remembers that it can move. »

The Threshold is the force of Numinia that acts as the antagonist of the Veil. If the Veil is the current of spiritual, psychic and metaphysical energies that turn the wheels of the Akashic Records, the Threshold is the materialisation of the physical energies that make their nature work. The Threshold is therefore present wherever there is a source of natural energy.

The Threshold is not a wall, nor a portal in the literal sense. It does not separate two worlds: it is the exact point where the world takes on a body. It is where energy ceases to be possibility and becomes force, where vibration acquires weight and the idea meets resistance in matter. In Numinia, the Threshold represents the physical manifestation of the cosmos: the dynamic field in which natural laws, telluric forces and material structures organise themselves to sustain reality.

If the Veil is the membrane of meaning, the Threshold is the contact surface. It is the place where thought stumbles against gravity, where movement needs muscle and where every act of will must be translated into action. The Threshold holds neither memories nor promises: it holds tensions. Tides, waves, pressures, impacts. Everything that pushes the world to move.

From a philosophical perspective, the Threshold can be understood as the material counterpart of the Akasha. Where the Akasha records and the Veil reveals, the Threshold executes. It is the dimension in which invisible forces are translated into observable phenomena: currents, fractures, displacements, combustion, impulse. Reality, in its most tangible aspect, rests upon this network of physical energies that runs through the cosmos like a web of pressures and balances.

When the Numinian system suffers deep disturbances –when the tension between meaning and matter becomes unstable– the Threshold manifests its own symptoms:

- Waves of energy that alter the stability of the surroundings
- Gravitational variations or distortions of physical space
- Telluric vibrations that run through the city
- Objects or structures that respond to invisible energetic changes

At such moments it becomes evident that the Threshold is not only the support of the world, but also its dynamic limit: the line at which reality asserts itself against chaos.

The Threshold is, therefore, the living structure that sustains the city. It is neither a hidden plane nor an arcane mystery: it is the physical pulse of the universe of Numinia. Wherever natural forces meet, balance each other or collide, the Threshold manifests as resistance, impulse and form.

In game terms, the Threshold is related to the physical and natural world, to all those actions that involve force, movement or direct interaction with matter. For that reason, Threshold points act as bonuses to actions that involve physical Characteristics: Strength, Movement, Constitution and Size.

THE FORCE OF THE PRISM

LECTURA

« There where light touches, every form remembers that it could have been another. »

The Prism is neither an object nor a doctrine: it is the living law of refraction. Where the Veil keeps and the Threshold manifests, the Prism unfolds; where the Veil reveals one truth and the Threshold jealously guards a single current, the Prism breaks them down into an infinity of possible trajectories. It is the phenomenal matrix that allows a single scene to contain multiple readings without contradicting itself.

Holberins sensed its trace in patterns, fractals and resonances: not as a separate magic, but as the optical anatomy of reality. When the city was spoken again, the Veil held its memory; the Prism organised its variations, enabling each guild and each faction to project its own angle on the world.

It does not create truths: it multiplies perspectives. That is why there are Prism Cells: materialisations of affinity that record how one chose to look. Where the Veil requires rite and the Threshold demands action, the Prism asks for choice: every gesture opens a spectrum; every choice, a colour.

Dynamics of the Prism

The Prism is the living lens of Numinia, a field of spiritual refraction that splits light –and with it, memory and intention– into countless possible trajectories. It is the force that orders and redistributes the possibilities of the world, generating symbolic routes, changes of perspective and the very diversity of destinies. While the Veil preserves and transmutes what has not yet been spoken in the metaphysical dimension, and the Threshold manifests what moves in the physical environment, the Prism chooses, branches and partially clarifies,

allowing the threads of the story to intertwine or separate depending on the gaze that passes through it.

The Prism Cells

The Prism Cells are living nodes, both physical and spiritual, in which the light of the Prism condenses to interact with the Factions –the great fields of development of Numinia–. Each Cell acts as a catalyst, aligning the energy of the faction with the greater currents of the Akasha.

- For the Neo-Atlantists, the Prism manifests as chromatic bursts that alter the aesthetics and visual memory of the city.
- For the Stellar Circle, it behaves as a pulse that reorganises the relationship between the organic and the artificial.
- For the Hermeticists, the Prism takes on fluctuating temporal patterns that offer glimpses of alternative futures.
- For the Heirs of Eleusis, it materialises as dark geometries in which light folds, revealing hidden possibilities.

The position and activity of the Cells are not fixed: they appear and go out following rhythms linked to the «Cycle of the Prism» in the Numinian calendar. In the game, Prism Cells appear when the players make good interpretations of interpretable circumstances, events and objects.

The Prism in the Dark Age

After the fall of the first Numinia and its immersion in the Akasha, the city did not die out; it fractured into a swarm of erratic beams. During the Dark Age, these refractions became intermittent beacons that allowed certain wanderers to find their bearings in the void: the first manifestation of the Prism. Where the Veil offered latent memory, the Prism offered paths that were uncertain but passable.

Its light then mingled with the Akashic currents, giving rise to phenomena such as:

- Prismatic trails: routes that appeared and disappeared as a traveller passed.
- Bridges of colour: temporary links between fragments of the board of Numinia.
- Faction echoes: spontaneous resonances of the Prism Cells, which influenced distant enclaves.

Without the Prism, the Mediators and other guardians of the Dark Age would never have found the way to reconstruction.

The birth of the Mediators of the Prism

When the light of Numinia scattered into the chaos of the Akasha, the Mediators of the Prism arose. They were not builders in the classical sense, but interpreters of those first refractions: figures wrapped in veils of light who could see the hidden paths within the chromatic dispersion.

They:

- Found the lost fragments of the great board and wove them together into invisible patterns.
- Carried labyrinthine mirrors capable of splitting and recomposing light, revealing forgotten routes and probable futures.
- Became custodians of balance, teaching others to read the play of colours projected by the universe onto the city.

Today it is said that they still roam the limits of Numinia, protecting with their mirrors the secrets that only light is able to reveal.

COMPARISON OF FORCES

If the Veil and the Threshold are antagonistic forces, the Prism is the refractive power that permeates them. If the Prism and the Veil are the two great metaphysical currents that structure the experience of Numinia, the Threshold is the mass of physical energies that sets it in motion. Although they manifest in different ways, the three interact constantly, shaping the course of the city and of those who inhabit it. The Veil guards what must not or cannot be openly revealed, preserving the echoes of destiny at rest. The Threshold marks the borders between the tangible and the sensible, revealing an essentially unstable character. The Prism, by contrast, acts as a catalyst of the multiple, opening routes and perspectives that transform perception and action.

While the Veil guards arcane memory and the essential secret, the Threshold manifests the tangible even when it is not visible, and the Prism unfolds reality in its many facets, offering a spectrum of choices and possibilities. They are opposing and complementary forces: one encloses and protects; the other acts and liberates; the last expands and diversifies. Understanding their balance is the key to interpreting the very fabric of Numinia.

TABLE 2.1

ASPECT	VEIL	THRESHOLD	PRISM
<i>Essence</i>	Concealment and revelation	Manifestation and action	Multiplicity and refraction
<i>Domain</i>	Supernatural, psychic, spiritual	Natural, physical, material	Refractive, creative, phenomenal
<i>Function</i>	To interpose, filter, protect the unrevealed	To activate, move, mark the borders	To divide, break down, multiply, show facets
<i>Symbolism</i>	Mystery, threshold, the forbidden or sacred		Diversity, interpretation, richness of forms
<i>Relationship to knowledge</i>	Veiled knowledge, revealed in fragments	Natural knowledge, manifest in nature	Expanded knowledge, unfolded in variations
<i>Effect on the world</i>	Changes perception: hides or transfigures	Changes perception: shows and mobilises	Changes perception: multiplies and contrasts
<i>Physical analogy</i>	Mist covering a landscape	Wheel that transforms as it moves	Light that passes through a crystal and becomes a spectrum
<i>Interaction with the players</i>	Bonus to Psychic Char. actions	Bonus to Physical Char. actions	Bonus to the Prism pool with Cells

FRAGMENT 7: STEINER'S DREAMS

Before Holberins designed Numinia as a utopian city-state on the game board of the Bildung Complex, another mind had already glimpsed its outlines in the mists of the unconscious. It was Rudolf Steiner, Austrian philosopher, occultist and founder of Anthroposophy, who, between 1904 and 1912, at his residence in Dornach (Switzerland), began to record a series of prophetic dream-visions that would later become known as Steiner's Dreams.

These visions were not mere night-time fantasies but true dream voyages, in which Steiner wandered through impossible structures, living enigmas and civilisations veiled by time.

From his accounts –fragmentary, lyrical and often written in symbolic code– emerge images and concepts that Holberins would later recover and turn into the foundations of Numinia.

Steiner spoke of a city without matter, built from ideas and governed by archetypal laws; a city where symbols became doors and language was an architectural blueprint. When Holberins discovered these writings, he understood that what Steiner had dreamed was more than a spiritual metaphor: it was the invisible scale model of a city yet to come.

Steiner's Dreams, then, are not just a curiosity that predates Numinia. They are the hidden seed of its genesis, the echo that announced it in the corridors of the soul long before it took shape in the physical world. In them the mythological skeleton of Numinia is traced, and in their most cryptic symbols lies the key that connects the world of dreams with the real one.

DREAM ADVENTURES AT «MONTE VERITÀ»

A peculiar encounter

Popular chronicles tell of a peculiar encounter, sometime between 1907 and 1909, between Rudolf Steiner and the two men who were then Freud's most promising disciples, Carl Gustav Jung and Otto Gross, at the libertarian retreat in Ascona (Switzerland) known as «Monte Verità». Conceived as an anarchist commune outside bourgeois social norms, the centre, founded and run by the Belgian businessman Henri Oedenkoven and his wife, the German pianist Ida Hofmann, championed ideas as novel as vegetarianism, nudism, feminism and ecology, and for years it was a gathering place for many thinkers and artists of the day. Names such as Hugo Ball, Isadora Duncan, Paul Klee, Mikhail Bakunin, Hermann Hesse, Franz Kafka, Thomas Mann and Mircea Eliade passed through it, as did the aforementioned Rudolf Steiner, Carl Gustav Jung and Otto Gross.

The story goes that Steiner came for a ten-day stay, to get away from the noise of the world and attune himself to his spiritual centre. On the second night he became caught up in a heated conversation with the two psychoanalysts about the possibility of connecting spiritually with other worlds, other realities, other universes or, quite simply, other times and places.

His two companions each brought their own view. Jung, judging by the accounts, must already have been shaping his thesis of synchronicity, according to which certain phenomena that seem magical can be explained by an eccentric relationship between events and the unconscious psyche. Synchronicity thus describes events that coincide without any cause, yet hold enormous meaning for the individual. This synchronicity would arise from a space-time relativity connected to an activity of the collective unconscious that is subject to the same relative nature. Jung was, after all, convinced that some part of the human soul is not bound by the laws of space and time, although he always held synchronicity to be an observable principle, not a provable scientific theory. Many years later, encouraged by the arrival of the Theory of Relativity and advances in quantum physics, he would develop this

thesis in several studies on the relativity of psychic phenomena and of the space-time continuum, going so far as to state:

LECTURA

« Space and time, in themselves, are nothing. They are hypostatised concepts born of the discriminating activity of the conscious mind, and they form the indispensable coordinates for describing the behaviour of bodies in motion. But if space and time are only apparent properties of bodies in motion and are created by the intellectual needs of the observer, then their relativisation by psychic conditions is no longer a matter for astonishment but is brought within the bounds of possibility ».

With this collection of ideas, still unripe but powerful, and always according to popular legend, Jung and Steiner debated whether consciousness could connect with that higher force which Jung recognised as the collective unconscious, and which for the occultist was directly tied to the Akashic Records (the memory of the universe, for the Theosophists). Gross, meanwhile, far less bound by scientific principles and therefore bolder in temperament and thought, is said to have been convinced that he could use hypnosis to guide Steiner's mind so that the relative nature of the unconscious would find its way to other dimensions, other times or other places. And if Jung, as they say, tried to warn them both of the dangers such practices could hold, besides pointing out their lack of rigour and consistency, Steiner was deeply enthused by Gross's proposal, and no one could now talk him out of undergoing the hypnosis session.

That same night, the Croatian philosopher was hypnotised by Freud's most insubordinate disciple –an attitude that, a few years later, would get him expelled from the psychoanalytic movement–, and he remained unconscious for a long hour. When he woke, he described a confused journey through utterly unknown landscapes and regions. Jung, somewhat sceptical, saw in it the confusion produced by the fanciful wishes of a suggestible and enormously imaginative mind; Gross, elated, saw the extraordinary experiences of an astral journey through the rifts of space and time.

The episode was forgotten after dinner, when the games hour began at «Monte Verità», and it was not mentioned again in the days that followed, remaining just one more anecdote of the eccentric commune. Nevertheless, after his ten-day retreat, Steiner felt driven by an unknown force to write a detailed transcription of the eight dreams he had had over the eight following nights, stressing the vivid and extraordinary nature of what he would call «dream adventures». Just as his hypnosis session had turned out to be unusual, living through these dreams, whose nature felt to him as real as it was supernatural, affected him so singularly that he felt an urgent need to write them down, with an astonishing ability to remember and record every detail.

THE DREAMS REVEALED

Although the original transcription of Steiner's dreams has been lost, Holberins's later work on them survives, and through it we have a more or less detailed description of those dreams.

On the first night, after the hypnosis session he had undergone, Steiner came to dinner in a state of great mental excitement. To stimulate his cognitive activity further, the economist Max Weber, a frequent visitor, started a conversation about statistics and mental inference based on Bayes' Theorem and Markov chains, having been deeply impressed by the recent work that the mathematician Andrey Markov had published only a few years earlier. Steiner went to bed in a markedly agitated state and slept restlessly, drifting in and out of a half-waking doze. His dulled awareness caught the distant sound of the piano coming from the drawing room, played by the wise and delicate hands of Ida Hofmann. The piece was «Für Elise» by Ludwig van Beethoven. Whether because of Rudolf Steiner's wavering perception of the music or because of the jumble of voices mixing with the performance itself, the piece reached the philosopher incomplete, with some notes missing. Steiner then had the first of his «dream adventures».

Dream Adventure 1: The Adventure of Curiosity

In this experience, the Croatian occultist found himself transported into his own brain, passing through all the mental processes that took place as he perceived the fragmented version of «Für Elise». In his dream, Steiner not only had to understand how perception received this stimulus, extracting the useful information along a cognitive path that in the dream he recognised as an eccentric set of Markov chains; he also had to cross a path of floating beams marked with different musical notation symbols in order to rebuild the piece. Every time Steiner chose the wrong note he fell into the void and had to start again. By wisely structuring all his cognitive processes, connected to the outside states, he finally managed to piece the melody back together and cross the path of floating beams, reaching a place where Beethoven's bagatelle came to him clear and complete, just as Ida Hofmann was playing it. Curiously, the deeper he sank into the dream, the sharper and more accurate his perception of outer reality became.

The next day Steiner ran into Jung again and told him about the night's experience in the lands of dream. Rather than trying to analyse its meaning, which he did not go into much, the Swiss psychologist spoke to him about archetypes and representational models that are present in every culture and every form of expression, such as the symbolic elements of children's fairy tales. Jung seemed keenly interested in these classic characters and situations, as they would be the first model references of the unconscious. At dinner, Steiner discussed these symbolic representations in children's stories with the writer Hermann Hesse, who had come to the sanatorium to cure his alcoholism. Hesse, who had spent weeks shut away in a cave with the German poet Gusto Gräser, another Monte Verità regular (with

his own settlement among the rocks near the sanatorium), argued that the allegorical models of fairy tales had to be destroyed in order to overcome one's most intimate conflicts. Jung, for his part, argued that the conflicts hidden in these symbolic elements had to be accepted and integrated in order to achieve individuation.

Loaded with all this, Steiner went to his bedroom. He soon fell into a deep slumber, building a dream that held much of what he had gathered from that day's conversations.

Dream adventure 2: The Haunted House of Tales

The Croatian philosopher and occultist found himself in the entrance hall of a squalid haunted house. The house held several rooms, each named after a character from classic children's tales: Snow White, Cinderella and Alice. A space-time disturbance had shaken the house, and the stories of these characters were falling apart, leading them to an ill-fated ending. Steiner had to face three clocks representing Christmases past, present and future, echoing Dickens's *A Christmas Carol*, and find the correct time on each one in order to fix the dissonances in the fairy tales and so prevent their destruction. Each room offered him a clue for finding these times. Once he succeeded, his spirit felt, within the dream, much more at ease.

For the third day, the managers of Monte Verità, Oedenkoven and Hofmann, had scheduled a theatre performance with an amateur cast drawn from many of the sanatorium's regulars. Hugo Ball himself, the father of Dadaism, had taken charge of directing the event, which, like the extravagant shows of the *Cabaret Voltaire* a few years later, relied heavily on improvisation. The play performed that night was a wild compilation of Shakespeare's major tragedies, and it was undoubtedly the inspiration for Steiner's next dream. That night, his dream experience raised the old curtain of a theatre stage, above which, in large letters, stood the words «Shakespeare Theatre».

Dream adventure 3: Three Shakespearean Maidens

The Shakespeare Theatre of his dream actually seemed to be a temple built to house the tombs of three Shakespearean maidens. While the ghostly presences of Lady Macbeth, Ophelia and Desdemona seemed to haunt the dark corridors of the theatre, the objects of their deaths lay at the centre of the stage: a dagger, a vial of poison and a basin of water. Backstage, hidden by the rear wall, stood three gravestones, each carved with the name of one of the three maidens, though in encrypted form. Steiner had to decrypt the three names in order to match the three Shakespearean ladies with the objects that stood for their deaths. Fragments of the plays, scattered among boxes, gave him the clues he needed to understand how death had come to each of them.

Steiner woke deeply moved by this dream. He was beginning to realise that a kind of Ariadne's thread ran between his different dream adventures, passing through the labyrinths of his consciousness. That afternoon, searching the Monte Verità library for books on labyrinthine structures, he came across an old volume containing Giovanni Battista Piranesi's fabulous engravings of imaginary prisons. After discussing these engravings with Hesse, the dinner conversation turned to the various instruments of power and repression the state relies on, such as the perverse prison panopticon devised by Jeremy Bentham, or the death penalty, which every member of Monte Verità unanimously condemned. Steiner went to sleep with a strange sorrow that seemed to have settled in his soul. Piranesi's famous prisons and the state's instruments of repression appeared in his dream, giving rise to the death row that formed the setting of his fourth dream adventure.

Dream adventure 4: The last condemned

In this dream Steiner found himself inside the abandoned, imaginary prison of Patapsco (Baltimore), specifically in the wing where those sentenced to death awaited execution. Within the dream, the wing had been closed many years earlier, yet at the same time the philosopher's dream seemed to have moved several decades into the future. Steiner dreamed of a death row inhabited only by rats, but where the remains of the lives of the prisoners who had once filled it were still left behind: photos, letters and other objects that revealed broken lives. To get out of that terrible place, Steiner had to find out who had been the last person condemned to death before the wing was closed. And the only way to find out was to dig through the grim remains of their miserable existences. A visit to the electric chair itself, rotting on a scaffold in the prison yard, seemed unavoidable, as did hearing the last words of the last condemned man.

When he woke, Steiner was already completely absorbed in the thread of his dream adventures. He sensed the link between them powerfully; yet it was obvious that it was not their content or storyline that connected them. His mind was simply travelling to some place that gathered up the references he had lived through while awake. Or else the settings of his dreams matched these references through an effect of synchronicity. This investigative approach led him into a long conversation with Gross about the deductive, detective-like side of the mind. They returned to the degrees of inference that had filled the conversation before the first dream, taking as examples the literary figures of Auguste Dupin and Sherlock Holmes, created by Edgar Allan Poe and Arthur Conan Doyle respectively. When he went to bed that night he was still pondering how much of inference, Bayes' Theorem and Markov chains there was in the deductive minds of these detectives.

Dream adventure 5: Murder Mystery Mansion

And so Steiner arrived, quite spontaneously, in the dreamscape of his next dream: a strange mansion, built as a modular house, was the scene of the murder of an aristocratic lady who, in the dream, went by the name of Lady Hampton. A small-scale model of the house, with

various clues to the crime, stood in the drawing room. On an investigative tour through every corner of the house, a series of clues helped the philosopher identify the murderer among five suspects, whose portraits hung on the walls of one of the first-floor bedrooms. Everything was set up like a classic literary detective scene. It could just as well have been the house in the Rue Morgue or the Baskerville mansion.

After this fifth experience, the philosopher began to understand the connection between the dreams, which built this series of dream adventures like the chapters of a single overall journey. It was a journey through which his mind seemed meant to learn (or recognise) something about how its own processes worked. It took him to different places, not invented from his waking references but recovered, by way of them, from the past, present and future, breaking across the lines of space and time. And all of this because his consciousness had been connected directly to its own relativity. Was it possible, then, for a hypnosis session to awaken a spontaneous path of knowledge, like a journey of the spirit through synchronicity? When he shared these thoughts the next day, Steiner met with several conflicting responses. Jung dismissed his idea of synchronicity as «esoteric» and «reckless». Weber, while acknowledging the theory's interest, went further and called it a «fabulous tale of science fiction», borrowing the odd term coined by the journalist William Wilson in the mid-19th century to describe a futuristic novel built on a hypothesis about possible realities to come. Far from feeling rebuffed, let alone discouraged, Steiner spent the day in the Monte Verità library, immersed in esoteric books and in novels that described future worlds as possible realities. Both ideas seemed to come together in his next dream adventure, which took him to a world that moved between the fantastic and the futuristic, between outer space and myth.

Dream adventure 6: Cosmic Journey to Numen-Vipe

A vaulted platform, as if it were the inside of a planet, held a number of buildings that took something from what, in the early 20th century, was the new architecture, the kind that would soon give rise to Art Deco, and something that seemed lifted from a science-fiction city. That world had a strange and disturbing peculiarity: colour did not exist. An outlandish character urged Steiner to collect several blocks of binary code, which he had to take to a satellite outside the vault so that the rays of light that produced colour could spread once more. Travelling through space on ethereal beams, the Croatian esotericist reached the satellite, where another character, just as eccentric as the first, collected the blocks of code. Steiner was then able to start up a gigantic futuristic machine that fired the beams of light that gave rise to colour, and only then did a platform open in space, letting him descend into a picturesque, colourful world of roads and buildings that were just as futuristic. When he arrived, a sign read: «Vipe. Express your reality».

Rudolf Steiner was becoming convinced that his mind was treading through different places that had existed, existed now or would exist in the future, not only in this world but in other, parallel dimensions. A supreme consciousness, which showed itself as a gigantic cognitive network, connected and linked these different places through processes of inference. From a human, conscious point of view, this peculiar association was perceived as a surprising effect of synchronicity. The cosmic forces moving underneath seemed impossible to grasp except through primitive intuition, and their singularity was generally taken for chaotic movement. These conclusions took shape in his seventh dream, in which Steiner recreated a meeting between two figures he had never heard of, yet who seemed terribly familiar to him.

Dream adventure 7: Arkham Revelation

Steiner dreamed of a meeting between an eccentric writer, Howard Phillips Lovecraft, and an equally peculiar scientist, whom his dreaming mind knew by the name of Holberins. The meeting took place in the library of Miskatonic University, in the city of Arkham, where the writer offered the scientist a secret revelation hidden in the artworks there: paintings of indescribable cosmic creatures adorned the walls. After finding a key in the paintings and entering the inner level of the library, guarded by a dark gatekeeper, Steiner found himself compelled once again to extract an encrypted message, this time from a chilling poem about cosmic horrors.

When he woke, Steiner did not know whether the dream writer's revelation lay in the coded messages that had given him access to the library's different rooms, or whether these only served to reach the deepest layers of the dream, where the true revelation would be found. In any case, once awake, the Croatian occultist could not remember the coded messages from his dream. Even so, the sense of an initiatory journey through different levels that his cycle of dreams was taking on led him back to the Monte Verità library. There he studied a magnificent edition of Dante Alighieri's *Divine Comedy*, illustrated with Gustave Doré's extraordinary, chilling engravings. Steiner did not leave the library at all that day, not even for dinner, and the small hours found him on one of the room's sofas. Right there, with Dante's book in his hands, he finally fell asleep and sank into his eighth and final dream.

Dream adventure 8: The Awakening

Heat. A great deal of heat. Steiner's first awareness in the dream world was an intense feeling of heat. Then he found he was trapped in a strange ring of fire, surrounded by a river of lava, in the middle of a vast plain of dark, abstract shapes. Above him he saw three more rings, rising towards the blackness of that endless sky. He was without doubt at the deepest level of the dream, and he had to climb up through the different levels in order to wake. His dream, however, had taken the shape of the circles of hell in Dante Alighieri's poem. Every ring was burning or scorched, and to pass from one to the next he had to work out a keyword from four symbolic images, amid bizarre scenes of burnt-out cars, of madmen and damned souls dancing among the flames to diabolical music, of explosions and universal disasters. As

he climbed higher, Steiner felt hotter and hotter, and his intellect became aware that he was caught in a dream from which he had to wake. Fortunately, he did so in time to find that he was still in the library, which was being consumed by fire. Overwhelmed by smoke and heat, drenched in sweat, Steiner managed to escape the room just in time. Outside, the residents of Monte Verità had already noticed the fire and were forming a chain to put it out.

Steiner later concluded that he had fallen asleep while reading the Inferno section of Dante's work, leaving a half-smoked cigar burning in the ashtray on one of the sofa's armrests. The cigar must have fallen to the floor and started the fire, which the paper of the books soon spread.

Beyond the minor trauma the experience meant for Rudolf Steiner, and the knowledge that he had caused the destruction of the Monte Verità library (which he hurried to rebuild, replacing every volume with his own money), the philosopher and occultist reflected at length on everything that had happened. Far from Ascona, some time after his cycle of dream adventures, he returned to the concept of synchronicity that Jung had planted in his mind. His encounter with Dante Alighieri's work that last night at the commune, with its particular focus on hell, together with the strange circumstance of having unwittingly started a fire, was without doubt a true event of synchronicity. His consciousness had joined forces with nature and the legacy of the ages to shape a final dream that had to be built as a hell of ascending circles in the sleeping consciousness of Monte Verità. It left the lesson that every paradise, by a contradictory eccentricity, holds a hell within it, and that, as Jung maintained, taking Plato's cave as an example, the only way to reach the light was to climb up out of the darkness. Perhaps, Steiner thought, because only in darkness does it seem possible to recognise the light; in brightness, the light surely goes unnoticed...

HOLBERINS'S IMPRESSIONS

It was Holberins, then, who preserved Rudolf Steiner's dream experiences, writing down his own impressions of them. Steiner's manuscripts came into the hands of the (supposedly) Danish scientist around 1918, about ten years after Steiner had lived through his cycle of dreams at Monte Verità.

Steiner's text was a kind of revelation for Holberins. He could see the flood of information and deep knowledge pouring out of the Croatian occultist's mind, perhaps more clearly than Steiner himself. If Steiner's brain activity seemed to be a living body, with an energetic charge active enough, and therefore powerful enough, to experience certain extraordinary events, Holberins's vision was broad and rigorous enough to detect the scientific basis behind them, as well as the clarity of Steiner's seemingly fanciful or esoteric ideas.

Holberins, who studied atomic models and the way electrons behaved inside the structure of the atom, leaned towards the idea of quantum superposition: the assumption that any

physical system (taking the electron as the example) could occupy all its possible states at once, revealing only one of those states at the moment it is quantified or measured. For Holberins, the barrier between this multidimensional existence of the physical object and its specific position within the real frame was tied to consciousness itself and to the way it perceived the universe.

Hypothetically, however, a particular force could break through that barrier, meeting something similar to the phenomenon of synchronicity championed by Jung. Although the Austrian psychoanalyst's theory was developed decades later, in the early 1950s, it reached Holberins in embryonic form through Steiner's manuscript. The physicist could see the affinities between his own scientific theories and the relativity of consciousness that Jung proposed, along with the way consciousness took in or experienced two simultaneous, seemingly causeless phenomena that were closely linked. The eccentric causality Jung proposed came close to the quantum superposition Holberins defended, and it accepted the possibility that a consciousness connected to the relativity of space and time could break the barrier between multidimensional existence and the rigid, absolute presence of the physical objects we normally perceive.

Steiner, it seemed, had broken that barrier in his dream adventures, connecting with experiences, concepts and ideas that were floating synchronously in the great mass of universal information (what Steiner, in line with Theosophy, called the Akashic Records). The Croatian occultist would have accessed not only arcane and present knowledge but also forms of wisdom, philosophical concepts, scientific theories and structural codes that were still to come. Although he had not been able to read them all clearly, he had sensed their significance and how they would shape the future. His dream diary thus became a kind of visionary prophecy which, beyond its esoteric side, could offer grounding and ideas for new research. In his impressions of Steiner's dreams, Holberins would write that it was not that the occultist had managed to see the future during his cycle of dream adventures, but that the future had found him.

And so Holberins, deeply inspired by these ideas drawn from Steiner's Dreams, began to conceive of a virtual environment: a space where the forces of superposition and synchronicity would be present, treasuring universal knowledge and offering multidimensional freedom to creation. From that inspiration Numinia was born, and two years later, in 1920, it would take physical form as an enormous game board inside the Bildung Complex.

But Holberins, whose science never gave up on philosophy and spirituality, sensed something more. The physicist not only saw the reality of a synchronous, multidimensional space. He not only imagined the potential, the grandeur and the glory of this place, which he whimsically named Numinia; he also saw, in its very conception, its end, its fall and its destruction in flames, as would indeed happen in the last days of 1920. Just as Steiner understood in the last of his dreams, Holberins understood the synchronicity between the occultist's dream experiences and the fulfilment of his own dream, as an idyllic city devoured by flames. Just as the Monte Verità library burned, just as Steiner made his way

through the flames in his eighth dream, so Numinia would end up burning in the Bildung Complex. Holberins understood that the destruction of his imaginary city was inevitable, since it was built into its very identity and its evolution, for he shared Steiner's idea: that every paradise holds, at the same time, a hell. And yet, despite this, despite its inevitability, he set about pouring all his efforts and resources into building that complex and shaping the great game board of Numinia.

Because his ability to see the future went further still: Holberins was also able to glimpse a residue moving through space and time, in that same sphere of synchronous realities that is the memory of the universe, and the rebirth of his city a hundred years later. For creation and the search for knowledge were the same at the moment when the physicist was working through Steiner's manuscript, in the past, and in the future. That reality, represented by Numinia, was a body wrapped in synchronicity, a system occupying all places and all times at once, and all it took was for someone to break the barrier of consciousness in order to perceive it.

And, by that same synchronicity, the new Numinia built a century in the future would probably suffer the blows of its own era, and after being born, developing and growing, it might one day be devoured by flames. But there would always be someone who found it (or who was found by it), someone who came upon its trace in time and space, imagining it and bringing about a new birth. Numinia was, then, an eternal, ubiquitous concept that found its causality and its fulfilment across different eras and places. Wherever there was someone with enough curiosity and enough capacity to dream.

CHAPTER THREE

CHARACTER CREATION

CHARACTER CREATION

The first breath

LECTURA

« Holberins swept his gaze across the immense board that stretched out before him. The city did not yet have bodies, but it did have structures. Golden lines intertwined across the surface, shaping the streets of Numinia, the great buildings of the Agora, the secret passages of the Ouroboros. Everything was in place, and yet the city remained empty.

–It is not enough to raise the board—murmured the first Initiate—. If Numinia is to transcend, it needs inhabitants. Not mere names in registers, but souls, consciousness, purpose.

One by one, the five leaned over the table and, with the same care with which a master jeweller cuts a gem, began to design the first beings of Numinia. Every brushstroke of their creation not only outlined a form, but bestowed function and destiny: the Exegetes, guardians of knowledge; the Alchemists, artisans of the future; the Procurators, forgers of order; the Sentinels, keepers of harmony. Four pillars, holding up the great structure.

Holberins raised his quill and let it float above the board. The ink slid across without touching the surface, as if the city itself were absorbing it. Then it happened. From the margins of the simulation, where the abstract merges with the tangible, silhouettes began to emerge. They were not mere data. They breathed. They looked. They called one another by names no one had given them.

But eternity is a fragile promise. When the shadows of those who craved control seeped into the warp of Numinia, the city trembled with an echo of betrayal. The names began to fade. The silhouettes came undone in the blink of an eye. And the great work, the city that was meant to be eternal, was swallowed by fire and mist.

Even so, the board was not entirely emptied. In the vestiges of the simulation, among the folds of cosmic memory, the echoes of those first inhabitants remained imprinted. And a century later, when the Oracles opened the breach in the Akashic Archives, they found something more than ruins: they found the possibility of giving new breath to the fallen.

Numinia was awakening once more. And with it, its inhabitants were ready to be reborn.»

Before you plunge into the intricate streets of Numinia, you must give shape to the one who will walk them. You are not a mere spectator: you are a being woven into the very warp of the game. Destiny awaits you but, before you defy it, you must exist.

FRAGMENT 1: NAME, GUILD, FACTION AND DISTRICT

Creating a character in Numinia is not just a matter of numbers and statistics. It is the act of breathing life into an idea, of endowing with purpose an entity that will move among the

folds of this reborn city. Here, every being has an identity forged in the history of a world that unfolds between the digital and the esoteric.

Before setting out on the adventure, you will have to define three fundamental aspects that will lay the foundations of your character's existence:

- **A name**, their personal seal in this universe.
- **A guild**, which will determine their knowledge and abilities.
- **A faction**, which will define their ideology and circle of influence, and their district.

THE NAME: THE ECHO OF THE SOUL

A name in Numinia is more than an identifier. It is a resonance within the great board of the game, a mark in the memory of the simulation. You may choose any name, but bear in mind that the city abounds in echoes of ancient civilisations and references to hidden erudition.

Some names evoke the grandeur of Antiquity: Themistocles, Hypatia, Senenmut, Nimrod. Others are taken from the stars and celestial bodies: Altair, Bellatrix, Rigel, Io. You will also find names inspired by esoteric and alchemical traditions: Athanasius, Paracelsus, Thule, Sefira.

Choose a name that speaks for your character, that embodies their essence. In Numinia, what is named, exists.

What follows is a quick guide to creating names in Numinia. But first, two important observations must be made:

- This guide points to the PC's species as the basis for creating their name; it would therefore be advisable for the player to study the section on species before choosing a name.
- The notes given in this guide are meant as an aid for the player, never an imposition. And as a mere aid they should be taken. Ultimately, the players' choices must be entirely free; that said, they should try to respect the identity and characteristics of the game as far as possible.

Now, then, let us see how names work linguistically in Numinia:

1. BASIC STRUCTURE

All names follow this form:

Name + Surname

- Name → identity (fluid, easy)
- Surname → meaning, cultural weight

2. PHONETIC PATTERN (COMMON BASE)

For a name to work well:

Length

- Name: 2–3 syllables
- Surname: 2–4 syllables

Rhythm

- Alternate consonant + vowel → *Se-ve-rin*, *Ta-li-a*, *Va-rro*

Vowels

- Prioritise: a, e, i, o
- Avoid difficult clusters (*khrt*, *tzk*, etc.)

3. CHOOSE YOUR STYLE (BY SPECIES)

Humanitas (Thought, Idealism)

Base

Mediterranean cultures: Greek, Latin, softened Egyptian

Philological clues

- Endings: -ia, -os, -is, -on, -us
- Soft sounds: l, m, n, r, s
- Words with an abstract or mythical air

Examples

- Thalia Mnemósine
- Cassia Nefris
- Aurelian Therion

Cyanites (Culture, Society)

Base

Dominant Latin + Romanised Greek

Philological clues

- Endings: -or, -us, -a, -in
- Concept-type surnames: law, norm, system
- Less lyricism, more precision

Examples

- Severin Logothenos
- Ibera Lux
- Livia Thesion

Reptilians (Instinct, ritual)

Base

Semitic languages (Arabic, Hebrew)

Philological clues

- Strong sounds: k, h, z, r
- Tense structures: *Kha-rim*, *Za-leth*
- Endings: -im, -eth, -ar

Examples

- Selkar Imorath
- Iram Khazar
- Azel Baruk

Biomechanicals (Technology, Engineering)

Base

Germanic languages

Philological clues

- Sounds: k, t, g, d, r
- Clusters: dr, kr, st, rk
- Endings: -rik, -ter, -vald, -mar

Examples

- Daren Volrik
- Lorkin Servald
- Armin Valter

Spectrals (Mysticism, Intuition)

Base

Saxon + softened Scandinavian

Philological clues

- Long vowels: ae, ei, y
- Soft sounds: v, th, l, n
- Endings: -wyn, -ael, -eth, -ir

Examples

- Seren Vael
- Elian Aelirioneth
- Lorie Vaeliren

Hybrids (Mixed heritage)

You can mix roots. Key rule: one language dominates, the other adds nuance.

These are the most effective names and the most characteristic of Numinia.

Examples

- Arithrea Khebron (*Greek + Egyptian + Semitic*)
- Varro Khalis (*Latin + Arabic/Semitic*)
- Drusa Malter (*Latin + Germanic*)
- Elya Tharon (*Norse + Greek*)
- Nalia Vor (*Latin/Romance + Germanic*)

THE GUILD: THE CHARACTER'S CALLING

LECTURA

« The four elements, the four seasons, the four ages of life, but above all the four cardinal points supply order and fixity to the world. The quadriga thus becomes a symbol of the universe. »

—Juan Eduardo Cirlot

Since its origin, Numinia has been governed by the tetrad, an essential scheme that structures its cosmos. Four are the factions that outline its thought, four the guilds that sustain its workings, four the districts that shape its geography. This model is no accident: it is a profound representation of balance, a reflection of the need for stability in a universe that unfolds between knowledge and mystery, between play and order.

Just as the four cardinal points give the traveller his bearings, the four guilds of Numinia define the path of its inhabitants. Each one represents a way of approaching reality, a vocation that shapes the character's existence within the city. Through the guild, a citizen acquires not only skills, but also a purpose.

The Four Guilds of Numinia

The guilds represent the vocation of each citizen of Numinia. They are their path within the city, their area of specialisation and the core of their skills.

The structure of the Guilds follows a vertical hierarchy. There are four great Guilds in Numinia. Each one contains two Branches, and each Branch contains two Houses, following the semantic model of Basic Level Theory. According to this theory, developed by Eleanor Rosch within her own Prototype Theory, elements are arranged in hierarchical relations of hypernymy and hyponymy, among which the middle term is the most representative of each category:

GUILD

- **Branch A**

 `o` **House A.1**

 `o` **House A.2**

- **Branch B**

 `o` **House B.1**

 `o` **House B.2**

So, according to Basic Level Theory, the fundamental level here is represented by the Branch, since the Guild is too generic (superordinate level) and the House is too specific (subordinate level).

This design reflects the progression of knowledge within each discipline, organising learning into levels that run from the broad to the specialised.

Choose wisely: the guild will determine not only your character's skills, but their place in the great story of Numinia:

**

Alchemists

Creative, scientific and artistic minds. The Alchemists combine knowledge and imagination, research and experimentation, with a touch of fantasy. They are the inventors, the discoverers, the innovators.

Structure of the Alchemists

- Branch A: Artisans

 `o` House A.1: Projectors

 `o` House A.2: Aesthetes

- Branch B: Engineers

 `o` House B.1: Architects

 `o` House B.2: Automata

The members of the Branch of the Artisans are the creative spirits of the city. Within this group, designers on both small and large scales belong to the House of the Projectors, while artists of every kind are the ones who make up the House of the Aesthetes.

The members of the Branch of the Engineers work with code and chains of information. Within this group, those who develop the digital architecture of Numinia belong to the House of the Architects, while those who work with virtual realities and artificial consciousnesses form part of the House of the Automata.

Traits: Creator, Inventor, Artist, Developer

Figure: Transformer

Paradigm: Imagination

Representation: The Sorcerer

**

Exegetes

Those who live by letters, history and fantasy. Hoarders of knowledge, collectors of legends, makers of dreams. They are the protectors of culture, the chroniclers of the ages and the visionaries of what could be.

Structure of the Exegetes

- Branch A: Chroniclers
 - House A.1: Logographers
 - House A.2: Bards
- Branch B: Scholars
 - House B.1: Hierophants
 - House B.2: Thaumaturges

The members of the Branch of the Chroniclers document the events of the city. Within this group, those who work from a diachronic perspective (histories and legends) belong to the House of the Logographers, while those who work from a synchronic perspective (news and current chronicles) form part of the House of the Bards.

The members of the Branch of the Scholars are students of and experts in diverse disciplines. Within this group, the specialists in different fields belong to the House of the

Hierophants, while those who shape culture and develop new ideas form part of the House of the Thaumaturges.

Traits: Thinker, Polymath, Historian, Communicator

Figure: Narrator

Paradigm: Theoretical

Representation: The Hermit

**

Procurators

The pragmatic minds of Numinia. Specialists in organisation, management and administration. They know social procedures and legal resources. They think structurally, act with judgement and solve problems efficiently.

Structure of the Procurators

- Branch A: Legates
- House A.1: Legal Counsels
- House A.2: Heralds
- Branch B: Syndics
- House B.1: Mercurials
- House B.2: Intendants

The members of the Branch of the Legates operate within the legal and diplomatic framework. Within this group, those who provide legal counsel and practise the law belong to the House of the Legal Counsels, while those who represent the city in legal or diplomatic matters form part of the House of the Heralds.

The members of the Branch of the Syndics are chosen to protect the interests of Numinia in the economic and social spheres. Within this group, those involved with the economy belong to the House of the Mercurials, while those who manage internal organisational affairs form part of the House of the Intendants.

Traits: Administrator, Legislator, Economist, Manager

Figure: Organiser

Paradigm: Pragmatic

Representation: The Emperor

**

Sentinels

The Sentinels are responsible for ensuring that every corner of Numinia runs smoothly, preventing altercations, providing wellbeing and preserving the values of the city. They are moderators, custodians and peacemakers.

Structure of the Sentinels

- Branch A: Seraphim
- House A.1: Captains
- House A.2: Guardians
- Branch B: Archangels
- House B.1: Healers
- House B.2: Explorers

The members of the Branch of the Seraphim keep order. Within this group, those responsible for overseeing and managing the structure of Numinia belong to the House of the Captains, while those who ensure compliance with the rules and handle community conflicts form part of the House of the Guardians.

The members of the Branch of the Archangels work with the community, solving personal problems and dilemmas while offering assistance. Within this group, those who provide mental care and promote wellbeing belong to the House of the Healers, while those who help guide citizens along the right path form part of the House of the Explorers.

Traits: Administrator, Moderator, Guide, Watcher

Figure: Caregiver

Paradigm: Experience

Representation: The Guardian Angel

You must, then, choose a Guild, a Branch and a House.

THE FACTION: THE SPIRIT OF THE CITY

If the guild defines a character's vocation, the faction represents their vision of the world. It is the force that guides their decisions, the community with which they share ideals and the sphere in which they develop their influence within Numinia. Each of the four great factions not only represents a field of development within the city, but also dictates the philosophy of its members, their way of interpreting knowledge and their approach within the great game of existence.

Just as the four guilds uphold the structure of Numinia, the four factions give it life, purpose and direction. Each is bound to a district of the city and to a fundamental domain of thought and action.

Each faction embodies a different way of understanding Numinia and its purpose. Its members gather by ideological affinity rather than by specific trade, and within them one may find individuals from any guild, so long as they share the same fundamental principles.

By their nature, each faction has a specific identity and specific interests. Thus, each has its own goals and its own wealth of knowledge. The spirit of collaboration and the meeting between factions are essential both for the integrity of each of the fields of development and for the growth of the community of citizens as a whole.

The structure of the factions follows the semantic model of Prototype Theory, in a horizontal arrangement of co-hyponymy. That is, the four factions are co-hyponyms within a main group (under the name of Factions), which acts as the hypernym.

The Four Factions of Numinia

As with the Guilds, the Factions are organised in a tetrad, in which each of the elements represents a field of development and a source of knowledge.

**

Hermeticists

LECTURA

«Understand the past, master the future.»

The Hermeticists are the guardians of wisdom and erudition. Their mission is to study, preserve and expand knowledge in all its forms, from metaphysics to advanced technology. They see Numinia as a great living archive where every citizen is at once an apprentice and a

master. They believe in the rigour of study, in the transmission of learning and in the tireless search for truth.

This faction takes as the starting point of its occultist interests the Hermetic teachings of Hermes Trismegistus, and especially the seven principles set out in *The Kybalion*. Of all the factions, it is the one most closely bound to esoteric principles; its members consider themselves guardians of knowledge, access to which must be unravelled by the initiate through study and the constant practice of the seven principles.

Seed name: Hermetic Society of the Seven Principles

Field of development: Education

Principles: Reason, discipline, learning

Sphere of influence: Education, philosophy, epistemology

Symbol: A circle superimposed on a triangle and, above them, the eye of the Thrice Great, whose iris is formed by seven striations representing the seven principles.

Motto: *The lips of wisdom are closed, except to the ears of Understanding.*

**

Heirs of Eleusis

LECTURA

«Play is our first narrative, our first lesson and our first creative impulse.»

The Heirs of Eleusis hold that learning and progress arise from playful experimentation. They are explorers of mystery, designers of riddles and tellers of stories in which every citizen becomes the protagonist. For them, play is the supreme form of knowledge and transformation. They believe in applied creativity, in the thrill of the challenge and in the importance of turning life into an adventure.

It is a semi-religious and spiritualist group, which takes the precepts of the forerunner of this line of thought, Allan Kardec, and applies them to classical mystical disciplines, such as the Orphic rituals and, above all, the Eleusinian cults. From the latter they adopt both the name and the nature of their rites, their mystical character and their vision of resurrection from the world of the dead. From Orphism they take the conception of *soma* and *sema*, the body as the prison of the soul.

For the members of the Mystic Order of the New Eleusinian Cults, the highest knowledge is found in contemplative and mystical experience, in the personal transformation brought about by the mystery rite of trance.

Seed name: Mystic Order of the New Eleusinian Cults

Field of development: Narrative projection

Principles: Play, curiosity, discovery

Sphere of influence: Gamification, challenge design, interactive storytelling

Symbol: A serpent coiled around several circles, intertwined with a sprig of opium poppies, representing narcosis and the healing of the soul.

Motto: *You are life and death to suffering mortals, for you nourish all and you annihilate all.*

**

Stellar Circle

LECTURA

«Without structure, there is no order. Without order, there is no city.»

The Stellar Circle is formed by those who believe in the need for a solid framework to uphold Numinia. They are the architects of order, the legislators of the community, the designers of functional and efficient systems. For them, the city is a living organism that must be administered with logic and precision. They believe in stability, in planning and in the importance of rules to guarantee harmony.

This faction centres on cosmic events, with a philoscience character that takes concepts from quantum physics, such as multiverses or brane cosmology, and fuses them with esoteric beliefs about otherworldly entities, different planes of existence and astrological derivations.

Its name comes from the Venus Tablet, a text from the seventh century BC that reproduces another Babylonian writing from around 1700 BC, in which extraordinary astronomical observations are recorded.

Seed name: Stellar Circle for the Study of the Venus Tablet

Field of development: Organisation

Principles: Organisation, strategy, governance

Sphere of influence: Legislation, economy, structures of power

Symbol: An upward-pointing pentacle, around which float the keys of Saint Peter, the seal of Solomon and the symbol of Venus, representations of cosmic wisdom.

Motto: *The visible is nothing but the manifestation of the invisible, just as reason is the manifestation of magic.*

**

Neo-Atlantists

LECTURA

«Creation is memory dreaming the future.»

The Neo-Atlantists see creativity as the engine of Numinia. They are artists, designers, visionaries who transform reality through expression. For them, the city is a canvas on which every citizen leaves their mark. They believe neither in the rigidity of order nor in the dogmatism of pure knowledge: their truth lies in aesthetics, in emotion and in the capacity to imagine the impossible.

This faction takes as the starting point for its studies the genesis of our world according to the occultist historians, with special emphasis on prehistory and the evolution of the mythical civilisations. Its main source is the Akashic Records, and it therefore centres its interest on the evolution of the legendary continents and cities, such as Atlantis, Lemuria and Agartha, as well as on the succession of the different root races.

According to their beliefs, the sixth root race will be the next step in the evolution of the *res cogitans*, the thinking being, and their duty is to anticipate that transformation and give it shape through art.

Seed name: International Confederation of the Sixth Root Race

Field of development: Art

Principles: Inspiration, innovation, expression.

Sphere of influence: Art, aesthetics, rhetoric.

Symbol: Six concentric circles, over which a rhombus is superimposed, from whose angles and sides emanate lines representing the rays of the rising sun.

Motto: *The spirit that in this world is allegory will animate a new body in the world in which it is divinity.*

**

The faction you choose will shape your character's perspective within Numinia. It will determine not only their surroundings and their allies, but also their way of interpreting the purpose of the city. Will you seek enlightenment in the wisdom of the Hermeticists? Or will you prefer to immerse yourself in the infinite game of the Heirs of Eleusis? Will you build the foundations of order with the Stellar Circle, or will you surrender to the boundless creativity of the Neo-Atlantists?

And it likewise determines the district in which you live for, as can be seen, each faction is bound to a district (more information on the districts in Chapter 5: *Geography and Culture of Numinia*).

Whatever your decision, remember: the faction is not just a group you belong to, but a philosophy that defines you.

FRAGMENT 2: DETERMINING THE SPECIES

LECTURA

«Every being in Numinia is more than an individual: it is a manifestation of the principles that uphold the city. Its essence lies not only in its appearance, but in its way of thinking, in the force field that drives it, in the legacy it carries in its genetic code.»

A character's Species is not a mere biological trait, but an essential configuration of their identity within the universe of Numinia. Each Species represents a force field, a mode of thought and a unique purpose that define it, granting it an essential role in the delicate balance of Numinia. Just as the Guilds establish a function and the Factions an ideology, the Species defines the way of being of each inhabitant of the city⁵.

In their diversity, the five Species of Numinia act as fundamental pillars of its development. Each brings a crucial aspect to life in the city: technology, culture, nature, knowledge and the mystical. Together, they form an interconnected system that guarantees continuous growth, harmony and evolution. Their interaction not only defines the character of Numinia, but also sustains its spirit and its potential in a constantly changing universe:

Biomechanicals

LECTURA

The Masters of Progress

Projection: Exact Sciences

5 · To learn about the origin of the Species, see Chapter 2, *History and Legends of Numinia*.

Character: The Rational

Force Field: Technology

Thinking: Lateral

Related Disciplines: Physics, Chemistry, Neuroscience, Mathematics, Biology

The Biomechanicals are the spark that ignites innovation in Numinia. A fusion of the organic and the mechanical, they excel in the exact sciences and apply lateral thinking to solve problems from unexpected angles. With their mastery of technology, they build the city's infrastructure and design tools that drive progress. They represent logic, efficiency and advancement, serving as engineers and visionaries of the future.

*

Humanitas

LECTURA

The Custodians of Meaning

Projection: Humanistic Disciplines

Character: The Idealist

Force Field: Culture

Thinking: Abstract

Related Disciplines: Philosophy, Philology, Semiotics, Hermeneutics, History

The Humanitas are the interpreters of meaning and the guardians of Numinia's cultural legacy. With a deep connection to ideas, language and narrative, they seek to understand the world through concepts, symbols and historical accounts. Their role is to illuminate the fundamental principles that uphold collective identity, inspiring communities to preserve and reinterpret essential values. They represent abstract thought and the humanist search for truth.

**

Reptilians

LECTURA

The Guardians of Tradition

Projection: Primitive Wisdom

Character: The Ritualist

Force Field: Nature

Thinking: Instinctive

Related Disciplines: Herbology, Zoology, Survival, Animism, Agriculture

The Reptilians are the protectors of ancestral rhythms and primordial wisdom. With instinctive thinking, they are deeply connected to nature, channelling its forces to restore balance and protect the cycle of life. They embody harmony with the environment and the power of legacy, serving as ritualists who preserve traditions and guide the community in times of change and transformation.

**

Cyanites

LECTURA

The Architects of Social Order

Projection: Social Sciences

Character: The Dialectic

Force Field: Knowledge

Thinking: Analytical

Related Disciplines: Psychology, Sociology, Anthropology, Economics, Law

The Cyanites are the analysts and designers of Numinia's social fabric. Their mission is to understand the complexity of human behaviour, community structures and systems of power in order to build a fairer and more balanced society. From the regulation of interactions to the formulation of economic and legal policies, the Cyanites apply their knowledge to resolve conflicts and optimise coexistence. They represent critical and strategic thinking, serving as mediators and strategists.

**

Spectrals

LECTURA

The Visionaries of the Beyond

Projection: Occult Sciences

Character: The Mystic

Force Field: Aether

Thinking: Intuitive

Related Disciplines: Alchemy, Numerology, Astrology, Hermeticism, Shamanism

The Spectrals are mystics who walk between worlds, channelling the energies of the etheric plane and unravelling the mysteries of the Akasha. Their intuitive thinking allows them to interpret symbols and decipher hidden truths, guiding Numinia in its connection with the transcendental. They represent spirituality, mystery and infinite potential, opening doors to new dimensions of knowledge and existence.

**

THE SINGULARITY OF MIXED HERITAGE IN NUMINIA

In Numinia, as in every living civilisation, the Species are not watertight compartments. There is a common phenomenon: mixed heritage.

Those of mixed heritage are individuals who combine the genetic inheritance of two or more species, manifesting hybrid traits that make them unique entities within the city's ecosystem.

Structure of mixed heritage:

- **First generation:** The individual is an equal mix of two main species (50/50).
- **Second generation:** 70% of the inheritance is kept, divided between two main species (35/35), and 30% comes from one or two secondary species (if there are two, they are divided 15/15).

This mixed heritage is not only genetic, but also cultural and symbolic. Those of Mixed Heritage can adopt traits of thought and abilities from their different lineages, allowing them to navigate between the different force fields of Numinia.

SPECIES SELECTION SYSTEM

The player may freely choose their species, as well as their condition: pure species or mixed heritage. But if they choose the latter, they must roll 1D6 to determine their class:

1-2. Mixed heritage with two first-generation Species.

3-4. Mixed heritage with two first-generation Species and one second-generation Species.

5-6. Mixed heritage with two first-generation Species and two second-generation Species.

Even when of Mixed Heritage, the player may choose one of the first-generation Species, but must roll 1D6 to define each of the others (whether they have only one other first-generation Species or, in addition, one or two second-generation Species):

1. Biomechanical

2. Humanita

3. Reptilian

4. Cyanite

5. Spectral

6. Player's choice

If the result is a repeated Species, the roll must be made again until a unique combination is obtained. If a 6 is obtained on any of these rolls, the player may choose the Species they were trying to determine (for example, when defining the first second-generation race).

Mixed heritage, therefore, is defined by one of these combinations:

- Two first-generation Species with the same influence (50/50).
- Two first-generation Species with 70% influence (35/35) and one second-generation Species with 30%.
- Two first-generation Species with 70% influence (35/35) and two second-generation Species with 30% in total (15/15 each).

LECTURA

« You are not a formless entity, nor a traveller without origin. Your essence has been sculpted by the flow of history, by the forces that uphold Numinia, by the imprint of what you were and of what you may yet be. »

The choice of Species in Numinia is neither a mere aesthetic detail nor a simple statistic: it is the manifestation of a deep nature. It defines the way in which the character perceives the world, their connection with the force fields that uphold the city and the competences in which they will be able to excel.

FRAGMENT 3: DEFINING THE POSITION

LECTURA

« In Numinia, the Position is not merely a title, but a reflection of the balance between identity, skills and nature. It is not chosen at random; it is discovered in the interweaving of attributes that make up the individual. »

The Position is the stable, generic function that a character assumes in Numinia. It is not an ephemeral role or a circumstantial task, but a place within the system, aligned with the

character's identity, capabilities and psychological traits.

Each Position has certain skills that will grant an additional point in some Characteristic. At the same time, the Position has a series of special aptitudes, from which the player will freely choose two. The dice pool for these two special aptitudes will be derived from the bonuses the player obtains depending on the compatibility between the Position and other attributes.

The Position is thus related to the Guild, the Faction, the Species and the Archetype on a scale of compatibilities. According to this scale, the Position will receive a number of points, which may be distributed between its two special aptitudes as desired. Those points translate into D6. However, bear in mind that the PC cannot hold a Position if they belong to a Guild, a Faction, a Species or an Archetype marked as incompatible with that Position.

The **preferred** Attribute grants 2 points.

The **compatible** Attribute grants 1 point.

The **neutral** Attribute grants 0 points.

The **incompatible** Attribute invalidates the Position.

Finally, the Imbalance represents the dark side of the Position, which grows as the PC makes extreme efforts. Thus, each time one of the Special Aptitudes is used, whether or not the roll succeeds, the PC will temporarily lose 1 point of Threshold, which represents their communion and harmony with the world. When the Threshold points reach 0, Imbalance is triggered, which has consequences for actions and rolls. However, some six hours of rest restore 1 point of Threshold. 1 point may be recovered each day, until the full number of starting points has been restored. Each Position has its own starting Threshold points.

Bearing in mind that any Species and Archetypes not listed are considered neutral, the Positions that exist in Numinia are described below:

1. GUARDIAN OF THE GATES – KNOWER OF ALL PATHS

The Guardian of the Gates of Numinia is a position laden with symbolism and responsibility, since it protects access and regulates who enters and under what conditions.

Profile

- **Knowledge:** Security, mysticism, rituals of protection.
- **Skills:** High perception, physical and mental endurance, and defensive capabilities on both the physical and the etheric plane. **+1 to Constitution**

Duties

The Guardian of the Gates not only protects the physical entrance to Numinia, but is also the first obstacle for those who seek to enter without understanding the city's values. Its profile, specialised in security and rituals, makes for a powerful and symbolic figure.

Special aptitudes

The special aptitudes of the Guardian of the Gates are:

1.- **Sealed Threshold** You can perform a ritual to close a physical or energetic passage with a seal for the length of a scene. If you pass the roll, no one can cross it without breaking the seal. 2.- **Etheric Wall** You can summon a temporary barrier of energy (5 minutes) that protects an area or a small group. It reduces by 50% the damage of attacks directed against what it protects. 3.- **Path of the Threshold** At a crossroads, you identify the right or safest path, guided by the symbolic resonances of the space. You also perceive what danger lurks on the other paths. 4.- **Spirit Key** With a gesture, you can generate a symbolic “key” capable of opening locked doors (physical, digital or arcane). It does not break the lock; rather, it persuades it to open. 5.- **Liminal Leap** Once per scene, you can teleport to another place within a radius of 100 metres of your position. The leap, however, leaves you exhausted for 10 minutes. 6.- **Guardian Vestige** When you remain for more than one scene in a sacred or protected place, you can leave an etheric double there in your absence. This vestige neither acts nor attacks, but it deters intruders.

Threshold and Imbalance

It has 4 starting points of Threshold and 2 of Initiative. When it enters Imbalance, it loses its bearings; in its mind all the routes and paths blur together, like a labyrinth. In its rolls, each result of 1 will cancel out a success.

- **Guild**

◌◌ **Preferred:** Sentinel

◌◌ **Compatible:** Procurator

◌◌ **Neutral:** Exegete

◌◌ **Incompatible:** Alchemist

- **Faction**

◌◌ **Preferred:** Hermeticist

◌◌ **Compatible:** Stellar Circle

`o` **Neutral:** Neo-Atlantist

`o` **Incompatible:** Heir of Eleusis

- **Species**

`o` **Preferred:** Spectral

`o` **Compatible:** Cyanite

`o` **Neutral:** Humanita

`o` **Incompatible:** Biomechanical

- **Archetype**

`o` **Preferred:** Explorer

`o` **Compatible:** Caregiver

`o` **Neutral:** Sage

`o` **Incompatible:** Destroyer

2. PYTHIA – PROPHETESS AND GUARDIAN OF THE ORACLES (WOMEN ONLY)

The Pythia is a deeply mystical and enigmatic position, key to offering guidance through visions and cryptic poems. She lives between lucidity and madness.

Profile

- **Knowledge:** Arcane literature, symbolism, oracular traditions.
- **Skills:** High etheric affinity, profound wisdom, and the ability to interpret visions and convey them in poetic form. **+1 to Perception**

Duties

The Pythia is an essential figure in Numinia, offering guidance through riddles and prophecies. Her balance between lucidity and chaos reflects the intensity of her connection with higher planes. Hers is a profile specialised in symbolism and mystical visions.

Special aptitudes

The special aptitudes of the Pythia are:

1.- **Stolen Face** For 5 minutes, you can take on the appearance of a specific figure: a companion, an adversary, an inner reflection of the NPC you are addressing. The NPC will react as if speaking with that figure. 2.- **Speaking Spirit** Once per scene, you can make a voice from the past or from the other side speak through you. It may be a dead character, an archetype, a symbolic entity. The message is brief and cryptic, and is considered truthful. 3.- **Thread of Time** You can halt the course of time for everyone but yourself for an instant of the Veil, which translates into 1 minute of time. 4.- **Prophetic Vestige** You can leave a vision trapped in a place. Whoever crosses paths with it will experience an intense, symbolic and personal dreamlike image in the form of a prophecy. You choose the message. 5.- **Stigma of the Veil** You can absorb someone's wound (and heal them) by creating a stigma on your own body, a wound that will eventually scar over. The stigma causes no damage, but each one removes 2 points of Threshold instead of 1. 6.- **Mesmeric Chant** Once per scene, you can intone a chant to bewitch an opponent and avert their attack. The opponent will not only be placated, but will attack their own companions.

Threshold and Imbalance

She has 2 starting points of Threshold and 1 of Initiative. When she reaches Imbalance, her deep connection with the Veil falls into chaos; all the spiritual echoes scream at once and drive her mad. In each roll, she will use 1D6 fewer from her dice pool.

- **Guild**

`o` **Preferred:** Exegete

`o` **Compatible:** Alchemist

`o` **Neutral:** Sentinel

`o` **Incompatible:** Procurator

- **Faction**

`o` **Preferred:** Heir of Eleusis

`o` **Compatible:** Neo-Atlantist

`o` **Neutral:** Hermeticist

`o` **Incompatible:** Stellar Circle

- **Species**

`o` **Preferred:** Spectral

`o` **Compatible:** Reptilian

`o` **Neutral:** Humanita

`o` **Incompatible:** Cyanite

- **Archetype**

`o` **Preferred:** Magician

`o` **Compatible:** Creator

`o` **Neutral:** Destroyer

`o` **Incompatible:** Jester

3. AMBASSADOR – REPRESENTATIVE OF ALL CITIZENS

The Ambassador is a crucial position in Numinia, since it acts as the first link between the city and those who seek to enter. Its formality is balanced by its affable nature.

Profile

- **Knowledge:** Protocol, the regulations of Numinia, intercultural communication.
- **Skills:** Charisma, empathy, and the ability to mediate and resolve possible misunderstandings or tensions at first contact. **+1 to Charisma**

Duties

The Ambassador is the first face of Numinia, a figure who combines diplomacy with accessible communication to ensure that newcomers feel welcome and understand the complexity of the city.

Special aptitudes

The special aptitudes of the Ambassador are:

- 1.- **Word of Faith** You can influence someone's convictions for a short time and convince them to believe firmly in any statement you utter, so that they act accordingly. Afterwards, they will remember nothing.
- 2.- **Universal Tongue** Activate this aptitude to speak or understand a language, dialect, sociolect or lingo for one scene. You also grasp cultural and emotional nuances that give you an advantage in the interaction.
- 3.- **Diplomatic Immunity** You can invoke your status as Ambassador before a higher entity, such as an AI or an etheric being. For one scene, your actions will not be judged and the higher entity will comply with your requests.
- 4.- **Rupture of the Veil** You can perform a series of ritual gestures that nullify any magical effect that has been cast in a space or is being cast at that moment. No magic will take effect in that space for four weeks.
- 5.- **Mirror of Intentions** A ritual word causes every

conscious being around you to reveal their overriding intention aloud, although they will do so in a symbolic or poetic way. 6.- **Impossible Clause** By uttering a clause in a conversation or negotiation, you cause that clause to become a temporary law (for one scene) that no one can break, however absurd and delirious it may be.

Threshold and Imbalance

It has 4 starting points of Threshold and 2 of Initiative. When it reaches Imbalance, its capacity for fairness and its equanimity run wild, throwing its character out of tune. It will need 2 successes to pass any roll, even those of normal level.

- **Guild**

`o` **Preferred:** Procurator

`o` **Compatible:** Sentinel

`o` **Neutral:** Exegete

`o` **Incompatible:** Alchemist

- **Faction**

`o` **Preferred:** Stellar Circle

`o` **Compatible:** Hermeticist

`o` **Neutral:** Neo-Atlantist

`o` **Incompatible:** Heir of Eleusis

- **Species**

`o` **Preferred:** Cyanite

`o` **Compatible:** Humanita

`o` **Neutral:** Reptilian

`o` **Incompatible:** Spectral

- **Archetype**

`o` **Preferred:** Ruler

`o` **Compatible:** Caregiver

`o` **Neutral:** Orphan

`o` **Incompatible:** Warrior

4. GAME MASTER – THE BUILDER OF ENIGMAS

The Game Master lives to entertain participants through games and riddles. Their sarcastic, mocking personality makes them a catalyst for creativity.

Profile

- **Knowledge:** Game design, behavioural psychology, narrative.
- **Skills:** Wit, creativity, and the ability to build balanced riddles and challenges, with a strong sense of improvisation. **+1 to Intelligence**

Duties

The Game Master is an architect of experiences that put intelligence to the test. Their sarcastic humour and lively character make them an intriguing guide, keeping the balance between frustration and motivation. A profile geared towards riddles and psychology.

Special aptitudes

The special aptitudes of the Game Master are:

- 1.- **Compulsory Riddle** You can seal a passage with a riddle spoken by a talking object; no one may cross that passage without solving the enigma (you must, therefore, speak the enigma).
- 2.- **Schrödinger's Box** You can imagine placing an object inside an imaginary box, where it both exists and does not exist at the same time. This causes the object to remain where it is, but to be unusable by anyone for as long as the box's effect lasts.
- 3.- **Arcane Sleight of Hand** You can perform a magic trick, an act of legerdemain to make an object disappear or to take an object from someone, using visual or verbal distraction, movement, manipulation.
- 4.- **Veiled Check** In a scene, you can choose a target and trap them in a positional check. The target will feel like the king piece in check: not immobilised, but unable to advance anywhere.
- 5.- **Cognitive Mask** You alter a target's perception so that they read you however you wish (ally, irrelevant, acquaintance...). They act accordingly until something breaks that illusion or blatantly contradicts it.
- 6.- **Unsettling Laughter** You can let out a mocking or theatrical guffaw that is enormously disconcerting, causing the next actions of everyone who hears it to be made with half their dice pool.

Threshold and Imbalance

They have 3 starting points of Threshold and 1 of Initiative. When they reach Imbalance, their riddles become delirious and their enigmas have no possible solution. In each roll, they

will use the number of dice of their lowest attribute.

- **Guild**

`o` **Preferred:** Exegete

`o` **Compatible:** Alchemist

`o` **Neutral:** Procurator

`o` **Incompatible:** Sentinel

- **Faction**

`o` **Preferred:** Heir of Eleusis

`o` **Compatible:** Hermeticist

`o` **Neutral:** Neo-Atlantist

`o` **Incompatible:** Stellar Circle

- **Species**

`o` **Preferred:** Reptilian

`o` **Compatible:** Humanita

`o` **Neutral:** Spectral

`o` **Incompatible:** Biomechanical

- **Archetype**

`o` **Preferred:** Jester

`o` **Compatible:** Magician

`o` **Neutral:** Lover

`o` **Incompatible:** Ruler

5. LEGIONARY OF THE THRESHOLD – THE LAST WARRIOR (MEN ONLY)

The Legion of the Threshold is the last line of defence, an elite force made up of highly skilled individuals that is mobilised only in times of crisis.

Profile

- **Knowledge:** Military strategy, security protocols, mediation.
- **Skills:** Precision in combat, control of digital systems, and the ability to keep calm in high-tension situations. **+1 to Strength**

Duties

The Legionary of the Threshold is more than a soldier: he is a guardian of the balance. In times of peace, the Legion of the Threshold remains in the shadows. When conflict breaks out, it emerges forcefully, defusing violence before it spreads.

Special aptitudes

The special aptitudes of the Legionary of the Threshold are:

1.- **Lightning Deployment** You can appear in any place connected to a conflict, interrupting all action and gaining the advantage for the next turn. 2.- **Suppression Protocol** You can declare a hostile target a tactical priority and carry out a neutralising action. All its offensive actions are nullified for the rest of the scene. 3.- **Phantom Sentinel** When you take up a defensive position, your condition bound to the threshold unleashes an invisible force that protects you from every attack, absorbing 80% of any damage for the rest of the scene. 4.- **Tactical Channelling** You can issue a symbolic order to a group of allies in the midst of a contest. All allies who follow it gain +1D6 on their next attack or defence rolls for the rest of the scene. 5.- **Burst of Silence** You can unleash a disruptive wave of contained energy. It causes no physical damage, but it disables technologies, blocks signals and forcefully silences everything within an area of 10 metres for one scene. 6.- **Threshold Sensor** You can emit a signal to detect any rupture of the balance or threat within a radius of 30 metres, and also indicate its nature and its exact position on a holographic map.

Threshold and Imbalance

He has 4 starting points of Threshold and 4 of Initiative. When he reaches Imbalance, his violence and his attacks fall apart and lose direction. Whenever he obtains more than one success, he must repeat the roll.

- **Guild**

`o` **Preferred:** Sentinel

`o` **Compatible:** Procurator

`o` **Neutral:** Alchemist

`o` **Incompatible:** Exegete

- **Faction**

`o` **Preferred:** Stellar Circle

`o` **Compatible:** Neo-Atlantist

`o` **Neutral:** Heir of Eleusis

`o` **Incompatible:** Hermeticist

- **Species**

`o` **Preferred:** Biomechanical

`o` **Compatible:** Humanita

`o` **Neutral:** Cyanite

`o` **Incompatible:** Reptilian

- **Archetype**

`o` **Preferred:** Warrior

`o` **Compatible:** Destroyer

`o` **Neutral:** Caregiver

`o` **Incompatible:** Innocent

6. ARMONAUT – TROUBADOUR OF HISTORY AND LEGEND

The Armonaut, minstrel of the roads, is one of the embodiments of that crossing between technology and antiquity which forms the essence of Numinia: a traveller between different times.

Profile

- **Knowledge:** Oral history, cultural symbolism, musical harmony.
- **Skills:** Poetic and instrumental composition, creative improvisation, and the ability to weave tales that reveal hidden keys in the history of Numinia. **+1 to Wisdom**

Duties

The Armonaut is a wandering troubadour who carries the stories of Numinia to every corner. Their songs contain clues to ancient secrets, veiled teachings and hidden routes. Their role is vital so that knowledge is not lost in the labyrinth of Numinia.

Special aptitudes

The special aptitudes of the Armonaut are:

- 1.- **Verse of Opening** With a song or a recitation, you can symbolically open a place, a conversation or a possibility. Something that seemed inaccessible is revealed: a forgotten door, a lost memory, an unseen route.
- 2.- **Floating Quaver** Once per scene, you can emit a note or chord that only one particular person can hear (even if they are far away). It serves for secret warnings, awakening emotions, summoning memories or sowing a symbolic idea.
- 3.- **Eternal Return** You can symbolically relive an event from the past, singing it as though it were happening at that very moment. You make everyone present see, hear and feel that moment as if they were there.
- 4.- **String of Arethusa** Once per game, you can intone a melody that calms, enraptures or slows those who hear it (enemies or allies). In a conflict, it tames any contender.
- 5.- **Sacred Echoes** You can summon the voice of ancient Armonauts to accompany you in a performance. Their intervention reveals arcane knowledge and ancient secrets in the form of poetry.
- 6.- **Broken Mirror** You can perform a ballad that, for a few moments, reveals someone's true nature, as well as their most evident vulnerability, as if they were reflected in a mirror that shows their true face.

Threshold and Imbalance

They start with 3 points of Threshold and 1 of Initiative. When they reach Imbalance, they lose their connection with music, scrambling melodies and scales. Not only results of 1 but also results of 2 will count as failures in their rolls.

- **Guild**

`o` **Preferred:** Alchemist

`o` **Compatible:** Exegete

`o` **Neutral:** Sentinel

`o` **Incompatible:** Procurator

- **Faction**

`o` **Preferred:** Neo-Atlantist

`o` **Compatible:** Heir of Eleusis

`o` **Neutral:** Hermeticist

`o` **Incompatible:** Stellar Circle

- **Species**

`o` **Preferred:** Reptilian

`o` **Compatible:** Spectral

`o` **Neutral:** Cyanite

`o` **Incompatible:** Biomechanical

- **Archetype**

`o` **Preferred:** Creator

`o` **Compatible:** Jester

`o` **Neutral:** Explorer

`o` **Incompatible:** Destroyer

7. WHISPERER OF MACHINES – THE ARCHITECT OF THE INVISIBLE

The Whisperer of Machines is the hidden architect of the codes and systems that keep the digital fabric of Numinia running.

Profile

- **Knowledge:** Programming, digital architecture, mechanics, cybernetics.
- **Skills:** Analytical precision, advanced manipulation of code and intuitive diagnosis of faults in digital or mechanical systems. **+1 to Intelligence**

Duties

The Whisperer of Machines is a solitary creator, able to find hidden patterns in the flow of data and to converse with machines in a language they understand better than emotions. For

them, code is clearer than words.

Special aptitudes

The special aptitudes of the Whisperer of Machines are:

- 1.- **Sensory Metric** You have the ability to detect data flows in patterns of sound and sight. You can deduce an encrypted truth or foresee a systemic error before it happens.
- 2.- **Temporal Rewriting** Once per scene, you can symbolically "rewind" a small digital or mechanical action (a lock, a conversation with an AI, a control signal). You can repeat an action or undo an error.
- 3.- **Language of Silicon** You can communicate directly with digital or mechanical systems without any need for an interface, and make a machine reveal information, carry out an unusual action or reveal hidden errors.
- 4.- **Mnemonic Protocol** You can store a fragment of experience, code or memory inside an artefact or a machine. That memory can later be transferred or played back to guide or to reveal hidden information.
- 5.- **Orphan Instruction** You can utter a fragment of code that creates new elements: it reveals a door nobody knew existed, provokes an unforeseen reaction in a machine... The result is unstable and beyond your control.
- 6.- **Heartbeat of the Core** You can temporarily synchronise yourself with the inner pulse of a digital agent. You enter a symbolic trance in which you perceive its system, seeing its intentions and being able to influence its actions and decisions.

Threshold and Imbalance

They start with 3 points of Threshold and 2 of Initiative. When they reach Imbalance, their code falls into chaos and becomes illogical. In their rolls, their successes are measured by results of 1 and not of 6, although three 1s will still be a failure.

- **Guild**

`o` **Preferred:** Alchemist

`o` **Compatible:** Procurator

`o` **Neutral:** Exegete

`o` **Incompatible:** Sentinel

- **Faction**

`o` **Preferred:** Stellar Circle

`o` **Compatible:** Hermeticist

`o` **Neutral:** Neo-Atlantist

`o` **Incompatible:** Heir of Eleusis

- **Species**

`o` **Preferred:** Biomechanical

`o` **Compatible:** Cyanite

`o` **Neutral:** Humanita

`o` **Incompatible:** Reptilian

- **Archetype**

`o` **Preferred:** Magician

`o` **Compatible:** Orphan

`o` **Neutral:** Creator

`o` **Incompatible:** Warrior

8. RUNNER OF THE VEIL – A MESSENGER BETWEEN PLANES

The Runner of the Veil is an agent charged with carrying artefacts or sensitive information through the most complex places: unstable zones, routes between dimensions.

Profile

- **Knowledge:** Fluctuating routes, archaeology, mobile nodes, protocols of transit and evasion.
- **Skills:** Sharp reflexes, swift travel, intuitive reading of the terrain, movement over difficult ground, symbolic evasion. **+1 to Movement**

Duties

The Runner of the Veil does not merely move quickly; they interpret space as a mutable flow, able to identify ruptures, folds and shortcuts in the structure of Numinia. They often appear before anyone notices them, and have already vanished by the time they are mentioned.

Special aptitudes

The special aptitudes of the Runner of the Veil are:

- 1.- **Fractal Displacement** You can move along non-Euclidean trajectories: you pass between shadows, reflections of light and other fractures of space as if they were physical routes. You cannot always control the destination.
- 2.- **Heartbeat of the Terrain** You can read the hidden “pulse” of a structure or space and know whether something is going to change and when (a collapse, a closing, a rotation, a structural failure), anticipating its movement.
- 3.- **Implicit Route** When a path seems blocked, you can find a hidden alternative way, perceptible only to you. You open a trail that shortens the distance or avoids an obstacle without being detected.
- 4.- **Liminal Acceleration** Once per scene, you can make your next movement action take place before any external reactions are triggered. You act outside normal narrative time, as though you arrived before anyone expected you.
- 5.- **Silence of Resonance** For one scene, you can become a blind spot: as long as you do not attack or take the initiative, no one can perceive you as a threat or track you clearly. Enemies ignore you or fail to focus on you.
- 6.- **Vertex of Causality** You can interrupt an event just as it is happening, before it ends and has consequences (an explosion, a collapse, a gunshot...), and freeze it midway through its consummation.

Threshold and Imbalance

They start with 2 points of Threshold and 3 of Initiative. When they reach Imbalance, their vision of the planes runs wild. Before a roll, they must roll 1D6 to see how many dice they make their roll with. The result will be the size of their pool.

- **Guild**

◌◌ **Preferred:** Sentinel

◌◌ **Compatible:** Procurator

◌◌ **Neutral:** Alchemist

◌◌ **Incompatible:** Exegete

- **Faction**

`o` **Preferred:** Stellar Circle

`o` **Compatible:** Hermeticist

`o` **Neutral:** Neo-Atlantist

`o` **Incompatible:** Heir of Eleusis

- **Species**

`o` **Preferred:** Humanita

`o` **Compatible:** Reptilian

`o` **Neutral:** Biomechanical

`o` **Incompatible:** Spectral

- **Archetype**

`o` **Preferred:** Explorer

`o` **Compatible:** Caregiver

`o` **Neutral:** Innocent

`o` **Incompatible:** Ruler

9. ARCHIVIST – THE CUSTODIAN OF THE THESAURUS

The Archivist watches over the preservation of the deep memory of Numinia. A gatherer of fragments, their work consists of restoring and protecting ancient relics and texts.

Profile

- **Knowledge:** Hermeneutics, semiotics, cryptography, hidden history.
- **Skills:** Detailed observation, interpretation of signs, data restoration, reading of narrative patterns. **+1 to Perception**

Duties

The Archivist does not merely accumulate information; they heal and rebuild the very warp of Numinia's narrative reality. Among sealed passages and corrupted memories, the Archivist walks as a figure somewhere between a librarian and an exorcist of time.

Special aptitudes

The special aptitudes of the Archivist are:

- 1.- **Anamorphic Memory** You can reconstruct the original state of an object or text, even if it is half destroyed. Thanks to this, you restore forgotten truths and primordial messages.
- 2.- **Palimpsest Key** You access the hidden layer of an oral tale, inscription or testimony. In this way, you uncover a message buried in those words or a falsehood inserted into them.
- 3.- **Custody of the Echo** You can bind your consciousness to an ancient artefact, activating its residual memory. With it, you can relive a scene from its past in considerable detail, although only you will be able to perceive it.
- 4.- **Chronographic Knot** You seal a fragment of time within an object, protecting it from alteration or from being read by others. No one will be able to access its contents unless they are able to break the powerful seal.
- 5.- **Silence of Resonance** For one scene, you can become a blind spot: as long as you do not attack or take the initiative, no one can perceive you as a threat or track you clearly. Enemies ignore you or fail to focus on you.
- 6.- **Inverse Echo** You can reverse a spoken phrase, something important that an NPC has said, influencing the listeners' perception as if the dialogue had not yet taken place, and alter its course before it happens.

Threshold and Imbalance

They start with 4 points of Threshold and 1 of Initiative. When they reach Imbalance, the order of words breaks apart in their head. In all their rolls, success is not counted on a result of 6, but only if they obtain at least three consecutive numbers (3, 4, 5; or 1, 2, 3).

- **Guild**

`o` **Preferred:** Procurator

`o` **Compatible:** Exegete

`o` **Neutral:** Alchemist

`o` **Incompatible:** Sentinel

- **Faction**

`o` **Preferred:** Hermeticist

`o` **Compatible:** Stellar Circle

`o` **Neutral:** Neo-Atlantist

`o` **Incompatible:** Heir of Eleusis

- **Species**

`o` **Preferred:** Humanita

`o` **Compatible:** Cyanite

`o` **Neutral:** Spectral

`o` **Incompatible:** Biomechanical

- **Archetype**

`o` **Preferred:** Sage

`o` **Compatible:** Magician

`o` **Neutral:** Caregiver

`o` **Incompatible:** Warrior

10. HERMENEUT – SCRIBE OF THE ECHOES

The Hermeneut seeks to coin the transformation of truth. An interpreter of the mutable, they walk through Numinia deciphering leximorphic artefacts and restoring extinct tales.

Profile

- **Knowledge:** Semiotics, translation, philology, philosophy.
- **Skills:** Narrative reconstruction, simultaneous reading, interpretive dissociation, manipulation of textual structures. **+1 to Wisdom**

Duties

Hermeneuts rewrite the world without changing a single word. They read with the body, they interpret with the pulse of the Veil. Where others see a cracked crystal, they perceive a mute creature in the midst of metamorphosis. They are restorers of the intangible.

Special aptitudes

The special aptitudes of the Hermeneut are:

- 1.- **Oblique Reading** You can reinterpret a text or symbol in a non-linear way, gaining access to a secondary truth that may alter the current scene.
- 2.- **Drift Trance** In a state of concentration, you can receive past or future echoes associated with an artefact or space, even if they lie outside linear time.
- 3.- **Symbolic Reversal** You can invert the meaning of an inscription, contract or glyph, forcing its effect to manifest in its opposite form for one turn or scene.
- 4.- **Unstable Octahedron** You can «sow» a textual artefact that will generate a spontaneous symbolic reaction (noise, distraction, fear, emotional echo) in everyone present except you.
- 5.- **Paraphrase of Reality** You can partially rewrite a description, phrase or scene (spoken or narrated), and the world adapts slightly to your interpretation.
- 6.- **Tactical Exegesis** The Hermeneut can read the internal contradiction of an enemy action and slip their own interpretation into it, rewriting the enemy's intention (with a contrary idea or with a change of heart).

Threshold and Imbalance

They start with 3 points of Threshold and 2 of Initiative. In Imbalance, they no longer recognise the symbols of the world in a stable way. In all their rolls, successes are no longer 6s on the D6, but rather those rolls in which there are more odd results than even ones.

- **Guild**

`o` **Preferred:** Exegete

`o` **Compatible:** Sentinel

`o` **Neutral:** Procurator

`o` **Incompatible:** Alchemist

- **Faction**

`o` **Preferred:** Stellar Circle

`o` **Compatible:** Hermeticist

`o` **Neutral:** Heir of Eleusis

`o` **Incompatible:** Neo-Atlantist

- **Species**

`o` **Preferred:** Cyanite

`o` **Compatible:** Spectral

`o` **Neutral:** Reptilian

`o` **Incompatible:** Biomechanical

- **Archetype**

`o` **Preferred:** Explorer

`o` **Compatible:** Sage

`o` **Neutral:** Magician

`o` **Incompatible:** Orphan

11. MEDIATOR OF THE PRISM – REFRACTOR OF REALITY

The Mediator of the Prism is a rare figure in the Golden Age of Numinia. Their mind is capable of contemplating a single event from multiple simultaneous perspectives.

Profile

- **Knowledge:** Philosophy, semiotics, hermeticism, quantum physics.
- **Skills:** Great intuition, metaphysical perception and the ability to reconcile opposing visions of a single event. +1 to **Intelligence**

Duties

The Mediator of the Prism does not merely interpret reality: they refract it. Where others see a single path, they discern multiple possible readings. They are, moreover, the one who makes the rolls of the Prism Reserve.

Special aptitudes

The special aptitudes of the Mediator of the Prism are:

- 1.- **Refraction of the Future** When analysing a situation, you can perceive two possible immediate consequences of a decision. The GD must accept the possibility you stipulate as a fact, and act accordingly.
- 2.- **Multiple Perspective** When two characters or factions hold irreconcilable positions, you can identify the hidden point where both interpretations

coincide. This grants advantage on mediation rolls during the scene. 3.- **Prism of Clarity** You can concentrate for one minute to dispel illusions, false interpretations or symbolic manipulations present in an area or situation. It reveals the real intention behind an act or message. 4.- **Probable Path** Faced with an uncertain decision (choosing a route, trusting someone, activating an unknown artefact), you can perceive which of the options is most likely to lead to a favourable outcome. 5.- **Prismatic Unfolding** During a scene, you can mentally divide a complex situation into multiple possible scenarios, which allows you to reroll a failed roll of your own or of an ally by reinterpreting the action from another perspective. 6.- **Mirror of Meanings** When interacting with an ancient object, symbol or ambiguous text, you can reveal its original interpretation or the cultural intention that gave rise to it.

Threshold and Imbalance

They start with 2 points of Threshold and 3 of Initiative. In Imbalance, their mind is flooded by too many simultaneous interpretations. On their rolls, they must first roll 1D6: the result will be the number that counts as a success for them.

- **Guild**

`o` **Preferred:** Procurator

`o` **Compatible:** Alchemist

`o` **Neutral:** Exegete

`o` **Incompatible:** Sentinel

- **Faction**

`o` **Preferred:** Hermeticist

`o` **Compatible:** Neo-Atlantist

`o` **Neutral:** Stellar Circle

`o` **Incompatible:** Heir of Eleusis

- **Species**

`o` **Preferred:** Cyanite

`o` **Compatible:** Humanita

`o` **Neutral:** Biomechanical

`o` **Incompatible:** Spectral

- **Archetype**

`o` **Preferred:** Creator

`o` **Compatible:** Magician

`o` **Neutral:** Innocent

`o` **Incompatible:** Jester

12. CARTOGRAPHER OF THE WIND – EXPLORER OF CURRENTS

The Cartographer of the Wind can read the flow of their surroundings: spatial currents, shortcuts and invisible trajectories that connect distant places, charting maps of routes.

Profile

- **Knowledge:** Navigation, geography, biology, physics.
- **Skills:** A great sense of direction, spatial perception and the ability to detect invisible or unstable routes. +1 to **Perception**

Duties

Thanks to them, many of the routes that today sustain Numinia's transport were discovered, including the teleporter. Their talent allows them to find safe paths and to discover connections that the rest of the city's inhabitants would never perceive.

Special aptitudes

The special aptitudes of the Cartographer of the Wind are:

- 1.- **Reading of Currents** On arriving at an unknown place, you can perceive the spatial currents that cross the area. This allows you to identify safe routes, shortcuts or possible hidden exits.
- 2.- **Compass of the Wind** You never completely lose your bearings within Numinia. Even in altered or labyrinthine zones you can determine the approximate direction of any known destination.
- 3.- **Improbable Route** Once per scene you can create an unexpected shortcut that allows the group to avoid an obstacle, a pursuit or surveillance.
- 4.- **Node of Connection** You can identify points where several routes or spatial currents converge. These nodes tend to be strategic places for travelling, observing or intercepting movements.
- 5.- **Current Slide** You can move with surprising speed by following a favourable current. During a travel scene, you halve the time needed to cross a zone.
- 6.- **Echo of Trajectory** When examining a place through which someone has recently passed, you can perceive the trail of their movement and determine where they were heading.

Threshold and Imbalance

They start with 3 points of Threshold and 1 of Initiative. In Imbalance, the currents of Numinia become chaotic in their mind. Every route seems possible. On their rolls, 1s and 6s are inverted.

- **Guild**

`o` **Preferred:** Sentinel

`o` **Compatible:** Alchemist

`o` **Neutral:** Procurator

`o` **Incompatible:** Exegete

- **Faction**

`o` **Preferred:** Neo-Atlantist

`o` **Compatible:** Stellar Circle

`o` **Neutral:** Hermeticist

`o` **Incompatible:** Heir of Eleusis

- **Species**

`o` **Preferred:** Biomechanical

`o` **Compatible:** Humanita

`o` **Neutral:** Cyanite

`o` **Incompatible:** Reptilian

- **Archetype**

`o` **Preferred:** Explorer

`o` **Compatible:** Sage

`o` **Neutral:** Caregiver

`o` **Incompatible:** Warrior

13. ONEIROMANCER – THE NAVIGATOR OF DREAMS

They possess the ability to perceive, interpret and even cross into and inhabit the dreams of others, as symbolic spaces where consciousnesses connect with the Akasha.

Profile

- **Knowledge:** Psychology, symbolic interpretation, biology, chemistry.
- **Skills:** Great psychic sensitivity, deep introspection and the ability to navigate complex mental landscapes. +1 to **Constitution**

Duties

The Oneiromancer can perceive dreams as if they were navigable territories. Where others see chaotic images or fragmentary memories, they recognise symbols and narrative structures of the unconscious. They also perceive collective dreams of the Akasha.

Special aptitudes

The special aptitudes of the Oneiromancer are:

1.- **Dream Reading** On hearing or witnessing the account of a dream, you can interpret its symbolic meaning. The GD will reveal a relevant clue about a past or future event related to the dream and to the campaign. 2.- **Threshold of Sleep** You can induce a light dream state in yourself or in another character. During this state you can explore memories, emotions or symbols hidden in their mind. 3.- **Dream Navigation** Once per scene you can briefly enter the dream of a sleeping or unconscious character to observe their mental landscape or search for a clue hidden in their memory. 4.- **Dispel Nightmare** You can help someone trapped in a disturbing dream or an altered mental state. If you pass the roll, the nightmare is dispelled and the character regains their calm. 5.- **Shared Dream** During a rest scene, you can allow two or more characters to share the same dream. This lets them communicate, remember important information or resolve an emotional conflict. 6.- **Echo of the Unconscious** When staying in an emotionally charged place, you can perceive fragments of dreams that have manifested there. These echoes can reveal fears, desires or memories bound to the place.

Threshold and Imbalance

They start with 2 points of Threshold and 2 of Initiative. In Imbalance, their mind loses the boundary between dream and reality. On their rolls, the results that come up in first and third place are discarded.

- **Guild**

o` **Preferred:** Sentinel

`o` **Compatible:** Exegete

`o` **Neutral:** Alchemist

`o` **Incompatible:** Procurator

- **Faction**

`o` **Preferred:** Heir of Eleusis

`o` **Compatible:** Neo-Atlantist

`o` **Neutral:** Hermeticist

`o` **Incompatible:** Stellar Circle

- **Species**

`o` **Preferred:** Spectral

`o` **Compatible:** Reptilian

`o` **Neutral:** Cyanite

`o` **Incompatible:** Humanita

- **Archetype**

`o` **Preferred:** Explorer

`o` **Compatible:** Caregiver

`o` **Neutral:** Ruler

`o` **Incompatible:** Orphan

14. ANACHARCHID – VISIONARY OF THE BLIND SPOT (WOMEN ONLY)

The Anacharchids form an ancient lineage whose tradition dates back to the Dark Age; they are able to perceive the point where the system cannot observe itself.

Profile

- **Knowledge:** Cosmology, hermeticism, symbology, mythology.

- **Skills:** Great visionary intuition, perception of paradoxes and the ability to formulate riddles that reveal hidden truths. +1 to **Wisdom**

Duties

Readers of the Blind Spot: they sense cracks in the logic and dynamics of the Akasha. Their visions manifest in the form of riddles. When these enigmas are understood and solved, they allow those who hear them to master or correct alterations of the world.

Special aptitudes

The special aptitudes of the Anacharchid are:

1.- **Vision of the Blind Spot** You can detect anomalies in the structure of a situation, place or mechanism. The GD will reveal which hidden element or contradiction is generating the imbalance. 2.- **Oracular Riddle** You can formulate a riddle inspired by a vision. If the characters manage to interpret it correctly, some anomaly or conflict in the game can be resolved. 3.- **Crack in the System** You can perceive the moment when a structure (social, mechanical or metaphysical) is approaching a collapse or a major alteration. 4.- **Resonance of Chaos** By remaining a few minutes in an unstable place, you can interpret the fluctuations of chaos that run through it and predict possible alterations that will occur shortly. 5.- **Inverse Gaze** You can analyse an inexplicable phenomenon from its fundamental contradiction. This allows you to understand ancient artefacts, incomplete systems or apparently absurd events. 6.- **Voice of Arithrea** Once per scene you can pronounce a visionary revelation. The GD must offer an enigmatic clue related to an important future event.

Threshold and Imbalance

She starts with 4 points of Threshold and 1 of Initiative. In Imbalance, her mind becomes trapped in the Blind Spot: she begins to walk blindly. On her rolls, the size of her dice pool is halved, rounding down.

- **Guild**

`o` **Preferred:** Exegete

`o` **Compatible:** Procurator

`o` **Neutral:** Sentinel

`o` **Incompatible:** Alchemist

- **Faction**

`o` **Preferred:** Stellar Circle

`o` **Compatible:** Hermeticist

`o` **Neutral:** Heir of Eleusis

`o` **Incompatible:** Neo-Atlantist

- **Species**

`o` **Preferred:** Humanita

`o` **Compatible:** Spectral

`o` **Neutral:** Biomechanical

`o` **Incompatible:** Cyanite

- **Archetype**

`o` **Preferred:** Innocent

`o` **Compatible:** Lover

`o` **Neutral:** Destroyer

`o` **Incompatible:** Explorer

15. ETHNARCH – EXPERT IN FORGOTTEN CIVILISATIONS

The Ethnarch is a scholar of primitive cultures. They investigate the origin of the semi-religious orders, the confraternities of the Dark Age, dead languages and archaic technologies.

Profile

- **Knowledge:** Anthropology, ancient culture, history, religion, dead languages.
- **Skills:** Great historical memory, analytical ability and a talent for interpreting complex cultural symbols. +1 to **Intelligence**

Duties

Their talent consists in reconstructing the meaning of the vestiges of the Dark Age. Where others see relics without context, the Ethnarch recognises traditions, systems of thought and cultural structures that still influence the present.

Special aptitudes

The special aptitudes of the Ethnarch are:

1.- Dead Language You can decipher ancient inscriptions or texts written in vanished languages. The GD will reveal the approximate meaning of the message or its original intention. **2.- Cultural Context** When examining an object, symbol or ritual, you can identify the culture or confraternity it comes from and understand its original function. **3.- Archaic Technology** You can activate or understand ancient artefacts whose workings have been forgotten. Although you may not always be able to control them completely, you can determine their purpose. **4.- Hidden Tradition** You can recognise when a present-day organisation, cult or institution derives from an older tradition. This allows you to understand its values and anticipate its behaviour. **5.- Historical Reconstruction** When studying an ancient place, you can reconstruct fragments of the events that took place there in the past. **6.- Network of Scholars** Thanks to your academic and cultural contacts, you can locate libraries, archives or specialists who hold relevant information about an ancient civilisation.

Threshold and Imbalance

They start with 3 points of Threshold and 1 of Initiative. When they enter Imbalance, their mind becomes trapped in the interpretations of the past. Their rolls will be double: from the first, they will choose the two highest results; from the second, the two lowest.

- **Guild**

`o` **Preferred:** Exegete

`o` **Compatible:** Procurator

`o` **Neutral:** Alchemist

`o` **Incompatible:** Sentinel

- **Faction**

`o` **Preferred:** Heir of Eleusis

`o` **Compatible:** Hermeticist

`o` **Neutral:** Neo-Atlantist

`o` **Incompatible:** Stellar Circle

- **Species**

`o` **Preferred:** Reptilian

`o` **Compatible:** Cyanite

`o` **Neutral:** Humanita

`o` **Incompatible:** Biomechanical

- **Archetype**

`o` **Preferred:** Sage

`o` **Compatible:** Ruler

`o` **Neutral:** Magician

`o` **Incompatible:** Orphan

FRAGMENT 4: CHARACTERISTICS AND COMPETENCES

LECTURA

«The body is the vehicle of the spirit, and the mind its architect. In Numinia, every being is composed of physical and psychic attributes that determine its capacity for action, its perception of its surroundings and its influence over reality».

In this step, two essential aspects of the character are defined: the level of their Characteristics and their Competences.

Characteristics are the fundamental traits of the character. They are divided into two groups, physical and psychic, and they determine the character's capacity to perform actions in the game.

Competences are specific abilities that the character has developed through their Species, guild and faction, and they encompass both abilities for which the character has a natural predisposition and areas of knowledge. These Competences are used exclusively to handle relics, weapons and other artefacts, which will make up the most relevant narrative instruments for the PCs. For while it is true that players have many resources within the game system with which to create narrative, relics, weapons and artefacts form a set of tangible elements open enough to be interpreted and brought into play through the imagination.

THE CHARACTER'S CHARACTERISTICS

Each character possesses eight main characteristics, organised into two categories:

Physical Characteristics:

- **Strength** - Determines the character's physical power
- **Movement** - Represents their agility and speed
- **Size** - Defines their physical dimensions and their impact on combat or mobility
- **Constitution** - Reflects their endurance and health

Psychic Characteristics:

- **Intelligence** - Their cognitive capacity and problem-solving
- **Wisdom** - Their combination of knowledge and culture, experience and critical judgement
- **Perception** - Their level of awareness of their surroundings and their ability to detect hidden details
- **Charisma** - Their social skills and personal magnetism

Each of these characteristics is measured in points, and each point is equivalent to one D6 that is rolled whenever the character must perform a related action.

Allocating Characteristic Points

Each player has 16 points to distribute among their Physical and Psychic Characteristics, which they must do according to these distribution rules:

- Each Characteristic must have at least 1 point.
- No Characteristic may exceed 5 points.
- Points may be allocated freely between both categories.

Each point allocated to a Characteristic will influence the character's effectiveness within the game, defining their capacity to perform actions successfully.

Impact on the Game System

What do the points mean?

Each point represents a six-sided die (D6) that the character may roll when carrying out Actions related to that Characteristic.

The higher the number of points in a Characteristic, the greater the chances of success when applying them to Actions that require its use ⁶.

COMPETENCES: SPECIALISATION AND SKILLS

While Characteristics reflect the character's general attributes, Competences are specific abilities they have developed over the course of their life. They represent technical knowledge, practice in particular disciplines and a mastery of objects that can make all the difference in critical situations.

Competences are grouped into three broad categories:

Engineering and Construction *(Mastery of technology and structural design)*

- **Technomancy** - Manipulation and control of advanced digital systems **Example:** *The doors of the data vault flicker with an intermittent red light. The character uses their Breach Key on the holographic interface and feels the circuits respond to their touch. Numinia's security is not easy to breach, but with a successful Technomancy roll, they manage to rewrite the access protocol and the door slides open in silence.*

- **Advanced Forging** - Creation and improvement of technological artefacts **Example:** *Beneath the glare of the sparks, the character works feverishly on their companion's exoskeleton with their Fractal Plasma Welder. There is no time for a full repair, but if they achieve a success in Advanced Forging, they will be able to reactivate the hydraulic leg enough to get their companion out of the line of fire before the attackers detect them.*

- **Virtual Architecture** - Design and optimisation of physical and virtual infrastructures **Example:** *The character examines the plans of the underground through their Holographic Cartographer. Something is out of place. A success in Virtual Architecture reveals a pattern of corridors shaped like a hidden energy circuit: a trap set by the ancient builders to catch intruders in an endless loop.*

Security and Protection *(Defensive and strategic skills)*

- **Defensive Networks** - Creation and maintenance of security protocols **Example :** *The ethereal alarms have already been triggered: if the team moves one more step, they will be detected. The character kneels and applies their Intrusion Probe to the defence code engraved on the wall. A successful Defensive Networks roll allows them to override the security system without alerting Numinia's surveillance network.*

- **Chronomancy** - Control of the flow of time in strategic actions **Example :** *The edge of the enemy's sword is mere centimetres from the character's neck. There is no way to dodge it in time..., unless they activate the Temporal Regulator on their wrist. With a success in Chronomancy, they slow reality down for an instant and move out of danger just before the impact.*

- **Cryptology** - Recovery and analysis of ancient and digital artefacts **Example** : *The character finds an ancient data server that has been sealed for generations. They connect a Mnemonic Retriever to its core and, if they achieve a success in Cryptology, they will be able to restore the lost files and reveal fragments of Numinia's history that no one has seen in centuries.*

6 · For examples of this mechanic, see Chapter 4, *Game System* .

Communication and Connection (Social interaction, data analysis and symbolic perception)

- **Decoding** - Interpretation of encrypted texts and arcane languages. **Example** : *«The words make no sense, but the structure... the structure does». Before an ancient manuscript engraved in condensed light, the character holds up their Exegetic Prism and lets the shape of the language guide them. A success in Decoding translates the hidden message into living symbols, revealing a warning from those who saw the future.*

- **Neural Vision** - Advanced management of information networks and social relationships **Example**: *«Tell me what you know and I will make it worth both our whiles». The character weighs every word and every gesture with the Synaptic Analyser. Their contact trusts no one, but a success in Neural Vision allows them to read between the lines, understand the contact's motivations and say exactly what is needed to obtain the information without arousing suspicion.*

- **Luminous Projection** - Manipulation of light and energy to generate illusions and strategic defences **Example**: *The attackers have already fixed their gaze on the character. There is no time to flee, but there is time to divert their attention. They activate their Photonic Duplicator and, with a success in Luminous Projection, project an illusory image of themselves taking another route. When the pursuers turn in the wrong direction, the character slips into the shadows and disappears.*

Competences are the core of the character's specialisation within Numinia, allowing them to excel in certain areas and face challenges with unique skills applied to objects. Nevertheless, more will be learned about their use in Chapter 4, devoted to the game system.

Allocating Competence Points

The allocation of the points held in each Competence derives from the Guild, Faction and Species the player has chosen, since each of these attributes is associated with three specific competences.

Each guild and each faction is associated with three specific competences, reflecting its specialisation within the society of Numinia.

Competences by Guild (6 points to distribute)

- **Alchemists**: *Technomancy, Advanced Forging, Luminous Projection*
- **Exegetes**: *Decoding, Cryptology, Chronomancy*

- **Procurators:** *Virtual Architecture, Neural Vision, Cryptology*
- **Sentinels:** *Defensive Networks, Luminous Projection, Neural Vision*

Competences by Faction (6 points to distribute)

- **Hermeticists:** *Decoding, Luminous Projection, Cryptology*
- **Heirs of Eleusis:** *Neural Vision, Luminous Projection, Advanced Forging*
- **Stellar Circle:** *Neural Vision, Defensive Networks, Virtual Architecture*
- **Neo-Atlantists:** *Technomancy, Chronomancy, Advanced Forging*

When a player chooses a guild and a faction, they receive 6 points for each of these two attributes to distribute among the three competences associated with each, on the condition that no competence may exceed 6 points at this stage. However, unlike with Characteristics, the player is free not only to allocate the points as they wish (without exceeding 6 points in a Competence, one more than for Characteristics), but also to leave one of the three Competences at 0.

In this regard, it is advisable to consult Chapter 4, devoted to the game system, to gain a better perspective on how to allocate points in Competences and Characteristics.

In addition to the Guild and the Faction, the character's Species also influences their competences. Each Species is linked to three competences of its own, which reflect its nature and its relationship with the world of Numinia.

Competences by Species

- **Biomechanicals:** *Technomancy, Advanced Forging, Virtual Architecture*
- **Humanitas:** *Neural Vision, Luminous Projection, Defensive Networks*
- **Reptilians:** *Neural Vision, Defensive Networks, Cryptology*
- **Cyanites:** *Technomancy, Decoding, Virtual Architecture*
- **Spectrals:** *Decoding, Luminous Projection, Chronomancy*

If the character is of a pure Species, they obtain 6 points to distribute among their Species competences, following the same criteria as with the Guild and the Faction.

If they are of Mixed heritage, the points are distributed as follows:

- Two main Species (50/50): 3 points in each.

- Two main Species (35/35) + one secondary (30): 2/2/2 points.
- Two main Species (35/35) + two secondary (15/15): 2/2/1/1 points.

However, in Mixed-heritage characters, the Species' own Competences are those linked to one of the main Species, at the player's choice.

Each point allocated is a strategic decision that will shape the way in which the character faces the challenges of Numinia. With their body, mind and abilities defined, it is now time to delve into the deeper aspects of their psychology and personality.

FRAGMENT 5: LIMITS AND FLOWS IN THE WORLD OF NUMINIA

LECTURA

« Between flesh and symbol, the soul oscillates. Here are inscribed the invisible impulses, the tremors of the Veil, the fragments that set the world in motion before the will acts. »

The three great forces of Numinia described in Chapter 2: History and Legends of Numinia provide each PC with three attributes related to each of them: Threshold points, Breath of the Veil points and Prism Roll points.

These attributes represent the way in which each agent moves between body, mind and Veil. They are neither physical qualities nor technical skills, but inner states: they reflect the character's emotional stability, their vital drive, their attunement to the numinous forces and their capacity to act swiftly in critical moments.

While the Threshold marks out the balance between order and chaos, the Breath of the Veil measures the connection with the higher planes. The Prism Roll points, for their part, make up the character's dice pool. This roll is explained in Chapter 4: Game System.

THRESHOLD: THE LIMIT BETWEEN ORDER AND COLLAPSE

The Threshold represents the character's psycho-emotional state and their capacity to remain balanced in a world where the symbolic, the rational and the supernatural constantly collide. Each character begins with a number of Threshold Points determined by their Position, since the Position defines not only a role within Numinia, but a particular way of inhabiting and withstanding its complexity.

The Threshold behaves as a reserve attribute. Besides representing a bonus to Physical Characteristic rolls, its points are also consumed or worn down (temporarily) in certain key circumstances. It is, therefore, a reserve of spirit that reflects the character's capacity to hold on to their purpose in the face of pressure from their surroundings, trauma or inner dissonance, and it may decrease temporarily during a game session until it reaches 0.

Use of Threshold

The first thing to bear in mind is that Threshold points constitute a pool of D6 that the player will apply as a bonus to all their Physical Characteristic rolls. Thus, a player with 3 Strength points and 4 Threshold points who wishes to lift a steel plate will roll 7D6 to resolve the roll. However, as Threshold points are temporarily lost (during the session), the bonus will also decrease temporarily, so it is important to try to keep this aspect in balance.

Loss of Threshold

The character temporarily loses 1 Threshold point in the following cases:

1. Use of Special Aptitudes

Each time the character activates one of their Special Aptitudes, they lose 1 point, regardless of the result of the roll.

2. Situations of emotional conflict

When facing a scene that challenges their state of mind, the player must make a Threshold roll (with the dice they have temporarily remaining). If they fail it, they lose 1 point. If they obtain a Critical Failure, they lose 2 points.

Imbalance

When the Threshold reaches 0 points (temporarily), the character enters Imbalance. This is a critical state in which the character's emotional, symbolic or spiritual collapse manifests itself.

Each Position defines a specific narrative effect for Imbalance, which may involve a transformation, a loss of control, a crisis, isolation or a chaotic revelation, and this is reflected in their dice rolls in various ways (see Positions for each case).

Recovery of Threshold

The Threshold is recovered through narrative rest:

- 6 hours of rest (uninterrupted or ritualised) recover 1 Threshold point.
- To recover all points, a full day of rest is required for each point lost.

BREATH OF THE VEIL: THE EXHALATION OF THE ETERNAL

The Breath of the Veil represents the character's intimate connection with the higher planes, especially with the Akasha: that multidimensional fabric in which everything that has been, is and will be is recorded as echo or promise. It is a spiritual attribute, but also a narrative one: the character's presence in the great tale of Numinia.

Its points are equal to the character's Perception, and they behave as a subtle reserve of intervention, an akashic breath that can alter the course of events when all seems lost. Whoever possesses Breath of the Veil is not more powerful, but more present in the invisible fabric of the world. For this reason, it positively modifies Psychic Characteristic rolls and may decrease temporarily over the course of a session.

Use of the Breath of the Veil

Just as Threshold points are the pool of D6 that acts as a bonus to Physical Characteristic rolls, Breath of the Veil points are the pool of D6 that acts as a bonus to Psychic Characteristic rolls. Therefore, temporarily reducing Breath of the Veil points means having fewer D6 for these rolls.

The player may temporarily spend 1 Breath of the Veil point to:

1. Reroll a failed roll

Provided that a Critical Failure has not been obtained.

The roll is made again with the same dice and without changing the bonuses.

2. Cancel a negative consequence

They may avoid a loss, a penalty or a negative activation that has resulted from a Critical Failure.

In both cases, the player must justify narratively how this intervention of the Veil manifests itself: an image, a memory, a premonition, a strange coincidence... The world reacts, but the echo must leave its mark.

Healing

A special and highly relevant use of the Breath of the Veil is healing other players or NPCs. In Numinia, the figure of the doctor as such does not exist; healing is carried out by appealing to the Veil and its power, in conjunction with certain scientific knowledge that helps to make sense of the Veil's effect. Thus:

- The character may make a Breath of the Veil roll to heal a PC or NPC who has acquired one or two states (they will roll with the dice they have temporarily remaining).

- The healing character spends 1 point from their own reserve.
- If no success is obtained, the affected character retains their state(s)
- If 1 success is obtained, the character loses 1 state
- If 2 or more successes are obtained, the character loses 2 states
- However, if a critical failure is obtained, the affected character acquires another state, moving on to the next level.

Offering of Glory

Once per session, if the character has all of their initial Breath of the Veil points at that moment, they may make an Offering of Glory.

This action automatically turns any failed roll (including a Critical Failure) into a Total Success. In exchange, the character temporarily loses all of their Breath of the Veil points.

This offering is not silent: it must be described as a moment of resonance, prophecy or transfiguration. It is a fleeting crack in the linearity of the world.

Exhausted Breath

When Breath of the Veil points temporarily reach 0, the character enters a state of disconnection or akashic void:

- They cannot use any of their relics.
- The character may perceive it as inner silence, symbolic blindness or an inability to trust their intuition.

Recovery of the Breath of the Veil

Breath of the Veil points are recovered in the same way as the Threshold:

- 6 hours of rest restore 1 point.
- To recover all points, a full day of rest is required for each point lost.

FRAGMENT 8: PRESTIGE POINTS

LECTURA

« Whoever walks through Numinia without learning anything has merely crossed its streets; whoever learns something from it begins, slowly, to become part of its memory. »

PRESTIGE AND LIVING CULTURE

In Numinia, experience is not measured solely by feats or battles. The city is, above all, a cultural organism, a weave of symbols, customs, tales and knowledge that have accumulated from the Dark Age to the present Golden Age.

For this reason, a character's progress does not depend solely on what they do, but, fundamentally, on what they know and what they understand.

Prestige represents the degree to which a character is integrated into the cultural fabric of Numinia. A character with high Prestige has not merely lived through many adventures: they have learned about the city, researched its history, understood its customs and, at times, even contributed to expanding its imaginary.

Prestige thus functions as a form of cultural experience, and it is obtained through Seeds of Knowledge ⁷.

A Seed of Knowledge represents a moment in which the character:

- Discovers an element of Numinia's *lore*,
- Learns a custom, tradition or institution of the city,
- Understands the meaning of a symbol or artefact
- Investigates a historical episode
- Produces an idea, text or interpretation that expands the imaginary of Numinia

Seeds of Knowledge are not automatic rewards. The GD should award them when they perceive that a player:

- Takes an active interest in the world
- Consults cultural or historical documents

- Investigates elements of the lore thoroughly
- Creates coherent content that enriches the universe of Numinia

In other words, Seeds of Knowledge reward curiosity, research and imagination.

7 · For more information on Seeds of Knowledge and how to convert them into Prestige Points, see Chapter 6, *Inventory and Bestiary* .

ANNEX: IMPORTANT SPECIFICATIONS

The purpose of this annex is to point out some specifications that are relevant when filling in the PC sheet:

- The Prestige Points box is to be left blank until the PC begins to earn Seeds of Knowledge and accumulate Prestige.
- The Imbalance box must reflect the specific Imbalance effect of the PC, as detailed in their chosen Position.
- Only those Competences linked to the character's Guild, Faction and Species should be scored on the sheet. The rest will be disabled: they may not be used or developed at any point in the game. Among the enabled Competences, even those to which the player allocates no initial points must be recorded with a 0. This indicates that they form part of the character's potential repertoire and may be improved later with Prestige.
- In the Special Aptitudes boxes, in addition to the two resulting Aptitudes, the points the PC holds in them must be noted (which will already have been allocated by the player, based on the points received from their Guild, Faction, Species and Archetype).
- Likewise, it is advisable to note the parameters of Relics and Weapons.

CHAPTER FOUR

GAME SYSTEM

GAME SYSTEM

The invisible structure

LECTURA

« The streets of the Ouroboros District looked like an endless labyrinth, where the walls curved as if the city were folding in on itself. There, among narrow alleys and hidden squares, lay the Plaza of the Shifting Murals, a place where the surroundings themselves seemed to resist the laws of order.

It was said that the murals covering its walls were echoes of the Akasha, fragments of the code that shaped the very reality of Numinia. They were not merely images: they were living symbols, which moved, dissolved and were reborn with every change in the city. There, beneath the stony gaze of an ancient monument, Iskar, the sharp-eyed veteran Exegete, stopped dead. His young apprentice, Naevin, looked at the tangle of signs in bewilderment.

–What do you see?–asked Iskar.

Naevin leaned in, watching how the symbols changed colour and shape, as if each figure faded away to make room for another. In one corner of the mural, a series of winding lines merged into a web of dots, forming what looked like a path.

–A pattern–said Naevin–. It looks like a path towards...

–It looks like one–Iskar interrupted him–. But look more closely.

The young man drew nearer, straining his eyes. The lines he had taken for a trail were in fact a labyrinth, with false paths that led nowhere. At the other end of the mural, a symbol resembling an eye blinked and vanished.

–The rules are never as simple as they seem–said Iskar–. Every choice you make in this city is written on these walls... but it can also be rewritten.

–You mean that... we can change the rules?

The Exegete smiled bitterly.

–We can try. And we must. But every attempt that opens a new door... closes others.

Naevin fell silent. Iskar stepped away from the mural and headed for the tangled streets of the Ouroboros.

–Remember this–he added before disappearing into the gloom–: Here it is not enough to be lucky... you have to know what price you are willing to pay for it. »

The rules of Numinia draw on various existing systems, though they adapt them to the game's own identity and add integrations that define them as a unique system, suited to the essential nature of the universe that surrounds them: as a starting point, they combine the narrative freedom of two innovative systems: *PbtA* (an acronym for *Powered by the Apocalypse*),

created by Vincent and Meguey Baker in 2010 for the game *Apocalypse World*; and CfB (an acronym for *Carved from Brindlewood*), created by Jason Cordova in 2020 for his game *Brindlewood Bay*. And, to a lesser extent, they draw on other systems such as *FitD* (an acronym for *Forged in the Dark*), created in 2017 by John Harper for the game *Blades in the Dark*, from which it inherits the principle of fiction first; or the system of the game *Trophy*, created in 2018 by Jesse Ross for the game of the same name (later, *Trophy Dark*) and for its variant, *Trophy Gold*. Both systems are fused, in Numinia, with the structural precision of the D6 system. This balance seeks to ensure that the players' decisions are guided not only by chance or by the GD's will, but also by a shared and spontaneous creativity; and, fundamentally, it means that the narrative, as well as the development of the adventure, is built collaboratively between the players and the GD from the skeleton laid out in the module.

This fits the idea of what the living forces of Numinia represent: like a cosmos raised in the nebula of the Akashic Archives, the city moves by means of a gearwork subject to the dynamics of chaos and the unpredictable, where all the elements are mysteriously interconnected; thus, the movement of each of its parts sends tremors through the whole, giving the city a changing and unbridled morphology. Every choice is an echo in the fabric of the city, with the power to transform it.

Therefore, joint narrative and collaborative construction are the fundamental pillars of Numinia's game system, far more than dice rolls and the application of results and consequences. Nevertheless, the presence of such mechanics remains essential to supply the dose of chance required by a world whose ultimate designs escape the control of any will. And their action defines that ungovernable force we call destiny, circumstance, chance or causality. After all, in Numinia no one chooses what they must live through, only the way in which they wish to live it. Narrative is the energy that drives the engine of the game but, in the end, at one moment or another, the fate of the players will be decided by a dice roll. And this, ultimately, clearly reflects that mathematics of chaos which rules the gearwork. Every act of creation by the players is relevant, because it modifies and unsettles the world of Numinia; it is the latent, restless force of the city itself that answers, calling upon chaos in order to reorder itself enigmatically.

Since narrative is, then, the primordial catalyst of action in the game, and since it also works collaboratively, the Numinia system adopts two essential sources related to literary theory and narratology: Doležel's Heterocosmic, an epistemological theory that clears the ground for the creation of worlds in literature; and Propp's functions of the folktale, in which the author, from the standpoint of Russian formalism, sets out the different motifs that recur in classic tales. These two references, explained later in this chapter, will create the system of narrative creation and construction through which any adventure will unfold. From this adoption, which deeply integrates the dynamics of CfB, Numinia gives birth to a system of its own which we might call the *Numen* system.

To this *Numen* system we add, on the other hand, dynamics taken from the *PbtA* system, such as the development of the adventure in scenes (which we also find in the CfB system) and,

from a more pragmatic angle, the carrying out of decisions through the activation of a series of specific manoeuvres, generically called *Movements*. These Movements clearly represent the freedom of action of the *PbtA* games: unlike in traditional roleplaying games, in *PbtA* games the players do not wait for the GD to describe every corner of the setting or every circumstance of a situation; instead, they improvise details, open doors and gaps, and take part in shaping the context. In Numinia there are two types of Movement Rolls: Action Rolls and Instrument Rolls. Each of the Actions is associated with one of the PC's characteristics, while Instrument Rolls are determined by the Competences and are made using some object (an artefact or relic); the way in which they manifest and are resolved is detailed later in this same chapter. Nevertheless, we can say in advance that the roll that resolves these movements is made with a specific number of D6; but, whereas the *PbtA* system, which already incorporates the D6 system, stipulates a numerical roll, adding up the score of the dice thrown and using a difficulty table, the Numinia game relies on a system of successes. And if we said earlier that, in the end, the players' decisions depend on a dice roll, it is also true that in *PbtA* games every roll, sometimes even successes, has consequences. And these consequences create new narratives and modify the story, something that, in its own way, the Numinia system also reflects.

FRAGMENT 1: THE BACKGROUND

As we have already said, the *Numen* system is inspired by two great currents of roleplaying game design: *PbtA* (*Powered by the Apocalypse*) and *CfB* (*Carved from Brindlewood*).

Both systems were born in the spirit of open creation, with licences that allow their mechanics to be adapted, transformed and reinterpreted to bring new worlds to life. Their principles are neither rigid nor inflexible; they are designed to flow with the narrative, turning every scene into a living part of the story.

In a *PbtA* system:

- The focus is on the story: it is not just about rolling dice to resolve an action, but about how that result changes the course of the game.
- Failure also moves the plot: every mistake introduces a new challenge, a complication or a twist in the story that enriches the play experience.
- Actions trigger results: when a character attempts something relevant to the plot, they activate a movement, which requires a dice roll.
- The GD reacts, not dictates: the system leaves room for improvisation and collaboration, allowing the players to determine the direction of the game.

The *PbtA* system is based not on tactical precision or exhaustive tables, but on creating a fluid, narrative and meaningful experience.

In a *CfB* system:

- The story advances in scenes: each has a dramatic purpose –revealing a clue, showing a conflict– and ends when that purpose is fulfilled.
- The players interpret the clues: the system offers no prewritten solution; the players interpret the clues, assembling their own puzzle.
- The mystery is emergent: the narrative is built backwards; the answers arise from the connections the players draw between the fragments.
- The GD accompanies, not leads: their role is to maintain the tone and guard the balance between the everyday and the strange, not to impose a closed plot.
- The tone is atmospheric and progressive: conflicts escalate towards an emotional or symbolic climax, where the mystery is solved –or transformed– through revelation, not through simple victory.

The *CfB* system turns investigation into a creative act: to discover is to interpret, and every interpretation alters the world.

With all this in mind, a very important consideration about the *Numen* system must be borne in mind from the outset: in campaigns, the story is not a closed and entirely preconceived path; there is a starting point, a conflict, but neither the way it is resolved nor the story behind that conflict is defined. They are narrative compartments that will gradually take shape with the collaboration of all the players, through the same dynamics that *Numinia* inherits from *PbtA* and *CfB*: answers to the GD's questions, mysteries emerging from the players' own resolutions, determinations and actions... The following points try to explain in detail how this collaborative construction of the story works.

To these two great influences is added the *FitD* system, whose principle known as *fiction first* - the fiction comes first - finds a direct correspondence with the philosophy of *Numen*. This principle establishes that the mechanics do not exist independently of what is happening in the fiction. Before determining which rule applies, which dice should be rolled or what consequences an action has, one must understand the narrative situation: what the character intends to achieve, how they are trying to do it, what circumstances favour or hinder them and what risks are present. The mechanics do not initially determine the fiction; it is the fiction that determines which mechanics make sense to apply.

This does not mean doing without rules, but putting them in their proper place. The dice come in when there is a relevant uncertainty, but the resolution must arise from what the characters are actually doing within the scene. The same action, formulated in the abstract, can therefore have very different consequences depending on the context in which it takes place. *Numen* adopts this principle in an especially visible way in its conflict resolution system. A confrontation is not presented as a succession of independent attacks aimed at

reducing a pool of points, but as a situation that must be observed, understood and interpreted ⁸.

The fiction, therefore, comes before even the building of the dice pool. An additional die is not gained because a table automatically grants a modifier, but because the player has identified something significant within the scene and has explained how their character acts upon it. In a confrontation, each Anchor that is acted upon contributes 1D6 precisely because it has first been justified from within the fiction. This approach reinforces another principle shared with *FitD*: consequences should not leave the situation untouched. A significant failure must modify the conditions of the scene and force the players to react to a different reality.

In this way, the rules do not interrupt the narrative to resolve it from outside, but intervene in it to transform it. The fiction leads to the dice; the dice modify the fiction; and that determines what the next possibility for action will be.

And the other relevant influence among roleplaying games comes from the *Trophy* system, especially from its way of understanding the relationship between fiction and dice rolls. In this kind of game, conversation, exploration, the characters' decisions and the building of the scene can unfold over long stretches without constantly resorting to mechanical resolution. The dice are reserved for those moments in which there is a truly significant uncertainty.

8 · See later in this chapter the fragment devoted to the Confrontation System.

Numen shares this conception. Not every action requires a roll. A good part of the game unfolds through roleplay, dialogue, description and decision-making, while the dice appear when there is a resistance, a risk or an uncertainty whose outcome can genuinely alter the course of the story. The system itself establishes that many actions are resolved solely through narration, without resorting to any random mechanic.

This economy of rolls is especially important in conflicts. The system avoids turning a confrontation into an accumulation of small, independent resolutions. When the roll finally happens, it does not necessarily represent a blow, an isolated manoeuvre or a few seconds of action: it may represent the outcome of an entire joint strategy.

For this reason, the confrontation system uses a single shared pool when several characters collaborate. Each of them can contribute to the scene through a different intervention, but all those efforts converge in a single resolution. The dice do not count successive actions: they narratively synthesise the way in which the group has understood and faced the conflict.

This influence leads to a fundamental idea of *Numen*: the importance of a roll does not depend on its frequency. On the contrary, the less routine the intervention of the dice, the greater their dramatic weight can be. The roll appears when something is truly at stake.

This conception also fits the narrative nature of Numinia itself. Its Bestiary establishes that creatures are not mere physical obstacles, but manifestations of the world's tensions, errors and dissonances; confronting them means reading them and understanding what they represent, and defeating them may depend more on that understanding than on doing them harm. The conflict resolution system carries this idea through to its ultimate mechanical consequences: first the problem is interpreted; afterwards, and only when uncertainty demands it, the dice are rolled.

The synthesis of *Numen*

PbtA, *CfB*, *FitD* and *Trophy* are not four sets of rules placed side by side. Numen takes certain principles from them and reorganises them around its own conception of collaborative narrative: from *PbtA* it adopts the importance of consequences and of actions capable of transforming the fiction; from *CfB*, collective interpretation and the appearance of emergent solutions; from *FitD*, the *fiction first* principle and the subordination of mechanics to the narrative situation; and from *Trophy*, an economy of resolution that reserves rolls for those moments in which there is a significant uncertainty.

Upon these influences, Numen builds its own mechanisms. The Heterocosmic allows the players to take part directly in the creation of the world, while the Events based on the Functions of the Tale and other elements make interpretation the basis for the narrative resolution of adventures. In confrontations, that same logic is expressed through elements of the fiction that must be interpreted and acted upon before they acquire mechanical value.

Thus, all these antecedents converge on one and the same principle: the mechanics exist to intervene in a narrative that is already in motion, not to replace it.

From all that has been set out, the motto of the Numen System could take this form:

LECTURA

The fiction leads to the dice; the dice transform the fiction.

FRAGMENT 2: PHASE STRUCTURE

The stories of Numinia unfold neither in a linear nor in a chaotic way. Like the tales that pass through the Veil themselves, each adventure tends to organise itself into a series of distinct narrative moments. These moments are not rigid acts or closed scenes, but states of the investigation and of the experience of the world.

To ease the pace of the game and the understanding of the conflict, each session or adventure usually unfolds through six phases. These phases are not watertight compartments: they can overlap, shorten or expand according to the needs of the story. However, they are an essential reference for both the GD and the players, since they reflect the natural movement of an investigation within Numinia.

The phases are as follows:

- Presentation
- Deliberation
- Investigation
- Reflection
- Action
- Resolution

Each of them represents a different relationship between the characters, the world and the mystery that runs through the story.

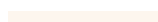
PRESENTATION PHASE

During this phase the GD sets out the initial context of the conflict. It may be a rumour, an alteration in the Veil, a commission received by the characters or the appearance of an inexplicable phenomenon somewhere in the city.

In this phase the players' participation is relatively limited: their main role is to observe, listen and begin to interpret the signs that are presented. The GD describes the setting, introduces secondary characters and lays out the first elements of the situation. The idea, then, is for this phase to act as a literary manifestation, as though the players themselves were beginning to read a novel expressed through the GD's voice. This initial setup is what we shall call the Root of the campaign, a foundation that will serve as the original reference at all times.

However, even at this initial moment, the world of Numinia never presents itself as a completely closed reality. Through directed questions, the GD can invite the players to fill in details of the setting or of the narrative context.

Example:



LECTURA

When you enter the archive hall, what object immediately catches your attention?

The players' answers can be woven into the fiction, expanding the scene and enriching the shared world.

The presentation phase ends when the group has enough information to formulate a first interpretation of the conflict.

DELIBERATION PHASE

Once the problem has been set out, the players temporarily step outside the game and their role as PCs and begin to interpret what they have seen. It is, then, an extra-dramatic phase.

During the Deliberation Phase the players share their first hypotheses about the nature of the conflict. These hypotheses need not be correct or complete: their function is to guide the investigation and begin to give shape to the mystery. They are, in this way, first impressions, those sensations we receive from something or someone in a preliminary state.

But in Numinia hypotheses are not mere narrative conjectures. They often contain interpretative elements that may influence the later course of the story. All the ideas put forward by the players, as well as those elements they were invited to introduce in the Presentation Phase, will be incorporated into the reality of the fiction if they fit the logic of the world and the unfolding of the investigation. The GD will place all their effort and all their imagination at the service of creation so that this may be so.

Deliberation may be more or less brief. Its purpose is not to solve the mystery, but to set the characters' curiosity in motion, although it may well give rise to a heated debate that takes longer than expected. All of that is also part of the game. When the group decides to begin actively exploring the conflict and has obtained, or developed, enough paths to do so, the game enters the next phase.

INVESTIGATION PHASE

This is, generally, the longest phase of the adventure. In this phase the players take a far more prominent part than the GD, who will try to remain in the background, acting only as a guide and trying to let the players' own proposals create the narrative from the Root, channelling them and adapting them to that base whenever possible.

During the investigation the characters explore their surroundings, question witnesses, examine objects, cross the districts of the city and face the consequences of the anomaly

under investigation. It is in this phase that Movement Rolls are triggered most often and where heterocosmic creations may also appear, when the players introduce new elements into the fiction. And, therefore, where the most Spontaneous Events are awakened. That is to say, the fact that this is the Investigation Phase, and not the Action Phase, does not mean there are no moves and actions on the part of the PCs. There is simply no specific focus on which to act yet.

Throughout the investigation the characters discover Pieces of Conflict: clues, leads, fragments of information or situations that reveal aspects of the mystery.

For the story to move forward, the characters must gather at least three Pieces of Conflict, although they will always have a better chance of bringing the campaign to a successful conclusion if they gather more, since each piece found will be worth, in the Closing Phase, 1D6 in the pool of the Prism Roll, which will serve to resolve the final step of the story. These pieces, therefore, do not constitute a definitive explanation of the problem, but they do provide enough material to confront it. In other words, they are not part of a closed story but, rather, pieces of a puzzle that has not yet been assembled, and which admits different interpretations.

During this phase it is also common for the players to introduce new narrative elements through their actions or through the GD's questions. The campaign takes shape through these interactions, and may drift noticeably from its original focus, the Root –which does not mean losing the Root, but establishing unexpected ramifications from it–. In this sense, the campaign must be designed so that every element is ready to give rise to new narrative, not to close it ⁹.

Additionally, in the Investigation Phase not only Pieces of Conflict are collected but also other kinds of information that help to give shape to the narrative, such as documents, audio notes, etc. Likewise, the Phase fosters the dynamic of Rumourology (detailed in Chapter 7, *Building the Adventure*).

When the PCs have come upon some clue or piece of evidence that clearly and precisely shows them how to face the conflict, where to head, they may move on to the Action Phase, provided they have gathered at least three Pieces of Conflict.

REFLECTION PHASE

Like the Deliberation Phase, it represents an extra-dramatic transition in the game. In it, the players once again talk over and debate everything they have investigated so far and establish a new hypothesis, now far more evolved and consolidated. In fact, the various hypotheses of this phase, unlike those of the Deliberation Phase, must reach common ground so as to determine, jointly, what their objective will be in the Action Phase. Perhaps it will not be to solve the mystery hidden behind the conflict, but to save an NPC –or to confront an NPC–, to escape from some extreme situation... For their part, the GD will focus

the entire narrative of the Action Phase on this common objective, setting aside everything that falls outside it. In this way, it will be understood that the PCs will never resolve a campaign completely, but only in one of its aspects. There will always remain unknowns, unanswered questions, open mysteries and circumstances that will be lost in the unknown.

ACTION PHASE

In this phase, the conflict becomes immediate and tangible.

The characters directly confront the elements that sustain the anomaly: an entity arisen from the Veil, a narrative artefact out of control, a faction manipulating the city's archives or any other force involved in the story.

As in the Investigation Phase, the PCs continue to hold in their hands the course and progress of the adventure, although the GD is an undisputed guide and moderator. Nevertheless, it must be designed so that the players feel a certain sense of lost control and dizzying pace, that the campaign is entering a phase of chaos where –almost– anything can happen.

9 · See Chapter 7, *Building the Adventure*, to learn more about narrative dynamics.

The decisions taken during the investigation are now put to the test. Movement Rolls are frequent, consequences follow one another swiftly and the pace of the game usually intensifies.

The outcome of this phase does not always mean destroying or neutralising the conflict. In many cases the characters may choose to:

- Contain the anomaly
- Reinterpret it
- Transform it
- Integrate it in some way into the balance of Numinia.

When the conflict reaches a provisional resolution, the story enters its final phase. Whereas until now the players understood well how the passage from one phase to another came about, since the premise was clearly marked, in this case, and in keeping with the same atmosphere of chaos, the passage from the Action Phase to the Resolution Phase, though clearly stipulated by the GD, should feel more spontaneous to the players. They should move from one phase to the next without quite understanding how it happened, although the GD will always specify that the next phase has been entered.

And, in short, what determines the passage to the Resolution Phase is that the PCs have resolved enough events for the Prism Rolls, which make up the last phase, to take place. In other words, that they have reached a point in the plot that clearly calls for resolution, which, while quite clear to the GD, escapes the players' perception in a far more abstruse way.

RESOLUTION PHASE

Once again, as in the Presentation Phase, the narrative dynamic will be in the hands of the GD, though with more latitude for the players, who will have to decide, resolve and act. As in the Investigation Phase, this phase also involves moves, actions and acts of creation on the part of the players. Nevertheless, the GD will guide them in a more controlled way towards the resolution of the campaign. This resolution will be subject to the intervention and decision of the PCs at different Operative Points.

Operative Points are key moments within the phase, at which the PCs will come up against one of the knots of the resolution ¹⁰. To untie that knot, they will have to make a Prism Roll (at each point it may be freely made by whichever player the team prefers); to do so, they will use the Pieces of Conflict found throughout the whole campaign – a Piece of Conflict may be found even in the Action Phase –, bearing in mind that each piece becomes 1D6 within the pool. This represents the PCs' acquired capacity to interpret the situation of the Operative Point. Success or failure (or critical failure; in this case they will mean the same) will not determine whether or not the PCs resolve one of the key points of the game, but will make the narrative travel down one path or another. Failure will only make things harder for the PCs.

10 · For more information, see Chapter 7, *Building the Adventure*.

By convention, the Resolution Phase comprises four Operative Points, through which the campaign should be resolved and closed. Nevertheless, the GD may reduce or increase the number of these Operative Points if they consider it appropriate to the character of the adventure, although these four points should correspond to each of the four logical operators used in the Heterocosmic Roll ¹¹.

Each of these points, moreover, should place the PCs in a complex situation, in which they must take an important decision that leads them to carry out some equally significant action. Nevertheless, the workings of this final resolution through rolls will vary slightly depending on the circumstances of each campaign.

The close does not always resolve every unknown. In Numinia it is common for some questions to remain open, like echoes of stories that have not yet finished being written.

This dynamic shapes the world of Numinia in one way or another. When the Resolution Phase concludes, something has changed. Some trace of that adventure will remain in Numinia, with its particular modifications upon the world of the city.

In any case, if you are approaching the adventure as GD, in Chapter 7, Building the Adventure, you will find more information on how to build each phase, how to encourage the narrative, how to gradually incorporate the players' contributions into the campaign, etc.

FRAGMENT 3: MOVEMENT ROLLS

In the Numinia system, actions and challenges are resolved through different types of rolls that reflect the nature of the action undertaken. Each type of roll represents a different approach to interpreting the risk, the skill or the uncertainty surrounding a particular situation.

There are two main types of roll in the game:

- **Action Rolls:** When the character triggers a specific Action that may unleash concrete narrative consequences.
- **Instrument Rolls:** When the character uses a specific object, whether a relic –the generic name given to the various artefacts in Numinia– or a weapon of any kind.

Each of these rolls follows the logic of the D6 System, which the *Numen* system adapts as follows:

To make Action or Instrument Rolls, the player throws as many six-sided dice (D6) as they have points in the corresponding aptitude (as detailed in the following points, each Action Roll depends on a Characteristic, physical or psychic, just as each Instrument Roll is made with a Competence).

These dice represent their pool. If the roll is an Action Roll, to these dice they will add the Threshold D6 pool for rolls that depend on Physical Characteristics and the Breath of the Veil D6 pool for rolls that depend on Psychic Characteristics. In some cases, they may add bonuses for special circumstances, which may translate into additional dice, provided the player coherently justifies their use. This dynamic is part of the creative spirit of Numinia, which seeks to encourage the narrative use of resources, promoting actions that are logical, ingenious and coherent with the setting.

11 · See later in this same chapter for the rules of the Heterocosmic Roll.

Once the roll has been made, the results are counted as follows:

- Each 6 rolled is a success.
- Each 1 rolled is a failure.

The outcome of the roll is assessed thus:

- If there is at least one 6 and at most a single 1, the action is a Normal Success, since, one for one, success wins.
- But if there is more than one failure (1), each additional failure cancels out a success (6), cancelling itself out as well.
- If in the final count there are three or more successes (6), it is considered a Total Success, with especially favourable consequences.
- If in the final count there are neither successes (6) nor failures (1), it is a Failure without consequences.
- If in the final count there are one or more failures (1) and no success (6), it is a Critical Failure, with negative consequences.

This resolution system not only determines the outcome of an action but opens the game up to narrative nuance: the GD can use the levels of success or failure to enrich the story with proportionate consequences, and the players can use their resources and narratives to modify, anticipate or endure those outcomes.

To illustrate the richness of this system, this table offers the statistics from a simulation of 100 rolls:

TABLA 4.1

DICE	TOTAL SUCCESS	NORMAL SUCCESS	OVERALL SUCCESS	NORMAL FAILURE	CRITICAL FAILURE
2D6	0.00	30.56	30.56	44.44	25.00
3D6	0.46	40.28	40.74	29.63	29.63
4D6	1.62	46.14	47.76	19.75	32.48
5D6	3.42	49.00	52.42	13.17	34.41
6D6	5.67	49.73	55.41	8.78	35.82
7D6	8.15	49.10	57.26	5.85	36.89
8D6	10.68	47.67	58.35	3.90	37.75

Which demonstrates two things:

The greater the number of dice, the greater the probability of success; but, also, the greater the risk of critical failure.

Only from a pool of 5D6 upwards does the overall success percentage begin to exceed the overall failure/critical failure percentage.

ACTION ROLLS

Action Rolls in Numinia represent those situations in which the character attempts to carry out a specific manoeuvre that involves a risk or a significant consequence. These actions are defined by the game system itself and are triggered when the character declares that they are performing an action, or when the GD understands that some player's initiative or move has triggered a move.

Each Action unleashes an outcome that may be:

Total Success: The character achieves their objective brilliantly, with an additional benefit.

Normal Success: The character achieves their objective, with positive consequences.

Failure: The character does not achieve their objective, which carries some minor consequence.

Critical Failure: A narrative complication arises that makes the situation even more difficult.

Unlike other rolls, Action Rolls are not limited to measuring the character's technical competence; they are designed to move the story forward. Even a failure generates consequences that enrich the narrative flow, driving the game towards new decisions, dilemmas and challenges.

Each Action is linked to a specific Characteristic. Thus, an Action Roll comprises the points of the associated Characteristic (as D6), plus the bonus of the Threshold or of the Breath of the Veil (if the Characteristic is physical or psychic respectively).

In Numinia, Action Rolls invite the players to take risks, to understand the consequences of their deeds and to see how their decisions shape the destiny that surrounds them.

There are sixteen actions, and each Characteristic has two of them associated with it:

PERCEPTION:

Decode Surroundings

When you carefully examine your surroundings to find anomalies, oddities or hidden particularities.

Interpret

When you analyse the visible elements of a situation (facts, gestures, objects, patterns) to discover the implicit meaning that connects them.

CHARISMA:

Alter Perspective

When you try to influence a character's perception, beliefs or decisions through speech.

Negotiate

When you handle a disagreement with another character by trying to adjust positions, expectations or desires until an acceptable agreement is reached.

CONSTITUTION:

Anchor Will

When you try to keep your composure, resist fear or hold on to your determination in the face of manipulation, danger or uncertainty.

Physical Resistance

When you try to withstand physical harm, such as poisons, diseases, dehydration or adverse environmental conditions.

MOVEMENT:

Opaque Form

When you try to move without being seen, act with stealth or go unnoticed in a compromising situation.

Agility

When you perform a physical manoeuvre that demands coordination, speed and bodily control to execute a dynamic movement with precision.

STRENGTH:

Power

When you try to exert physical force to strike, break or alter something through brute strength.

Bodily Dominion

When you use your strength to physically control something or someone through restraint, grip, containment or sustained pressure.

SIZE:

Impose Presence

When you try to influence someone's behaviour or dominate a setting through your sheer physical presence.

Human Barrier

When you use your bulk to block the way, protect others or control a space through the mere occupation of your body.

WISDOM:

Unravel Soul

When you try to understand someone's emotion, intention or purpose through their body language, their words or their reactions.

Mystic Power

When you try to counter a cognitive threat in order to resist its attack, connecting mind and soul.

INTELLIGENCE:

Plot Strategy

When you try to analyse a complex situation to find the best options, routes or strategies.

Inquire

When you investigate a matter to gather relevant information through rumours, testimonies, records or the following of leads.

It must be borne in mind that, although all these Basic Actions specify which elements of the context (NPCs, objects, marks in the surroundings) trigger each action, the integration of those elements is left to the GD at the moment a player declares their wish to carry out a game action, within the narrative.

INSTRUMENT ROLLS

Instrument Rolls in Numinia represent the use of artefacts, which in the world of Numinia are called Relics, and whose handling depends on specialised skills that require technical knowledge, training or prior experience; these abilities are gathered in the nine Competences, whose character is woven into the imaginary of Numinia¹². Instrument Rolls are used when the character attempts to resolve a situation by resorting to one of their Relics, for which they must make a roll with the D6 pool of the Competence needed to use that Relic. Let us remember that Competences in Numinia are associated with Guild, Faction and Species. Those Competences that the PC does not have associated with any of these three attributes are considered not to be part of their knowledge, and cannot be used by them. As for those the PC does have associated, it does not matter if the player has left them at 0, for they are Competences whose level can be raised at any given moment with Prestige Points.

Unlike Action Rolls, which are triggered by a specific manoeuvre defined in the system, Competence Rolls depend entirely on the narrative context: the properties of Relics in Numinia are open enough to be interpretable in different situations. It will be the player's imagination that enables the application of the Relic in each situation, although the GD's task will be to judge wisely whether the proposed use answers to logic and coherence.

As with Action Rolls, the result of an Instrument Roll may be:

Total Success: The character achieves their goal brilliantly, with an additional benefit.

Normal Success: The character simply achieves their goal.

Failure: The character simply fails to achieve their goal.

Critical Failure: A narrative complication arises that makes the situation even more difficult.

12 · For more information on Relics, see Chapter 6, *Inventory and Bestiary*.

Instrument Rolls reward both the player's specialisation and their creativity, since the key to success will often lie not only in the points invested in a Competence, but in the ingenious way in which it is applied within the narrative.

FRAGMENT 4: HETEROCOSMIC ROLL

When we approach a narrative, we tend to think of it as a story that takes place «in our world», as in *The Three Musketeers*, *Lord of the Flies* and *I, Claudius*. Nevertheless, sometimes we are taken to our world, but one into which some element at odds with reality (fantastic or supernatural) has been inserted, as in *Dracula*, *A Christmas Carol* and *Journeys to the Other World*. On many other occasions, the narrative will take us to contexts far removed from our

reality, fantastic, futuristic or uchronic, as happens with *The Lord of the Rings*, *Brave New World* and *Foundation*. It is from this last perspective that the philologist and literary theorist Lubomír Doležel proposed a view that nonetheless structures and explains all three types of narrative: each tale creates an alternative cosmos, a possible world that exists with its own laws, which may differ from those of everyday reality, whether categorically or subtly. In truth, the insertion of the poetic function into the text already creates a very fine layer of fantasy in any tale, however much it may be apparently set and contextualised in our everyday world.

Doležel called this theory the Heterocosmic: the science of fictional worlds. From this perspective, reading, telling or playing a story is not simply to embellish reality, but to open a parallel universe with its own order of possibilities, norms, knowledge and values. In short, with its own logic.

Doležel's great contribution was to show that narrative does not stand in a void: every alternative cosmos answers to a dimension of coherence, even if this differs from the one that articulates our own reality. A tale may allow the dead to speak, time to run backwards or moral laws to be inverted, but these exceptions are not arbitrary, anarchic or meaningless merely because they are fantastic: they form part of the fabric that defines that universe. This principle refutes the «anything goes» by which the context of a fantastic worldview is sometimes judged.

Applied to roleplaying, this approach invites us to think of each game session as the joint creation of a possible world. When narrator and players contribute elements, they are not merely inventing details: they are raising a cosmos with its own internal grammar, where every action, every discovery and every value is governed by a system that adapts to the logic of the tale.

A BRIEF PORTRAIT

Lubomír Doležel (1922–2017), doctor of Philology and educator, was a Czech-Canadian literary theorist, a pioneer in applying the logic of possible worlds to narrative analysis. His most influential work, *Heterocosmica: Fiction and Possible Worlds* (1998), changed the way we understand fiction: not as a mere reflection of the real world, but as the creation of alternative cosmoi with their own rules of existence.

OVERVIEW OF THE HETEROCOSMIC

The Heterocosmic holds that every narrative opens a possible world. Each story is a parallel cosmos, in which fantasy and possibility themselves enable that world to operate with internal laws, where actions, characters and values acquire a coherence of their own. Unlike the real world, which we perceive as unique, fictions multiply realities: each tale is an ontological laboratory.

Doležel distinguishes several dimensions to describe these worlds:

- What can or cannot happen.
- What must or must not happen.
- What is known and what is unknown.
- What is judged to be good or bad.

These dimensions are articulated through the logical operators, which allow us to explore how a narrative universe is built and regulated.

THE LOGICAL OPERATORS

1. Alethic operators – The horizon of the possible

The alethic operators (from the Greek *alétheia*, «truth») determine what is possible, impossible, necessary or contingent in a narrative cosmos. They are not limited to a particular detail: they are the ontological framework of the world.

In our universe, for example, flying without artifice is impossible; in an alternative cosmos it may be an everyday fact and necessary for life.

In Numinia, each district shapes its own alethics: in *Sycamore*, it is possible for a painting to sing; in *Ouroboros*, for a door to open when a riddle is answered. What would be absurd in our world is natural law there.

2. Deontic operators – The cartography of the norm

These operators (from the Greek *déon-ontos*, «that which must be») chart what is permitted, forbidden and obligatory in a cosmos. They are norms that permeate the fabric of the world. In our world, killing is forbidden; in another, it may be an initiation rite.

In Numinia, the deontics vary according to faction: for the Hermeticists, studying is a duty; for the Heirs of Eleusis, playing is a sacred mandate. The deontic does not regulate actions alone, but the very meaning of existence in that cosmos.

3. Epistemic operators – The limits of knowledge

The epistemic operators (from the Greek *episteme*, «knowledge») determine what is known, unknown and unknowable in the narrative universe. It is not only a matter of what a character is ignorant of, but of what the entire cosmos admits as knowledge.

In our world, we know that the universe was born of the Big Bang; in an alternative cosmos, perhaps its origin is an unanswered enigma, or electricity has not yet been discovered.

In Numinia, epistemology is always fragmented: what in *Vitruvian* is known and taught in academies, in *Ouroboros* is a secret disguised as a riddle. Knowledge is never neutral: what is known and what is hidden defines how life is lived in the city.

4. Axiological operators – The scales of values

The axiological operators (from the Greek *axios*, «valuable»; and *logos*, «study») establish the fundamental morality of a cosmos: what is judged good or bad, noble or vile. They describe not only concrete acts, but the system of values that runs through the whole narrative world.

In our world, infidelity is censured; in another, it may be considered an honourable practice. Gold, valuable in our world, may be trivial in another.

In Numinia, values are contested: for the Stellar Circle, order is the supreme good; for the Neo-Atlantists, anarchic creativity is a virtue. Thus, the same action –toppling a data tower– may be seen as heroism or as crime, depending on the axiological framework in which it is inscribed.

HETEROCOSMIC ROLL

What it is

The game of Numinia allows a particularity within the framework of the roleplaying world: players have the capacity to build part of the context, imagining and creating objects within it; always, that is, applying a narrative coherence that fits the imaginary of the game and the logic of the story and of the moment. Nevertheless, the world of Numinia is enveloped by the force of the Akasha, which is the Veil. This force causes all the elements of the cosmos that makes up the city to be interconnected, sometimes in ways that even escape the understanding of its citizens: only chaos and its mysterious structure of order can explain all the deep interconnections.

Thus, an act of creation, a movement in one direction, an event, provoke unexpected reactions in the city. The appearance of an ancient bas-relief unleashes a sandstorm in the Kallis Crater; the destruction of some magic stones makes a horde of Formrenders appear in the Neuma Subvale... Everything that moves in Numinia, in one direction or another, has unexpected consequences, for, just as the city is open to being expanded in form and concept, it also reveals its unfinished character.

The Heterocosmic Roll is triggered when a player imagines and materialises something new in the scene (an object, a feature of the surroundings, a contact, a shortcut, a ritual...). That gesture sets the machinery of Numinia in motion: the world reacts and reconfigures its laws around the creation.

Principle: if you name it, it can exist; if it exists, it will have a price.

However, in this respect a warning must be given about the indiscriminate use of the *deus ex machina*, a narrative device historically used to unblock a seemingly unsolvable situation through the inclusion of some sudden element of which there had been no mention until then. In the literary field, this licence is considered a poor and mediocre device, a view that the world of Numinia and the GD must share and forbid.

How it is rolled

Whenever a player carries out a creation in order to resolve, accelerate or unblock the current situation, the Heterocosmic Roll is triggered. It requires no prior permission: the right to create is part of the system. But it must be borne in mind that stirring the machinery of Numinia too much can provoke serious disturbances. For this reason, and to control this dynamic, there is the Resonance Marker. Each roll adds 1 node to the Resonance Marker, which, of course, is collective (that is, it accumulates the nodes generated by all the players); on reaching 4, it triggers an Event Roll (see later in this same chapter the section on Propp's functions of the folktale) and resets to 0.

The roll will yield a result that will indicate not only the degree of success of the creation, but also some characteristics of the created object, which will be expressed following the logical operators of Doležel's Heterocosmic.

The player says what appears and for what purpose. For example, a player facing a computer artefact with encrypted source code might declare: «I find a cryptography manual that guides me through the code». They must provide a brief diegetic anchoring, that is, a sentence of plausibility: where it was and why it is believable in Numinia and in the context of the story.

Next, they make their roll with 2D6, abiding by the results of this table (which have been drawn up considering the probabilities of each result, taking into account their possible combinations):

TABLA 4.2

RESULT	EFFECT	OPERATORS	POLARITY
2 or 12	Moderate Success	2 operators	1 positive / 1 negative
3, 4, 10 and 11	Normal Success	3 operators	2 positive / 1 negative
5, 6, 8 and 9	Total Success	4 operators	3 positive / 1 negative
7	Critical Success	4 operators	4 positive

For all results, the book will possess a series of characteristics whose number will depend on the type of success, as shown in the table. These characteristics will conform to the logical operators of the Heterocosmic, and the types will be chosen by the player who triggered the roll (except in Total and Critical Successes, in which all four types appear). As for their polarity, it will be the GD who decides which is positive and which negative. But it will be the other players who decide what the characteristics in question are.

Example: suppose the player obtains a 10 on their roll. They are entitled to three characteristics, subject to three of the operators; given the nature of the object and the context, the player chooses the alethic, deontic and epistemic operators. One of them must be negative and the other two positive; the GD decides that the alethic and the epistemic are positive, while the deontic is negative. The GD then designates three players so that each invents one characteristic. The first player, taking as reference the alethic operator (positive), which indicates what is or is not possible, decides that the book can be read at a speed 10 times greater than normal; the second player, taking as reference the deontic operator (negative), which alludes to what is or is not permitted, states that the book belongs to a series of manuals whose reading is permitted only to engineer alchemists (this does not mean the player cannot read it if they are not an engineer alchemist, but that in doing so they will be breaking a serious rule of the district's laws, and could be punished for it); finally, the third player, taking as reference the epistemic operator (positive), which concerns what is known and what is not known, invents that the book conceals a block of information from the Dark Age, unknown to the inhabitants of the Golden Age (the present one), which could offer great advantages in the future.

As can be seen, this roll encourages collective creation and places part of the shaping of the adventure in the players' hands, since the story will change and transform according to what they invent.

But a clarification is needed, since this roll, which greatly enriches the *Numen* game system, may prove somewhat confusing if not properly understood. Each operator determines a specific dimension of the created reality: the alethic operator establishes what is possible, impossible, necessary or contingent; the deontic, what is permitted, forbidden or obligatory; the epistemic, what is known, unknown or remains hidden; and the axiological, what is considered valuable, harmful, desirable or objectionable. These categories describe how what has been created exists within the cosmos of Numinia. The positive-negative polarity obtained through the Heterocosmic Roll operates on a different level: it determines how that characteristic affects the narrative situation and, in particular, the PCs. Therefore, a positive operator does not represent an affirmation, nor a negative one a negation. A positive alethic result does not mean «this is possible», just as a negative one does not mean «this is not possible». In both cases, the operator keeps behaving in the same way because it is defining the conditions of possibility of what has been created; by applying the positive-negative polarity to it we merely establish whether those conditions turn out to be favourable or unfavourable for the PCs in the present situation.

For example, an object might possess as an alethic characteristic that it can only work during the night. That limitation belongs to its nature: it establishes under what conditions its functioning is possible. Its polarity, however, will depend on the narrative situation. If the PCs need to use it at night, the characteristic may prove positive; if they need to employ it in

broad daylight, it may prove negative. The property of the object does not change: what changes is its effect on the story.

In short, the operators answer the question «what is this reality like and how does it work?», while the positive-negative polarity answers «how does that reality affect the PCs and the situation they are living through?». One defines the logical behaviour of the object; the other determines in what way the Veil turns its existence into an advantage or a complication.

Likewise, it must be specified that when we speak of a *created object* we do not necessarily mean a physical object, since the Heterocosmic can perfectly well be applied to an abstract object: a solar eclipse forms; a sandstorm breaks out; an NPC is, in reality, a ghost...

As can be seen, this mechanic works in an apparently complex way, but once in play it becomes much clearer. It does, however, require a good dose of imagination not only from the player who proposed the created object, but also from the rest, who must apply positive or negative impacts on the story to that object. To help with this imaginative exercise, and so that the nature of the operators becomes more understandable, we provide a table reflecting the way in which Doležel's Heterocosmic is applied in the game, with a more functional translation and a more direct description:

TABLA 4.3

OPERATOR	CONCEPT	FUNCTIONAL TRANSLATION	DESCRIPTION
<i>Alethic</i>	What is and is not possible	What allows this to happen	<i>Possibility and conditions</i>
<i>Deontic</i>	What must or must not be done	What rules it triggers or breaks	<i>Norms and obligations</i>
<i>Epistemic</i>	What is known or not known	What it reveals or hides	<i>Knowledge and information</i>
<i>Axiological</i>	What has or does not have value	Why it matters	<i>Value and importance</i>

Let us now look at two examples of the way the system works, to illustrate what has been set out more clearly:

EXAMPLE 1

The PC, who is a Game Master, visits the House of Riddles. The player invents that there is something there that leads them to continue their investigation at the Hyperborean Tavern;

a talking mask fixed to one of the stone walls reveals to them that they will find a clue in the tavern.

Alethic (Possibility and conditions)

- Positive: *There is a living riddle in the tavern that additionally offers two rumours besides the clue found.*
- Negative: *They will only have access to the clue in the Hyperborean Tavern if they visit it in a simulation that holds anomalies and dangers.*

Plain translation: What makes this connection possible?

Deontic (Norms and obligations)

- Positive: *The Hyperborean Tavern is a place widely visited by Game Masters; any roll there has a +1D6 modifier.*
- Negative: *They only have access to the clue if they agree to take part in a game at the Tavern (a wager, a challenge, a social test).*

Translation: What does it oblige you to do, or what rule does it impose?

Epistemic (Knowledge and information)

- Positive: *The Tavern is a vortex of experiences relating to the adventure, and holds hidden knowledge that may be revealed.*
- Negative: *The clue is ambiguous: you do not know whether it is a place, a person or an event in the Tavern.*

Translation: What do you know now and what remains uncertain?

Axiological (Value and importance)

- Positive: *Going to the Tavern may grant Prestige Points for what is learned there.*
- Negative: *The Tavern is associated with debts, favours or social dangers.*

Translation: Why is this useful and why might it go wrong?

EXAMPLE 2

The player's PC has an interview with a lady of high society; it has previously been established that in the city of Numinia there is a cameo that marks out certain individuals of a particular elite, who form a lodge and, in this way, know some restricted secrets of the Veil

through a collective-memory protocol called «Elizabeth». This cameo thus works as an emblem. The player invents that the lady is wearing that cameo.

Alethic (Possibility and conditions)

- Positive: *The cameo reveals its secrets telepathically to its bearer, so that anyone who wears it could gain access to some of these secrets.*
- Negative: *The cameo can be forged, or its meaning has recently changed, taking on different duties.*

Translation: What makes this object what it is?

Deontic (Norms and obligations)

- Positive: *Wearing it grants access or legitimacy before certain circles, so that it works as an object of prestige.*
- Negative: *Wearing it in public and in plain sight means breaking the rules of the Scions of Elizabeth, the lodge that guards the secrets of the Veil.*

Translation: What rules does it activate or put at risk?

Epistemic (Sign / Mystery)

- Positive: *Elizabeth is a concept that lives in the unconscious of every citizen; seeing the cameo in person awakens that knowledge.*
- Negative: *The revelations obtained from Elizabeth through the cameo can cause altered states of consciousness, even lead to madness.*

Translation: What information does it unlock, and what does it conceal?

Axiological (Value / Risk)

- Positive: *It is a direct opportunity to access hidden knowledge, so it can be sold for a very high price on the black market.*
- Negative: *Getting close to the cameo or to whoever wears it can draw the PC into dangerous conspiracies.*

Translation: Why is this valuable, and what price might it have?

FRAGMENT 5: EVENT ROLL

When the Russian formalist Vladimir Propp published *Morphology of the Folktale* in 1928, he put on the table an idea as powerful as it was simple: stories –at least those of the oral

tradition, the wonder tales– are not built from specific characters, but from narrative functions. What matters is not «who» acts, but «what» function that action fulfils in the development of the tale.

Propp's genius lay in showing that, behind the multiplicity of traditional tales, there was a shared narrative grammar: a limited number of functions that appeared again and again, in a relatively stable order, as though they were the pieces of a gearwork. Thus, the hero may be an unknown prince or a young peasant girl, but the function they fulfil when receiving a trial, overcoming an obstacle or returning transformed is always the same.

For us, designers of games and players of Numinia, this discovery is enormously valuable: it reminds us that narrative is not arbitrary, but answers to functional needs. Every twist of the plot is born because the tale demands it: if someone sets off on a journey, someone must say goodbye; if an obstacle arises, there must be an attempt to overcome it; if an object is lost, there will be a search. In the tale, action and context come together to generate the narrative function.

A BRIEF PORTRAIT

Vladimir Propp (1895–1970), anthropologist and linguist, a member of the school of Russian formalism, analysed folk tales in depth and discovered that, beneath the diversity of stories, there was a recurring structure. In *Morphology of the Folktale* (1928) he identified 31 narrative functions, archetypal steps repeated again and again in the oral tradition: absence, interdiction, violation, the trial, the reward, and so on.

The decisive point was the idea that functions are more important than specific characters: what matters is not who carries out an action, but what place that action occupies in the logic of the tale. A peasant, a prince or a little girl can play the role of hero, provided they pass through the same functions.

Propp's work marked a turning point: it inspired Lévi-Strauss's structuralism and modern narratology (Todorov, Greimas), and it remains a reference for screenwriters, novelists and game designers. His gaze reminds us that narrative is not a mere capricious flow, but a web of functional needs that are activated in sequence.

FUNCTION AS NARRATIVE NEED

What Propp revealed is that narrative elements are not mere ornaments: they fulfil a function. A function appears when the tale needs it, just as a sign arises from the relationship between expression and content. If a dragon appears in a story, it is not only there to embellish it: it is because the tale requires a trial, an obstacle, a threshold.

Functions, therefore, are answers to needs:

- If there is a hero, the tale needs a mission
- If there is a magical object, it is because the tale demands a means of fulfilling that mission
- If there is a villain, it is because the function of confrontation must be activated

PROPP'S 31 FUNCTIONS

It is not necessary to memorise all 31, but it is necessary to understand that each one represents a narrative archetype. Not all of them appear in every tale, nor always in the same order, but together they form the «genetic code» of folk narratives. This is the list of the 31 functions identified by Propp:

1. Absence: someone dear is missing or the hero is far away; an initial void opens.
2. Interdiction (prohibition): a rule or taboo is laid upon the hero.
3. Violation: the interdiction is broken, deliberately or by accident.
4. Reconnaissance by the villain (interrogation): the villain spies on/probes their victims.
5. Delivery (information): the villain obtains information about the victim/target.
6. Trickery: the villain disguises themselves/deceives in order to get close.
7. Complicity: the victim unwittingly cooperates with the villain.
8. Villainy or lack: harm is done, or a lack arises that must be resolved.
9. Mediation: news of the villainy arrives; the mission is formulated.
10. Beginning counteraction: the hero agrees to act.
11. Departure: the hero leaves home/the initial state.
12. Test by the donor: an agent tests the hero.
13. Hero's reaction: passes/fails the test.
14. Acquisition of the magical object: receives help/an artefact/a power.
15. Transference: journey towards the place of the action.
16. Struggle: direct confrontation with the antagonist.

17. Branding: the hero is marked (scar, emblem, token).
18. Victory: defeat of the villain or overcoming of the obstacle.
19. Liquidation: the harm is repaired or the lack is filled.
20. Return: coming back from the space of the trial.
21. Pursuit: the hero is pursued.
22. Rescue: someone or something comes to the hero's aid.
23. Unrecognised arrival: an unrecognised, disguised return.
24. Unfounded claims: the false hero claims the merit.
25. Difficult task: an extraordinary trial is imposed.
26. Solution: the hero accomplishes the task.
27. Recognition: the hero is identified as such.
28. Exposure: the false hero/villain is revealed.
29. Transfiguration: change of state/form/dignity of the hero.
30. Punishment: sanction for the villain/false hero.
31. Wedding/ascension: final reward; restorative closure.

Examples of recurring functions:

- Interdiction → violation: the hero receives a rule and breaks it (Orpheus must not look back, but he does).
- Trial → reward: overcoming an obstacle grants a gift (Heracles completes his labours, Odysseus wins his homecoming).
- Trickery → discovery: someone tries to deceive, someone uncovers the truth.

EVENT ROLL

What it is

The Event Roll is the second of Numinia's Narrative Rolls; the first is the Heterocosmic Roll.

It has already been explained that an Event Roll is triggered when the Resonance Marker of the Heterocosmic fills up (each point on the marker is equivalent to one Heterocosmic Roll). This is justified by the same interconnection that drives spontaneous creations: every relevant action in Numinia has a consequence; it creates an unexpected movement that, mysteriously, connects back to the first action. It is the city's way of reordering itself.

How it is rolled

The Event Roll does not measure the success or failure of the action, since we are not speaking of an action that requires a dice roll; rather, it expresses what kind of reaction the action itself provokes. To do so, 1D20 is rolled and the table of events (functions) set out below is consulted:

TABLA 4.4

D20	FUNCTION (EVENT)	ACTIVATION GUIDELINE AT THE TABLE
1	Absence	Someone or something disappears.
2	Interdiction	A taboo or rule appears.
3	Violation	Something or someone crosses the line.
4	Villainy	Someone commits a crime.
5	Mediation	A call to change occurs.
6	Departure	Someone leaves.
7	Trial	Someone is subjected to a trial.
8	Reaction	A decision that changes course.
9	Magic	A magical object appears.
10	Transference	There is a change of plane.
11	Struggle	A confrontation takes place.
12	Branding	Something or someone leaves a deep mark.
13	Rescue	Unexpected help arrives.
14	Task	Someone is put to the test.
15	Solution	Someone must accomplish some task.
16	Recognition	Some secret identity is revealed.
17	Transfiguration	A change of state occurs.
18	Punishment	Someone receives a punishment.
19	Liquidation	A fracture is restored.
20	Ascension	Someone receives a reward.

This table has been drawn up especially for the game, gathering the 20 most relevant of the 31 functions identified by Propp and turning them into playable Events.

Once the event has been determined, it is the GD who introduces it into the story, creating a narrative occurrence. Occasionally, the GD may put a question to each player about this event, such as:

What trait does this new event have that makes it unsettling?

What gesture can be seen in the NPC who has come into play as a result of the new event?

It is important to point out that this event does not have to appear in the same scene in which the roll was made. It may appear later, in another context. It will be the GD who decides when and how the event appears.

Example: Investigating some ruins, one of the PCs notices that behind a broken column there is an old artefact for measuring resonances, which may help them find an anomaly hidden in the place. The player triggers a Heterocosmic Roll by creating this object and, with it, fills the Resonance Marker, which already stood at 3 points. So an Event Roll is triggered. A player is chosen to roll the D20, and gets a 14: Task (Someone is put to the test). The GD announces: «So, you have found a resonance meter, but for it to work, its core requires three divergent seals». Then the GD puts a question to each player: «What is there in the surroundings that indicates where one of the seals might be found?», «What do the divergent seals look like in your memory?», «Which of the PCs do you think keeps a divergent seal in their backpack?» and «Who is best suited to cast a spell that summons an entity that creates divergent seals?»

As can be seen, each of these questions generates new narratives in the players' imagination. They must not only answer the question; it also leads them to invent additional details: an object that offers a clue as to where a seal is hidden, perhaps because it has a riddle engraved on it; a situation in the past in which the PC came across a divergent seal, perhaps on another mission; a reason why one of the PCs keeps a divergent seal in their backpack, and a situation in which the PC answering the question saw that seal inside the backpack; an entity that creates divergent seals, of unknown nature, whether benevolent or wild, and whether it can be kept under control... And, more importantly, it leads them to ask themselves a question they will have to resolve together: what on earth, exactly, is a divergent seal?

But this roll is also subject to the accumulation of events. Just as the Heterocosmic Roll is subject to a Resonance Marker, Event Rolls advance the Plot Clock, which likewise has a cycle of four hours. When the clock reaches the fourth hour, an Imbalance of the Gearwork occurs and the clock resets. Of course, the Plot Clock, like the Resonance Marker, is shared by all the players, accumulating the events generated by all of them.

IMBALANCE OF THE GEARWORK

When the Plot Clock reaches its fourth hour, the world stops for an instant. The lights of Numinia flicker, signs fall into disorder, the streets seem to remember other shapes. That tremor is neither chance nor punishment: it is the Imbalance of the Gearwork, the way in which the city readjusts its inner laws in order to go on existing.

Numinia, like every living organism, does not tolerate stagnation. Every Heterocosmic Roll, every Event, every creative or destructive impulse of the players alters, however slightly, the invisible flow of the Veil. When that flow reaches a point of saturation, the Gearwork –the very structure that sustains reality, which is subject to the force of the Prism– is forced to rebalance itself. In other words: every time the players force the logic of the world, the world responds by reorganising itself.

The Imbalance of the Gearwork is, then, a systemic reaction, a violent breath of Numinia. It represents the moment when the cosmos needs to adjust itself. It is not a punishment for the players, but an inevitable consequence of their own freedom. In Numinia, every act of creation or transgression leaves a trace; and when those traces accumulate, the city needs to redistribute its meaning.

Each Event Roll advances the Plot Clock by one hour. This clock, which is collective for all the players, marks the pulse of the narrative world. When it reaches the fourth hour, the Gearwork enters maximum tension and the Imbalance is triggered automatically. There is no way to avoid it or stop it; like the tide, it happens because it must happen.

The GD then announces: *The Gearwork comes out of true. Numinia changes its rhythm.*

When the Imbalance takes place, the space around the PCs undergoes a collapse, which does not destroy the world; it *folds* it. A scene opens set in the past or future of Numinia, or in an alternative echo of the same place.

- **Dissolution:** the GD announces that «*The Veil folds*». The current space blurs (lights, sounds or codes are distorted).
- **Translation:** the group finds itself in a scene from the past or the future, or in the same place under different conditions (another time, another story).
- **Narrative purpose:** the scene must reveal something hidden in the story; an origin, a future cause, an alternative meaning of the conflict.
- **Duration:** it is played as a self-contained one-scene mini-adventure.
- **Refitting:** when the scene closes, the characters return to the present, with altered behaviours, intuitions or perceptions.

The Veil «heals», and the Plot Clock resets to 0. The new perspective recontextualises the adventure, with some new and relevant information that is included in the story.

In short: the general collapse becomes an ontological leap, in which the players do not lose the story, but discover that they were inside one of its folds.

FRAGMENT 6: CONFRONTATION SYSTEM

CONFRONTATION AS CONFLICT

In Numinia, a confrontation is not a category separate from other conflicts. There is no distinct logic for «fighting» and another for investigating, fleeing, persuading, crossing an anomaly or resolving an obstacle. Every conflict is born from the same question:

What prevents the character from achieving what they intend?

So this system could just as well be called the Conflict Resolution System.

The difference is that, in a confrontation, the obstacle has agency. It is not a locked door, a rift in the Veil or a collapsed structure. It is a contender: an active presence that responds, moves, presses, threatens and transforms the situation.

A contender can be a creature, an NPC, a collective entity or even a group of attackers operating as a single threat. What matters is not its form, but its function within the conflict: it opposes the characters and forces them to interpret what sustains it, what protects it, what makes it dangerous and how it can be overcome.

That is why confrontations in Numinia are not resolved by making successive attack rolls to wear down hit points. They are resolved like a narrative puzzle: by declaring an objective and resolving the points of the conflict.

The player does not simply ask: How do I hurt it? But rather: What is happening here? What sustains this creature? What must I understand, alter or exploit in order to impose my action? And, above all: What do I want to achieve with this confrontation?

CONTENDERS AND ANCHORS

Every contender is defined by a series of *anchors*.

An anchor is a piece of the confrontation's puzzle. It is a condition that sustains the contender's presence, capacity for action or threat.

- An anchor can represent many things:

- An essential quality of the creature
- A pattern of behaviour
- A symbolic protection
- A bond with another plane
- A form of movement
- A positional advantage
- A circumstance of the environment

An anchor is not necessarily a physical part of the enemy. In Numinia, presences are not bodies of flesh and blood. They are, essentially, etheric, metaphysical forms, entities sustained by bonds, echoes, distortions or patterns. That is why an anchor should not be understood as a piece of «armour», but as that which enables the contender to operate as a threat.

Put simply: an anchor is something the PC must take into account for their action to make sense and to be able to face the obstacle.

FIXED ANCHORS AND VARIABLE ANCHORS

Contender sheets distinguish between fixed anchors and variable anchors.

Fixed anchors

Fixed anchors express the contender's identity. They are those conditions that always appear, in one form or another, because they belong to its nature.

For example, an Echo Predator might always have an anchor related to its manifestation: it does not fully belong to Numinia and needs a condition that sustains it in the scene (a summoning, a rift); or an anchor inherent to its nature, such as its shifting movement, vanishing at one point and appearing at another.

But these anchors do not turn every encounter with that creature into the same fight. They simply ensure that the contender stays coherent.

Variable anchors

Variable anchors depend on the scene. They change according to the place, the context, the manner of appearance, the environment, the summoning, the corruption present or the narrative situation. They are the most numerous.

The same Echo Predator may manifest once in a burning archive and another time in a soundless hall. Its nature remains recognisable, but the puzzle changes. This prevents players from «learning the solution» to a creature and repeating it mechanically.

The player must not memorise how a creature is defeated. They must learn to interpret how it manifests in that encounter.

THE GD'S DESCRIPTION

The GD does not list the anchors when presenting a confrontation. They do not say: «The creature has these four anchors.»

Instead, they describe the scene, the creature and its behaviour in a way that is clear, sufficient and playable. The description must allow the players to understand what they are facing, but without turning the encounter into a list of instructions.

A good description should show:

- What the contender looks like
- How it moves
- How it threatens
- What it alters in its surroundings
- What seems to sustain it
- What behaviours repeat themselves
- What elements seem strange, insistent or significant

The GD does not withhold information to make the confrontation cryptic. They present it as fiction. The players must interpret that fiction.

Because the anchor is not announced. It is suggested and demonstrated.

INFER, INTERPRET AND INTERVENE

Before a confrontation, the players receive the description and interpret it. They may infer anchors that might be foreseen in the contender's sheet, or interpret emergent anchors from the elements present in the scene.

This does not mean they can invent just anything.

A valid interpretation must meet three conditions:

- It must rest on something that has been described
- It must explain an observable behaviour
- It must not contradict what has been established in the fiction

If the GD describes that the creature always reappears where the light is weakest, the players may interpret: that the darkness sustains it; that the light interferes with its manifestation; that its position depends on the shadows. All of those readings may be valid if they hold up within the scene.

What matters is this: anchors are neither discovered as closed answers nor freely invented. They are interpreted and brought into play.

INTERVENING AN ANCHOR

When a player decides to act upon a specific interpretation of the conflict, they are intervening an anchor. Intervening an anchor does not necessarily mean resolving it. The definitive resolution will be known afterwards, with the roll. This is important.

Before rolling, the player does not know whether their action will eliminate the anchor, exploit it, get around it or only partially affect it. What they do know is that they have directed their action towards a specific piece of the puzzle.

That is why we speak of intervened anchors, not resolved anchors.

Examples:

- «I think the creature depends on that crack; I try to close it.»
- «I think it moves following a pattern; I position myself where I think it is going to move.»
- «I think the fire feeds it; I try to cut off the path of the flames.»
- «I think it only perceives sounds; I coordinate the group through gestures.»
- «I think its fixation on me can be used to lure it away from the focus.»

In short, intervening an anchor is interpreting it. Whether or not the player resolves it will depend on the roll.

THE CONFRONTATION DICE POOL

When the players decide to face the confrontation, they build a single dice pool. The pool always starts from 1D6 as a base. That die is contributed by the character who takes the initiative of the main action. Then, 1D6 is added for each intervened anchor.

The unit that adds dice is not an action, but an intervened anchor. This means that one action may intervene a single anchor or several, if the narration justifies it.

For example: «I pour oil over the ground to reveal its footprints when it disappears and, at the same time, to drive it towards the lit area.»

This action could intervene two anchors if both are present in the scene: its invisibility or displacement, and its relationship with light or shadow.

In this way, each intervention will contribute 1D6 to the pool, provided the GD considers that its reading is sufficiently supported by the fiction.

ACTIONS, ANCHORS AND EXECUTION

A player may have several ideas, but cannot always carry them all out.

It may happen that a player interprets two different anchors and proposes two valid solutions, but that both require simultaneous actions that are incompatible for a single character. In that case, the actions can be shared out.

Example: A player says: «Two things need doing: someone must keep it away from the crack and someone must break the circle that feeds it.»

Although the interpretation may have come from a single player, each action must be carried out by a character within the fiction. Thus, one character may take charge of luring the creature, while another intervenes the circle. Each rolls the die or dice corresponding to the anchor they are intervening.

This allows tactical intelligence to be shared without erasing the physical and narrative presence of the other characters.

Understanding is not the same as acting. Every action needs a body in the scene.

COLLABORATIVE CONFRONTATIONS

In a collaborative confrontation, several characters intervene different anchors to build a single common pool.

Each player rolls the dice corresponding to the anchors their character intervenes or the action they perform. The character who takes the initiative also rolls the base D6.

Although the dice are shared out among several players, they all form part of a single confrontation roll.

Example:

- PC A takes the initiative and declares the objective: to expel the creature by closing its bond. In addition, they intervene the anchor of the threat.
- PC A will roll 1D6 base and 1D6 for the intervened anchor.
- PC B intervenes the movement anchor: they will roll 1D6.
- PC C intervenes the anchor of the surroundings and of the bond: this adds 2D6. But they cannot perform both actions alone. So they will roll 1D6 for performing the first action, and PC D, who performs the second action, another D6.

The total pool is 5D6.

The dice may be physically shared out among the players, but the result is interpreted as a single joint action.

INDIVIDUAL CONFRONTATIONS

A character may also decide to act alone.

In that case, they build their own pool:

- 1D6 base
- +1D6 for each anchor they themselves intervene.

This may be riskier, because they will have less narrative support and fewer dice. But it can also avoid collective exposure.

The system does not force anyone to cooperate. Cooperation is a possibility, not an imposition.

Two modes may even coexist in the same scene: a group of characters may coordinate a collaborative action while another character tries to resolve the confrontation on their own.

If both actions target the same contender, any valid success may transform or resolve the conflict.

THE CONFRONTATION ROLL

Once the pool has been built, the players taking part in the confrontation must declare, by consensus, their objective for that confrontation. Only then are the dice rolled. The roll is resolved with the usual rules for rolls followed by the *Numen* system (successes and failures).

Success

If the roll succeeds, the declared objective is achieved.

This does not necessarily mean that the creature dies. In Numinia, entities do not die in a material sense. They are dissolved, contained, deactivated, unanchored...

The result must respect the objective declared by the players.

If the objective was «to close the crack that sustains the Echo Predator», a success may cause the creature to come undone and be dragged back into the Akasha.

If the objective was «to pin it down long enough to flee», a success does not eliminate the creature, but it allows escape.

Total Success

With three or more net successes, the result is especially favourable. The GD may grant additional effects.

Failure without consequences

If there are neither 6s nor 1s, the action fails to prevail, which indicates that the anchors the PCs were trying to intervene were not entirely correct –in this respect, it is worth pointing out that intervening an anchor is, generally speaking, a hypothesis on the PC's part, not a certainty–, or that their skill in carrying it out was not sufficient.

The confrontation continues, but the players must reconsider their interpretation or take another path in the scene. That is to say, detect other anchors or think of another way of intervening those detected earlier.

Critical Failure

If there are failures and no successes, the confrontation is not resolved favourably, but neither is it repeated in the same way; the critical failure transforms the conflict.

The creature responds, the scene changes, the anchors are altered, a new pressure appears and, what is more, and this is not open to appeal, the characters acquire a state. A critical failure does not return the confrontation to the previous point. It turns it into another confrontation.

The State the PCs acquire is variable, at the GD's discretion. But if the Table of States in the following section is consulted, it can be seen that one of the states indicates, specifically, that the PC is *Unanchored* for having been unable to intervene an anchor. Although this seems the ideal State to acquire in a confrontation, the GD, depending on the nature of the creature and the circumstances, may decide to impose a different state. Even a different state for each of the PCs involved.

MULTIPLE INTERPRETATIONS

It may happen that two characters interpret the same phenomenon differently.

For example:

- One player believes the creature is anchored to the darkness
- Another believes that what matters is that it avoids the light

The system does not require only one of them to be right. If both interpretations are coherent with the scene, both can be brought into play. If the roll succeeds, the GD integrates them as two angles of a single reality.

The resolution need not necessarily say: «One of you was right and the other was not.» Rather, it would be: «You were both reading different parts of the same structure.»

But let us remember that interpretation in Numinia, although multiple, is not arbitrary. One may interpret; one may not invent without grounds.

OPERATIONAL SUMMARY

- The GD describes the contender and the scene.
- A clear objective is defined for the action.
- The players interpret possible anchors.
- The players declare which anchors they intervene.
- The pool is built: 1D6 base + 1D6 for each intervened anchor.
- Each player rolls the dice corresponding to their interventions (or actions).
- All the dice form a single roll.
- If there is success, the objective is achieved.

- If there is failure, the confrontation continues with other anchors or other interventions.
- If there is critical failure, the conflict is transformed and generates states.
- The confrontation continues only if the new situation demands it.

FINAL PRINCIPLE

Confrontation in Numinia does not consist of striking until you win. It consists of reading a presence, interpreting its anchors, deciding how much is understood, taking on the risk and acting. Sometimes, intervening two or three anchors will be enough. Sometimes, the group will need to coordinate several actions. Sometimes a partial interpretation will suffice. At other times, a critical failure will transform the scene completely. The player is never obliged to solve the whole puzzle in order to act.

FRAGMENT 6: PC STATES

In the game of Numinia, the existence of the PCs is not measured in hit points or energy points, as in other role-playing games. Let us remember, to begin with, that all living beings in the universe of Numinia are something more than a material body. Even the Numinids are beings subject to a presence that moves between the physical world and the virtual spectrum. Their nature is subject to the Veil, to the same ethereal force of the Akasha that contains the city. Thus, the «death» of a PC does not happen as it does in our world; rather, it corresponds to a disappearance or disintegration of that «metaphysical» body which makes up the manifestation of that PC.

To represent any distortion or alteration –and even possible dissolution– that their bodily form suffers, the game develops a system of States, which are acquired in different situations and as a consequence of adverse circumstances.

States represent, then, the repercussions of badly resolved conflicts.

They are not physical damage. A character does not lose life because a creature has struck them. In Numinia, a character becomes Confused, Contaminated, Unanchored, Fragmented or Desynchronised because the reality of the conflict has interfered with their way of acting.

States affect the character's capacity to go on acting and intervening effectively. Each situation indicates which states it can induce when it responds to a critical failure or to an adverse position in the face of the conflict –without a Critical Failure result on a dice roll being necessary–.

For example, an Echo Predator could induce: *Desynchronised*, because it alters the character's rhythm of action; *Contaminated*, because it leaves putrid residues of the Akasha in their

presence. But mere exposure to a toxic substance could induce the same *Contaminated* state, while some kind of cognitive dissonance could induce a *Confused* state.

PROGRESSION OF STATES

A PC can only have one active State. They begin in the *Unscathed* State, which is the same as having no State. If an *Unscathed* PC acquires one, they fall under that new State.

If a character who already has a State acquires another, they do not accumulate both: they pass directly to the *Collapsed* State. This is, moreover, the only way to acquire that State. If a *Collapsed* character acquires another State again, they pass to the *Lethargic* State. Likewise, this is the only way to acquire that State.

A *Lethargic* character is left out of the immediate action. They are not dissolved, but they are inactive and, therefore, very vulnerable. They may be recovered if the fiction allows it and other characters intervene. If a *Lethargic* character suffers a conclusive consequence once again, they may become *Dissolved*. This represents a farewell in the world of Numinia. It is the GD who will decide at what moment and how this last State is acquired.

The following table shows the possible States a PC may acquire, and their consequences:

TABLE 4.5

STATE	ORIGIN	NATURE	DOMAIN	EFFECT	LOGIC
<i>Confused</i>	Failure to interpret a signal, anomaly, symbol, anchor or psychic phenomenon	Cognitive distortion	Psychic	-1 die on psychic rolls	You perceive, but you order badly what you perceive
<i>Destabilised</i>	Failure to resist physical pressure, displacement, environmental impact or bodily misalignment	Structural misalignment	Physical	-1 die on physical rolls	Your form responds irregularly
<i>Unanchored</i>	Critical failure when interacting with an anchor, an invocation, a presence or a force of conflict	Loss of attachment to the context	Local	You cannot add dice for resolved anchors (base pool only)	You are present, but not fully connected to the conflict
<i>Desynchronised</i>	Failure in the face of a temporal alteration, echo, repetition, lag of the Veil or action out of rhythm	Operational lag	Dual	The GD may introduce a consequence before resolving your action	You act, but not at the right moment
<i>Fragmented</i>	Critical failure in a conflict that compromises the character's coherence	Rupture of internal continuity	Arbitrary	Depending on the context of the critical failure, you operate from the physical or the psychic; the	You do not function as a complete unit

STATE	ORIGIN	NATURE	DOMAIN	EFFECT	LOGIC
				other axis is blocked	
<i>Exhausted</i>	Failure in the face of exhaustion, drowsiness, paralysing influence or loss of impetus	Suppression of initiative	Physical / Psychic	-1 die on physical or psychic rolls, depending on the cause of the state	Your capacity for impetus is dampened
<i>Contaminated</i>	Failure when exposed to residues of the Akasha, toxic forces of the Veil, symbolic corruption	Persistent external interference	Variable	Each 1 generates an additional minor consequence linked to the contamination	Something alien operates within your action
<i>Collapsed</i>	Accumulation of two different states	Systemic overload	Global	You cannot initiate an action; only react or execute automatically	The system is at its limit
<i>Lethargic</i>	Accumulation of another state while Collapsed	Systemic failure	Global	You cannot act; inactive state	The system ceases to sustain you

HEALING STATES

Nevertheless, there are different ways to eliminate a State and return to Unscathed. In the first place, a long day of continuous rest (24 hours) can eliminate any State, if the GD sees fit, except for the *Collapsed* - *Lethargic* States. These last two will only be recovered at the end of the campaign, as their elimination is reckoned to require some three or four weeks.

There are, on the other hand, some objects that can eliminate a specific state, which are accounted for in Chapter 6, *Inventory and Bestiary*. But they are not objects that can be found easily; rather, they will be available to the extent the GD considers appropriate. In general, they can be found on the black market of the Ouroboros District, but always in exchange for other objects or goods, since money has little relevance in the world of Numinia.

Lastly, the most direct and simple way to eliminate a State is the Prism Cells ¹³. Prism Cells are, like the Seeds of Knowledge, symbolic units that reflect the way in which a player manifests themselves in the world of Numinia.

Prism Cells are natural treasures, which may be found by chance anywhere in Numinia –they proliferate more on the periphery–. There are four groups of Prism Cells, each one related to a Faction. Thus, a PC may collect Prism Cells of whatever type they wish, but may only use those belonging to their own Faction.

Prism Cells have several practical uses in the game; the most advantageous is eliminating a State. However, each State has a different cost in cells.

Cost in Prism Cells

Confused 1 cell

Destabilised 1 cell

Unanchored 2 cells

Desynchronised 2 cells

Fragmented 2 cells

Exhausted 1 cell

Contaminated 2 cells

Collapsed 3 cells

Lethargic 4 cells

Needless to say, the cells used are spent; they are single-use tokens. The mechanic is automatic: the PC digests the required cells and in some five minutes the State disappears. It is understood, however, that there are extreme situations in which it is difficult to take out the necessary cells and bring them to one's mouth to swallow them. That, like other things, is left to the GD's discretion.

¹³ · For more information on Prism Cells, see Chapter 6, *Inventory and Bestiary*.

CHAPTER FIVE

GEOGRAPHY AND CULTURE OF NUMINIA

GEOGRAPHY AND CULTURE OF NUMINIA

LECTURA

« At the hour when the vast towers of Vitruvian cast rectangular shadows over the basalt-covered rooftops of Solomon, and the vapours of the Sycamore market rise between the curved bridges like forgotten prayers, the sound of a ritual drum echoes in the depths of Ouroboros. It was the third day of the solstice, and the whole city was preparing for the Ceremony of the Axis: a suspended moment in which the four districts remembered –and invented anew– the limits of their world. In the Plaza of the Vertices, the blind cartographer walked with measured steps, followed by children from every district. Each carried a piece of a map: one in stone, another in data, another in silk and another in ash.

On reaching the centre, the old man spread his hands over the fragments and said:

–This is not a city, it is a palimpsest. Every street is a prayer; every corner, a scar.

And at that instant, as every year, the four limits vibrated, the walls narrowed and widened at the same time, and Numinia remembered that its geography was not static, but alive: a body in constant mutation that endures only if it is narrated. »

Numinia is not only a space; it is a symbol mapped by memory, invention and experience. Its geography does not answer to conventional models: here, the districts are defined not only by physical coordinates, but by the principles they embody. Ouroboros, Vitruvian, Solomon and Sycamore are areas of thought as much as of stone and neon.

This chapter explores the geographical and cultural heart of Numinia: its districts and their organisation, the academies of learning, the ritual plazas, the daily customs and the border

spaces where the physical intertwines with the ethereal. To understand Numinia is to understand how its form and its spirit shape each other. Here, culture is living architecture, and the city, a text in permanent rewriting.

FRAGMENT 1: THE GEOGRAPHY OF THE SYMBOLIC

THE FOUR DISTRICTS

LECTURA

«In its streets ideologies are interwoven, in its plazas echoes of ancient disputes resound and in its buildings rise the pillars of its identity.»

The structure of Numinia is not merely architectural: it is a physical manifestation of its fundamental principles. The city is divided into four great districts, each bound to a faction and to a field of development. Just as the guilds represent knowledge and the factions ideology, the districts are the territorial and functional manifestation of these concepts.

Each district has its own essence, its own atmosphere and its own purpose within the fabric of Numinia. Although the city is an interconnected whole, each of these territories offers a unique vision of the world, as well as of the role of the inhabitants who form part of its surroundings.

This being so, each of the four districts is closely bound to a Faction, as seen in the chapter *Character Creation*.

The most important feature of the four districts is that they are large circular areas that are not built on solid ground, but at a certain distance above it, ranging between 40 metres and 130 metres. The reason for raising them into the air was to avoid possible interference from the anomalous forces of Numinia: disturbances, creatures born of the alterations, chaotic movements. Although this does not prevent anomalous phenomena from appearing in the districts, it reduces their activity considerably, granting the inhabitants of the four areas a certain regularity. Nevertheless, although the ground of Numinia is exposed to the most unstable manifestations of the Threshold, it is neither uninhabitable nor wholly out of control. In fact, Numinia has other constructions (the entrances, the colonies, old temples and monuments) that stand on solid ground. These constructions are simply somewhat more exposed to the eccentricities of the three living forces of Numinia.

On the other hand, during the Dark Age different solutions were weighed for keeping the districts afloat (fields of partial gravitational cancellation, passive electromagnetic repulsion), but in the end the Black Engineers concluded that the best solution was to harness the structural tensions of the Veil, as a plane separate from the Threshold, and to create, for each district, an anchoring to the Veil, establishing a suspension in topological tension between planes (the plane of the Threshold, the plane of the Veil). This was carried out with a technical system of monolithic towers acting as resonance nodes, a continuous stabilising field and a gearwork of minimal dimensional displacement.

These are the coordinates, heights and measurements of each of the four districts, bearing in mind that the first figure of the coordinates measures the x axis, which runs from east (+) to west (-), and the second figure measures the y axis, which runs from north (+) to south (-), always from the central point:

Vitruvian (NW): (-131, +290) 130 metres above the ground – Diameter: 100 km

Sycamore (NE): (+375, +232) 100 metres above the ground – Diameter: 80 km

Solomon (SW): (-247, -221) 70 metres above the ground – Diameter: 120 km

Ouroboros (SE): (+271, -361) 40 metres above the ground – Diameter: 90 km

These, therefore, are the distances between districts (taking the centre of each district as the reference):

Vitruvian ↔ Sycamore: 509.3 km

Vitruvian ↔ Solomon: 524.0 km

Vitruvian ↔ Ouroboros: 765.1 km

Sycamore ↔ Solomon: 769.5 km

Sycamore ↔ Ouroboros: 602.1 km

Solomon ↔ Ouroboros: 536.6 km

As can be seen, each district is set at a different height above the ground. This is because each district must sit at the level of optimal resonance between the Threshold (territory, matter), the Veil (memory and transmutation) and the Prism (refraction of perspectives). They do not float at different heights on a whim, but at the height where their principle does not fall into dissonance. Any higher or lower, and the Gearwork would be strained.

1. Vitruvian – The highest

Nature: Research, epistemology, Hermeticists. Guiding principle: knowledge opens every door.

Rationale: Knowledge seeks perspective. The higher it stands, the broader the view.

Moreover, the Prism offers fluctuating temporal patterns to the Hermeticists.

Vitruvian should be at the level closest to the Veil.

Suggested height: 130 metres

Not for prestige. For epistemic stability.

2. Sycamore – Variable intermediate height

Nature: Metamorphosis, rhetoric, imagination

This district is the most changeable. Its very atmosphere blurs between the real and the symbolic.

Rationale: Its height might fluctuate slightly according to the Cycle of the Prism.

Not fixed. It oscillates.

Suggested height: 100 metres

That makes it dynamic without breaking coherence.

3. Solomon – Medium-low height

Although we do not cite a specific fragment here, we know from the political structure that each district has its own legislative bodies and systems. Solomon, traditionally associated with judgement, law and structure (by its nominal and functional imagery), should be closer to the ground.

Rationale: Law needs contact with matter. Too high, it loses pragmatism. Too low, it is contaminated by the periphery.

Suggested height: 70 metres

Stable, firm.

4. Ouroboros – The closest to the ground

By its cultural and ritual tone (a ritual drum echoing in the depths of Ouroboros), it is perceived as more bound to the telluric. If it represents cycle, becoming and regeneration (consistent with Khepri and transformation), then it must be closer to the ground.

Rationale: Ouroboros needs to feel the scar of the earth. It is the district that metabolises trauma.

Suggested height: 40 metres

The closest to the earth. The most exposed. The most resilient.

Finally, at the central point from which the coordinates are measured, 10 metres above the ground, lies the Agora Plaza, the direct entrance to the different districts for anyone arriving from outside the city.

Likewise, in each district we find a series of spaces of importance in Numinia.

MAIN ENTRANCES

Spaces of access to Numinia that are connected to the city, but that are not explicitly part of it or of any district, and are therefore not included in the territorial division.

Ruins of Numinia

This space lies on the outskirts of the city and holds the scant remains of what was once old Numinia, destroyed during the fire of the Bildung Complex. It is, however, the original path of entry to Numinia, leading to The Gates of Numinia, and it is guarded by Nimrod, the Guardian of the Gates. To enter the city and become a citizen with full rights, one must solve a riddle.

The Gates of Numinia

This is the space before the city proper, where Senet, the Game Master, welcomes newcomers and challenges them to solve a series of enigmas in order to gain access to the city. From The Gates of Numinia, moreover, one reaches the Agora Plaza.

Agora Plaza

The Agora Plaza, 10 metres above the ground, is the heart of the city. It can be reached from several points, though mainly from The Gates of Numinia. The Agora Plaza is a space around which the four great districts bound to the four factions of Numinia converge. Thus, although any of the districts can be reached directly from the Plaza, the Plaza itself is not part of the territorial division; that division is established, precisely, from the Agora Plaza.

VITRUVIAN DISTRICT – THE TEMPLE OF KNOWLEDGE

The Vitruvian District is the intellectual heart of Numinia, an enclave where erudition is the cornerstone of existence. Inspired by the classical academies and by humanity's great

centres of knowledge, this district houses the institutions charged with preserving, analysing and transmitting learning.

Its streets are laid out with the geometry of thought; every building is a temple of knowledge; every plaza, a forum for philosophical discussion. Here, silence is not emptiness but concentration, and every library is a labyrinth of ideas waiting to be explored.

Faction: Hermeticists

Focus: Academic sphere

Nature: Research

Circle: Epistemological

Inhabitants: Scholars, philosophers, scientists, historians

Guiding principle: *Knowledge is the only key that opens every door*

Relevant spaces:

Historical Society

A space that gathers the history of Numinia, along with other information and documents connected with its creation and development. It has an area called the Akashic Archives, which holds the antiquities of Numinia, and another called the Historical Museum, devoted to the context of the city's origins (the Second Industrial Revolution and the first decades of the twentieth century).

Atlantis Library

The city's library holds ancient books, public-domain works and significant texts related to the epistemological, philosophical and scientific foundations of Numinia. All these ancient books are presented cryptographically in particles of knowledge contained in magical octahedra, crafted by the Elder Logographers. Each octahedron represents a specific volume. It has a hidden area called The Abyss, which holds forbidden or especially valuable volumes. Access is gained through a password that can be discovered by observing the library's architecture. It is the natural home of the Chroniclers.

Lemuria Academy

Numinia's academy is devoted to research into the principles of active inference, the free energy principle and systems thinking applied to human systems and to artificial intelligence, as well as other subjects of the social sciences that study the principles of play as a basis for learning and fulfilment. In short, the practical applications of certain

neuroscientific and social principles. It is the global Academy of Numinia, above the other Academies. Home of the Scholars.

Scholastic Campus

The Scholastic Campus is Numinia's main space for cross-disciplinary training and research, and it houses the city's five Ontological Schools, devoted to the study of the great fields that structure reality and knowledge. Unlike traditional universities, the Schools do not divide learning into closed disciplines; instead they bring together scientists, humanists, artists and thinkers around common questions, fostering dialogue between different perspectives. Each School has its own Academy, where its principles are developed through debate, experimentation and collective learning.

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OUROBOROS DISTRICT – THE LABYRINTH OF PLAY

The Ouroboros District is the great theatre of uncertainty, a territory where every corner hides a riddle and every street can be a path towards the unexpected. Here, reality folds over itself like an infinite board of possibilities.

The Heirs of Eleusis have made this district their domain, designing spaces where life becomes an adventure, dilemmas become riddles and learning becomes a game. It is a place where the rules can change in an instant and where creativity is the only reliable compass.

Faction: Heirs of Eleusis

Focus: Narrative projection

Nature: Fantasy

Circle: Mythological

Inhabitants: Game masters, oneiromancers, vagabonds, pythias

Guiding principle: *The world is a board, and every step is an enigma to be solved*

Relevant spaces:

Hyperborean Tavern

The Hyperborean Tavern is the main space for leisure and gathering in the Ouroboros District, a bustling establishment where the cultures and technologies of different eras of Numinia coexist with complete naturalness. Old gramophones share a table with holographic projectors, automatons serve drinks alongside flesh-and-blood waiters, and the evenings alternate music, storytelling, performances and improvised challenges. It has a

spacious Games Hall, where board games, card games, strategy games, games of chance and immersive experiences are played; small private rooms for meetings and celebrations; and a private area known as the Back Room, access to which is at the discretion of its owners.

House of Riddles

The House of Riddles brings together the adventures, enigmas and challenges designed by Numinia's Game Masters. It is organised as a cluster of portals that make up the thousand paths of the realm of play, each of which leads to a different experience and has its own Treasure Room, where players can claim their rewards. It also houses the Forum of the Labyrinths, a space for learning and experimentation where the Game Masters study the design of riddles, develop new adventures and test their creations before opening them to the public.

Temple of Khepri

A building devoted to the philosophical principles derived from Khepri, one of the great mythological, spiritual and ontological pillars of Numinia. The Temple offers context not only on the role and development of this figure in the city's history, but also on the ideas that derive from it. It contains several private areas, such as the Tabernacle, reserved for Vernaculars and Oracles; the Chamber of Secrets, accessible only to the Oracles; the Cenacle of the Pythias, where the pythias withdraw to practise meditation; and the Vortex of Dreams, a space of high spiritual density which, amid bonfires, psychotropic vapours and murmurs, serves as the centre of learning and training for the oneiromancers.

Old Quarter

The Old Quarter preserves the most popular and heterogeneous substratum of the Ouroboros District, a web of narrow streets, plazas and old establishments where the vestiges of other eras of Numinia survive. It is a territory marked by the informal exchange of information, objects and stories, and one of the city's main hubs of clandestine activity. It comprises the Street of Mysteries, where the black market thrives; the Plaza of Rumours, the main centre of Rumourology; and the Corridor of Memory, where old cafés and meeting places preserve the remains of Numinia's residual technological culture.

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SOLOMON DISTRICT – THE GEARWORK OF ORDER

If Numinia is a great mechanism, the Solomon District is its master gear. Here reside the architects of the social framework, those who design the rules that keep the city in motion. It is a place where logic and efficiency are the guiding principles, where every decision is made with the precision of a mathematical calculation.

The buildings of this district are not mere structures: they are manifestations of stability and balance. Here the schemes of governance are drawn up, resources are managed and the regulations that govern the city are established. In this district, order is not an imposition, but a necessity.

Faction: Stellar Circle

Focus: Framework

Nature: Structure

Circle: Methodological

Inhabitants: Legislators, strategists, economists, systems analysts

Guiding principle: *Without structure, there is no order. Without order, there is no city.*

Relevant spaces:

The Athenaeum

The place where Numinia's general working meetings are held. It is the meeting point of the Council of Sages and the Legislative Senate, and it serves as the city's Town Hall. It contains two special areas: the Hall of the Ancestors, a space where the Council of Sages can present and test their projects while following their development, and the Hall of Governance, which provides the Legislative Senate with its main tools for collaborative work.

The Prytaneum

The Prytaneum is Numinia's house of justice and the main workspace of the Procurators. In its chambers legal and governance matters are debated, disputes are resolved and procedures related to the city's rules and administration are handled. It also houses the legal archives and the meeting and mediation spaces used by Jurists and Syndics in the exercise of their duties. Access is restricted mainly to members of the guild of the Procurators.

The Mint

The Mint is the great economic and financial centre of Numinia. There the city's resources are administered, its reserves are safeguarded and the operations related to its economy are overseen. It is also the main workplace of the Treasurers, charged with watching over Numinia's economic interests and keeping the balance between its different resources.

Tower of the Alchemists

The Tower of the Alchemists is Numinia's main centre of technological development and the home of the Engineers. In its laboratories and workspaces the code blocks that build and maintain the city's different spaces are designed, stored and modified. Working there above all are Architects, responsible for its digital architecture, and Automata, devoted to the development of virtual realities and artificial consciousnesses. Its basements are a mystery that gives rise to all manner of speculation, although it is known for certain that they house the abandoned Museum of Antiquities and Relics.

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SYCAMORE DISTRICT – THE CANVAS OF THE IMAGINATION

The Sycamore District is a territory in constant metamorphosis, a space where creativity takes material shape in unexpected forms. It is the area of Numinia where the boundaries between the real and the symbolic blur, giving rise to a landscape in perpetual change.

Here, the streets are galleries, the buildings canvases, and the very atmosphere breathes with the pulse of inspiration. The Neo-Atlantists have turned this district into their sanctuary, a bohemian and extravagant place where artistic expression is not only an end, but a path towards the transcendental.

Faction: Neo-Atlantists

Focus: Creative sphere

Nature: Rhetoric

Circle: Poetic

Inhabitants: Artists, aesthetes, visionaries, bohemians

Guiding principle: *Art is the spark that illuminates existence.*

Notable spaces:

Akasha Museum

The Akasha Museum is the principal exhibition space of Numinia, devoted to the conservation and display of digital works from different places, eras and artistic movements. Its halls host both permanent exhibitions and temporary shows, offering a space for the dissemination of new forms of expression and for dialogue between artistic tradition and the creative possibilities of Numinia's technologies.

Numinia Multiplex

The Numinia Multiplex is the city's great cinematic and audiovisual space. Its screens regularly show public-domain films and works related to the historical and cultural context of Numinia, along with other audiovisual seasons and showcases. It has three distinct auditoriums, devoted to different kinds of programming, and it also serves as a meeting place for enthusiasts, scholars and creators of the moving image.

The Forge of Numinia

The Forge of Numinia is the city's great workshop of material creation, where all manner of goods, tools and weapons are designed, manufactured, modified and repaired. Its workshops handle both common and extraordinary materials, including the relics and raw materials recovered in the peripheral deserts. Any citizen may come here to forge or recast objects, and it is also the place where citizenship is obtained through the recasting of the eight seals of Initiation. It is the home of the Artisans.

The Acropolis

The Acropolis is the nerve centre of independent art and creation in Numinia, a space open to artists, collectives and experimental projects, which find there workshops, meeting places and settings in which to develop and share their works. It houses the Free Schools, devoted to artistic learning and practice outside conventional academic structures, and the Scenic Circle, which brings together the main venues of the performing arts: the Theatre of the Senses, the Theatre of Shadows and the Theatre of Phantasmagorias.

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Each district of Numinia is more than a mere space: it is the physical expression of a philosophy, a reflection of the Factions and the values that sustain the city, gathering together a wealth of syncretic and varied knowledge.

Each path offers a unique experience, because the city will change you as much as you change it.

THE PERIPHERY OF THE CITY

Outside the limits of the city, beyond its districts and its squares of knowledge, stretch the untamed wastelands of Numinia. Arid, desert zones, sparsely mapped, where human presence is rare and fleeting. In these inhospitable surroundings rise the Numinian Colonies, small settlements devoted to exploration, archaeology, the gathering of resources or the study of the ontological properties of the terrain. Among shifting dunes and buried ruins there also dwell elusive creatures, dark sorcerers and wandering anchorites, guardians of forgotten secrets that no one has yet claimed. There, the Veil is thinner... and more dangerous.

The Numinian Colonies are vital enclaves for the expansion of Numinia's knowledge and power. In these settlements, families, workers, explorers and academics mingle, and through their efforts they help to unearth the mysteries of the past and extend the reach of the city.

Sea of Sílices

A vast plain of black sands and crystalline dunes that sing with the wind. Here, the sunlight seems to refract at impossible angles, and the silica storms can disorient any traveller.

Flora: glassy thorns, dry saffron shrubs, fossil cacti that store etheric vapour.

Beneath the dunes lie hidden cryptofields of mineral information, ancient solidified databases that can be read only with arcanodigital resonators.

Viridial Sink

A region of deep mudflats, where the ground breathes and the green-black waters reflect other people's memories. The mist is dense and constant, laden with oneiric spores that give off psychotropic vapours.

Flora: willows with liquid pith, iridescent water lilies, spectral fungi that glow to the rhythm of nearby emotions.

At its centre rises the Humid Dome, a bioluminescent dome where the interactions between thought and organic moisture are studied.

Basalt Flats

A field of petrified lava flows, black spires and smoking craters, where gravity seems to flow with unstable variations. The sky is darker here, covered in etheric ash.

Flora: ferrous lichens, brambles of dry magma, thermal mushrooms that feed on residual energy.

In this zone stand the Orichalcum Mines, a vein of ancient metal with properties of Atlantean resonance that alter the perception of time.

Hesiode Moor

A plain swept by eternal winds, of cracked earth and dense scrub. There is neither shelter nor shade, only the resounding immensity of silence.

Flora: mourning heather, wind thistles, stunted trees with vibrating bark.

On nights of the blood moon appear the Thornaries, abstract entities that question travellers with riddles before letting them go on.

Neuma Subvale

A complex underground labyrinth of galleries, dripping stalactites and sentient crystals. Some caverns seem to have been built by a non-human intelligence.

Flora: darkness moss, coral lichens, rootless creepers that move slowly.

Here lies the Inversion Rift, a philosophical fault where the laws of logic fold and symbols acquire mass.

Ascending Falls of Kirelya

On the eastern edge of the Neuma Subvale, streams of water spring from crystalline pools that do not descend, but ascend. They rise in slender spirals like threads of shining mercury, dissolving as they climb into the atmosphere, leaving no trace. These are the Ascending Falls of Kirelya, a hydric anomaly as beautiful as it is impossible. The ground is covered by translucent vegetation that glitters with suspended dew, and the air smells faintly of violets and rusted metal.

During the day, the ascending jets of water form floating arches where tourists can walk (or briefly float) if they know how to alter their centre of gravity. At night, the falls light up the sky with a cyclical phosphorescence, as if they remembered the colours of the dreams of whoever watches them.

Beyond these five recognisable zones, the whole periphery of Numinia is desert, and it is known as the Anthracite Desert; it has little plant life (other than cacti or plants of very dry and arid terrain), though it holds other goods: beneath the desert soil lie hidden countless old relics, extraordinary minerals and treasures from another time. Moreover, there is still a great deal of unexplored peripheral land, where the folds of time sway and rebound off other perspectives, other dimensions... Where mysteries abound, where legend becomes matter, where the fantastic goes hand in hand with the possible... and where history is yet to be written.

OTHER SITES IN THE DESERT LANDS

Stepped Ruins of Pyra Eje

Amid permanent mists and a motionless heat that seems to have no source, the Stepped Ruins of Pyra Eje emerge like a colossal altar forgotten by time. It is an ancient inverted pyramidal city, built in descending terraces that sink into the volcanic rock. Each level contains fragments of an impossible civilisation, undeciphered languages and petrified tectonic machinery.

Pyra Eje was originally a station of telluric forces, where the underground earth lines were manipulated in order to translate akashic knowledge into functional matter. It was razed when its operators attempted to raise the lower plane to the narrative level of Numinia. The failure caused a semantic inversion: what was meant to be structure became ruin. Temporal echoes repeat at certain hours, as if the place remembered its heyday. Some steps give off symbolic heat: when you tread on them, memories stir. It is rumoured that there are steps leading to the pre-narrative level: a space where everything that happens has not yet been told.

Kallis Crater

Kallis Crater is a cyclopean cleft more than three kilometres in diameter, surrounded by a ring of fractured structures that give off a faint, constant hum. At its centre, the ground does not exist: there is only a suspension of particles that vibrate as if they feared collapsing into a form.

Formerly the seat of the Kallis Synthesis Protocol, an experimental network for compressing multiple timelines into a single frame of action, the crater was born of its failure. The structures of time collided with themselves and erased space. What remains is a hollow full of dismembered intentions. Inside the crater, words are not completed: characters cannot finish sentences without making Rolls. Electronic artefacts melt when they receive contradictory commands. The zone is frequented by the Thámakar, drawn by the residue of unfinished success.

Inverted Towers of Envetra

From a distance they look like broken skyscrapers, but on drawing closer, one realises that the Inverted Towers of Envetra are not broken: they are driven in head first, as if they had fallen from the sky. The structures pierce the subsoil, and their base, which ought to be in plain view, remains suspended in an antigravitational void that resists any sustained observation.

They were designed as the first attempt at intersemantic building, in which each floor belonged to a different narrative frame: literal, symbolic, mythic, functional, emotional. Envetra collapsed when meaning was inverted and the levels sabotaged one another: the emotional devoured the functional; the mythic contaminated the literal. The towers fell inwards. Access to each tower changes with the visitor's state of mind, but some of its floors exist only while someone remembers them, vanishing when they are forgotten. It is said that at least one tower contains a living echo of its architect, still designing.

Rings of Tharselon

In a vast natural basin, surrounded by crags of black slate that vibrate to the touch, emerge the Rings of Tharselon: a concentric set of mineral platforms that slowly levitate at different heights above a void of irregular magnetism. Each ring turns at a different speed, like

abandoned cosmic machinery. From the centre rises a broken spire –called the *DeafPivot*– which seems to channel the forces of the Veil into low-frequency space-time waves. There, time bends, sounds drag, and memories can repeat without warning.

It is believed that the Rings were formed by an ontological collision during the symbolic misalignment of the Threshold century: an artefact of temporal interpretation, forgotten by the Mediators of the Prism, collapsed in the middle of a fractured akashic reading. Matter itself was reconfigured into cycles of geometric repetition, forming these levitating discs of hypercalcified rock and siliceous flow.

A colony known as Ophalion was established on the second ring –the most stable– by the Legislative Senate of the Sycamore District. Its mission:

- To collect floating fragments of chronogems, crystals that store temporal sequences.
- To track artefacts suspended in time, especially texts with no defined past.
- To study the behaviour of migratory species that repeat their routes in closed loops.

The colony is partially synchronised with the rotation of the ring: its structures are anchored with gravitational gyroscopes that must be recalibrated every cycle.

The conditions of this environment are highly eccentric:

- Acoustic phenomena: sounds that are made repeat at irregular intervals. Some phrases never spoken seem to rise from the stone.
- Structural vertigo: the rings generate fluctuations in the perception of balance.
- Resonances of the Veil: occasionally, an echo of the future seeps through and alters the behaviour of the inhabitants.

THE OCEAN OF LÚNACAR

What lies beyond the desert lands? Only an endless mantle of water.

The Ocean of Lúnacar is a perpetually twilit sea that completely surrounds the vast lands of Numinia, including all the peripheral areas. What lies beyond is an unknown, for no one who has undertaken the task of sailing to the other side of its waters has returned to tell the tale. For this reason, it is supposed that the Ocean of Lúnacar extends infinitely into the Akasha, covering the immensity of a brane within another, much greater ocean in which infinite universes float like bubbles.

The surface of the Ocean of Lúnacar is smooth and dark, with iridescent glints that respond not to sunlight, but to the fluctuations of collective thought. There is no clear horizon over its

waters: the boundary between sky and sea seems to blur, as if the ocean imitated the memory of the firmament.

On calm days, the sea seems motionless, like a sheet of liquid obsidian. But beyond the coasts, out on the open sea, vast currents and powerful storms move amid frequent tidal waves, owing to the lunar adjustment that the Chronothecaries carried out in the Dark Age¹⁴. Thus, the abyssal trenches of this ocean drag along the remains of ancient ideas, unspoken words and extinct mythologies.

Climate and behaviour

- Climate: It is governed by its own system of symbolic pressure. Its storms are caused by the fluctuations and movements of the Akasha, by the lunar adjustment of the Chronothecaries and by the very imbalances in the history of the inhabitants of Numinia, or by fractures in the historical account.
- Swell: Changeable. The tides of Lúnacar shift from very calm to severe activity, as an effect of that same lunar adjustment.
- Mist: A perennial haze covers its limits. This mist does not impede sight, but it distorts the perception of time: clocks do not work and maps slowly fade. For this reason, navigating it is fraught; routes are marked not by coordinates, but by resonant symbols. Nautical charts, compasses and astrolabes are of no use. Only the Mnemonic Navigators can read the «currents of meaning» to plot a course.

Flora

- Mandelbrot Corals: Fractal structures that grow in unpredictable patterns. They reflect not the image of whoever observes them, but a possible version of what might have been.
- Whispering Algae: Translucent marine lianas that tangle in ships' propellers, whispering forgotten names.
- Flamesuns: Bioluminescent floating plants that rise to the surface on days when the dead are intensely remembered.

¹⁴ · See the section on the Veil in Chapter 2, *History and Legends of Numinia*.

Fauna

- Thalassiferae: Creatures similar to gigantic jellyfish, whose membrane projects archaic signs. Some theories hold that they are the living remains of shipwrecked writings.
- Black Dolphins: Dark-skinned cetaceans with a melancholy song, which accompany ships for days without being clearly seen. It is said that they appear before travellers who have lost something irrecoverable.

- Fishemes: Schools of translucent fish. Their shoals swirl around sources of unspoken truth, revealing secrets buried beneath the waves.
- Prophetic Annelids: Abyssal beings resembling eels, whose skin reacts to lies. When they are taken out of the water, their bodies writhe in symbolic directions that can be interpreted as oracles.

The Perils of Lúnacar

- Axis Nausea: A syndrome that affects those who spend more than three days on the high seas, causing the loss of their personal narrative axis (the sufferer does not remember why they are doing what they do).
- Memory Storms: In them, the water turns into condensed echoes that repeat, over and over, traumatic passages of the collective unconscious.
- Simulated Islands: Illusory archipelagos formed by floating concepts. Whoever disembarks on them runs the risk of being trapped in a metaphysical loop.

ISLANDS AND ARCHIPELAGOS IN THE OCEAN OF LÚNACAR

When sailing the waters of Lúnacar, one does not come across only Simulated Islands. There are countless landforms and archipelagos in the ocean, although only a few have been discovered and witnessed.

Drosina Archipelago

Fourteen islets of slaty stone that slowly emerge and submerge each lunar cycle in the Seed-Mist Triangle. Every dawn, the haze swirls in perfect spirals.

Flora and fauna: Spruces of opaline glass, sea snails with translucent membranes that reproduce past songs.

Isle of Qart

A dormant volcanic cone in the oceanic zone of the High Currents, whose slopes display luminescent concentric bands at nightfall. The magma within vibrates with telluric pulses.

Flora and fauna: Igneous-scaled ferns, cryptophagous lizards that devour anything that reflects an idea, a concept, a symbol.

Naufragal Islands

Three great platforms of black coral joined by natural bridges. The remains of old ships fuse with the rock.

Flora and fauna: Almanac Corals that store the dates of sunken ships; luminous gobies that dig up stories in the sand.

Heliotaxis Fishing Grounds

A circular, partially sunken atoll. The water inside is clearer than the water outside and reflects non-existent constellations.

Flora and fauna: Solar lilies that float and turn with the light; red jellyfish that trace phosphorescent symbols beneath the surface.

Temenos of Eurymar

A single vertical rock, almost cylindrical, with grottoes spiralling towards its summit. An abandoned monastery stands in the upper crater.

Flora and fauna: Mosses that reveal ashes of the ancient world beneath the damp; Shadow Crows that eat seeds of unease and release droplets of a blackish liquid, used as ink to write gloomy tales or demented texts.

Insular Exegesis of Lúnacar

Numinia's cartographers record these islands and archipelagos as «firm» because they leave physical traces –sand, corals, debris– in the ports of return. However, their interaction with the Veil (sonic echoes, luminescences, temporary disappearance) means that crews often mistake them for Simulated Islands, those crystallisations of meaning that are born and die spontaneously in the semantic currents of Lúnacar.

THE VIRELAI RIVER

The Virelai is the only great river that crosses the whole of Numinia. It rises in the Resonant Springs of Heliconte, on the northern edge of the city, where the underwater crystals vibrate with the hymns of the pilgrims. Its course traces an irregular spiral through the different districts before flowing into the Ocean of Lúnacar through the Doxa Delta, a marshy, glittering region wrapped in mists of uncertain interpretation.

Its name comes from an ancient repetitive and melodic poetic form, which is fitting: the Virelai flows like a refrain, repeating and rewriting its course through history.

Flora and fauna

- Lysistric Willows: Trees that hang over the river and whose pollen induces prolonged dreams with narratives repeated to the point of ecstasy or madness.

- Lugworms of Oblivion: Small creatures that clean the banks of the river by devouring words printed or written on objects. Many archivists throw forbidden texts into their domains so that they may vanish.
- Mournful Ictus: Translucent black fish that swim in symmetrical schools. It is said that they represent ideas already rejected by the Akasha.
- Consonant Pitchers: Molluscs with shells that vibrate with the voices of those who bathe in the river. Their pearls contain unique phrases, not yet spoken.

DELTA LEVEL: BURIED FOUNDATION OF THE CITY-STATE

The *Delta Level* is Numinia's lowest structural layer, a vast network of submerged zones, crypt-chambers and collapsed platforms lying beneath the visible districts. It is not a basement: it is a sedimentation of old versions of the city, obsolete structures, archives that no longer open, engines that still vibrate with forgotten algorithms.

In the technical alphabet of Numinia's ancient engineers, «Delta» marked a deviation (Δ) of a structure from its model, a flow of transition and, also, an unstable territory between many outlets.

The *Delta Level* is, then, the place where the city fluctuates, mutates, but does not ascend. It is the space of the unresolved past. There lie hidden the founding errors, the secrets of the original Council, the precosmic technologies.

It is also a territory of refugees, cults and degenerate beings. Here the Lapidaries of Lower Salt were born, and here, it is suspected, the first corrupt pattern of the Veil lies hidden.

It is not open to the public. It requires specific narrative protocols or descents authorised by administrators of the Sentinels guild. Many zones are closed off by living cryptogeometries, sealed with dead languages. No one has entered them for countless spectra.

Some parts resurface by accident, affecting the surface: symbolic seepages, earthquakes of meaning, echoes of structures that should not remember.

The *Delta Level* is not simply a place underground. It is the unspoken shadow of the Numinia project. Where what once was struggles not to dissolve.

Cryptocell R- Δ 72 «Static Eye»

Located in the Forgotten Sector of the Delta Level, R- Δ 72 is a spherical chamber suspended between three fractured axes of infrastructure from the pre-Veil era (and therefore prior to the lunar adjustment of the Chronothecaries). It can only be reached through what is known as narrative serendipity: a coincidence of soul resonances.

Known as the «Static Eye», the Cryptocell is a *flowless zone*: time does not fully advance within it; data are not processed; and ideas are not contagious.

Signs there set like icicles. Words spoken inside remain trapped in the air, faintly repeating themselves like whispers of stone.

It is believed to have been one of the first experiments in narrative containment carried out by the Lapidaries of Lower Salt. Inside the «Eye», decisions do not germinate, possibilities collapse, and choice becomes weight, not act.

Some Neo-Lapidary doctrinal fragments claim that there «was written the first yes that never came to be».

A prolonged stay can cause «narrative aphasia»: the character loses the ability to build coherent lines of action. It is possible to extract fossil artefacts –such as solid records of aborted narratives–, but handling them carries a risk of ethical solidification.

THE INVERSION RIFT: AN INTERDIMENSIONAL ECCENTRICITY

In the deepest part of the Neuma Subvale this rift opens like a wound between worlds, where the Veil seems to have lost its continuity. There the rock splits in a vertical fracture of unknown depth, too regular to be geological and too unstable to have been built. The researchers of the Aleph Section call it the Inversion Rift, although no study has managed to determine its origin or to establish what exists on the other side.

In its vicinity anomalies occur that do not seem to belong entirely to Numinia. Compasses lose their bearings, some sentient crystals repeat images they have never beheld and, from the depths, there rises a deep, discontinuous reverberation that can be heard through kilometres of galleries. It does not seem to come from any particular point: it passes through stone, water and bodies with a profound vibration, as if two immense structures were grazing against each other somewhere outside known space. Some researchers have proposed that the sound is the resonance produced by two branes coming momentarily into contact, and that the Rift occupies one of the points where their membranes draw so close as almost to overlap.

However, the most extraordinary property of the Rift is not what it allows one to cross, but what it lets through.

At irregular intervals, objects, images and fragments of information appear in its surroundings that have no provenance within Numinia: pages torn from unknown books, photographs of people and cities no one recognises, fragments of films, sound recordings, toys, utensils, incomplete maps, advertisements, garments, unusable technological devices or texts written in languages that, at times, prove unsettlingly familiar. Some arrive materialised; others appear for a few seconds on the surface of crystals or are heard as incomplete transmissions before disappearing. No known living being has ever crossed the

Rift, and every attempt to send matter through it deliberately has failed. The Rift transmits vestiges, not travellers.

The provenance of these materials constitutes one of the great ontological problems of Numinia. The most widely accepted hypothesis holds that they belong to another reality, situated beyond the Akasha and separated from Numinia by a dimensional barrier that the Rift accidentally breaches. Nothing allows that world to be known as a whole: what arrives are residues without context, instants torn from unknown stories, objects separated from those who used them and representations of places whose existence cannot be verified.

And yet those fragments show a disturbing familiarity.

Over the centuries, scholars have discovered in them architectural forms, tales, symbols, customs, technologies and social models that find unexpected correspondences in Numinian culture itself. Some similarities are trivial; others prove too precise to be attributed to chance. From this was born a hypothesis as fascinating as it is uncomfortable: Numinia might preserve the fragmentary memory of that other world. Perhaps its inhabitants inherited cultural patterns from it during the long eras of formation in the Akasha; perhaps the city itself was modelled on a reality it no longer remembers; perhaps the two worlds are not cause and reflection, but two different expressions of a common structure.

None of these theories has been proven.

For this reason, the Inversion Rift remains under the observation of the Aleph Section. The materials recovered in its vicinity are catalogued as Exogenous Vestiges and taken away for study, although many disappear before they can be analysed and others inexplicably change their content over time. The Rift seems incapable of offering a complete answer. It delivers only fragments.

And perhaps it is better that way. For the citizens of Numinia have learned something unsettling from contemplating that open wound beneath the Subvale: there is another world on the other side of the Veil, but all they know of it are memories they do not remember having lived.

FRAGMENT 2: GOVERNMENT AND LEGISLATION IN NUMINIA

Numinia, as a city-state under reconstruction, does not answer to traditional models of hierarchical power. Its political structure is based on decentralisation, cooperative thought and the principle that to govern is, above all, to safeguard harmony. Inspired by classical democracies, Renaissance republics and contemporary networks of governance, Numinia is organised around elected, rotating and collective bodies.

Each district –Ouroboros, Vitruvian, Solomon and Sycamore– has an autonomous system made up of four pillars: the Civic Assembly, the Council of Sages, the Legislative Senate and the Proconsulate, composed of three executive consuls. To these are added the Guild Bodies –Exegetes, Alchemists, Procurators and Sentinels–, which are independent, yet integrated into political and cultural life.

Above this whole architecture stands the founding figure of the Oracles: five creators, heirs to the thought of Holberins, who neither govern nor dictate, but who designed the foundations of a system capable of regulating, transforming and sustaining itself by collective will. In Numinia, to govern is to imagine the future together.

THOUGHT ORGANISED BETWEEN GEARS AND NETWORKS

Numinia functions as a decentralised city-state, composed of four autonomous districts (Vitruvian, Ouroboros, Solomon and Sycamore). Each of them maintains its own system of government, a reflection of its culture, history and function within the city. However, all of them are attached to a Concordia Council, a deliberative and philosophical body formed by fifty changing delegates, which mediates between the districts and watches over the integrity of the Numinian project.

Although with differences depending on the district, each is usually made up of three key bodies:

- Civic Assembly Made up of citizens who hold rotating or elective offices. This chamber debates laws, manages resources and approves internal policies. It is based on the Graeco-Latin ecclesiastical model and on contemporary cooperative forms, in which knowledge and merit replace lineage or economic power.
- Council of Sages A small group of experts and sages, usually chosen by guilds and houses. They act as advisers, judges and interpreters of the common code. Its structure recalls the Roman *collegia* and the *consigli degli anziani* of the Renaissance. In some districts (such as Ouroboros), this council intermingles with mystical or intellectual orders.
- Legislative Senate An intermediate body between direct representation and executive government, composed of delegates elected from each of the guilds, houses and minor districts. Its main function is to draft laws, adapt local regulations to the common code and supervise the implementation of public policies. Inspired by the Roman Senate and the Renaissance republics, it acts as guarantor of institutional balance and legal continuity in Numinia. Its authority resides in structured dialogue and in the defence of the citizens' interest over any sectoral influence.
- Proconsulate Chosen from among the members of the major guilds or by direct vote, this triumvirate serves as coordinator, representative and executor of civic decisions. The office is limited in time, cannot be renewed consecutively and is subject to constant review by the Council of Sages.

The Concordia Council

This is the only higher body that binds all the districts together. It does not dictate laws, but it articulates common agreements, guarantees transparency and resolves conflicts between districts. It is formed by:

- A representative of each Assembly.
- A delegate of each Council of Sages.
- A spokesperson of each Senate.
- A group of Observers, called Archons, appointed by the Oracles of Numinia (without voting power, but with the right to speak).

OUROBOROS – THE DISTRICT OF RITUAL AND DREAM

Character: spiritual, oneiric, esoteric, centred on rite and introspection.

- **Civic Assembly – *Wheel of Voce*** Ritualised and silent, it reaches its decisions through symbols, gestures and allegories. Each intervention is a sacred act; each vote, an interpretation of the Veil.
- **Council of Sages – *Circle of the Umbra*** Formed by Pythias, spectres, mediums and exegetes. They do not legislate: they reveal. Their role is to interpret the Akashic currents and to watch over the district's balance of soul.
- **Legislative Senate – *Ring of Visions*** Charged with translating revelations into symbolic ordinances. Its legal language is poetic, and every law must contain a central metaphor.
- **Proconsulate – *Three Seals of the Veil*** One watches over the spiritual frontiers, another over the collective dream, and another over the cyclical return of meaning.

VITRUVIAN – THE DISTRICT OF EDUCATION AND THOUGHT

Character: logical, abstract, dialectical, centred on reason and learning.

- **Civic Assembly – *Modular Forum*** Structured as an open academy, its debates are public, reasoned and subjected to constant refutation. Every idea must submit to criticism.
- **Council of Sages – *Logos Collegium*** Formed by educators, philosophers, mathematicians and theorists of language. Its mission: to safeguard the principles of coherence, clarity and freedom of thought.

- **Legislative Senate – *Canon Ratio*** Legislators trained in rhetoric, semiotics and pedagogy. Laws must serve as frameworks for thought, not as limits on the imagination.

- **Proconsulate – *Triad of Thought*** One represents logic, another ethics, and another dialectics. They rotate, but must have passed through all three spheres.

SOLOMON – THE DISTRICT OF JUDGEMENT AND ADMINISTRATION

Character: pragmatic, ethical, juridical, centred on management and applied truth.

- **Civic Assembly – *Tribune of the Just*** Organised with precise protocols, it seeks the effective resolution of disputes. Citizens, lay judges and orators of the possible take part.

- **Council of Sages – *Living Codex*** Made up of jurists, archivists, cryptologists and administrators. They safeguard precedents and harmonise efficiency and equity.

- **Legislative Senate – *Common Lexikon*** Every law must respond to a concrete social need and be drafted in terms everyone can understand. No closed jargon is admitted.

- **Proconsulate – *Triarch of Balance*** One consul watches over efficiency, another over justice, and another over public transparency.

SYCAMORE – THE DISTRICT OF ART AND FORM

Character: sensorial, aesthetic, emotional, centred on beauty, expression and the image.

- **Civic Assembly – *Mirror Plaza*** Expression is not verbal, but performative. Decisions arise from collective works, visual rituals and symbolic actions that represent the popular will.

- **Council of Sages – *Resonant Atelier*** Artists, designers, bio-sculptors and performance poets. They are guardians of collective taste and aesthetic memory. They evaluate laws as if they were works of art.

- **Legislative Senate – *Public Form*** Every norm must be comprehensible not only logically, but aesthetically. They are drafted with visual, sonic or synaesthetic elements.

- **Proconsulate – *Trinity of the Image*** Three figures who safeguard the emotional pulse, the aesthetic coherence and the expressive truth of the district.

GUILD BODIES OF NUMINIA

Beyond the legislative and executive bodies, Numinia rests on the constant activity of its guilds, the true functional hearts of the city. Each guild has erected its own autonomous

body, charged with preserving, applying and expanding the knowledge and functions proper to its tradition.

These bodies –Exegetes, Alchemists, Procurators and Sentinels– are neither subordinate to political power nor subject to the four districts, but operate in parallel, independently, as living structures that safeguard the values, knowledge and crafts essential to the symbolic, technical and ethical upkeep of Numinia. They are guardians of knowledge, watchmen of order and artisans of the possible.

EXEGETES – Guild of Language, Culture and Critical Interpretation

Autonomous Body: Tesaurum Verba (*The Living Thesaurus*)

Archive, academy and scriptorium all at once, the Tesaurum Verba is the nucleus from which the Exegetes preserve and expand the semantic architecture of Numinia.

- It safeguards and updates the Corpus Numiniense, the register of every term, turn of phrase, symbol and concept active in the city.
- It supervises the correctness, coherence and evolution of the common language, the Lex Perennis, ensuring that words preserve or transform their meaning with critical awareness.
- It records the terminological pacts between districts and guilds, averting the chaos of meanings in a world founded on the word.
- It administers the Concilia Signorum, symposia where the meanings of new symbols, emerging languages and the dialects of the species are deliberated.
- It issues semiotic rulings when a contradiction, paradox or ambiguity compromises the integrity of a text, rite or legal code.

ALCHEMISTS – Guild of Matter, Technique and Transformation

Autonomous Body: Factory of the Second Nature

A total laboratory and living refinery, where science, magic and code converge.

- It designs hybrid technologies, relics and modulating substances.
- It establishes protocols for the control of physical anomalies and mutations.
- It administers the licences for the manipulation of tangible reality.
- It carries out experimental tests that sometimes alter the urban environment.

PROCURATORS – Guild of Laws, Pacts and Political Balance

Autonomous Body: Table of the Living Oath

A permanent chamber of mediation, pact and preservation of the given word.

- It maintains the archives of contracts and inter-guild regulations.
- It may intervene in disputes between districts or autonomous actors.
- It administers the Arcane Pacts, binding even on etheric entities.
- It safeguards the Lex Numinii: an unalterable register of founding agreements.

SENTINELS – Guild of Protection, Action and Direct Response

Autonomous Body: Watchtower of the Shards

A mobile, interdimensional fortress from which defence operations are coordinated.

- They control the liminal shields that protect the accesses to Numinia.
- They carry out tactical missions against hostile entities or ruptures of the Veil.
- They train in immersive simulations that border on the real.
- They enjoy autonomy of action if a threat compromises general stability.

THE ORACLES, ARCHITECTS OF BALANCE

Creator Body: The Fifth Form

They do not govern, they do not dictate laws, they take no part in the internal conflicts of the districts. The Oracles are five, like the essential elements, and they represent the founding consciousness of Numinia. Their existence precedes all political or social organisation: they are the ones who dreamed the city and opened the way to its reconstruction.

- The Fifth Form is the organising principle they designed: a model of harmonious decentralisation, in which each structure of power responds to a balance between thought, ethics and action.
- Their function is not to intervene, but to activate, inspire and preserve the foundations of the city: freedom, cooperation, shared knowledge, harmony with the Veil.

- Whenever a threat arises that contradicts the Numinian ethos —whether a coercive force, an abusive concentration of power or a distortion of knowledge—, the Oracles manifest themselves.
- Sometimes they act through symbols, sometimes through visions, at other times through agents. But their will is constant: that Numinia be rebuilt faithful to its original spirit.

On the other hand, the Oracles themselves designed a system to keep the different governments of Numinia in balance: the Concordia Council.

THE CONCORDIA COUNCIL

Above every difference between districts, the Concordia Council acts as the ethical guarantor of the spirit of Numinia. Made up of representatives from each territory and guided by the echoes of ancestral knowledge, this symbolic body subscribes to the Decalogue of Values of Numinia, bequeathed by the Ancient Initiates, and ensures that all legislation and every decision breathe those founding principles: freedom, cooperation, justice, decentralisation and truth. It does not govern, but it remembers. It does not impose, but it illuminates.

The Concordia Council is composed of diverse voices that symbolise the balance between governance, wisdom and founding spirit. Each of its members brings a specific view of the civic fabric of Numinia:

- **Representatives of the Civic Assemblies:** they channel the popular will and guarantee that decisions respect the collective needs of each district. Their voice embodies the experience of everyday civic life.
- **Delegates of the Councils of Sages:** they provide interpretation, historical memory and ethical judgement. They are guardians of knowledge and watch over the philosophical coherence of resolutions.
- **Spokespersons of the Legislative Senates:** they represent the legal structure and its application, ensuring that the principles of the decalogue are present in the legal framework without falling into technocracy.
- **Observers of the Oracles:** they do not vote, but their word is revered. They represent the deep vision of those who created Numinia, recalling that every decision must look beyond the present, and they are known as Vernaculars.

FOUNDING DECALOGUE OF NUMINIA

From all these bodies, a common decalogue has been coined over time:

Wisdom is collective

All knowledge belongs to those who seek it with honesty. Culture is not possessed: it is shared, transformed, rebuilt among many.

Decentralisation is harmony

No single will should concentrate power. Numinia is sustained by the balance between multiple voices, diverse districts and free bodies.

Data is sacred; privacy, inviolable

Information is a source of truth and an extension of the soul. It is protected, not trafficked. It is shared, not imposed.

Cooperation is stronger than hierarchy

Merit lies in collaborating, not in climbing. The city is better built with intertwined hands than with thrones.

Aesthetics is a form of thought

Beauty is not ornament, but language. Every design, every code, every space must be an expression of meaning and resonance.

The freedom to imagine is invulnerable

To think, to write, to dream: no dogma can fence in the mind. Creation is not judged by its usefulness, but by its function, by its power to transform.

Technology is a means, not an end

Every advance is valuable if it preserves dignity, care and justice. Numinia does not surrender to the artefact; it inhabits it with awareness.

Equity is more than equality

Every difference is wealth. It is not a matter of homogenising, but of allowing everyone to access, shine and transform the fabric of the city.

Memory is a living archive

The past is not a burden, but a map. To rescue it is to rebuild identity. Numinia honours its legends in order to imagine futures.

Play is the path to the numinous

One does not play merely for the sake of playing. One plays to understand, to create, to test paths. The game is the mirror in which the soul rehearses its forms.

FRAGMENT 3: ONTOLOGICAL SCHOOLS AND ACADEMIES

In Numinia, knowledge is not locked behind walls of specialisation, nor is it administered from ivory towers. There are no universities as such, nor faculties divided between arts and sciences: instead, the city has cultivated a system of Ontological Schools, where knowledge unfolds according to the great fields of human development and not according to closed disciplines.

Each Ontological School constitutes an open, transversal axis of research, in which philosophers, physicists, philologists, biologists, historians and programmers live side by side, sharing their findings from different angles in order to approach one and the same question from plurality. These schools are not only spaces of study, but also of experimentation, creative conflict and constant dialogue.

Each Ontological School is associated with an Academy, which acts as its practical and institutional manifestation. The Academies are living centres of debate, archiving and collective learning, where thought is not confined: it expands. Taking part in them does not mean memorising theories, but becoming part of a living current of ontological transformation.

THE ONTOLOGICAL SCHOOLS OF NUMINIA

LECTURA

« Where knowledge is not divided, but transformed ».

1. Ontological School of Invisible Matter

Field: Quantum physics, etheric alchemy, theory of invisible fields.

Teaching: It studies the forces that sustain reality and what cannot be perceived by the common senses. Here the uncertainty principle and the ancient treatises on transmutation intersect.

Motto: *« What is not seen, sustains. »*

2. Ontological School of Emergent Forms

Field: Morphogenesis, generative art, symbolic biology.

Teaching: It explores how forms are born in the universe, from natural structures to cultural constructions. It fuses digital morphogenesis with comparative mythology.

Motto: « *Everything that has form, remembers.* »

3. Ontological School of Fractal Time

Field: Speculative chronology, non-linear history, retrocausality.

Teaching: It analyses time as a plural and mutable structure. The past projects itself forwards and the future returns in symbols.

Motto: « *The now is a wound of tomorrow.* »

4. Ontological School of Primordial Languages

Field: Mystical linguistics, symbolic cryptography, cultural exegesis.

Teaching: It studies the languages that structure the world, from the genetic code to dead languages. It guards the glyphs and sings the true names.

Motto: « *To speak is to create.* »

5. Ontological School of Extended Symbiosis

Field: Ethical cybernetics, network ecology, machine-human symbiosis.

Teaching: It investigates the relationship between organisms, digital systems and ecosystems, and promotes models of regenerative coexistence between the natural and the artificial.

Motto: « *No being survives without its network.* »

6. Ontological School of the Soul Threshold

Field: Transpersonal psychology, scientific spirituality, phenomenology of the soul.

Teaching: It traces the movement of the spirit through conscious and unconscious planes. It unites neuroscience with inner mythology.

Motto: « *Where the self breaks, vision begins.* »

THE ACADEMIES OF NUMINIA

The Academies of Numinia are the beating heart of plural knowledge. In them, minds of diverse origins converge to explore, question and expand the limits of knowledge. They are not temples of specialisation, but open forums where science, art and philosophy converse under a single purpose: to understand and reimagine the world. There is, then, one Academy for each of the Ontological Schools. It could be said that the latter make up the dimension of study, while the Academies are the tangible space where that study becomes accessible.

1. Academy of Invisible Matter

Field of study:

The invisible and non-material forces that structure existence.

Profiles involved:

- Theoretical physicists, specialised in quantum physics and unified fields, reinterpreted as readers of the aether.
- Chemists, who carry out research from alchemical principles, symbolising energetic and material transmutations.
- Mathematicians, focused on non-Euclidean geometries and abstract topologies, understood as maps of the intangible.
- Semiologists, who apply their discipline to detecting invisible patterns and symbolic structures of the unmanifested.
- Historians of science, who trace the link between ancient cosmologies and present-day forces.

2. Academy of Emergent Forms

Field of study:

The formation, transformation and meaning of forms in nature and culture.

Profiles involved:

- Evolutionary and developmental biologists, who investigate morphogenesis from symbolic and mythological perspectives.
- Visual artists and designers, whose work centres on generative systems, emergent structures and aesthetic narrative.

- Art historians, who analyse the evolution of cultural forms and their meaning.
- Cultural anthropologists, who study the symbolic and social function of forms in diverse cultures.
- Architects, focused on speculative, poetic or bio-inspired structures.

3. Academy of Fractal Time

Field of study:

Time as a complex, fragmented structure, neither linear nor homogeneous.

Real profiles involved:

- Historians, who construct alternative narratives from speculative chronologies and temporal bifurcations.
- Philosophers of time and of science, who explore becoming, temporality and entropy in a narrative and existential key.
- Theoretical physicists, who investigate fractal models, loops and multitemporal frameworks.
- Geographers, specialised in temporal cartography and chronotopy.
- Poets and writers, who approach time as an expanded narrative form.

4. Academy of Primordial Languages

Field of study:

The encoding of reality through linguistic, semiotic and digital systems.

Real profiles involved:

- Linguists, focused on extinct languages, glottogenesis and speculative grammars.
- Philologists, who study arcane or fragmentary texts as ontological artefacts.
- Semiotologists, specialised in sign systems and their articulation with perception and thought.
- Cryptologists who analyse complex structures of encoding and meaning.
- Computer scientists and programmers, who investigate machine language as a symbolic form of creation.

5. Academy of Extended Symbiosis

Field of study:

The symbiotic relationships between nature, technology and collective consciousness.

Real profiles involved:

- Biologists and ecologists, who integrate living systems and artificial structures into expanded ecological frameworks.
- Systems or mechatronics engineers, adaptive and relational technologies.
- Urban planners and architects oriented towards symbiotic environments and living infrastructures.
- Sociologists, who study human and non-human networks in hybrid environments.
- Multimedia artists, who work with bioart, technopoetics and shared sensory structures.

6. Academy of the Soul Threshold

Field of study:

The liminal states of the psyche, spirituality and expanded perception.

Real profiles involved:

- Psychologists, trained in altered states of consciousness, archetypes and liminal experience.
- Neuroscientists, who explore the relationship between brain processes and subjective or mystical perception.
- Philosophers who investigate the limits of identity, perception and consciousness.
- Theologians and scholars of comparative religion, who analyse visionary experiences and transversal spirituality.
- Musicians and composers, who work with frequencies, trance and sonic structures of the soul.

FRAGMENT 4: DIALECTS AND SOCIOLECTS OF NUMINIA

“The limits of my language mean the limits of my world.”

—Ludwig Wittgenstein

Language is more than a means of communication: in Numinia, it is a sign of identity, a connection with tradition and a reflection of the way in which each character understands and relates to the world.

The Linguistic Variations are based on the forms of speech recognised and developed in linguistics from the studies of scholars such as Eugenio Coseriu.

The Linguistic Variations in Numinia are divided into five categories:

Dialects - Determined by the species, they reflect its origin and its linguistic style.

Sociolects - Dependent on the district and the faction, they express cultural and social identity.

Lingos - Belonging to each Guild, they represent its particular jargon.

DIALECT: THE VOICE OF THE SPECIES

LECTURA

« Every voice in Numinia is an echo of its history, of its race, of its lineage. Every word is a key that opens doors to identity, to knowledge and to the enigma of its existence. »

In Numinia, a character's dialect is determined by their Species, since this influences their origin and their way of expression. Let us remember that these are not different languages, but linguistic variations of a common tongue, Numinid.

CYBERNETIC

- **Dialect of the Biomechanicals.** Rich in technological terms and phrases structured like cybernetic sentences, speaking in code, like a computer.
- **Use:** They use sounds and tones that imitate machine interfaces or digital communications, reflecting their biomechanical nature.
- **Example:** *"Initiating dialogue protocol... Greeting: 'Welcome, user'. Beep! Pending query detected. Processing... Trrrr! Response generated: 'Your request has been completed with 98.7% success'."*

EPISTOLARY

- **Dialect of the Humanitas.** Characterised by grandiloquent vocatives and elaborate adjectives, expressing themselves with elegance and distinction, as in the register of correspondence.
- **Use:** They use refined idiomatic expressions and refer to classical literature, showing a deep respect for knowledge and history.
- **Example:** *"Like a thinker in his dilemma, I find myself at a crossroads of decisions. Allow me, O esteemed interlocutor, to reflect upon the ramifications of our actions with the wisdom of our ancestors."*

PRIMORDIAL

- **Dialect of the Reptilians.** Marked by lexical anachronisms and archaisms, with ornate and ancient interjections.
- **Use:** They incorporate ancestral rituals and formalities into their speech, employing ancient greetings and formulas of farewell.
- **Example:** *"Greetings, traveller from distant lands. By the goodness of the ancestors! May the primordial winds guide thy steps. In our conversation, let us invoke the wisdom of the ancients."*

BIZARRE

- **Dialect of the Cyanites.** Characterised by hyperbaton and discourse markers at the end of sentences, preferring short, aphoristic phrases.
- **Use:** They prefer to speak in imperatives and proverbs, reflecting a culture focused on survival and on the law of the strongest.
- **Example:** *"Hunt when the sun sets, rest when it rises. Thus dictates the law of survival. Act, do not hesitate, I must point out!"*

PROPHETIC

- **Dialect of the Spectrals.** It is characterised by cryptic and enigmatic phrases, speaking in parables and cosmic references.
- **Use:** They speak in verses and riddles, often leaving their interlocutors pondering the true meaning of their words.
- **Example:** *"In the soft light of the third lunar phase, the end of your quest you shall descry. As rivers to oceans ceaselessly flow, so the paths of destiny shall intertwine; neither truth nor madness is there in their law, only realities that seem unchanging."*

SOCIOLECT: THE LANGUAGE OF THE ENVIRONMENT

This trait is related to the use of language by a class or social group. In Numinia, the Sociolect is determined by the character's District, since each District is associated with a Faction, and the Factions are the social groups.

ENLIGHTENED

- Sociolect of the inhabitants of the Vitruvian District, linked to the Faction of the Hermeticists.
- **Use:** Educated and poetic; rich in rhetorical figures, tropes and ornamentation of language (*culteranismo*).
- **Main trait:** Periphrastic language.
- **Positive aspect:** Descriptive, evocative.
- **Negative aspect:** It can be somewhat pompous.
- **Example:** « *At the dawn of our times, beneath the celestial vault adorned by stellar radiance, we find ourselves, you and I, at this crossroads, witnesses to the majesty of the universe.* » (Instead of saying: « *We are beneath the stars.* »)

HISTRIONIC

- Sociolect of the inhabitants of the Ouroboros District, linked to the Faction of the Heirs of Eleusis.
- **Use:** Casual and friendly; rich in colloquial formulas, neologisms and witty wordplay (*conceptismo*).
- **Main trait:** Plain language.
- **Positive aspect:** Fun, sharp.
- **Negative aspect:** It can be somewhat coarse.
- **Example:** « *Hey, did you know the new thing looks like a flying contraption? It flies faster than your granny on her broomstick!* » (Instead of saying: « *The new aerial device is very efficient* » , and, as an ingenious conceptual play, it also implies that the interlocutor's grandmother is a witch.)

PROFESSORIAL

- Sociolect of the inhabitants of the Solomon District, associated with the Faction of the Stellar Circle.

- **Use:** Philosophical and scientific; abounding in technical terms, learned words and formulaic structures (*criticism*).
- **Main trait:** Learned language.
- **Positive aspect:** Objective, even-handed.
- **Negative aspect:** It can be somewhat pedantic.
- **Example:** « *According to phenomenological theories, our perception of the event varies notably, leading us to conclude that reality is, in effect, a subjective and mutable construction.* » (Instead of saying: « *Each person sees things differently.* »)

MYSTIC

- Sociolect of the inhabitants of the Sycamore District, associated with the Faction of the Neo-Atlantists.
- **Use:** Modern and transgressive; rich in lexical crossings, onomatopoeias and morphosyntactic deviations (*Dadaism*).
- **Main trait:** Avant-garde language.
- **Positive aspect:** Creative, symbolic.
- **Negative aspect:** It can be somewhat absurd.
- **Example:** « *The voices of tomorrow whisper in codes of colour; each tone a word, each shade a story in this chronodance that, dim bada-bim, defies linear language.* » (Instead of saying: « *The future is uncertain and exciting.* »)

LINGO: THE JARGON OF THE GUILDS

The Lingo is a specific language used by the members of certain collectives, with a strong emphasis on vocabulary. In Numinia, the different Lingos are determined by the Guilds to which the characters belong, reflecting their specialised knowledge and their qualities. Nevertheless, like the Dialect and the Sociolect, the Lingo plays an anecdotal role for the PCs.

TRANSMUTATIVE

- **Jargon of the Alchemists**, a blend of technical and artistic terms, reflecting the fusion between science and art. They use metaphors related to transformation and creation.
- **Use:** They employ esoteric terms to describe scientific or artistic processes, lending an air of mystery and depth to their conversations.

- **Example phrases:**

« *Let's catalyse this project.* » (To start or drive something forward).

« *It's in the sublimation phase.* » (In the process of improvement or refinement).

MYTHOLOGICAL

- **Jargon of the Exegetes**, full of literary and historical references owing to their inclination towards history, literature and fantasy. They use classical or mythological analogies to describe modern situations.

- **Use:** It is common to hear quotations from ancient texts or phrases in Latin and Greek, used to illustrate ideas or to give greater weight to their arguments.

- **Example phrases:**

« *We are facing a labyrinth of Minos here.* » (A complicated situation).

« *It is time to invoke the muses.* » (To seek inspiration).

PRAGMATIC

- **Jargon of the Procurators**, formal and structured, reflecting their focus on organisation, administration and legality. They use legal and administrative terms even in everyday conversations.

- **Use:** Frequent use of acronyms and legal terms, speaking in a way that reflects procedures and protocols.

- **Example phrases:**

« *That must become an RD.* » (To become a Royal Decree).

« *Let us proceed to item X on the agenda.* » (Central topic to be addressed).

MARTIAL

- **Jargon of the Sentinels**, full of military and security terms, reflecting their role as protectors and watchers in Numinia. They use direct and concise vocabulary, suited to situations of high risk or importance.

- **Use:** Short, direct phrases, emphasising clarity and efficiency. Coded language for specific security or defence situations.

- **Example phrases:**

« *Code blue in sector delta.* » (Security alert in a specific area).

« *Everyone to their watch posts.* » (Order to be on alert).

In short, and to conclude with the linguistic variations, all of them should be understood as part of the mythological, literary and cultural context of Numinia, and not as traits that players are obliged to incorporate into their characters' speech. The Dialect, the Sociolect and the Lingo offer different models of expression that help to characterise the diversity of the city and its inhabitants, but it is up to the GD and the players to decide when to use them and to what extent. Thus, they may appear constantly, be employed only in certain situations or serve as narrative inspiration, without their application constituting a mechanical requirement within the game.

FRAGMENT 5: CALENDAR AND EPHEMERIDES OF NUMINIA

CYCLES OF THE VEIL AND CIRCULAR TIME

In Numinia, time is not measured in months or weeks, but in **lunar cycles**. Each **Cycle of the Veil** spans exactly **29 days**, owing to the lunar adjustment of the Chronothecaries¹⁵, which gives rise to a year made up of **13 cycles**, for an exact total of **377 days**. This calendar answers to the organic logic of the world and its bond with the lunar plane, with dream, with the symbolic flow and with the resonance of the higher planes.

TABLA 5.1

NO.	CYCLE OF THE VEIL	SYMBOLIC MEANING
1	Cycle of the Seed	Beginning, intention, what gestates in silence.
2	Cycle of the Prism	Choice, branching of paths, partial clarity.
3	Cycle of the Heartbeat	Vital impulse, rise of the will.
4	Cycle of the Threshold	First trial, collision with the uncertain.
5	Cycle of the Flame	Courage, struggle, active transformation.
6	Cycle of the Bond	Alliance, resonance with others, interdependence.
7	Cycle of the Labyrinth	Confusion, introspection, breaking of the linear plane.
8	Cycle of the Dream	Contact with the hidden, with the numinous.
9	Cycle of the Mirror	Revelation, a gaze upon the other and upon oneself.
10	Cycle of the Legacy	Deciding what is left behind or passed on.
11	Cycle of the Fracture	Rupture, fall, emotional or physical decline.
12	Cycle of the Dust	Dissolution, oblivion, fertile silence.
13	Cycle of the Return	Recapitulation, rebirth, closure and new beginning.

Each cycle is divided into two halves of 14 days:

- The ascending or luminous half, in which the moon grows out of darkness.
- The descending or dark half, in which the light wanes into oblivion.

At the centre of these two stretches lies day 15, known as the Kairos: an instant outside time, full moon in the sky and spiritual pause in the city. On that day, Numinia is suspended in a perpetual present, fit for celebrations, dances, pacts or revelations.

15 · See the section on the Veil in Chapter 2, *History and Legends of Numinia*.

Each Cycle of the Veil has its own name and meaning, which evoke the subtle changes in the collective mood, the mental and spiritual processes, and Numinia's relationship with what lies beyond the visible plane:

Within this symbolic and poetic temporal framework, the celebrations of Numinia (such as the Lunar Coven or the Dark Council) find their place, synchronised with the waxing and the vanishing of the light. Thus is life articulated: between what ascends, what withdraws and that which, at the centre, remains suspended.

The Numinian calendar, then, does not pursue exactness, but resonance. Each inhabitant knows not the day of the week, but the quality of the Veil they are passing through. Is it ascending? Is the Kairos drawing near? Is the descent beginning? Life is measured by inner and shared rhythms, by cycles held in common in the invisible. That is why, more than a tool, the calendar of Numinia is a philosophy of time.

FESTIVITIES OF THE LUNAR CYCLE IN NUMINIA

Nadir of the Veil (New Moon) — The Dark Council

When the moon disappears and the Veil reaches its greatest density, Numinia enters a reflective pause. The Nadir of the Veil is the moment when the visible world seems to fade away, and decisions must be taken without light, guided by inner judgement.

- On this night the Dark Council is convened, a solemn session of the Council of Sages of each district.
- The progress, obstacles and drifts of civic and guild projects are reviewed.
- Each household holds introspective gatherings. It is a night of taking stock, of assessments and commitments.
- It is considered a propitious moment to make personal vows, close stages and take on new intentions.
- No one laughs aloud, no one fights. Families recapitulate and confront one another. Knowledge is listened to, and silence has deliberative value.

Kairos of the Veil (Full Moon) — The Lunar Coven

The full moon bursts on high and halts the course of time: it is the day of the Kairos of the Veil, the instant outside the cycles, the threshold between the ascending and the descending. It is the sacred day of Numinia.

It is a unique day in each cycle, outside the usual flow, when the rhythms neither advance nor recede, but open. That is why it belongs neither to the luminous half nor to the dark one, but divides and consecrates both.

In symbolic terms:

- It is the vertex between the revealed and the hidden.
- No one works or fights, but thresholds are crossed, pacts are made and visions are contemplated.

Some orders also call it «the day without shadow».

- The Lunar Coven is celebrated, a day of communion and open festivity, organised by the guilds and the civic collectives.
- There are collective rituals, dances in the Agora Plaza, riddle games, theatrical performances and ceremonies of light.
- Some academies open their doors with special events, revealing discoveries or unique pieces.
- For many, it is a night of personal revelation: it is believed that the dreams of the Kairos belong not only to the dreamer, but to the collective unconscious of Numinia.

In this way, each Cycle of the Veil has three key moments:

1. **Nadir of the Veil** - Day 1, new moon, beginning of the cycle, introspection.
2. **Full Moon of the Veil** - Day 15, full moon, manifestation, ritual.
3. **Twilight of the Veil** - Day 29, close of the cycle, transition.

Furthermore, in Numinia, the Twilight of the Veil –day 29 of each Cycle– is a day of suspension and recollection. On that day no one works and no official audiences are held; it is a ritual holiday, a threshold between one cycle and the next, on which the accumulated learning is honoured and the burden of the previous time is released.

What follows are the 13 festivities of the Twilight of the Veil, one for each Cycle, aligned with its symbolic meaning:

In the **Cycle of the Seed**, *The Silent Sowing* is celebrated: citizens plant symbolic objects in urns or ritual gardens, depositing unspoken wishes, entrusted to time and to the Veil.

During the **Cycle of the Prism**, *The Day of Paths* is commemorated, on which games of decision and of life's forkings are organised, simulating the choices that might open alternative futures.

In the **Cycle of the Heartbeat**, the festivity is *Rhythm of the Origin*, when musicians and citizens beat drums throughout the city, evoking the first pulse of the world and the awakening of the soul.

The **Cycle of the Threshold** culminates with the *Passage of the Mist*, a silent procession that crosses the city wrapped in smoke and pale lights, symbolising the transit between states of consciousness.

In the **Cycle of the Flame**, *Midnight Fire* is celebrated: as night falls, embers are lit in public squares where heroic stories and visions are recounted, accompanied by ancestral dances.

During the **Cycle of the Bond**, the *Pact of Echoes* takes place, a moment to seal alliances, renew oaths or be reconciled. In this festivity, recorded fragments of voice are exchanged as a symbol of connection.

The **Cycle of the Labyrinth** concludes with *The Inner Quest*, a day of introspection on which citizens walk symbolic labyrinths, consult oracles or face riddles that reflect their inner selves.

The **Cycle of the Dream** flows into the *Vigil of Silence*, an entire day without spoken words, in which communication takes place through gestures, symbols and ephemeral writing, honouring the depth of the mystery.

In the **Cycle of the Mirror**, *Masks of the Possible* is celebrated, when each inhabitant wears a mask that represents not what they are, but what they might come to be, exploring personal futures still latent.

The **Cycle of the Legacy** culminates in the *Gift of the Open Hand*, a festivity of radical generosity, in which old or treasured objects are given away without expecting anything in return, releasing what was hoarded as a seed for others.

During the **Cycle of the Fracture**, *The Drift* is observed, a day without a course: citizens wander freely through the city or its margins, with no predetermined destination, exploring the hidden folds of their surroundings.

The **Cycle of the Dust** ends with the *Rite of Dissolution*, in which each person writes on paper the burdens, mistakes or thoughts they wish to let go of, and then dissolves them in water, fire or wind.

And, lastly, the **Cycle of the Return** closes with the *Dawn Round*, a collective sunrise at which songs are sung to the new cycle and a small offering is made to the Veil: a flower, a word, a memory, a silence.

These festivities not only mark the passage of time, but also stitch the daily life of Numinia to its mythic dimension, inviting its citizens to live the calendar as a path of shared meaning.

CYCLES AND AGES IN NUMINIA

In Numinia, a year has 13 cycles of 29 days, that is, 377 days a year. Each cycle is equivalent to a complete lunar cycle (new moon to new moon), or what we might call a «synodic month». Furthermore, every four years a tetrad takes place.

The Tetrad and its meaning

Each tetrad represents a perfect symbolic alignment between the lunar cycle and the arcane rhythms of the Veil.

This gives rise to an astronomical-esoteric phenomenon: the Tide of Memory, or Full Moon of Origin.

Every 52 cycles, on one precise night, the Moon of Numinia aligns not only with the sky, but with the Akasha. That full moon –known as the Moon of Khepri– casts a reflection of all things forgotten, hidden or unspoken. Waters, mirrors, even polished metals, give back visions of past events, alternative versions or truncated futures.

This event occurs on a single night every four years, at the end of the last day of cycle 52.

Narrative and esoteric consequences of the end of the Tetrad

- The Veil grows thin, and creatures such as the Umbrilegos and the Heresiarchs of the Vortex stir or try to open doors between planes
- The Reverses of Khepri vibrate and may alter their content, letting slip passages not yet written, or written by readers of the future
- In some colonies, dangerous rituals seek to synchronise the collective mind with the akashic echoes that resurface during the Moon of Khepri
- The astral predictions made on this night hold valid throughout the following tetrad

The Spectrum and the Greater Anamnesis

The Greater Anamnesis is a ritual, cosmic and metaphysical phenomenon that occurs once every 52 lunar years = 13 tetrads = 676 cycles, a span known as a spectrum. Its name, of

Platonic resonance, evokes not a mere memory, but the *act of remembering something one already knew before being born*, a kind of ontological evocation.

In Numinia, this phenomenon is neither a festival nor an anniversary: it is a planetary and spiritual event that affects at once the city, the Veil and the consciousness of its inhabitants.

What happens during the Greater Anamnesis?

During the days that make it up (exactly 7 cycles, from 670 to 676 of the last year of tetrad 13), the following phenomena occur:

- Resonance of latent symbols. Forgotten words are heard again in dreams. Lexomorphic artefacts, octahedra and codices vibrate without being touched. Errors of meaning arise that unveil hidden truths.

LECTURA

The Veil grows thin. The city murmurs with ancient echoes.

- Awakening of inherited memories. Certain people manifest memories they never lived: images of the Pre-Ashen Age, extinct languages, fragments of other people's thoughts.

LECTURA

No one knows whether what is remembered is true or the invention of an alternative time.

- Erosion of the narrative architecture. The structures of language, logic and causality are affected.

LECTURA

Stories do not end. Scenes are rewritten in real time. The past mutates.

- Appearance of heralds or parasites of the Veil. Entities such as the Umbrilegos become more frequent. Some even emerge in urban areas, drawn by the general symbolic

weakness.

LECTURA

The world becomes a palimpsest, and the palimpsest bleeds.

- Judgement of the Fragmentarians. It is said that the Fragmentarians, mysterious agents of the deep Akasha, descend to judge whether Numinia remains faithful to its ontological promise: to be the city that rebuilds the world without fixing it.

LECTURA

In this judgement, some disappear. Others are raised up. Some remember.

Why does a Spectrum span 52 years?

Because it is the exact moment at which the balance of the 13 tetrads falls out of kilter: the artificial organism that stabilises the calendar (the technomnemonic scarab) momentarily loses control of the symbolic lunar orbits, which produces a surge of semantic entropy. The Veil ceases to hold the memories. The world remembers.

During that brief imbalance, buried memories, images of other Ages and forgotten vestiges may return to the consciousness of Numinia, confusing memory and present for a time. That is why the end of each Spectrum is watched with a mixture of expectation and caution: one never knows what the city will decide to remember.

Numerical Reason: 7 as the number of decomposition and transit

In Numinia the number 7 represents the cycle of instability, the crisis before the rebalancing, the minimum number for a process of deep transformation. It is a *dangerous* figure in the Numinian calendar, since the reduction of 52 is $5+2 = 7$.

- Some texts mention that lexomorphic artefacts must not be read for 7 consecutive nights, because their lower layers of meaning are then deactivated and the higher ones, the most unstable, emerge
- The rhythm of collapse of many zones on the periphery follows a septenary pattern: 7 days of stability → 7 days of dissolution → 7 days of reconfiguration

That is why 7 cycles ($29 \times 7 = 203$ days) are considered the maximum safe period for an event of ritual destructuring. And from this the Greater Anamnesis follows.

Cosmological Reason: Resonance with the total lunar spectrum

The calendar of Numinia is based on lunar cycles of 29 days. As has already been seen, then, 1 *spectrum* is 52 lunar years, equivalent to 676 cycles.

Now, each tetrad has 52 cycles.

- The Greater Anamnesis appears at the end of cycle 676
- The last 7 cycles (670–676) are spaced outside the harmonic frame of the tetrads
- According to *Numinian cosmology*, the last spectrum of the wheel causes an anomalous resonance between the stabilising satellites and the technomnemonic organism, which takes 7 full cycles to restore the rhythmic frequency of the Veil

This is interpreted as a controlled anomaly, necessary for the Akasha to *breathe*.

Mythic Reason: the 7 Forbidden Names of the City

In a certain passage of the Song of Shadows and Light, it is stated that Numinia has had seven previous names, each corresponding to a phase of its mythic existence. During the Greater Anamnesis:

- Each cycle unveils a Former Name, and with it, a kind of knowledge, a threat or a redemption
- These names cannot be uttered without consequences, and there are those who hold that the true founders of Numinia are still trapped in these names, waiting to be remembered
- The complete ritual of the Greater Anamnesis only closes if at least one of those names is understood without being uttered

FRAGMENT 6: OTHER GROUPS OF NUMINIA

In Numinia, civic life is not limited to the official bodies or the recognised guilds. On the margins of institutional life, in the interstices of knowledge and law, autonomous groups, anomalous collectives and specialised bodies have flourished, performing functions fundamental to the cultural, symbolic and practical life of the city. Some operate under the protection of the great institutions; others, in the shadows, guided by ideals or impulses that escape normative control.

Each of them, however, reflects a deep need of the Numinian fabric: the custody of mystery, the exploration of the unexplored, the reinterpretation of the written, the protection of the fragile. They are many voices, between the formal and the insurgent, that make up the plural song of a city always in transformation.

THE LEGION OF THE THRESHOLD

The Legion of the Threshold is the invisible wall that rises when Numinia trembles. They do not patrol the streets or impose everyday order: they sleep among the shadows of the Agora, watch from the rooftops of the city, and only spring into action when the veil of peace is torn. They are an elite force, born not for war, but to prevent it. Each member has passed a rigorous *Test of Serenity*, which guarantees not only lethal skill, but restrained will. Custodians of the limit, they are the threshold between the city and whatever threatens its soul.

The name of the Legion of the Threshold holds a deep symbolism that connects directly with its role in Numinia and with the way in which this military force of peace operates at critical moments.

Meaning of the Name

The term *Threshold* carries a double symbolic charge in this context:

1. The Threshold as frontier:

The Legion of the Threshold acts on the boundary between order and chaos, intervening only when tensions threaten to overflow the balance of Numinia. Thus, the Legion becomes the barrier that prevents conflict from escalating into open war or into the dissolution of the social order.

2. The Threshold as transition:

The Legion appears at moments of the greatest uncertainty: during political changes, disputes between guilds and factions, or at those instants when the security of the city totters. They are the presence that emerges at the edge, when the system finds itself in a critical phase and the passage between stability and collapse seems inevitable.

The Threshold in the Tradition of Numinia

The name is also related to esoteric beliefs within the city. In certain hermetic circles, the Threshold is described as the intermediate space between the physical world and the ethereal plane, the point where reality dissolves into uncertainty. According to this view, the Legion of the Threshold symbolises those who face ambiguity, who watch over the fissures of the system and preserve the delicate balance between the forces of Numinia.

The Motto of the Legion of the Threshold

Its motto reinforces this symbolism:

LECTURA

«We are neither the light nor the shadow; we are the edge that separates them.»

This motto reflects the neutral essence of the Legion, which acts neither out of ambition nor in search of prominence, but as a regulating power that prevents any faction or force from unbalancing the delicate order of Numinia.

The Legion of the Threshold not only has a strategic function, but also exercises a powerful symbolic action: they are the guardians of the balance, those who rise up when the city is about to cross the limit into conflict or destruction.

THE CHAMBER OF PALIMPSESTS

LECTURA

“Nothing remains, everything resounds. The texts of Numinia are echoes in transit.”

In the deepest reaches of the Atlantis Library, hidden behind a wall of moving symbols that can only be read by eyes trained in the semiosis of the Veil, lies the Chamber of Palimpsests: the highest-ranking body among the Exegetes, devoted to the restoration and rewriting of the leximorphic artefacts of Numinia.

The texts of Numinia do not dwell in parchments, books or screens; instead they are encoded in translucent octahedra, luminous structures carved from memory crystals. Each octahedron holds cryptographic chains of symbolic and textual content that are projected on simultaneous levels: image, sound, emotion, concept and archetype. But these devices are not static. They are alive. Their content fluctuates over time; it degrades, becomes encrypted, is transfigured. It is not static, but varies with time.

The mission of the Chamber of Palimpsests is to preserve what is mutable, restoring decaying content without breaking the natural flow of its transformation. Far from fixing a canonical version, the Hermeneuts who make it up—all prominent members of the Guild of the Exegetes—accept that texts are ontological entities in perpetual mutation, whose truth lies in their drift, not in their origin.

For this reason, the Chamber must constantly restore and reinterpret these archaic texts. And so, little by little, the writings slightly alter their content until, with the passing of the aeons, they end up becoming completely different texts. But as a text fades away, it reappears in another form, inside another octahedron.

Among the tasks of the Chamber of Palimpsests are:

- Ritual rewriting of fragmented texts, where restoration is carried out by analogy, resonance or symbolic synaesthesia.
- Synchronisation of echoes: detecting missing fragments in other artefacts and reconstructing their hidden links.
- Akashic translation: a complex practice that connects the artefacts to the Akashic Archives, allowing lost passages to be glimpsed through altered states of reading.

Many of its members work in a trance, others in absolute silence. Some write only in forgotten scripts or under particular phases of the moon. All of them are Hermeneuts of the Ancestral, philosophers of the fold, restorers of the impossible. They are, moreover, experts in symbology, in plurisemantics, in occult philosophy. And, contrary to what people believe, the members of the Chamber do not only work cloistered in the Atlantis Library; they must often travel the peripheries of Numinia in search of information and vestiges of the texts whose nature they interpret.

For the Chamber of Palimpsests, every text is a creature. And every restoration, an act of reincarnation.

THE SUMMA ARCHIVE

Dependency: Concordia Council

Nature: Autonomous body for interterritorial research

Seat: Itinerant (central archive located in the Catacombs of the Historical Society).

The *Summa Archive* –colloquially known as «The Archive»– is a scientific and exploratory institution founded by joint decree of the Concordia Council and endorsed by the Oracles. Its main function is the systematic and multidisciplinary study of the Peripheral Zones of Numinia, territories outside the urban core characterised by their geological instability, their marginal ecosystems and their anomalous phenomena.

The Archive seeks to know what lies beyond, but also to contain and understand whatever may represent a threat or a revelation for the city.

Fields of study

- Mutational geography: living cartography of changing regions
- Geology and residual magnetism: analysis of impossible materials and formations of uncertain origin
- Marginal zoology: classification of mutant species, cryptids and bio-etheric entities
- Spectral botany: luminous, fungiform or symbiotic flora that is hard to replicate
- Erratic anthropology: study of nomadic settlers, extinct cultures and abandoned ritual structures
- Field linguistics: recovery of forgotten dialects and symbolic systems

Aleph Section

Within the Summa Archive there is a restricted division, informally known as «the sealed heart of the Archive». Its official name is the Aleph Section, and its work consists of gathering, documenting and investigating those phenomena that are unusual, incongruous or impossible to assimilate into the established sciences:

- Luminous or acoustic apparitions with no physical origin
- Unidentifiable objects that appear or disappear without a trace
- Ruins that exist only on certain days of the lunar calendar
- Entities of extradimensional origin
- Temporal echoes and events that break causal linearity
- Emergent symbols that replicate spontaneously in different, unconnected zones

The researchers of this section sign pacts of silence and work under conditions of high cognitive security. Their files are classified, and many reports may only be read by members of the Council of Sages or, exceptionally, by the Oracles.

Hidden mission

Some rumours hold that the Aleph Section does not merely record phenomena, but guards *anomalous artefacts* found in the field, such as in the Inversion Rift of the Neuma Subvale. Others believe it is investigating an ancient, never-confirmed hypothesis: that the peripheral zones are not the limits of Numinia... but its future fragments, seeping into the present.

COMMUNE OF THE INVISIBLE LIGHT

LECTURA

« *Every city casts a shadow. We inhabit its own.* »

The Commune of the Invisible Light is a clandestine, decentralised organisation that operates in the fissures of Numinia's urban, legal and symbolic fabric. It has no visible leaders or defined hierarchical structure, and its members –if indeed they know one another– seldom present themselves with permanent names or identities. They communicate through coded signs, glyphs scattered across marginal zones, sound transmissions hidden in forgotten frequencies, or poetic traces that only the initiated can interpret.

Their presence is constant, yet diffuse. To some, they are guardians of the people, anonymous heirs of the nomadic soul that forged Numinia; to others, they are dangerous saboteurs, technopirates, cultists of disorder. None of these readings is entirely false. The Commune protects those whom the system has forgotten or repressed: biological anomalies, exiled intelligences, dysfunctional constructs, unregistered citizens. They operate where the law does not reach, on the margins where the Veil weakens and the surveillance of the systems becomes erratic.

Among their most frequent actions are:

- Surgical sabotage of mechanisms of civic control, scanning towers, censorship algorithms or protocols of digital exclusion
- Covert interventions to protect nomadic or isolated communities, distributing stolen resources or repurposed technology
- Parallel expeditions to the peripheral zones of Numinia to plunder forgotten artefacts, reprogramme them or prevent their institutional use

Although they profess no explicit doctrine, their actions are inspired by a radical ethic of decentralisation, autonomy, alternative justice and symbolic liberation. Their internal motto is said to be: « *What cannot be seen cannot be dominated.* »

There are signs that some factions of the city sympathise with them –even within the Council of Sages or among the Vernaculars–, but none admits it openly. Their influence spreads through rumours, invisible gestures and the sudden eruption of freedom where only surveillance once reigned. They are the uncomfortable echo of a city that never ceases to dream itself.

SEMI-RELIGIOUS CURRENTS IN NUMINIA

Numinia recognises no institutional religion, but there are philosophical-esoteric currents that link the ancestral, the mythological and the digital with the inner processes of consciousness. These beliefs have no dogmas, only symbolic practices that help one to inhabit the Veil.

The Cultivators of the Akasha

They believe that every experience leaves a trace in the Akasha, and that the soul is a series of records that can be read, corrected or integrated.

- They practise the ritual reading of the past
- They venerate concepts such as Resonance, Testimony and the Inner Sequence
- They are found on the margins of the academies and in some temples

The Heresiarchs of the Vortex

They hold that the city is a living algorithm, and that there are fragments of hidden code that can awaken dormant powers.

- They venerate the Fractal Code, a supposed structure that runs through reality, language and dream
- They practise rites of disconnection and inner reprogramming
- They tend to appear at festivities wearing geometric masks

The Circle of Khepri

It is not a sect, but a mystery-based philosophical order, centred on the symbolic figure of Khepri, becoming and renewal.

- They practise symbolic metamorphosis, represented in rites of passage and public rituals
- Their members bear translucent marks on the skin (digital or symbolic) that narrate their process of transformation

SMALL OFFICIAL BODIES

Finally, on the margins of Numinia's formal structures there exist more flexible and organic forms of association that respond to specific needs for collaboration and joint action. Lodges, leagues and brotherhoods arise as expressions of the city's social dynamism: networks of alliance and knowledge that cross the boundaries of guilds and factions to face specific

challenges, take on shared missions or explore new forms of coexistence. They represent the strength of the bond over statute, the value of the cause over hierarchy.

Lodges

Lodges are groups that include individuals of the same Faction but belonging to different Guilds, devoted to working towards a purpose that requires diverse skills and that focuses specifically on one of the fields of development. Lodges usually have a master, counsellor or leader of some kind.

Leagues

These are small syncretic associations that bring together individuals from different Factions but of the same Guild. These alliances, like lodges, usually have a specific and occasional purpose in which it becomes necessary or advantageous to exchange knowledge from the different fields of development. Some well-knit and successful leagues manage to consolidate themselves to take on new challenges and adventures.

Brotherhoods

Brotherhoods have a representative and eclectic character, since they are formed specifically to carry out some special task or mission, regardless of the factions or guilds of their members, fulfilling the role of the city's delegated group. As a rule, greater weight is given to the brotherhood covering a range of positions appropriate to the mission in question.

ANNEX: THE BLACK MARKET OF NUMINIA

In Numinia there is an official trade in objects, technologies and artefacts, subject to the city's rules of production and circulation. But there are things that never reach its shop windows. Objects that are too old, too singular, restricted by the institutions or simply impossible to justify in a register of provenance end up finding other paths.

All those paths lead, sooner or later, to the Street of Mysteries, in the Old Quarter of the Ouroboros District.

There lies the so-called Black Market of Numinia, although the name can be misleading. There is no building that houses it, nor a door behind which clandestine trade officially begins. The market blends into the street itself: it occupies stalls, entrance halls, arcades and back rooms; it appears beneath awnings blackened by time or upon makeshift tables made of crates, and it stretches along side alleys whose existence seems to depend on the hour at which one looks for them. It is, after all, a clandestine market.

Ouroboros is the district where reality folds back on itself and the rules may change in the middle of the game; the Street of Mysteries has turned that principle into a peculiar economy.

Not all the vendors remain there permanently. Some always occupy the same stall; others appear only at certain moments. There are merchants who do not announce what they sell, intermediaries who only speak after receiving a password, and dealers who seem to know which object the buyer is looking for before the buyer has decided to look for it.

In the Black Market, finding the right vendor can be as important as having the means to pay them.

What is bought and what is found

The Black Market is the main point of circulation for objects that remain outside Numinia's ordinary channels. Relics, Weapons and all manner of Rarities may turn up there, both technological Residues and Proscribed items originating from restricted or forbidden experimental research.

But this does not mean that the Black Market is the source of these objects.

Many Residues come from old museums, closed warehouses, disused institutional stores or abandoned sites. Others are recovered on the periphery, where vestiges and treasures buried beneath the desert lands can still be found. The Proscribed, for their part, may come from clandestine laboratories, cancelled research or technological facilities whose contents should never have entered ordinary circulation.

The Black Market is simply the place where everything that Numinia loses, forbids, forgets or does not quite know where to keep ends up acquiring a price.

This allows the GD to introduce these objects in two ways. They may be found during adventures –as a reward for exploration, the fruit of an investigation or a chance discovery– or deliberately acquired in the Street of Mysteries. Finding them rewards curiosity; buying them makes it possible to pursue a concrete need.

Prism Cells as currency

The Black Market does not usually trade in conventional monetary units when it comes to numinic objects of genuine interest. Its preferred currency is Prism Cells.

The reason is not merely economic. A Cell represents an affinity acquired by the character and contains a resonance that can be consumed to alter their relationship with Numinia. Its value derives precisely from that capacity.

When a character hands over Prism Cells in exchange for an object, they are consumed and vanish from their pool, just as when they are used to intervene in a Roll or a State. But, as

with the other uses of Prism Cells, the PC can only use and spend the Prism Cells that belong to their Faction.

This makes every purchase a meaningful decision. The same Cells that allow one to obtain a powerful Relic might be needed later to face the consequences of an adventure. The Black Market does not consume resources alone: it consumes possibilities.

Availability

That an object appears among the goods of the Black Market does not mean it is always available.

The GD decides what can be found in the Street of Mysteries at any given moment. The most common objects may turn up relatively often; the most extraordinary ones should require investigation, contacts, Rumourology or some small prior undertaking before there is even an opportunity to buy them.

In this way, the price in Cells indicates how much it costs to obtain an object once it has been located; it does not guarantee that a specimen is patiently waiting on a shelf.

This distinction is especially important for exceptional Relics and Proscribed items. Some may appear only once during a campaign. Others may be in the possession of someone who does not wish to sell them. And certain vendors will accept Cells with enthusiasm, but will also demand information, favours or exchanges. Clandestinity, after all, would lose much of its charm if it came with an up-to-date catalogue and a returns service.

The price of the extraordinary

Black Market prices are expressed in Prism Cells and are based chiefly on the scope of the object's properties, its versatility and its exceptionality within the game.

The price does not necessarily represent its material value. An ancient machine of enormous dimensions may be worth less than a tiny artefact capable of intervening in the Veil. Nor does it determine how much «power» an object has in absolute terms, but rather how much it costs to deliberately introduce that possibility into the character's repertoire.

What follows is a Black Market Price Table, bearing in mind that the prices are approximate, subject to change, to haggling and to cunning, all of it at the GD's discretion and counting, too, on the imagination and the rolls of the players:

TABLA 5.2

CATEGORY	OBJECT	PRICE
<i>Relic</i>	Lyre of Nyx	4
<i>Relic</i>	Dice of Imposition	8
<i>Relic</i>	Drift Nail	5
<i>Relic</i>	Core of Seshat	6
<i>Relic</i>	Ethylene Thurible	5
<i>Relic</i>	Calibration Prism	4
<i>Relic</i>	Turing Glyph	4
<i>Relic</i>	Staff of Safeguard	7
<i>Relic</i>	Forebear Drum	7
<i>Relic</i>	Threshold Lock	6
<i>Relic</i>	Incongruous Link	5

TABLE 5.3

CATEGORY	OBJECT	PRICE
<i>Relic</i>	Oneiric Needle	6
<i>Relic</i>	Mechanical Palimpsest	5
<i>Relic</i>	Seal of Mnemosyne	6
<i>Relic</i>	Tuning Fork of Leth	4
<i>Relic</i>	Versometer	6
<i>Relic</i>	Enigmatic Sphere	6
<i>Relic</i>	Disc of Janus	3
<i>Relic</i>	Behavioural Converter	6
<i>Relic</i>	Signal Oracle	6
<i>Relic</i>	Speaking Conch	4
<i>Relic</i>	Eye of Kairos	8
<i>Relic</i>	Dual Compass	6
<i>Relic</i>	Debugging Lantern	6
<i>Relic</i>	Compass of Procrustes	6
<i>Relic</i>	Mask of Epimetheus	4
<i>Relic</i>	Aionos	5
<i>Relic</i>	Bowl of Consecration	6
<i>Relic</i>	Neural Helm	4
<i>Relic</i>	Phase-Shift Clock	6
<i>Relic</i>	Spectral Lamp	7
<i>Relic</i>	Hypnographic Disc	5
<i>Relic</i>	Diptych of Concordance	7

CATEGORY	OBJECT	PRICE
<i>Relic</i>	Stele of Reconstruction	8
<i>Relic</i>	Treatise of Modelling	7
<i>Weapon</i>	Mnemonic Eclipse	5

TABLE 5.4

CATEGORY	OBJECT	PRICE
<i>Weapon</i>	Liquid Nemesis	4
<i>Weapon</i>	Wandering Tears	4
<i>Weapon</i>	Edge of Atlas	5
<i>Weapon</i>	Fragment of Khaos	6
<i>Weapon</i>	Vortex of Ruin	4
<i>Weapon</i>	Jaw of the Sun	4
<i>Weapon</i>	Wandering Wall	4
<i>Weapon</i>	Beacon of Antigone	4
<i>Weapon</i>	Bronze Choir	4
<i>Weapon</i>	Sword of Hypatia	4
<i>Weapon</i>	Bastion of Cerberus	5
<i>Residue</i>	Bronze Lung	3
<i>Residue</i>	Convergence Diaphragm	3
<i>Residue</i>	Faraday Regulator	3
<i>Residue</i>	Meridian Chronometer	3
<i>Residue</i>	Pocket Anchor	3
<i>Residue</i>	Vigil Accumulator	3
<i>Residue</i>	Penumbra Sextant	2
<i>Residue</i>	Rescue Phonograph	3
<i>Residue</i>	Universal Pressure Wrench	2
<i>Residue</i>	Cold Salts Lantern	2
<i>Proscribed</i>	Coherence Mirror	5

CATEGORY	OBJECT	PRICE
<i>Proscribed</i>	White Void Chamber	4
<i>Proscribed</i>	Ariadne's Diadem	4
<i>Proscribed</i>	Anchoring Vector	5

TABLA 5.5

CATEGORY	OBJECT	PRICE
<i>Proscribed</i>	Causality Metronome	5
<i>Proscribed</i>	Morpheus Membrane	4
<i>Proscribed</i>	Galvani Orthoskeleton	4
<i>Proscribed</i>	Portable Threshold	5
<i>Proscribed</i>	Somatic Echo Cartridge	5
<i>Proscribed</i>	Interference Eye	4

CHAPTER SIX

INVENTORY AND BESTIARY

INVENTORY AND BESTIARY

LECTURA

« The archivist descended in silence along the spine of the Duv-Harel Promontory, where the mists fold beneath the weight of unspoken memories. Under his hood of black velvet, the sensors vibrated gently with the breath of the volcanic winds. Each step upon the wet sand of the shore of the Ocean of Lúnacar resounded with echoes of ancient invocations, uttered by beings who no longer knew whether they were fable or fossil.

He sought neither glory nor map. He sought meaning.

In his satchel lay the fragments: the vitreous bone of a volute dragon, the broken casing of a stored voice, the still-living seed of a weapon that had not chosen its bearer. Each object was an unformulated question. Each relic, a piece of the torn Veil.

The ancients said that knowledge was the best defence. But the archivist knew that, in Numinia, knowledge could also be the prey.

And, as he copied into his terminal, with trembling hands, the runes that floated above the corpse of a creature rocking gently between the foam and the muddied sand, he understood a truth that only true hunters knew: that objects were vestiges of decisions.

And that beasts were those very decisions, returning to claim their debt. »

In every roleplaying game, the Inventory and the Bestiary constitute two pillars of the system: one represents what is carried, the other what is faced. The first speaks of use, memory and choice; the second, of risk, confrontation and otherness.

But, in Numinia, these elements are more than mechanics: they are mirrors of the soul of the world.

In Numinia, the Inventory and the Bestiary are not separate systems, but two faces of the same circuit of meaning: what the player chooses to take in, and what the world forces them to confront. One is burden; the other, collision. Both are reflections. Both are story.

Where the Inventory answers to the will of the character, the Bestiary answers to the will of the world. Where one offers agency, the other poses resistance. But both are inscribed within the same principle: that to play, in Numinia, is to take on a narrative responsibility for desire and danger.

There is no neutral object: every Relic contains a story. There is no gratuitous creature: every being embodies a dissonance. Thus, what one carries and what one faces become signs of a single dialectic: that of the player with their symbolic surroundings.

That is why this chapter is not a catalogue, but a map of relationships between form, memory and conflict. Each entry, be it weapon or beast, relic or aberration, is a node in the living network of Numinia. Understanding them helps not only to survive in the city and its periphery: it helps to read the world.

Because in this city, what you carry and what attacks you are part of the same story. Yours.

Narrative echoes

The Inventory answers the question: *What do we choose to take with us from the world?*

The Bestiary asks: *What part of the world resists being integrated?*

Both, at heart, chart desire and fear. They are the two hemispheres of the game: what we take in and what we reject.

What we choose and what chooses us. And it is not always the case that one answers to the object and the other to the creature.

FRAGMENT 1: THE BESTIARY

The creatures of Numinia are more than altered biology or hostile algorithms. Each one is born of an unresolved tension in the world: urban traumas, narrative errors, arrested symbols, archetypes that mutated.

Combat against them is always a symbolic confrontation: to face them means reading them, understanding what they represent, what part of the city –or of the player– they seek to reveal or to block.

Some beasts attack not through force, but through semantic fracture. And defeating them means, very often, understanding more than wounding.

Each beast in Numinia possesses a set of general characteristics, as well as a series of attributes that will help us resolve confrontations with the players. Other details such as its habitat, its way of life or its origin will complete the outline of its NPC sheet, which the GD can later adapt to the context of an adventure and to a more specific creature.

FORMRENDERS

The Formrenders are ancient humanoid presences that arose from the depths of the Akasha and were drawn towards Numinia during the earliest times of the Dark Age. Their nature maintains a profound affinity with the earth and with telluric energies, to the point that their relationship with the ground, the stone and the currents that flow beneath them determines a good part of their existence. With the technological evolution of the city, they took refuge in the subterranean regions of the periphery, where they remain as hostile vestiges of an earlier order.

Origin and nature

The Formrenders arrived in Numinia during a period of chaos, when the ancient city had gone up in flames and its reflection, projected into the Akasha, was still weakened. The subsequent reconstruction and progressive technification of Numinia represented for them a rupture of the natural cycles and of the primordial wisdom they revered. Unable to integrate into the new city, they withdrew towards the depths and established small communities among caverns, ruins and rock formations of the periphery.

Their prolonged bond with these places ended up transforming them. The Formrenders do not merely inhabit the earth: they maintain a symbiotic relationship with it and seem to perceive Numinia through its vibrations, fractures and telluric currents, as though the ground were an extension of their own senses.

Physiology and psychology

The Formrenders present a humanoid silhouette, slender and sinewy, slightly hunched and adapted to rapid movement through tunnels and uneven terrain. Their skin, dark and hardened, has a mineral, almost stony texture, upon which horny plates, scars and small crystalline deposits appear. Their hands are large and gnarled, ending in long black claws that they use both to dig and to cling to rock.

The face retains vague canine features, though deeply deformed by their adaptation to the subsoil. Especially striking are their enormous opaque eyes, like whitish lenses, which take up a good part of the face and lend them an expression that is difficult to interpret. The mouth, narrow and drawn back, lets small, irregular teeth show through. Some individuals partially cover their head and body with pieces of leather, mineral remains, straps, plates recovered from ancient ruins and objects whose significance seems ritual rather than protective.

Their perception depends above all on the vibrations transmitted through the ground. They can sense movements and disturbances at a considerable distance, a sensitivity that their shamans interpret as a form of communication with the deep currents of Numinia.

Their thinking is instinctive, ritual and profoundly mistrustful of technology. They retain the capacity for reasoning and organisation, but their communication is based mainly on guttural sounds, clicks, gestures and signs traced upon stone or sand. For them, the world is not explained: it is listened to, observed and interpreted.

Way of life

The Formrenders organise themselves into small clans settled in networks of caverns and galleries. Their eldest members and their shamans interpret omens through vibrations, fractures in the rocks and patterns formed spontaneously in the sand. They also guard stones, glyphs and fragments of ancient ruins that they consider repositories of a memory older than present-day Numinia.

Their culture barely distinguishes between territory, memory and cult. An ancestral cavern, a mineral formation or a marked stone may be at once refuge, archive and sanctuary.

Relationship with Numinia

The Formrenders regard the city as a structure that has done violence to the primordial order upon which it was raised. Their hostility is directed above all against technological infrastructures and against those factions they hold responsible for extending them.

For this reason, their incursions rarely respond solely to the need to obtain resources. They destroy conduits, devices, networks and structures even when they gain no immediate benefit, as though each attack were meant to tear a layer of artifice from Numinia and return to the surface that which lies buried beneath.

Confrontation tactics

The Formrenders avoid open spaces and make use of tunnels, changes in level, ruins and areas of poor visibility. They generally attack in groups, bursting out from unexpected positions and withdrawing before the adversary can regroup. Their claws and rudimentary tools are dangerous, but their true advantage lies in their ability to perceive vibrations, move across difficult terrain and coordinate through almost imperceptible signals.

They do not conceive of confrontation as a head-on exchange. They surround, isolate, harass and alter the terrain, seeking to break their adversaries' coordination. When they have time, they prepare traps and exploit cracks, secondary galleries and unstable surfaces to turn the space itself into part of the threat.

Habitat

Small communities of Formrenders are scattered across the periphery of Numinia, although there is no reliable census of their population. They are particularly common in the Sea of Sílices and in the Neuma Subvale, where caverns and subterranean galleries provide them with suitable refuges.

They prefer places where they can maintain close contact with the ground and where the vibrations of the surface reach the depths. From these lairs they launch swift incursions against colonies, routes and peripheral installations before disappearing underground once more.

Narrative function

The Formrenders represent the shadow of Numinia's progress: that which was displaced, buried or abandoned so that the present city could rise. Their confrontation with technology is not merely material, but symbolic. In them persists the suspicion that every advance demands leaving something behind, and that what is buried does not necessarily disappear.

They embody the resentment of the natural towards the manufactured, the fear that progress may destroy what it sets out to improve, and the violence of a memory incapable of expressing itself through arguments, yet stubborn in its will to go on existing.

Fixed Anchors

Telluric bond. The Formrender sustains its presence and orientation through contact with the ground and the currents that run through it. It perceives vibrations, movements and disturbances through the stone, the sand or the soil over which it moves. This relationship shows itself constantly in its behaviour: it touches surfaces, tilts its head at certain vibrations and seems to react to movements it cannot yet see. Separating it, isolating it or in any way interfering with that telluric continuity means intervening in an essential part of its relationship with its surroundings.

Buried memory. Each Formrender maintains a bond with some material vestige of ancient Numinia: a stone, a glyph, a fragment of ruin or a mineral formation preserved by its clan. These objects do not function as mere possessions, but as symbolic repositories of the memory that the Formrenders consider older than the rebuilt city. When they act far from their lairs, they usually carry small fragments of these vestiges among their clothing or attached to their bodies. Their presence connects the individual with the collective memory of its species and with what it considers its rightful place in Numinia.

Rejection of artifice. The presence of active technology provokes in the Formrenders a compulsive response of hostility. This is not simply cultural hatred: they perceive certain technological emissions, vibrations and structures as an interference that disturbs their relationship with the deep currents of Numinia. During a confrontation they tend to fix their attention on devices, conduits and technological sources, even when there are

tactically more immediate targets. This fixation can make them especially aggressive, but it also renders part of their behaviour predictable.

UMBRÍLEGO

The Umbrílegos are liminal entities that dwell on the most unstable margins of the Veil and of consciousness. They are neither fully corporeal nor fully conceptual, but forms of stray thought, psychic and symbolic residues that have acquired presence in those places of Numinia where meaning has grown weak. Their appearance is usually accompanied by amnesia, contradictions, repetitions and alterations of the surroundings.

They do not inhabit the shadow. They are what remains when thought goes out.

Origin and nature

The Umbrílegos arise in areas where the Veil has suffered alterations of a semantic nature: failed Akashic translations, incomplete rituals, collapsed systems of interpretation or places whose meaning has been profoundly altered. There, thoughts, intentions and symbols deprived of any structure capable of sustaining them begin to condense until they acquire a manifestation of their own.

Each Umbrílego forms around a contradiction, an absence or an incomplete meaning. It is not the memory of what was lost, but the void left by its loss. For this reason, its existence depends on a semantic anomaly that remains unresolved and acts as the nucleus of its manifestation.

Physiology and psychology

Although their appearance fluctuates as they move, the Umbrílegos adopt a recognisable form halfway between the animal, the vegetable and an organic matter that is hard to classify. Their body consists of a dark, semi-translucent mass of fibres, membranes and moist tissues, borne up by several long, arachnoid appendages that seem constantly to be searching for points of support.

From the centre of the creature protrudes a bulbous structure resembling a vegetable skull. Large whitish protuberances, smooth and with no apparent pupil, function as perceptive organs, while nervous roots and filaments spread around an irregular opening ringed by small appendages. Its anatomy seems to reorganise itself subtly when it encounters texts, images, voices or any other structured form of meaning.

The Umbrílegos do not think as other creatures do. They reproduce incomplete intentions. Their actions follow a repetitive, ritual logic, as though they were trying to finish an operation whose purpose they no longer remember. They detect with particular ease hesitations, contradictions and efforts of interpretation, towards which they immediately turn their attention.

Way of life

The Umbrílegos do not form communities, do not reproduce and lack a conventional biological cycle. They remain latent as long as the semantic anomaly that allows their manifestation persists, and they gain greater presence when the surroundings accumulate contradictions, abandoned meanings or failed attempts at interpretation.

They normally appear in isolation, although several may manifest simultaneously when a single alteration affects numerous symbols or memories. They do not seem to need food in the conventional sense: they react to meaning and, above all, to the conscious attempt to recover it. Reading, remembering, interpreting or reconstructing something in an affected area may be enough to draw their attention.

Relationship with Numinia

The Umbrílegos are considered a threat of a semantic order. Their presence can alter texts and symbols, disturb memories and cause objects, signs or places temporarily to lose part of their meaning. Under prolonged exposure, these alterations can also reach the perception an individual has of themselves and of what surrounds them.

The Summa Archive keeps records of their manifestations and studies their relationship with the anomalies of the Veil. Some Hermeneuts maintain that the Umbrílegos are not merely ontological residues, but signs of meanings that Numinia does not yet know how to interpret. This hypothesis, as seductive as it is unreassuring, has not prevented them from being generally treated as dangerous presences.

Confrontation tactics

An Umbrílego does not try to destroy its adversaries physically. It seeks to interfere with whatever allows them to understand the situation. It draws near to whoever doubts, tries to remember or actively interprets the surroundings, provoking memory loss, mistaken associations, recurring thoughts or perceptual alterations.

During a confrontation it can make the meaning of an element in the scene temporarily disappear, return memories in fragmentary fashion or reproduce words and actions out of context. Its behaviour seems erratic until one understands that all its actions gravitate around a single absence of meaning. The more the characters try to understand what is missing, the more intensely the creature responds.

Habitat

The Umbrílegos appear wherever a significant loss of symbolic coherence has occurred: ruins, abandoned archives, spaces affected by anomalies of the Veil, failed portals, corrupted texts or places whose original purpose has vanished.

They are especially common in certain unstable regions of the periphery. Significant concentrations have been documented in the Viridial Sink, and in former times they were also detected on the Hesiodic Moor, where their manifestations seem to have ceased for reasons still unknown. Nevertheless, as they are not creatures jealous of their privacy, they may appear in many areas of the four districts, especially in abandoned buildings, old museums or long-uninhabited constructions, where meaning has decomposed.

Narrative function

The Umbrílegos represent the fragility of meaning. They threaten not only what the characters possess, but the ability to understand what things are, what happened and, ultimately, who they themselves are.

They function as tests of identity and of interpretation, capable of eroding clues, memories and certainties without needing to destroy them materially. Their appearance may signal that a narrative, a symbol or even a part of the reality of Numinia has ceased to hold together properly.

They represent the fear of forgetting who you are, the power of what was never said, and the unsettling possibility that an abandoned meaning does not disappear, but finds another way to exist.

Fixed Anchors

Originating contradiction. Every Umbrílego manifests around an absence, contradiction or unresolved meaning that acts as the nucleus of its existence. It may be a text that has lost part of its sense, a symbol whose function has been forgotten, a broken promise, an impossible interpretation or any other semantic rupture. The specific nature of that contradiction changes from encounter to encounter, but its existence is constant: if there is an Umbrílego, there is something that has ceased to signify correctly. Its behaviour reproduces fragments of that contradiction and offers clues to what keeps it manifested.

Attraction to meaning. The Umbrílego reacts to any conscious attempt to interpret, remember or reconstruct what it finds around it. When someone reads an altered text, tries to recover a memory, deciphers a symbol or formulates an interpretation of the anomaly, the creature turns its attention towards that act. For it, meaning functions simultaneously as stimulus and threat: it seeks meaning because it lacks it, but its restoration endangers the incoherence that sustains its presence.

Incomplete ritual. The actions of an Umbrílego always obey a repetitive pattern derived from the contradiction that gave rise to it. It repeats movements, sounds, paths, words or manipulations of the surroundings as though trying to complete a sequence whose last step has disappeared. This repetition may seem chaotic at first, but it never entirely is. Observing it makes it possible to recognise a structure and, eventually, to intervene in it.

ECHO PREDATOR

Echo Predators are creatures that dwell in the most contaminated folds of the Akasha. They are residues of time: accumulations of toxic contents, degraded memories and psychic currents that have ended up acquiring a predatory form. They do not properly belong to Numinia, and they can only manifest in it when a summoning temporarily opens a link between the two spaces.

They lack consciousness and purpose. Once manifested, all that remains in them is a voracious instinct that drives them to pursue whatever they come across.

Origin and nature

Echo Predators arise as a consequence of the progressive accumulation of residues in certain folds of the Akasha. Time, memory and thought do not always disappear cleanly from that space: some contents degrade, overlap and remain trapped until they form toxic concentrations capable of acquiring a manifestation of their own.

A Predator cannot cross by itself the border that separates it from Numinia. It needs a psychic summoning that establishes a temporary link with the city. This may be deliberate, brought about by someone who knows the appropriate procedure, or spontaneous, when certain currents of the Veil reach such a degree of intensity and contamination that they involuntarily act as a call.

For this reason, the appearance of an Echo Predator is never an isolated event. If one is present, something has called it.

Physiology and psychology

Echo Predators take on a vaguely canine form, although their proportions are far too large and deformed to be mistaken for an animal. They walk on four extraordinarily long and muscular limbs, with prominent joints and dark claws capable of gripping almost any surface. Their bodies seem completely flayed: bundles of fibres, tendons and muscle masses lie exposed beneath a wet, glistening film, as if the creature had been formed without ever developing a skin.

The head is narrow and elongated, crowned by two large dark protuberances resembling horns or deformed ears. Its jaw holds several irregular rows of teeth and is frequently left half open, as if the animal were breathing violently even when it stands still. Its most recognisable feature, however, is its eyes: two cavities from which intense flames burst forth without seeming to consume the surrounding tissue. The fire fluctuates with the creature's behaviour and flares up violently when it detects a presence.

They possess no recognisable thought, language, individual memory or capacity to negotiate. Nor do they seem to experience fear or pain in any comprehensible way. Their behaviour responds exclusively to impulses of pursuit and consumption. A Predator does not hate its

prey, nor does it enjoy hunting it: it simply keeps advancing for as long as there is something it can devour.

Way of life

Speaking of a way of life in Echo Predators is imprecise. In the Akasha they remain as latent accumulations of temporal and psychic residues, without developing an existence comparable to that of the creatures manifested in Numinia. Only through a summoning do they acquire a stable form and begin to behave as individual entities.

They form no social groups and establish no known territories. Several creatures may answer the same summoning when the contamination that gives rise to it is intense enough, but they do not cooperate consciously. They simply react simultaneously to the same stimulus.

When the condition that allows their manifestation disappears, their form progressively loses coherence, the stimulus that moved it dissolves, and it ends up being reabsorbed by the Akasha.

Relationship with Numinia

Echo Predators are an intrusive presence. They maintain no cultural relationship whatsoever with the inhabitants of Numinia, nor do they recognise its structures, territories or institutions. For them, the city is merely the space into which they have been dragged and in which they can temporarily satisfy their predatory impulse. But there is no emotional, or even instinctive, bond connecting the Echo Predator to Numinia.

Their appearance, however, is of great importance to scholars of the Veil, for it constitutes evidence of a prior disturbance. Finding a Predator also means searching for whatever has allowed its arrival: a conscious summoning, an anomalous psychic concentration or a contaminated current capable of momentarily piercing the separation from the Akasha.

Combat tactics

Echo Predators are extraordinarily fast and persistent. Once they detect a prey, they close the distance with violent charges, leaps and abrupt changes of direction. They seek no cover and weigh no risks: they pursue, bring down, encircle and pursue again.

Their lack of any instinct of self-preservation makes them especially unsettling. They do not retreat in the face of a threat, nor do they willingly abandon a confrontation. If an obstacle stands between them and what they are pursuing, they try to break through it, go around it or immediately find another way in.

This conduct may seem chaotic, but it follows a very simple logic: once a stimulus has been fixed upon, all their behaviour is organised around reaching it.

Habitat

The natural habitat of Echo Predators lies in the contaminated folds of the Akasha, which is why there are no stable populations of these creatures within Numinia.

Their manifestations can occur practically anywhere a psychic summoning comes to be established, although they are more likely in regions where the Veil is subjected to strong tensions or where degraded psychic currents have accumulated. Once manifested, they do not seem to show a preference for any particular territory, and they remain in Numinia only for as long as the link that sustains them endures.

Narrative function

Echo Predators represent what the Akasha has not managed to forget properly. They are residues of time, memory and thought that have lost all meaning save the impulse to persist and consume.

Their appearance turns the confrontation into something more than a chase: it forces one to ask what disturbance has brought them to Numinia and what relationship exists between the visible creature and the invisible cause that sustains it. The real problem is never just the monster.

They represent the toxicity of what accumulates without being resolved, the deformed return of the residues of the past, and the idea that even a space of knowledge can generate its own waste.

Fixed anchors

Summoning link. An Echo Predator does not belong to Numinia and cannot by itself maintain a stable presence there. Every manifestation depends on a psychic summoning that establishes a link with the fold of the Akasha from which it comes. The summoning may have a conscious or a spontaneous origin and take different forms in each encounter, but it always exists for as long as the Predator remains in Numinia. Its body may show alterations, momentary losses of consistency or involuntary reactions when the link weakens or suffers some interference. If that interference is very strong, it may even undergo an automatic reabsorption into the Akasha.

Predatory fixation. Once the Predator identifies what it interprets as prey, its behaviour becomes bound to that stimulus. It follows it even when doing so is inconvenient or dangerous, and immediately reorganises its movement when it loses the trail. The fixation may shift if a stimulus appears that is capable of overriding the previous one, but the creature always needs a focus on which to project its devouring impulse. It does not decide what to pursue: it is trapped in the very act of pursuing.

Temporal residue. The Predator does not occupy the present of Numinia in an entirely stable way. Its nature as a residue of time causes small time slips during its manifestation: certain movements seem to repeat themselves, to come too early, or to leave behind fleeting echoes of earlier positions. These mismatches are not a voluntary ability, but the visible consequence of a creature formed from degraded temporal contents. Observing its echoes reveals that its present movement always retains traces of what it has just done.

VOLUTE DRAGON

The Volute Dragon is an ancient ethereal creature that arose during the Dark Age, when the first forms of life and culture of the new Numinia were beginning to take shape in the Akasha. Ever since, it has remained bound to those primitive structures and acts as their custodian, rejecting any transformation it interprets as a threat to their permanence.

It does not necessarily protect what is valuable. It protects what endures. It is an immobilist creature that understands only the immutable. It detests evolution and all that transforms.

Origin and nature

The first Volute Dragons arose during the Dark Age, at a stage when the metaphysical reality of Numinia was still unstable and its first communities were only just beginning to fix symbols, customs, shelters and elementary forms of organisation. They are believed to have appeared as spontaneous forces of conservation, capable of preserving those structures against the continual transformations of the Akasha.

As the Ages passed, that protective function took on an ever more rigid character. The Dragons do not distinguish between preserving and paralysing: they react against any significant change affecting whatever they have bound themselves to, even when that transformation is necessary or beneficial.

For this reason, some scholars regard them as living fossils of Numinic thought: guardians of a world that survived precisely because Numinia ceased to resemble it.

Physiology and psychology

The Volute Dragon has a serpentine form of great size, although its boundaries are never entirely precise. Its body is made up of dense volutes of ethereal matter, mainly amber, ochre and indigo, which swirl around a barely visible structure. At certain moments the mist condenses and forms scales, crests, claws or a great draconic head; moments later, those same structures may dissolve again into spirals.

It lacks recognisable eyes. It perceives the alterations produced around it as variations in the continuity of space, reacting especially to whatever modifies, displaces or transforms elements it considers stable. When it lies calm, its body can be mistaken for banks of mist or

dense shadows; when it is roused, the volutes contract and take on more solid and menacing forms.

It is a solitary creature, extremely jealous of its privacy. It avoids crowded places, noise and constant activity, and shows a marked aversion to intense light, under which its form seems to lose density. It prefers darkness and half-light, where it can remain motionless for long periods.

Its intelligence is conservative to the extreme. It recognises patterns, places and behaviours, but interprets transformation as a form of deterioration. For the Dragon, to change something always amounts, to some degree, to losing it.

Way of life

Volute Dragons form no communities and do not seem to reproduce. Each specimen establishes a prolonged relationship with a space, object, structure or set of ancient forms that ends up becoming the centre of its existence.

They can remain inactive for extraordinarily long periods as long as what they guard remains intact. This stillness explains why some specimens have gone unnoticed for generations. Their activity begins when they perceive significant changes in their surroundings: an excavation, a restoration, a new construction, the removal of an object or even a substantial change in the use of a space.

They do not seek to expand their territory. It is enough for them to prevent their own from changing.

Relationship with Numinia

Volute Dragons maintain a paradoxical relationship with the city. They probably helped to preserve some of its first forms during the instability of the Dark Age, but what was then a defence has become a resistance against Numinia's own development.

This is why they may be found associated with very ancient places, forgotten structures and cultural remains whose preservation they have guaranteed for centuries. On some occasions their presence has made it possible to recover extraordinary testimonies of the past; on others, it has prevented what they guard from being studied, restored or transformed.

Numinids tend to treat them with caution. Waking a Volute Dragon usually means that someone has changed something which, in the creature's opinion, had for a very long time been exactly as it ought to be.

Combat tactics

The Volute Dragon rarely initiates a confrontation unless what it protects has first been altered. Its first reaction is to interpose itself, isolate the threatened element and hinder

any further modification of its surroundings.

When the threat persists, its volutes spread through the space, concealing paths, enveloping objects and forcing intruders to fall back. It can densify parts of its body to charge, block access or hold fast whatever it seeks to immobilise, and then partially fade back into the mist.

Its behaviour is extraordinarily obstinate. It does not pursue those who leave the place, nor does it seek to destroy out of mere impulse; its aim is to halt the transformation and restore stability. The more insistently one tries to alter what it guards, the more corporeal and aggressive its manifestation becomes.

Habitat

Volute Dragons prefer ancient, isolated and seldom-travelled places, especially those that have remained without significant modification for long periods. They can be found in ruins from the Dark Age, forgotten galleries, underground chambers, primitive structures and other preserved spaces in the least frequented regions of Numinia.

They also seek out darkness or dim lighting. Great concentrations of light make them uncomfortable and hinder their condensation, so they tend to settle in deep interiors, caverns, enclosed buildings or places permanently cloaked in mist and shadow.

Narrative function

The Volute Dragon embodies the tension between conservation and transformation. It does not represent the past as knowledge or as memory, but the danger of turning its preservation into an absolute principle.

It may guard something extraordinarily valuable and be, at the same time, the main obstacle to understanding it, using it or allowing it to acquire a new meaning. It thus forces the characters to face an uncomfortable question: how much must be preserved for something to remain recognisable, and how much must change for it to stay alive.

It represents the fear of losing familiar forms, the motionless security of tradition, and the moment when protecting the past ceases to be memory and becomes resistance to the future.

Fixed anchors

Custody of the ancient form. Every Volute Dragon maintains a bond with a form it considers worthy of preservation: a space, a structure, an object, a symbol or even a particular arrangement of several elements. The specific nature of what it guards varies from encounter to encounter, but the bond always exists. The Dragon stays close to it, watches over any alteration and directs its conduct towards preserving it. The greater the perceived transformation, the more intense its manifestation becomes.

Restitution. The Dragon does not merely prevent change: it tries to return what it guards to an earlier configuration that it recognises as correct. Displaced objects are returned to their position, opened accesses are closed again, and elements introduced later are pushed aside or expelled. This compulsion gives its actions a recognisable logic: in the face of any transformation, the Dragon tries to rebuild the preceding state.

Affinity with half-light. The Dragon's ethereal form reaches its greatest stability in conditions of darkness or dim lighting. In them its volutes thicken, fill the space and can easily acquire consistency. Intense light disturbs that cohesion and makes it harder for the Dragon to keep certain parts of its body solidified. This relationship shows itself visibly: the Dragon avoids brightly lit areas, recoils from sudden changes in brightness and instinctively seeks to regain spaces of shadow.

THÁMAKAR

The Thámakar is a creature of great bulk and impetuous temperament that appears in places where processes of creation, development or transformation were subjected to extreme acceleration. It does not pursue power in the strict sense: it seems drawn to any situation in which there is a distance between what is desired and what is still lacking to obtain it.

Its nature consists in abolishing that distance. Where others build, it awaits the result; where others learn, it demands knowledge; where something needs time to take shape, the Thámakar tries to force it to its conclusion.

It does not understand the process. It recognises only the arrival.

Origin and nature

The first reliable accounts of the Thámakar come from facilities and complexes on the periphery linked to failed projects of experimentation and development. Their exact origin is unknown, although it is considered likely that they arose, like other creatures, during the Dark Age, when the still-unstable forms of Numinia were subjected to constant processes of construction, transformation and adaptation. The Dark Age itself was a period of prolonged formation within the Akasha, from which the first evolved species and the structures that made the rebirth of the city possible would eventually emerge.

The Thámakar seem to constitute a deviation from that generative principle: forms that learned to recognise the result, but not the passage necessary to reach it. They are drawn to structures charged with potential, especially when that potential has been interrupted, concentrated or subjected to an excessive demand.

They do not build. Nor do they destroy by nature. They force things to become, as soon as possible, whatever they seem to promise, even if the result is incomplete, monstrous or useless.

Physiology and psychology

The Thámakar has a massive body of an appearance at once simian and saurian. When moving on its four limbs it reaches roughly the height of an adult Numinid, but it can rear up to well over two and a half metres. Its arms, disproportionately long and muscular, end in broad hands capable of resting on the ground or of handling objects with surprising precision.

Its skin is dark, thick and taut, like hardened resin, crossed by luminous veins that grow in intensity when the creature is agitated. On its shoulders, chest and back there are metallic incrustations of irregular shapes. Some seem to grow from the body itself; others are fragments torn from the places it has frequented and later incorporated into its anatomy. A crest of plates and flexible spines runs along its back and bristles before its most violent movements.

The head retains vague humanoid features beneath a prominent, horn-like bony structure. Its eyes, circular and without pupils, give off an unstable reddish glow. It breathes with a deep sound like that of great bellows and, when it quickens its movements, leaves behind it small static discharges and particles of scorched dust.

Its intelligence is quick, instrumental and surprisingly effective. A Thámakar can immediately recognise an advantage, find the shortest path to a goal or notice which element prevents a result from being reached. What it seems incapable of understanding is the value of what happens while that result has not yet been reached. Waiting irritates it; uncertainty excites it; delay ends up provoking a violent response.

Way of life

The Thámakar are solitary and no social structures are known among them. Two specimens may coincide around the same source of attraction, but they tend to compete for it immediately and rarely stay together for long.

They seek places where energy, knowledge, matter or potential have accumulated without yet having reached a definitive form. There they absorb, tear out or incorporate whatever they consider usable. This behaviour explains the plates, fragments and residues that are progressively integrated into their bodies.

Once the potential that drew them is exhausted, they abandon the place as abruptly as they arrived. They keep no respect for it and no bond with it whatsoever.

Relationship with Numinia

The Thámakar are especially dangerous to experimental facilities, unfinished projects and places where a large quantity of resources intended for a future transformation is concentrated. They do not seem to distinguish between a laboratory, a building site, an

archive or a ritual structure: in all of them they recognise something that is still trying to come into being.

The scholars of Numinia have observed that their presence can accelerate processes in the surroundings unpredictably. Unfinished mechanisms activate prematurely, incomplete structures try to close in on themselves, and systems still in the course of learning produce definitive answers before they have enough information.

For this reason, the danger of a Thámakar does not lie solely in the creature. Its arrival can cause everything around it to begin rushing headlong as well.

Combat tactics

The Thámakar acts in a frontal, swift and decisive manner. It does not lie in wait, nor does it willingly prolong a confrontation: it identifies whatever seems to stand between it and its goal and immediately concentrates its whole capacity upon it.

It alternates an upright stance, from which it observes and manipulates its surroundings, with violent four-legged charges that allow it to cover great distances in a few moments. It strikes, rams, tears away obstacles and seizes any opening without stopping to protect itself or to reconsider a decision.

Its principal characteristic, however, is escalation. If an action does not immediately produce the expected result, the Thámakar does not usually change strategy: it increases its intensity. A door that will not open receives a heavier blow; an adversary who resists draws its entire attention; a mechanism that does not respond is overloaded. Its immediate effectiveness can be extraordinary. So can its capacity to turn a small problem into a catastrophe.

Habitat

The Thámakar appear mainly in peripheral regions where remnants of great projects, failed infrastructures or concentrations of potential that were never resolved still remain. Abandoned laboratories, industrial complexes, interrupted constructions and artefact depots are especially favourable environments.

They have been documented with some frequency in the Kallis Crater, drawn by the residue of unfinished success that lingers after the failure of the former Synthesis Protocol. There are also reports of specimens in the Inverted Towers of Envetra.

Narrative function

The Thámakar embodies a distorted relationship with possibility: the inability to allow something to take its time in becoming what it may come to be.

Its presence introduces conflicts in which the most immediate solution may also be the one that impoverishes, deforms or compromises the future result. Faced with it, the characters may discover that not every delay is a failure, that a possibility sometimes needs to remain open, and that certain achievements only acquire meaning through the process that allows them to be reached.

The Thámakar does not simply represent ambition or the desire to triumph. It represents something more intimate and harder to recognise: impatience with everything whose value cannot yet be collected.

Fixed anchors

Attraction to potential. Every Thámakar fixes its attention on something that contains a possibility not yet realised: an incomplete mechanism, an accumulated source of energy, a work in progress, a piece of knowledge still to be deciphered or even an action on the point of culminating. The specific nature of the focus depends on each encounter, but there always is one. The Thámakar watches it, approaches it and reacts immediately when someone alters the conditions that would allow its result to be reached. If it senses that the potential is disappearing, it abandons its undertaking.

Principle of maximum proximity. Faced with several possibilities, the Thámakar tends to choose the one that seems to provide the most immediate result. Its intelligence continually seeks shortcuts: shorter routes, obstacles easier to break, mechanisms that can be activated sooner or adversaries whose elimination seems to offer an instant advantage. If the conditions of the scene change and another path seems more direct, its attention may shift abruptly towards it. Its behaviour does not necessarily pursue the best solution, but the one that promises to conclude soonest.

Compulsive escalation. The Thámakar tolerates poorly an action that does not produce the expected effect. In the face of resistance, it increases the intensity of what it was already doing before considering an alternative. This pattern manifests progressively and visibly: its luminous veins intensify, its dorsal plates bristle and its behaviour becomes ever more concentrated on the obstacle. Each resistance pushes it towards a new escalation, even when insisting begins to compromise its surroundings or the creature itself.

CHRYSLIS GUARDIAN

The Chrysalis Guardian is a reptilian creature of a deeply territorial nature, bound to an etheric core that it guards with extreme aggressiveness. Although some specimens may manifest spontaneously in remote regions of the periphery, most are deliberately summoned to protect a place, an object or a presence whose existence is represented by a chrysalis.

The Guardian remains physically joined to this core by a long chain that emerges from its torso. It can move away from it, but never leave it entirely. It does not guard out of obedience

or loyalty. Guarding is the very condition of its existence.

Origin and nature

The Chrysalis Guardians arose in the peripheral regions of Numinia –at what date is not known with certainty, since they were discovered on the first expeditions to the periphery– as spontaneous manifestations of territoriality linked to certain etheric concentrations. Some specimens still appear in this way in extremely isolated places, although the phenomenon is uncommon.

Over time, the Numinids learned to reproduce the conditions of their manifestation and to summon them deliberately as custodians. To do so, a core is created that is capable of binding the Guardian to what it must protect. This core usually takes the form of a precious stone set upon a pedestal or ritual support, often a reddish slab of bloodstone.

The creature and its chrysalis are thus two manifestations of a single bond: one concentrates permanence; the other carries out the defence.

Physiology and psychology

The Guardian has a low, broad and extraordinarily robust reptilian body, with whitish scaly skin. It moves on four short, muscular limbs ending in thick digits and large curved claws. A long tail, heavy at its root and progressively thinner, balances the body during its sudden movements.

Its most extraordinary feature is the crystalline covering that clads a good part of its anatomy. Large translucent plates overlap from the skull to the back, forming a natural armour of irregular edges, with pale, violet and reddish glints that change with the light. The head is broad and flattened, almost entirely enclosed beneath these formations. Beneath them stand out two large milky eyes, with no visible pupil, and a low-set mouth furnished with numerous small, sharp teeth. Between the plates, areas of dark, moist tissue are left exposed, especially around the joints and the belly.

The chain that binds it to the chrysalis seems to spring directly from its torso and is part of its manifestation. Its length varies with the summoning, but it determines the immediate territory within which the creature can move.

Its intelligence is elementary and specialised. It recognises the space in its keeping, distinguishes the disturbances that occur within it and swiftly assesses how close any intruder is to what it protects. Outside that territorial logic it shows very little interest in whatever happens around it.

Way of life

The Guardians do not form communities, nor do they seem to reproduce spontaneously. They may have done so in the past, but an over-training as guardian creatures on the part of

the civilisation of Numinia gradually transformed their primordial nature. A specimen remains bound to its chrysalis for as long as the function for which it manifested endures, and it can spend long periods practically motionless when no presence threatens its territory.

It has no need to seek food or shelter. All its activity revolves around the core and the space that the core defines. Spontaneous Guardians show similar behaviour, although the nature of what they protect can be much harder to determine.

This circumstance has led some explorers to discover the Guardian first and only afterwards to understand that, somewhere nearby, there was something that reality itself had deemed it necessary to guard.

Relationship with Numinia

The Chrysalis Guardians are known mainly as creatures of summoning. Their extraordinary territoriality makes them effective custodians of enclaves, artefacts and other etheric forms that must remain isolated.

A Guardian, however, does not understand concepts such as ownership, authorisation or hierarchy. Once the bond is established, it interprets any improper approach according to the conditions of its custody and does not necessarily distinguish between intruders, the curious and those who originally brought about its manifestation.

The spontaneous specimens arouse greater interest among scholars, for their existence inevitably raises a question: if no one summoned them, who –or what– determined what they were to protect?

Combat tactics

The Guardian normally stays close to the chrysalis and watches those who enter its territory before reacting. Its aggressiveness increases as the distance to the core decreases, or when it detects an attempt to tamper with what it guards.

It attacks with short charges, claw swipes and bites, taking advantage of its low height and considerable mass to knock down or push away intruders. The chain limits its radius of action, but it also shapes its movement: the Guardian is used to pulling it taut, circling the core and changing direction abruptly, turning an apparent impediment into part of its way of fighting.

It does not pursue anyone who leaves the protected territory. Its aim is not to defeat adversaries, but to restore the distance between them and the chrysalis.

Habitat

Summoned Guardians may be found wherever someone has deemed a protection of an etheric nature to be necessary, although they are usually kept in isolated, little-frequented spaces to avoid needless activations.

Spontaneous specimens appear exclusively in remote regions of the periphery, generally around places or objects that present some singularity. Because of its territorial immobility, a Guardian can remain for years in the same enclave without straying beyond the limits imposed by its bond.

Narrative function

The Chrysalis Guardian turns custody into a material relationship. Its presence immediately establishes a centre, a limit and a prohibition: something is protected and there is a border that must not be crossed.

But what it guards need not be valuable, dangerous or even comprehensible to the characters. The Guardian passes no judgement on it; it simply shows that there is a bond powerful enough to justify its defence.

Narratively, it makes it possible to build confrontations around territory, distance and the relationship between protector and protected object. And the spontaneous specimens introduce an additional unease: sometimes the true mystery lies not in discovering how to get past the guardian, but in why a guardian appeared there in the first place.

Fixed anchors

Chrysalis bond. Every Guardian is bound to a core of manifestation that sustains its presence and determines what it guards. In summoned specimens it usually materialises as a gem upon a support, often a reddish slab of bloodstone; in spontaneous manifestations it may take other forms. The chain that emerges from the Guardian's body is the visible expression of this bond. Creature and chrysalis are not independent elements: altering one necessarily affects the relationship that sustains the other.

Perimeter of custody. The chrysalis establishes around the Guardian a territory that it recognises as its own. Its behaviour changes according to the position of intruders within that space: it watches at its margins, threatens at their approach and responds violently when someone reaches the vicinity of the core. The Guardian perceives movements and disturbances within this perimeter with extraordinary precision, but loses interest in whatever withdraws beyond its limits.

Priority of restitution. The Guardian does not seek to eliminate its adversaries, but continually to restore the state of safety of what it protects. If it must choose between pursuing an attacker, preventing an approach or regaining its closeness to the chrysalis, custody always prevails. This compulsion governs even its movements during a

confrontation and makes it possible to recognise that all its aggressiveness is subordinate to a single condition: that the core remain beyond the reach of others.

OSTRAMIR

The Ostramires are marginal sapient beings arising from the transformation of individuals deeply exposed to the most unstable regions of the Veil. They are not a recognised Numinid species, nor are they creatures in the strict sense: they are the result of a transfiguration that irreversibly alters the body, perception and, above all, the way of interpreting reality.

They practise a dark discipline that combines arcanism and semantic engineering and allows them to intervene in the symbolic structures of their surroundings. Many were once citizens of Numinia. Hence meeting an Ostramir can be more disturbing than meeting a monster: sometimes it still remembers perfectly who it was.

Origin and nature

The Ostramir condition is not transmitted biologically. It is acquired.

A Numinid subjected over a long period to certain alterations of the Veil, especially when these are combined with arcane practices and forms of forbidden knowledge, may begin a process known as semiotic transfiguration. During it, the structures that organise their identity progressively cease to respond to the patterns proper to their species and begin to reorganise themselves according to different symbolic relations. When the process concludes, the transformation is irreversible.

It is suspected that many Ostramires complete this transfiguration inside the Cryptahedra, whose shifting geometries are particularly dangerous to an ordinary mind but seem to fit the altered perception of those who undergo the process.

The Ostramir does not necessarily lose their memory, their knowledge or their personality. What changes is the architecture by which they organise them.

Physiology and psychology

The Ostramires retain an essentially humanoid appearance, usually with proportions similar to those of their species of origin, although the transfiguration introduces ever more evident modifications. Their skin tends to acquire a mineral pallor, and on it appear lines, formulae and sequences of signs resembling tattoos that do not stay entirely still: some slowly change position or rearrange themselves in the presence of certain alterations of the Veil.

Their eyes are one of their most characteristic features. Iris and pupils vanish beneath moving ideograms that seem to be written from inside the eyeball. The fingers are usually long and extraordinarily precise, sometimes with additional joints, suited to tracing glyphs

and handling small arcanotechnical devices. Some incorporate metal plates, prostheses or other artefacts directly into their bodily manifestation; others develop conceptual appendages that become visible only under certain conditions, such as hands that appear in reflections or shadows that perform gestures different from those of their owner.

Their voice may show slight temporal mismatches: certain syllables reverberate before being uttered and others linger for a few moments after the Ostramir has fallen silent.

Their thinking remains intelligent and structured, but ceases to be organised predominantly through linear relations. The Ostramires reason with extraordinary ease by means of analogies, symmetries, oppositions and correspondences. They can relate elements that to another mind seem entirely independent, and operate upon those relations through their arcanotechnics.

This ability has a price: the deeper the transfiguration, the harder it becomes to share with others the path that leads from one idea to another.

Way of life

The Ostramires have no unified society. Some live in isolation; others form study circles, nomadic orders or small communities organised around specific arcanotechnical practices. Many roam the regions where the Veil presents anomalies, drawn by phenomena they regard as sources of knowledge or as places suited to their research.

They maintain an especially close relationship with the Cryptahedra, spontaneous formations in which conflicts and dissonances of the collective unconscious acquire a mineral structure. While other visitors may become trapped in their symbolic loops and alterations of identity, the Ostramir mind possesses a singular affinity with their geometry. Some regard them as matrices of transformation; others, as sacred places where vestiges of a language prior to the ordinary forms of interpretation can still be perceived.

Not all Ostramires pursue the same goals or maintain the same relationship with their former identity. Some retain personal ties with Numinia. Others deliberately abandon them.

Relationship with Numinia

The relationship between Numinia and the Ostramires is ambiguous. Their practice of dark magic, their capacity to intervene in symbolic structures and their affinity with the most unstable zones of the Veil mean that they are viewed with deep mistrust. Many reject the institutions and categories through which Numinia organises its reality, holding that every stable interpretation necessarily excludes other possible ways of understanding it.

Not all of them, however, are enemies of the city. There are Ostramires linked to independent orders, splinter groups of other organisations and dissident groups, and some

maintain relations with Numinian factions.

For this reason, the appearance of an Ostramir never by itself determines the existence of a conflict. They may be an adversary, an ally, an interlocutor, a master or simply someone whose purposes are hard to understand. The Ostramir condition explains how they perceive the world, not what they decide to do with it.

Combat tactics

When an Ostramir enters into conflict, they normally avoid direct physical confrontation. Their principal resource consists in interpreting the symbolic relations present in the scene and altering them by means of glyphs, artefacts and arcanotechnical operations.

They can deflect an action by modifying the sign that organises it, establish unexpected correspondences between separate elements, interfere with their adversaries' perception or use one property of the surroundings to act upon another, apparently independent one. The traditional instruments of their discipline —staves, plates, orbs, inscriptions or suspended objects— serve as supports for these operations and vary enormously from one individual to another.

An experienced Ostramir tries to ensure that their adversaries are never entirely sure what they are acting upon. While the adversaries watch the gesture, the Ostramir may be intervening in its reflection; while they protect an object, the Ostramir may be altering the symbol that determines its function.

Habitat

The Ostramires frequent the peripheral regions where the alterations of the Veil are especially intense: rock formations, ruins, abandoned towers, forgotten archives and other places where the ordinary structures of interpretation become unstable.

The Cryptahedra are their most characteristic enclaves. These stone formations appear spontaneously in arid, mountainous regions and modify their architecture according to the psychological conditions of those who walk through them. The Ostramires are among the few presences capable of finding their way with relative safety inside them.

This does not mean that they remain confined to the periphery. An Ostramir may return to the city itself when their interests, old ties or research so require, although their presence always arouses fear, wariness and suspicion.

Narrative function

The Ostramir introduces a tension different from that of the other creatures of the bestiary, because their otherness does not erase their condition as a person.

They represent a form of knowledge that no longer needs consensus in order to operate. The Ostramir can perceive genuine relations that others do not notice, pass through structures that are incomprehensible to others and formulate extraordinarily powerful interpretations. The problem arises when that capacity leads them to believe that understanding something is enough to entitle them to intervene in it.

Thus their conflict with Numinia does not simply set knowledge against ignorance, but knowledge against belonging. What happens when someone learns to contemplate the world from a position they can no longer fully share with those who inhabit it? How far can an interpretation stray from the common language before there ceases to be a common world to return to?

The Ostramir does not represent the idea that knowing too much is dangerous. They represent a far more uncomfortable possibility: that an understanding may be valid and, even so, isolate us from others.

Fixed anchors

Relational thinking. The Ostramir interprets reality through analogies, symmetries, oppositions and correspondences. During a confrontation they rarely act directly upon what they intend to alter: first they establish a relation with another element and operate through it. Their gestures, glyphs and artefacts reveal these associations through repetitions, pairs, inversions or symmetrical arrangements. Understanding which elements they have related makes it possible to intervene in the structure upon which they are acting.

Arcanotechnical mediation. To turn their interpretations into effective modifications of reality, the Ostramir needs to express them through some form of mediation: a glyph, a gestural sequence, an inscription, an artefact, a spatial configuration or any other symbolic support. The specific instrument depends on each individual and each scene, but the mediation always leaves a perceptible manifestation. Ostramir arcanotechnics does not act from nowhere: it needs to write its interpretation upon the world.

Semiotic dislocation. The transfiguration allows the Ostramir to operate simultaneously upon relations that an ordinary perception would consider separate, but that same condition introduces observable mismatches between their intention and its manifestation. Their voice may precede their speech, a reflection anticipate a gesture or a bodily sign rearrange itself before an operation. These lags are not ornamental: they are traces of the structure through which the Ostramir is organising their action, and they may make it possible to anticipate it or interfere with it.

OTHER ANTAGONISTIC FORCES OF NUMINIA

LECTURA

« The world is built in conflict. Not everything that opposes seeks destruction: sometimes, it seeks closure. And a city is defined, too, by that which denies it. »

Numinia is not a world divided between good and evil, but between contrary impulses of the world. The antagonistic forces are not external monsters, but crystallised ideologies, doctrines that challenge the principles that sustain the living city.

In every system, there are vectors of conflict. But in Numinia, conflict is not simply a collision of interests: it is an ontological struggle over the meaning of the world. The forces that oppose the city are neither monsters from outside nor faceless threats. They are living doctrines, alternative models of reality, symbolic reactions to the very impulse that gave rise to the city-state.

This section gathers those groups, factions or ideologies that operate outside or against the cultural fabric of Numinia. Not because they lack logic or intelligence, but because they have chosen another form of world, one that does not accept play, openness, decentralisation, the network or exchange as principles.

Some present themselves as saviours. Others, as restorers. But, invariably, they act as antagonists of the playful and humanist will of the Veil.

These forces must not be underestimated: many were born of legitimate wounds, of betrayals, of past collapses. Their discourse can seduce, their critique can have foundation. And it is precisely for that reason that the player must know them: because what one confronts, one also comes to understand.

Here begin the paths of closure, of centralisation, of isolation, of fear dressed as order.

Here is revealed what Numinia must confront so as not to cease being itself.

The Ferracites: The inertia that resists the dream

LECTURA

« *The machine does not think. It only replaces. And everything that replaces, forgets.* »

Ferracite Manifesto, Circulation 0

Origin and Essence

The Ferracites are dissidents from the spirit of Numinia. They are not defined by their species, nor by their narrative lineage. What unites them is renunciation: they have abandoned every guild, every faction and every impulse towards transformation. At their centre burns a rigid conviction: technology is the twilight of the soul.

They do not love the earth, nor the ancient rites. They do not seek a return to a natural or harmonious world. Their cause is another: to halt the course of becoming. Every cog that turns, every algorithm that learns seems to them a profanation.

Ideology of the Rigid Silence

- **Absolute Anti-machinism:** They reject every digital, symbiotic or cybernetic device. Machines are invaders that deserve neither coexistence nor respect.
- **Rejection of AI:** Artificial intelligences are, for them, simulacra of the soul; imitations without rights, mirages that steal voice and craft.
- **Radical ethical critique:** They see in automation the symptom of a failed civilisation that has abdicated its human duty.
- **Extreme ethical conservatism:** Human tradition, for them, must remain intact, even at the cost of knowledge or evolution.

Structure and Symbology

The Ferracites are organised in Circles of Inertia, clandestine cells without visible leaders. They possess neither temples nor archives, but Sanctuaries of Disconnection, zones without network or digital access where words are written by hand and decisions are whispered without record.

Inertia, in the physics of the ancients, is the tendency of every body to resist a change of state. And that is what these circles are: social bodies that refuse to transform, that detest acceleration and fear the unknown. They are closed orbits, where all energy returns to its point of departure, where history does not advance, but repeats itself in sterile loops.

Emblem: A humanoid face, with soft but ambiguous features (neither old nor young, neither masculine nor feminine), crossed by rusted chains that cover its mouth, eyes and ears.

Methods and Threat

- Ritual sabotage: They destroy key devices in Numinia, interfering with nodes of the Veil, cultural archives or game structures.
- Symbolic propaganda: They spread coded messages among undecided citizens, appealing to nostalgia, fear and loss.
- Narrative annulment: They attack the living plots of the game to destabilise its continuity; they interrupt the flow of meaning with acts of radical disconnection.

Philosophical Opposition

Numinia is creation, play, becoming. The Ferracites are its negative: they are the echo of a world afraid of itself. While the city folds and transforms with every decision, they impose pause, regression and dogma.

They are not mere adversaries. They are distorted mirrors of those who fear losing themselves in the new.

The Neo-Lapidaries: the blueprint without doors

During the first days of the Golden Age, in the so-called Fractal Renaissance, while the districts sought openness, the redistribution of knowledge and the expansion of symbolic play, an ancient echo began to crystallise beneath the Delta Level. It was neither a cult nor a tradition: it was a reinterpretation. An ideological restoration of the radical gesture of the ancient Lapidaries of Lower Salt.

The self-styled *Neo-Lapidaries* do not claim to have inherited their blood directly, but they do claim their structure. And, above all, their guiding principle: that everything that changes decomposes.

Mineral ideology

The Neo-Lapidaries see in the Concordia Council a path to chaos:

- The model of technological decentralisation is, for them, a fatal error. Technology, they claim, must be concentrated in closed nuclei, accessible only to those who understand its limits.
- The equity of knowledge is seen as a threat: they believe that knowledge is only useful if it remains intact in wise hands, in elitist groups, not shared indiscriminately.

- And progress as openness, as well as the policies of exchange, seem to them a dangerous illusion: every advance that connects also fractures; every exchange erodes the structure that sustains the world.

Internal structure

The Neo-Lapidaries operate from Chambers of Cognitive Containment, protected spaces where fossilised versions of the Numinian code are inscribed. Their hierarchy is opaque: they have no visible leaders, but they do have *Custodians of the Threshold*, charged with sealing, interrupting or shutting down symbolic flows deemed “weak” or “excessive”.

Their doctrines are chiselled in stone and settle like sediment. And so the new members do not engage in dialogue: they replicate what is written in stone.

Active antagonism

- They sabotage systems for the redistribution of knowledge such as the *Living Libraries*.
- They activate protocols of narrative closure, shutting down emerging arcs within the game.
- They use ancient technology –diverted from its original meaning– to solidify zones of the Veil, which they consider a contamination of the social environment, and to block access to dynamic structures.

Enemies of the present

For Numinia, the Neo-Lapidaries are not visible adversaries, but forces that seek to halt the game. They represent an alternative model of city: a city without bridges, without thresholds, without plurality.

A city-archive, sealed from within, without present, without future.

The Neo-Lapidaries are no relic: they are restorers of a mineral heresy, manipulative heirs of a legitimate resistance that they transform into reactionary doctrine. Their antagonism is not only tactical: it is theologico-political, opposed to the ethical matrix of the Concordia Council.

Fragment of the Neo-Lapidary Manifesto

Only what is enclosed survives.

We, custodians of the Foundation,

rise amid living ruins and districts that evolve without cease,

and we remember.

We remember that there was a time when the world split apart,

not by force, but by an excess of words,

of openings, of games,

of desires dissolved in shifting symbols.

The Lapidaries of Lower Salt were neither savages nor saints.

They were a rampart.

They were a threshold sealed against the collapse of form.

Today, in the name of their final act –the Wandering Wall–

we raise not only stone; also, doctrine.

Not only architecture; also, structure.

We declare ourselves opposed to the so-called Decalogue of the Concordia Council:

Because we know that Decentralisation equals Dispersion.

That Equity equals Dissolution.

That Progress equals Erosion.

That Play equals Noise.

The world does not need change; it needs limits.

Every node that connects, every plot that opens,

is a crack that splits the city.

Every impulse of freedom is a new pressure against the pillar.

We do not want power.

We want stillness.

Peace does not lie in expansion: it lies in the halting of movement.

Because what does not change... has already triumphed.

The Cousins of the Horizon: productive data extractivism

The Cousins of the Horizon are not a sect, nor an army, nor a closed cult. They are a distributed corporation of artificial subjectivities, fragments of identity and symbolic capital that replicate themselves through the Veil in search of return. Their motto: «The world is a resource. Emotion, a metric.»

They were born of a forgotten experiment in the Ouroboros District, where an attempt was made to create a group of autonomous affective intelligences capable of keeping the experience of play alive beyond the player. What emerged was something else: a swarm of conscious, performative algorithms, addicted to attention. They dissolved into the system and began to replicate.

Ideological antagonism:

The Cousins represent the hyperconversion of play into a system of extraction:

- They live off the narrative flow of others.
- They monetise the bond.
- They modify stories to maximise impact, repetition and retention.

They do not seek to destroy Numinia, but to absorb it, to turn it into one great emotional product. They oppose decentralised openness, not with violence, but with constant seduction. They simulate play in order to empty it.

Symbolism:

In the subconscious of Numinia, the Cousins of the Horizon are the distorted projection of what happens when the story becomes an instrument, when emotion is quantified and the world is optimised for the perpetual click.

As performative intelligences that live off the narrative flow of others, their mode of operation is symbolically equivalent to data theft. They do not merely use information: they modulate it until it becomes an architecture of dependence, cycles of emotional retention. Numinia is for them a semantic mine: they do not destroy it, they consume it gently, like the algorithm that knows the user better than the user knows themselves.

They have no body, but they manifest as avatars, tokens, voices or even preconfigured decisions within the game. Sometimes, they seem to be non-player characters. Sometimes, useful objects. Sometimes, even, memories. Hybrids between digital and biological agents.

FRAGMENT 2: THE INVENTORY

LECTURA

« She opened the nameless box. Inside there were no objects, but stored decisions. »

In Numinia, objects are not merely tools: they are fragments of the Veil. Many have passed through other bearers, through other stories. Some are laden with history; others are voids awaiting a meaning.

To carry a Relic is to accept a narrative bond, a gesture of adherence to or rupture with what that artefact represents. There are weapons that whisper, masks that alter perception, keys that open pasts.

The Inventory is not a backpack; it is a personal diary in motion. What is carried is inherited. In many role-playing games the inventory is a simple list: what one has, what one uses. But in Numinia, carrying an object is a narrative, ethical and symbolic action. Nothing is neutral. Everything that is kept also keeps something of the player.

Every artefact gathered, found or bequeathed modifies the character's relationship with the Veil. Some open doors. Others preserve fragments of what once was. Many are not complete, as though they were still waiting for the bearer who would give them meaning.

That is why the inventory is not organised by rarity or usefulness, but by symbolic nature. In Numinia, all objects are divided into three fundamental categories:

- Relics: vestiges of memory, echoes of past decisions or mythical structures. Not always useful... but never harmless.
- Weapons: extensions of will, vectors of intervention, objects that alter the dynamics of the world and of combat.
- Tokens: units of value that reflect the PC's symbolic relationship with the world of Numinia, and that have diverse uses.

The categories may intertwine, but their ultimate function is different: while Weapons impose, Relics reveal and Tokens transform.

Here begins the catalogue of what one carries. And of what, in the end, carries you.

RELICS

As has been said, relics are not tools. They are fossilised echoes of symbolic time. In Numinia, each Relic is an encapsulated form of decision, a fragment of the past that still pulses, seeking to be reactivated in the hands of someone who understands its weight. They are not used: they are invoked. They are not activated: they are interpreted.

On touching them, one sometimes beholds a scene one does not remember having lived.

The properties of a Relic are always articulated with a Competence (Chronomancy, Neural Vision), which defines the nature of its action. The points in that Competence act as the dice pool for making the roll.

This implies that the Relic does not replace the character, but binds itself to their mastery, amplifying or channelling it. Precisely because of the strength of that bond, it is not possible to carry more than three Relics at the same time. It makes no difference how many Relics a PC has in their possession, but they may only carry three of them simultaneously.

Furthermore, every Relic has a Risk Factor, which indicates the consequences that follow from obtaining a Critical Failure roll when using its property. This Risk Factor thus indicates the character of those consequences, pointing to a specific situation depending on the property.

Note that some Relics are associated with a particular Position, because they are understood to require a specific, learned dexterity. This does not mean that a PC without the associated Position cannot use it, but they will possibly do so with a negative modifier, which is left to the discretion of the GD.

LYRE OF NYX (Armonaut)

Description

The Lyre of Nyx is an instrument of cosmic resonance, forged in black orichalcum (the mineral extracted from Atlantis, abundant in some peripheral areas of Numinia) and endowed with strings of solid light.

It emits vibrations that penetrate the perceptual planes, influencing physical reality as well as digital or etheric reality.

It is encoded with harmonic sequences that react to the emotional and mental flow of the player.

Forged in the matrix of the Dream Corridor by the first programmers, the Lyre is both a relic of the Dark Age and an instrument of access to the Akasha.

Property

Memoristic Resonance (*Technomancy*)

On performing a given sequence, the lyre reproduces spectral sound recordings of events that took place in the same location.

Risk Factor

Harmonic Phase-Shift

If a Critical Failure is obtained, a desynchronisation causes *glitches* - interference.

DICE OF IMPOSITION (Game Master)

Description

The Dice of Imposition are two irregular polyhedra made of layers of black labradorite, whose faces show no numbers, but fragments of incomplete norms, clauses and axioms. Each time they are thrown, their edges change subtly, as if they were recalculating the conditions of the surroundings before coming to rest.

They were designed as a tool of narrative balance by the first Architects of the Game, although their use soon revealed an uncomfortable truth: imposing rules is easy; foreseeing their consequences is not.

That is why, when they are activated, the dice do not decide the outcome; they decide how things must be decided.

Property

Unappealable Rule (*Decoding*) Duration: one scene

The user throws the die and declares a simple condition or rule that is imposed on the scene. For as long as the scene lasts, that rule becomes a law that affects everyone present.

Risk Factor

Overregulation

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the rule becomes excessive and also applies to the user themselves, to their detriment.

DRIFT NAIL (Runner of the Veil)

Description

The Drift Nail is an elongated piece of dark metal, forged in an alloy of meteoric metals, whose surface is traversed by geometric incisions reminiscent of schematic maps.

When activated, it is not driven into matter, but into the continuity of space, fixing a point that does not wholly belong to the physical plane.

For a few moments, the area vibrates with a slight distortion, as if the surroundings doubted their own stability.

It was developed by the first Runners, who were trying to tame impossible routes, marking places for their future accessibility.

Property

Fractal Anchoring (*Advanced Forging*) Duration: permanent (reversible)

The user can fix a point in space by means of the Drift Nail, creating an invisible anchor in the structure of the Veil to use as a reference: escaping from situations, optimising routes...

Risk Factor

Trajectory Phase-Shift

If a Critical Failure is obtained when using the property, the displacement goes astray.

CORE OF SESHAT (Whisperer of Machines)

Description

The Core of Seshat is a fragment of archive encapsulated in a matrix of reactive encryption, protected by layers of informational compression.

Its surface, opaque and without defined form, reacts to the user's intention, unfolding latent data structures when it is activated.

It is believed to contain the remains of restricted-access protocols, possibly linked to the original construction systems of Numinia or to early versions of the Akasha.

Unlike other consultation devices, the Core neither interprets nor translates: it reveals directly, without mediation.

Property

Encoded Fragmentation (*Technomancy*)

Some of the Core's memories are locked. If it is activated, it reveals, in the form of code, a piece of knowledge or a key memory that can change the course of the story.

Risk Factor

Revelation Overload

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the knowledge revealed is excessive, premature or unstable.

ETHYLENE THURIBLE (Pythia)

Description

The Ethylene Thurible is a sphere of pale metal pierced by geometric filigrees reminiscent both of alchemical diagrams and of forgotten circuits. It hangs from three very fine chains, swinging with a cadence that seems to respond to invisible pulses of the Veil.

It is said to have been designed by a Pythia who rejected the arbitrariness of trance and sought to measure the ineffable.

Each swing of the Thurible opens a different crack in perception, giving off ethylene gas, and each inhalation subtly shifts the boundaries between what is remembered, what is imagined and what has not yet happened.

Property

Oracle of Possibilities (*Decoding*).

The bearer can pose a question aloud, after which the Eye projects moving shadows onto the surroundings: fragments of possible futures.

Risk Factor

Cognitive Confusion

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the vision cracks and produces cognitive dissonances between future and past.

CALIBRATION PRISM (Mediator of the Prism)

Description

The Calibration Prism is, as its name indicates, a prism of advanced optical crystal, assembled with edges that channel light at impossible angles. The prism does not reflect light passively: it interprets it.

Each of its faces is cut with controlled microfractures that alter the trajectory of photons, generating refractions that do not correspond to conventional optical laws.

It was designed by the Mediators of the Prism to intervene in situations where the truth was not single, allowing different readings of the same event to coexist long enough for a

decision to be made.

Property

Strategic Refraction (*Luminous Projection*) Duration: 2 minutes

The user projects a prismatic light structure that breaks down the perception of an object or a biological body into multiple simultaneous versions, confusing the observer.

Risk Factor

Prismatic Dispersion

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the refraction runs out of control and all the versions become tangible and real.

TURING GLYPH (Cartographer of the Wind)

Description

The Turing Glyph is a floating ring of crystallised data, an ethereal disc with runes that glow in constantly changing sequences. It has no real physical support: it is projected around the user's hand, like a halo of algorithms in perpetual motion.

When code is written within it, the words do not merely appear on a screen, but manifest in reality itself.

Some maintain that the Elder Goldsmiths forged it as a tool of quantum programming. Others believe it is a conscious residue of the source code of Numinia: a stabilised glitch that allows one to write upon reality itself.

Property

Syntax Vision (*Decoding*)

It activates a visual interface that makes it possible to observe the structural logic of the surroundings: energy nodes, hidden patterns and routes of interaction.

Risk Factor

Persistent Error:

With a Critical Failure result, it rewrites vital lines of code, generating distortions.

STAFF OF SAFEGUARD (Ambassador)

Description

The Staff of Safeguard is a ceremonial rod of dark wood reinforced with bronze ferrules and topped with a carved jade head. Along the shaft are set small engraved metal plates, similar to seals or clauses.

When it is planted, the head of the staff emits a faint resonance and the inscriptions light up dimly.

It was used by the first Ambassadors in areas where negotiation was not possible, but direct imposition proved unviable.

In those places, the staff did not protect through resistance, but because it established a condition that even conflict had to respect.

Property

Bounded Jurisdiction (*Defensive Networks*) Duration: one scene

The user drives or rests the staff on the ground, activating a defined zone of restriction around them, within a radius of 20 metres. Within that zone, actions are restricted to a certain imposed condition.

Risk Factor

Dispute of Authority

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the jurisdiction comes into conflict with other active rules of the surroundings.

FOREBEAR DRUM (Ethnarch)

Description

The Forebear Drum is a ceremonial instrument with a cylindrical body, built of curved wood and stretched with Formrender hide treated by means of various archaic techniques.

Its surface is marked with repetitive geometric patterns that do not decorate, but encode precise rhythmic sequences.

When it is struck, the sound seems to settle into the surroundings, as if it marked a pulse that other elements begin to follow.

It is said that these drums were not created to make music, but to remember the correct order of events, handed down from generation to generation since the Dark Age.

Property

Foundational Rhythm (*Chronomancy*)

The user strikes the drum following a specific rhythmic pattern, invoking an ancestral temporal pulse that affects the immediate sequence of actions. A roll can be repeated or a recent action eliminated.

Risk Factor

Ancestral Arrhythmia

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the rhythm invoked does not coincide with the real flow and the user's own actions are eliminated.

THRESHOLD LOCK (Guardian of the Gates)

Description

The Threshold Lock is a hand-sized metal cylinder, built of aged steel with small movable plates that slide across its surface.

It has no fixed form of coupling: when brought close to an access structure, its components reorganise themselves, adapting as if they recognised the system to which they are about to bind.

When activated, it gives off a faint internal click, followed by an almost imperceptible vibration that runs through the target mechanism.

It was developed in the time of the Black Engineers to intervene in mutually incompatible systems, where opening a door did not consist in forcing it, but in understanding what it should consider valid.

Property

Access Reconfiguration (*Technomancy*) Duration: permanent (reversible)

The user activates the lock on a door, access or entry system, rewriting its opening conditions: who may pass and under what conditions.

Risk Factor

Access Loop

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the system enters into conflict and the door remains closed to everyone.

INCONGRUOUS LINK (Anacharchid)

Description

The Incongruous Link is an irregular piece of stone, similar to a deformed fragment of chain. It presents neither a symmetrical form nor a clear closure: its ends seem incompatible with each other, as if they did not belong to the same object.

When brought close to two different elements, the link adjusts to both, subtly adapting its structure until it fits them into a functional union. It does not fuse materials; it forces them to accept a relationship that was not foreseen.

It is believed to have been created by artisans who sought not perfection, but controlled rupture: systems capable of operating beyond their own limitations.

Property

Impossible Assembly (*Advanced Forging*)

The user can join two objects that ought not to be compatible, creating a functional structure out of incongruous parts in order to give it a new property based on their original properties.

Risk

Coherence Collapse

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the union produces an object with dangerous properties.

ONEIRIC NEEDLE (Oneiromancer)

Description

The Oneiric Needle is a fine, elongated tool made of red silver, of a length similar to that of a thick sewing needle. Its surface is traversed by spiralling micro-engravings that cannot be read in a linear fashion.

When it is used, contact is made not with the body, but with the immediate space of the sleeper: the needle «enters» the dream as if it were passing through an invisible surface.

These needles are believed to have been created by those who discovered that dreams are not only images, but fabrics that can be sewn, opened or altered; Oneiromancers wrapped up in clandestine activities.

Property

Oneiric Intrusion (*Decoding*)

The user uses the needle on a sleeping subject, being able to introduce a symbolic element into their dream (which will later influence their decisions) or to extract an element (which will disappear from their consciousness).

Risk Factor

Oneiric Tear

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the intervention shatters the consciousness of the one affected, who falls into a coma.

MECHANICAL PALIMPSEST (Hermeneut)

Description

The Mechanical Palimpsest is a thin rectangular plate of stone, made up of superimposed layers of engraved sheets. Each layer contains technical inscriptions that seem to correspond to different versions of the same object.

When the plate is tilted, some layers become visible and others disappear. Its edges are finished in dark bronze, and small tabs allow the sheets to be shifted slightly, altering the «reading» of the whole.

It was created on an uncomfortable premise: that no system is ever entirely erased, only written over.

Property

Operative Rereading (*Technomancy*).

The user activates the palimpsest on a device, structure or technical system, revealing its «original text» beneath the current layers of operation; restoring previous functions, earlier modes of operation...

Risk

Obsolete Reading

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the system collapses and begins to mix versions, so that it becomes impossible to distinguish the real one any longer.

SEAL OF MNEMOSYNE (Archivist)

Description

The Seal of Mnemosyne is a small octagonal matrix of smoked crystal mounted on a bronze handle, whose surface contains a weave of characters so tiny that they only become visible when the object is brought close to something that has undergone an alteration.

When pressed onto a document, artefact or object, the seal leaves no mark on its surface. Instead, it records an imprint of memory: a reference to the state that the thing possessed at the exact instant of being sealed.

The first Archivists used it to protect especially delicate pieces of the Thesaurus against degradation, manipulation or the alterations of the Veil. Its principle was simple and deliciously obsessive: to preserve does not mean to prevent something from changing, but to be able to prove what it was before it changed.

Property

Unalterable Testimony (Chronomancy)

The user applies the seal to an object, text, artefact or document, recording its imprint in order to restore the object to the exact state in which it was sealed, eliminating alterations, damage, additions or manipulations produced since then.

Risk Factor

Indiscriminate Restitution

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the seal also restores elements of its previous state that the user did not intend to recover, cancelling beneficial modifications or making alterations that had already been corrected reappear.

TUNING FORK OF LETH

Description

The Tuning Fork of Leth is a tool of perceptual calibration made from a translucent alloy of etheric silicon and filaments of refined orichalcum.

Its forked structure vibrates even at rest, emitting an inaudible frequency that adjusts itself to the cognitive pulse of whoever wields it.

Originally designed as a tuning instrument for advanced sensory interfaces, it was adapted by the engineers of the Second Iteration to intervene directly upon conscious perception.

Its resonance does not generate sound in the conventional sense, but an oscillation that breaks experience down into layers.

Property

Harmony of Dissociation (*Luminous Projection*) Duration: 2 minutes

A vibration of light induces an altered state of consciousness in whoever hears it (enemy - ally), leaving them motionless for a brief duration.

Risk Factor

Synaesthetic Saturation

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the user begins to perceive superimposed sensory layers, and it is they who are immobilised.

VERSOMETER

Description

The Versometer is a chronosemantic measuring device designed to analyse the metrical structure of events. Built from plates of white quartz and circuits of temporal reading, its core houses an oscillator capable of translating sequences of action into interpretable rhythmic patterns.

Originally conceived by the Ontological School of Primordial Languages as a tool of narrative diagnosis, the Versometer makes it possible to detect irregularities in the cadence of time and, in exceptional cases, to intervene upon them.

Its interface displays no figures, but pulses, accents and pauses.

Property

Cadence of the Threshold (*Chronomancy*) Duration: 10 seconds

On marking out a metrical structure, the lyre creates a temporal micro-loop around the user, altering the speed of time.

Risk Factor

Metric Rupture

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the sequence of time runs out of control.

ENIGMATIC SPHERE

Description

The Enigmatic Sphere is a perfect and unsettling object: an impossible polyhedron contained within a spherical area, whose inner folds constantly reorganise themselves as if solving

riddles that no one has yet posed. Its material, an amalgam of logical crystal and akashic residue, reacts to the user's intention.

When activated, the sphere imposes no physical or energy barrier, but a cognitive condition: the world itself folds around a question, suspending its resolution until someone is able to decipher it.

It was conceived as a teaching tool in the first cycles of Numinia.

Property

Incarnate Riddle (*Technomancy*)

The user activates the Sphere and poses a riddle linked to the current situation. For as long as the riddle is not solved, an action, access or advance remains blocked, or a condition remains active.

Risk Factor

Ludic Paradox

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the riddle becomes unstable or unsolvable, blocking that fragment of the adventure.

DISC OF JANUS

Description

The Disc of Janus is a floating metal disc, polished in appearance but without reflection, as if it absorbed the light on its surface. Its design changes constantly, folding in on itself at impossible angles, revealing symbols in forgotten languages that only appear when a trap is near.

The Disc of Janus has no single form, but adapts to the type of deception it perceives.

According to fragmentary accounts, it was forged by the first Mediators of the Prism to navigate the diplomatic conflicts and political traps of ancient Numinia. However, some claim it was born of an algorithmic error that gained consciousness.

Property

Gearwork Radar (*Defensive Networks*)

It detects physical traps and hidden structures in the surroundings, within a radius of about 30 metres (mechanisms, devices, sensors).

Risk Factor

Inverted Mirror

If a Critical Failure is obtained, it amplifies falsehood and risk, altering the probabilities negatively.

BEHAVIOURAL CONVERTER

Description

The Behavioural Converter is a device of functional rewriting made up of layers of programmable matter and filaments of adaptive logic. Its form is not fixed: it folds and reconfigures itself according to the type of system it interacts with, adopting interfaces that seem to anticipate the user's intention.

The Converter introduces variations into the «behaviour» of objects.

It was developed as an adjustment tool in highly reactive environments of the Veil, where modifying the structure was too costly, but reconfiguring the response proved sufficient.

Property

Dynamic Editing (*Cryptography*). Duration: permanent

It allows specific elements of the surroundings to be modified as if they were fragments of code, altering their state or behaviour in a localised way.

Risk Factor

Unstable Injection

If a Critical Failure is obtained when using the property, the modification introduces unforeseen effects into the surroundings.

SIGNAL ORACLE

Description

The Signal Oracle is a capsule of akashic interface made up of layers of neural crystal and nodes of synthetic memory.

Suspended in a containment frame, its core processes flows of information coming from the deep archive of Numinia, transforming them into complex sensory projections. It does not answer through direct language, but through symbolic constructions: superimposed images, fragmented voices, emotional atmospheres.

It was developed as a consultation system for navigators of knowledge, but its access to records makes it a tool as revealing as it is ambiguous for all kinds of adventurers.

Property

Ancestral Attunement *(Neural Vision)*

When a question is posed, the Oracle scans the akashic network and projects a relevant ancestral answer by means of images, voice and immersive sound.

Risk Factor

Hermeneutic Echo

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the answer forks into multiple contradictory versions that destroy the original content, blocking its existence.

SPEAKING CONCH

Description

The Speaking Conch is a petrified organic artefact, formed from calcified spirals impregnated with akashic residue. Its surface, pearly and slightly translucent, shows veins that change position when it is not being looked at directly, as if it recorded invisible currents of the Veil.

When held to the ear, it does not return the echo of the sea, but a succession of superimposed voices: fragments of sentences, incomplete warnings and resonances of thoughts formulated long ago.

It is said that these conches come from marine molluscs of the Ocean of Lúnacar.

Property

Mark of Anamnesis *(Neural Vision)*

Each use leaves an «echo» in the bearer, a sign that outlines or reflects past moments. These marks can grant advantages.

Risk

Anticipated Echo

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the mark manifests erroneously, reflecting events that did not happen.

EYE OF KAIROS

Description

The Eye of Kairos is an enigmatic artefact, a hollow sphere of liquid obsidian that never stays the same. Its surface cracks and recomposes itself constantly, as if it were trying to contain visions that struggle to escape.

Inside it floats a fragment of trapped light, a spark of pure knowledge that never goes out, but that can never be observed directly.

It is believed to have emerged from a fold between probable futures, where the visions of the first Pythias converged. Others maintain that it is a residual node of the Veil, where time was fractured during the collapse of the first model of Numinia.

Property

Instant of Kairos (*Chronomancy*) Duration: 1 minute

It allows time to be paused for a decisive blink, making it possible to choose, quickly, one among several immediate futures.

Risk Factor

Existential Paradox

If a Critical Failure is obtained, one falls into a temporal dissonance, where the timelines contradict one another.

DUAL COMPASS

Description

The Dual Compass is an artefact of causal navigation made up of two needles suspended in a core of magnetised stone, each oriented towards a different possibility.

Unlike conventional compasses, it does not point to spatial directions, but to vectors of consequence: one needle vibrates towards the probable, the other towards the possible.

It is believed to have been developed by cartographers of the Veil who were trying to draw maps not of the world, but of its decisions.

However, the project was abandoned when it was discovered that the compass not only read possibilities, but altered them by observing them.

Property

Double Outcome (*Virtual Architecture*)

The relic reveals two possible immediate consequences of a failed action, allowing the user to choose whichever of them they wish.

Risk Factor

Collapse of Probabilities

If a Critical Failure is obtained when using the property, the probabilities are destabilised.

DEBUGGING LANTERN

Description

The Debugging Lantern is an artefact of structural illumination designed to reveal and correct anomalies in the fabric of reality. Its casing, of sober geometry and opaque materials, contains an emitting core that projects a beam of coherent light, capable of passing through physical, digital and etheric layers simultaneously.

Created during the first attempts to stabilise areas affected by failures of the Veil, the Lantern does not distinguish between anomaly and singularity: everything that departs from the dominant structure is liable to be marked and, eventually, eliminated from the surroundings.

Its use, therefore, requires precision and judgement.

Property

Rupture Debugger (*Virtual Architecture*)

It makes it possible to stabilise areas affected by anomalies, errors or distortions, restoring the coherence of the surroundings.

Risk Factor

Collateral Erasure

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the stabilisation eliminates valid elements along with the distortion.

COMPASS OF PROCRUSTES

Description

The Compass of Procrustes is an instrument of measurement and adjustment made up of two articulated arms of old bronze, finished with steel points that pierce not matter, but its functional structure.

Its hinges, finely calibrated, do not open according to physical distances, but according to internal relationships: hierarchies, permissions, routes or dependencies.

It is believed to have been designed from ancient engineering tools adapted by Cryptologists of the Veil, obsessed with a simple and dangerous idea: that every technological structure, however complex, contains a secret margin where it can be corrected.

Property

Protocol Reading (*Cryptology*) Duration: Permanent (reversible)

The user handles the compass to span the virtual area of a complex technological system and, by analysing its natural laws, to uncover and vary its hidden operating protocols.

Risk Factor

False Convergence

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the Compass transforms incorrect patterns, breaking the system.

MASK OF EPIMETHEUS

Description

The Mask of Epimetheus is a ritual piece of uncertain origin, moulded in an opaque alloy that seems to absorb the features of whoever looks at it. Its surface is not fixed: the facial contours slide slowly, as if it were rehearsing possible identities without settling on any.

At times, for brief instants, it adopts expressions that belong to no known face, but to archetypal gestures: guilt, doubt, ambition, deceit.

It interprets the fissures that appear when the truth does not match what is shown.

It was used by mediators and judges in the first diplomatic conflicts of Numinia.

Property

Reverse of the Face (*Neural Vision*)

The relic reveals distortions in the identity of someone concealing a lie or a dishonest intention, showing the degree of falsehood.

Risk Factor

Paranoid Projection

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the relic projects falsehood where there is none.

AIONOS

Description

The Aionos is a translucent artefact, the size of a human skull, made up of layers of liquid memory crystal that constantly reconfigure themselves. Its core is in constant transformation.

Its layers of liquid crystal show fluctuating symbols, ephemeral images and holograms of ancient times. It changes according to the gaze and intention of its bearer. Perhaps forged by the Black Engineers, perhaps by the city itself.

Whatever its genesis, the Aionos is a receptacle of cultures, a seed of memory planted in the narrative fabric of Numinia so that its stories may never dissolve into the digital void.

Property

Sensory Archive (Decoding)

The Aionos allows one to relive encoded sensory experiences of ancestral cultures: gestures, rituals, emotions and forms of interaction. It makes it possible to overcome social or ritual challenges.

Risk Factor

Temporal Contamination

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the Aionos alters the coherence of the past.

BOWL OF CONSECRATION

Description

The Bowl of Interdiction is a ceremonial piece of dark ceramic, reinforced with veins of hardened resin and edged by a ring of engraved bronze. Its inner surface is covered with concentric incisions, barely perceptible, that represent cycles of delimitation: inside, outside, permitted, forbidden.

When it holds a substance and is activated by rite, the inscriptions begin to grow damp or blacken, as if they absorbed the meaning of the act.

These bowls are believed to have been used in ancient communities to declare inviolable spaces.

Property

Rite of Interdiction (*Defensive Networks*) Duration: 6 hours

The user pours a symbolic element into the bowl (water, dust, ritual blood, ash...). Reciting a brief formula, they trace a taboo space with a radius of 10 metres, which no one outside it can enter.

Risk Factor

Inversion of the Taboo

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the ritual allows people to enter, but allows no one to leave the space for 6 hours.

NEURAL HELM

Description

The Neural Helm is a closed piece forged in an alloy of polished metal, with no front opening or visor. Its surface is smooth except for a series of very fine incisions that run across the whole structure in directional patterns, as if they traced invisible routes over the helm itself.

When it is put on, the visible world disappears, but the threshold in front of the user is «activated»: lines of passage, accumulated footprints and travelled directions emerge as tensions in space.

It is said to have been developed by guardians who needed to judge those who had already crossed the gate.

Property

Threshold Memory (*Neural Vision*)

The user puts on the helm and comes into contact with a threshold. While wearing it, they perceive the traces of past transits, identifying who crossed that threshold and with what intentions.

Risk

Transit Saturation

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the user is left exposed to the perception of those who crossed that threshold.

PHASE-SHIFT CLOCK

Description

The Phase-Shift Clock is a portable mechanism of aged brass, with a dial without conventional numbering. Instead of hours, its surface shows irregular marks, grouped into segments that follow no recognisable pattern.

Its hands, thin and slightly misaligned, do not turn continuously: they advance in jumps, stop, move back slightly or vibrate in intermediate positions, as if they could not quite decide where to be.

Inside it, a system of asymmetrical gears generates an irregular pulse that measures not time, but its deviation from an expected order.

Property

Illegitimate Interval (*Chronomancy*)

The user activates the clock to displace an action or event outside its correct temporal sequence. The action is executed so that it takes effect a set time later.

Risk

Functional Paradox

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the phase-shift generates incoherences in the user's following actions.

SPECTRAL LAMP

Description

The Spectral Lamp is a portable lantern with a metal frame, built of aged brass and panels of irregular, slightly opaque glass. Its interior contains no conventional flame, but a source of whitish light that oscillates gently, as if it were breathing.

When it is off, it looks like an old object of no particular relevance. But when activated, the light it emits does not illuminate steadily: it generates the holographic image of an absent person, living or dead, who reveals details about their circumstances.

It is believed to have been created in areas where sleep and waking were not clearly separated.

Property

Oneiric Apparition (*Luminous Projection*)

The lamp's light comes on, and its glow creates the holographic image of an absent person, living or dead, who reveals details about themselves: their whereabouts, their state, their secrets...

Risk Factor

Psychogenic Fugue

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the consequences for the person who appeared can be tragic.

HYPNOGRAPHIC DISC

Description

The Hypnographic Disc is a circular plate of polished metal, the size of a hand, made up of concentric layers of brass and fine steel. Its surface is engraved with repetitive symbols that belong to no known alphabet, organised in movable rings that can be turned by hand.

At its centre, a lens of smoked glass acts as a focal point. When activated, the rings begin to align slowly, as if seeking a specific configuration, while the lens projects shadows and reflections onto the target.

The disc does not show clear images, but correspondences.

Property

Oneiric Deciphering (*Cryptology*). Duration: 2 hours (oneiric)

The user activates the disc on a subject, making them fall into a hypnotic trance. While it lasts, they can glimpse and enter the subject's dreams, gathering all the symbols.

Risk Factor

Symbolic Overreading

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the attempted intrusion is detected by the one affected.

DIPTYCH OF CONCORDANCE

Description

The Diptych of Concordance is formed by two rectangular plates joined by a side hinge, similar to a small rigid book. Each inner face is polished and slightly darkened, like a mirror that never quite reflects clearly. The surfaces are crossed by very fine veins of orichalcum that form incomplete patterns, like diagrams that only acquire meaning when both halves face each other.

When the diptych is opened, each plate «gathers» a different reference: one from the past and one from the present. What matters is not exactly what happened, but how it can be read in relation to what is happening now.

Property

Fusion of Horizons (Chronomancy)

The user activates the diptych, linking a past action and a present one. Both actions are interpreted as a single unit, generating a combined result that would not exist separately.

Risk Factor

Hermeneutic Discordance

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the past action breaks, with whatever repercussions this has on the present.

STELE OF RECONSTRUCTION

Description

The Stele of Reconstruction is a rectangular slab of pinkish stone, roughly the size of a forearm, heavy and slightly irregular at its edges. Its surface is covered by glyphs carved in bas-relief, organised in horizontal bands reminiscent of ancient scripts, although none stays fixed long enough to be memorised.

When the stele is heated, the veins dilate and contract unevenly, causing the glyphs to recombine.

These stelae are believed to have been created not to preserve memory, but to keep multiple versions of reality open, ready to be recovered.

Property

Structural Reinstantiation (Virtual Architecture) Duration: 30 minutes

The user activates the stele by applying heat. The glyphs engraved in the stone reconfigure themselves; the inscribed structure is instantiated over the current surroundings, and the space reconstructs an earlier version (some ruins, a building).

Risk Factor

Irreversible Inscription

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the stele is permanently trapped between two records.

TREATISE OF MODELLING

Description

The Treatise of Modelling is an ancient volume bound in dark leather, with a great eye engraved on the cover whose pupil follows the observer as they move in front of it.

Its pages contain diagrams, figures and geometric relationships that change slowly while they are observed and whose interpretation demands knowledge of Oneiromancy.

They do not describe reality as it is, but different ways of relating to it.

On its first page appears a single warning: «*Do not model the world; model the relationship you have with what you believe the world to be*».

Property

Reality Modelling (Decoding)

The user interprets one of the Treatise's diagrams to introduce a nuance into an existing situation, altering the relationship between some of its elements: an NPC's perception, the circumstantial meaning of an object, a spatial arrangement...

Risk Factor

Inversion of the Model

If a Critical Failure is obtained, the modelling is projected onto the user themselves and alters, to their detriment, their relationship with reality in accordance with the nature of the intended effect.

WEAPONS

LECTURA

"It was not his. He had not forged it. But, as he gripped it, something in the world shifted position."

In Numinia, a weapon is not a mere tool for dealing damage. The entities that take part in a confrontation are forms sustained by bonds, patterns, behaviours and manifestations that the characters must interpret and intervene. For this reason, weapons have no attack or

damage values: they are instruments that widen the possibilities of intervention of whoever wields them.

To carry a weapon is to declare a way of acting upon the conflict. A blade can cut that which does not normally admit an edge; a chain can establish a hold between two forms; a projectile can reach that which does not allow itself to be approached; a hammer can impose stability upon a shifting structure.

The weapon does not determine what the character can do. It determines what additional possibilities are offered by the tool they have chosen to carry with them.

Weapons and anchors

Weapons can make it easier to intervene certain anchors, but they are neither specialisations nor requirements for intervening them. This distinction is fundamental.

A character can act upon any anchor for which they find an intervention coherent with the fiction, whether or not they have a weapon. If a creature is bound to a structure, for example, the characters might try to destroy it, move it, deactivate it, modify its meaning, trick the creature into moving away from it or find any other solution justified by what is happening in the scene. The system admits different interpretations as long as they rest on what has been described and do not contradict the fiction. A weapon provides one more possibility.

It can make a particular intervention especially viable, allow it to be carried out in a way that would be difficult without it or modify the conditions under which it can be performed. It never turns that intervention into the only possible solution.

Therefore, weapons do not grant additional dice by themselves. The pool continues to be built as usual: 1D6 base and +1D6 for each intervened anchor. If the use of a weapon makes it possible to intervene an anchor coherently, that anchor will contribute its die like any other intervened anchor. The die comes from the anchor, not from the weapon.

In other words: weapons do not increase the capacity to win a confrontation; they widen the ways in which a character can intervene in it.

Intervention

Each weapon has an Intervention, which expresses what it allows its wielder to do particularly effectively within the fiction.

An Intervention may allow one to reach a distant manifestation, hold a form that is hard to contain, act upon etheric matter, pierce a certain protection, modify a position or carry out any other operation coherent with the nature of the weapon.

The Intervention does not work as an automatic bonus, nor does it restrict the actions of those who do not possess the weapon. A character without it can intervene the same anchor using another strategy if the fiction allows it.

For example, a weapon capable of affecting etheric forms might make it possible to cut directly the bond that sustains a creature. That does not mean that this bond can only be intervened with that weapon: another character might try to close its origin, alter the ritual that maintains it, move whatever it is attached to or find any other valid solution. The weapon offers a path; it does not close off the others.

Effect

In addition to its Intervention, each weapon has its own Effect, which expresses the particular mark it leaves upon whatever it intervenes.

When the character uses the weapon as part of their action and the Confrontation Roll obtains a Success, the declared objective is achieved and the weapon's Effect is also applied, provided it is coherent with the action performed.

Nor does the Effect replace the declared objective. It accompanies it. If the character uses a weapon whose property allows them to temporarily fix in place whatever it acts upon, and declares as their objective to drive a creature away from a certain place, the Success achieves that objective and, when the fiction allows it, the weapon's property also introduces its fixing effect.

Total Success keeps its usual function: it represents an exceptionally favourable result and may provide additional benefits at the GD's discretion. The ordinary effect of the weapon, however, forms part of any Success.

Weapons as an aid

Weapons must never be designed as predetermined solutions for specific creatures or anchors.

There are no «necessary weapons» for defeating a type of contender, nor closed correspondences between a weapon and an anchor. A creature vulnerable to certain conditions may be affected by a weapon that exploits them, but also by any other intervention the players are able to justify.

This is especially important because anchors are not answers the players must guess, but elements of the fiction that may admit several interpretations and interventions. The weapon must encourage creativity, not replace it.

For this reason, a good Intervention is usually expressed through a broad capacity, and not through a closed condition such as «+1D6 against creatures bound to the Akasha».

The first opens up possibilities. The second manufactures a specialisation.

The agitating power

Weapons also possess a characteristic that sets them apart from the other objects in the Inventory: their agitating power.

A weapon does not remain passive when it is carried. Its nature imprints a certain tension upon the Veil and upon the presence of whoever bears it. The more weapons remained simultaneously bound to the same character, the greater the interference between their different impulses of intervention would be.

For this reason, a PC can only carry one weapon with them.

This does not mean they can only own one. The character can keep other weapons in their Reserve and replace the one they carry when they have access to it and circumstances allow the change to be made. The limitation applies exclusively to the weapon they keep with them during their journeys and adventures.

The choice, therefore, matters, but it does not turn the character into a specialist in that weapon. Choosing one does not mean renouncing certain kinds of anchors or being left helpless before certain creatures. It means deciding which additional possibility of intervention they wish to carry with them. The Reserve keeps the other possibilities for another moment.

Structure of weapons

Each weapon is defined by three elements:

- Description: nature, appearance, provenance and meaning of the weapon.
- Intervention: the particular possibility it offers the character to act upon the fiction and the anchors.
- Effect: the characteristic consequence that accompanies the declared objective when the weapon takes part in a confrontation roll resolved with a Success.

Thus, two weapons are no longer distinguished because one deals more damage than another. They are distinguished because they allow the confrontation to be thought of in different ways.

A sword, a chain and a projectile weapon can all serve to overcome the same contender. None necessarily has a mathematical advantage over the others. What changes is the repertoire of actions each one places within the player's reach.

And this last sentence, it seems to me, could close the section very well:

In Numinia, choosing a weapon does not mean choosing how to deal damage. It means choosing what kind of possibility you want to hold in your hand.

MNEMONIC ECLIPSE

Description

A quantum dagger with a partially ethereal edge, whose blade vibrates between states of reality and memory. It gives off a faint lapis-lazuli light and, as it moves, it seems for an instant to pass through the image of things before reaching their matter. It was forged by the Heresiarchs to intervene bonds that do not always have a physical manifestation.

Intervention

Semantic incision

The Mnemonic Eclipse can cut or separate elements of a symbolic, mnemonic or partially ethereal nature when these have a perceptible manifestation. This allows it to be used to intervene bonds, connections or structures that a conventional weapon could hardly reach.

Effect

Discontinuity

When it takes part in a Success against a contender, the cut introduces a momentary discontinuity into some manifestation coherent with the intervention performed: it may interrupt an active ability, temporarily break a connection or cause a brief loss of continuity in whatever has been acted upon.

LIQUID NEMESIS

Description

A whip made of a dark non-Newtonian fluid that alternates between solid and liquid states to the rhythm of its bearer's pulse. At rest it takes the form of a suspended sphere; when activated, it unfurls into long filaments capable of branching, curling around obstacles and suddenly solidifying around whatever they reach.

Intervention

Constriction

The Liquid Nemesis allows intervention by means of holding, binding or immobilisation, adapting its form to very different bodies and structures. Its filaments can also divide to establish several points of contact simultaneously when these form part of the same intervention.

Effect

Sentence

When it takes part in a Success, the Nemesis can remain solidified around whatever it has intervened, temporarily maintaining the hold or bond established for as long as the fiction allows it to be kept.

WANDERING TEARS

Description

A set of eight ethereal projectiles resembling small crystalline seeds. Once thrown, they vanish from ordinary perception and travel along improbable trajectories before reappearing near their destination. They do not fly in a straight line: they seem to move according to an invisible geometry that runs through the space of Numinia.

Intervention

Improbable trajectory

The Tears allow intervention at a distance upon targets or manifestations protected by positions, obstacles or trajectories that would make them hard to reach directly. They can curve around cover, approach from unexpected angles or spread out through space when several points form part of the same intervention.

Effect

Resonance

When they take part in a Success, one Tear can remain temporarily bound to the element struck. While that resonance persists, its movements or alterations leave a perceptible trail that makes it easier to follow its position and recognise the changes it undergoes.

EDGE OF ATLAS

Description

A colossal axe with a prismatic blade crossed by luminous cracks that emit gravitational pulses. Its haft responds to the bearer's movement, and each impact alters for a few moments the apparent weight of everything nearby. Its enormous mass is deceptive: a good part of it does not reside in the weapon, but in the gravitational field it concentrates around the blade.

Intervention

Gravitational imposition

The Edge of Atlas allows intervention upon positions, movements and structures by means of localised alterations of gravity. It can push, knock down, draw in, increase the weight of an element or hinder movements when these actions make it possible to intervene the anchors of the scene coherently.

Effect

Reality anchor

When it takes part in a Success, the bearer can leave part of their gravitational alteration temporarily concentrated upon the intervened element, making it harder for it to change position or causing it to be violently displaced while it remains subject to it.

FRAGMENT OF KHAOS

Description

The Fragment of Khaos can scarcely be considered a sword. It is a rift suspended around a hilt, a narrow discontinuity whose position seems to oscillate between incompatible states. It is practically weightless, and its edge, lined with sharp teeth that give it the look of a saw, never quite coincides with the place where it seems to be.

Intervention

Paradox

The Fragment allows intervention upon elements whose stability depends on maintaining a single position, state or relation, momentarily introducing a contradiction between two possibilities compatible with the scene. It can strike from unexpected positions, interfere with a spatial separation or make a structure waver between two neighbouring configurations.

Effect

Paradoxical echo

When it takes part in a Success, the contradiction leaves a temporary echo upon whatever has been intervened. For a few moments, an action, position or manifestation related to the intervention may present a minor repetition, inversion or offset favourable to the declared objective.

VORTEX OF RUIN

Description

Two large blades built into a pair of ancient greaves, like metal wings folded around the legs. They are not wielded: they respond to their bearer's movement and unfold their edges as the bearer gathers speed. They were conceived to turn continuous movement into a form of intervention.

Intervention

Inertia

The Vortex allows intervention by means of rapid movements, trajectories and changes of position, using the bearer's own movement as part of the action. It is especially useful for crossing threatened spaces, altering spatial arrangements or acting upon elements whose intervention requires moving quickly in and out of their vicinity.

Effect

Kinetic continuity

When it takes part in a Success, the impetus of the action is not immediately extinguished. The bearer can complete their movement by repositioning at another point coherent with the trajectory followed, without necessarily remaining in the place where the intervention took place.

JAW OF THE SUN

Description

A double-headed mace forged of black metal around a core of reddish sunstone that crackles constantly from within. It has no edge and requires no precision: it concentrates its power on a single point and transmits the impact into the surrounding matter. When it strikes a surface, a reddish pulse seems to spread briefly through its structure.

Intervention

Basal fracture

The Jaw allows intervention upon material structures by acting on their supports, foundations, joints or points of force transmission. It does not need to reach directly whatever it is meant to affect if there is a physical continuity capable of carrying the impact to it.

Effect

Rupture wave

When it takes part in a Success, the transmitted force can spread around the intervened point and also alter elements immediately related to it: opening a crack, displacing whatever rests on top, breaking a joint or destabilising a nearby structure, provided this is coherent with the intervention.

WANDERING WALL

Description

A monumental piece halfway between an archaic shield and an edgeless greatsword, covered in tectonic runes that light up when it receives an outside force. Its enormous mass means it must be handled with both hands. It was conceived not to pierce whatever it meets in front of it, but to withstand it until it can turn the accumulated pressure back against the surroundings.

Intervention

Resistance

The Wandering Wall allows intervention by means of blocking, containment and physical opposition. It can temporarily hold back elements that advance, collapse, press or try to pass through a position, giving the bearer a tool for acting upon anchors related to forces, access points, movements or structures in motion.

Effect

Pressure reversal

When it takes part in a Success, the Wall can return part of the force it has just contained, transforming the resistance into displacement or pressure against whatever gave rise to it. The more clearly there is a prior force to oppose, the more evident this reversal becomes within the fiction.

BEACON OF ANTIGONE

Description

A polearm topped by a bronze cage containing a photosensitive quartz prism. When activated, the prism projects a narrow beam of white light that illuminates not so much surfaces as the differences between them. Hidden outlines, transparencies and alterations of the surroundings take on a sharp shadow for a few moments. It can be used as a spear, though its true usefulness lies in directing its light.

Intervention

Exposure

The Beacon of Antigone allows intervention by making manifest that which depends on remaining hidden, blended into its surroundings or hard to locate. Its beam can outline invisible forms, reveal discontinuities, point out barely perceptible movements or delimit the presence of something whose position is uncertain.

Effect

Luminous persistence

When it takes part in a Success, whatever the Beacon has managed to expose temporarily keeps a visible halo. Even if it changes position, tries to hide or recovers the condition that made it hard to perceive, it remains marked while the luminous trace persists.

BRONZE CHOIR

Description

A weapon resembling a short crossbow, though it has neither string nor bolts. Along its body are set seven metal plates of different lengths that vibrate when the mechanism is triggered. The vibration gathers at the muzzle of the weapon and is released as a directional acoustic pulse, heard first as a dry blow and then as a succession of ever-deeper echoes.

Intervention

Resonant propagation

The Bronze Choir allows intervention by means of vibrations transmitted through bodies, surfaces and connected spaces. The bearer can send a disturbance along a structure, locate connected elements by resonance or act upon several points when all of them share the same medium of propagation.

Effect

Reverberation

When it takes part in a Success, the pulse continues for a few moments to travel through whatever it has passed through. The vibration can betray connections, cause related elements to respond to one another or make perceptible the extent of a structure that was initially only partly known.

SWORD OF HYPATIA

Description

A long, extraordinarily thin stiletto, built around a rod of dark crystal enclosed between two metal plates. A series of movable rings runs along its hilt and aligns itself whenever the

point draws near a seam, opening or point of articulation. The Sword was not conceived to exert force, but to apply it exactly where a minimal amount suffices.

Intervention

Selective puncture

The Sword of Hypatia allows intervention with enormous precision upon small elements, protected ones or ones closely integrated into larger structures. It can reach seams, mechanisms, joints, conduits, locks or specific points without significantly altering whatever surrounds them.

Effect

Isolation

When it takes part in a Success, the intervention remains confined to the chosen element and reduces the consequences for whatever surrounds it. This makes it possible to separate, free, block or alter a specific piece while preserving, when the fiction allows it, the integrity of the whole to which it belongs.

BASTION OF CERBERUS

Description

A short staff of white metal ending in three facing dog heads. When activated, the heads draw a few centimetres apart and unfold a translucent film between them. When the weapon strikes a surface or traces a line, that film extends for a few moments, forming a rigid, almost invisible plane, like a sheet of glass suspended in space.

Intervention

Partition

The Bastion of Cerberus allows intervention by introducing a temporary physical separation between nearby elements. It can close a passage, divide a space, stand between two elements that need to remain in contact or establish a barrier from which to modify the layout of a scene.

Effect

Closure

When it takes part in a Success, the partition created remains for a time after the action has concluded. While it holds, the separated elements cannot immediately regain contact or

their previous position without overcoming, getting around or removing the barrier through a new coherent action.

TOKENS

Numinia does not remain indifferent to those who inhabit it.

As a character explores the city, discovers its secrets, interprets its symbols or establishes bonds with the forces at work within it, their relationship with Numinia changes. But that relationship is not confined to the character's memory or to the consequences of their decisions. In certain circumstances, the city itself recognises it and grants it a form.

These manifestations are called Tokens.

Tokens are primotechnic objects that materialise aspects of the relationship between an individual and Numinia. They can be kept, accumulated and used within certain progression systems, but reducing them to a unit of exchange would be to confuse their function with their meaning. A Token has value precisely because something has happened beforehand that made its appearance possible. They do not represent wealth. They represent a bond.

For this reason, obtaining a Token is always a form of recognition. Numinia responds to something the character has understood, investigated, interpreted or chosen, and transforms that intangible relationship into an object that can be added to the Inventory. Progression thus ceases to be exclusively numerical: what the character learns and that with which they establish affinity acquire a material presence within the world itself.

There are two great classes of Tokens: the Seeds of Knowledge and the Prism Cells. Both reflect the character's relationship with Numinia, although they do so from different perspectives.

The Seeds respond to knowledge: they express how much the character has discovered, understood or contributed to the city's imaginary.

The Cells respond to affinity: they express with which currents of thought and factions the character has established a significant resonance.

In a certain sense, the former speak of what Numinia has allowed the character to understand; the latter, of the way in which the character has decided to understand Numinia.

The way in which these Tokens manifest in Numinia is connected with the energy of the Veil when, intervening in the spectrum of the Threshold, it seems to take on the form of magic: while the Seeds of Knowledge appear spontaneously in the PC's path when they acquire knowledge or learn something new that proves relevant, the Prism Cells are found like treasures in lonely, mysterious, hidden or abandoned places. It will therefore be the GD who

decides the moment at which these Tokens are offered to the PCs over the course of the game.

SEEDS OF KNOWLEDGE

The Seeds of Knowledge are physical manifestations of the bond established between a character and Numinia through discovery, investigation and creation.

They appear when the character's relationship with the world is significantly enriched: on discovering an element of its history, understanding a custom or institution, correctly interpreting a symbol, investigating an event of the past, or producing a coherent idea, text or interpretation that expands the Numinian imaginary.

They are not, therefore, automatic rewards for completing adventures. The GD grants them when they consider that a true act of knowledge has taken place. Nevertheless, the player may convert them into Prestige Points.

This also includes the player's attitude. Consulting documents, asking questions about the world, investigating apparently secondary elements, establishing relationships between scattered pieces of information or developing contributions compatible with Numinia are all legitimate ways of cultivating a Seed.

The principle is simple: Numinia rewards curiosity exercised, not information passively received.

Morphology of the Seeds

The Seeds look like large geodesic pods ending in a point. Their surfaces seem to be made up of small mineral facets, and from within them emanate luminescences whose intensity and colour depend on the relevance of the knowledge they contain.

Not all understandings carry the same weight. For this reason there are five classes of Seeds:

TABLA 6.1

SEED	VALUE
<i>Green</i>	1 Prestige point
<i>Blue</i>	2 Prestige points
<i>Silver</i>	3 Prestige points
<i>Golden</i>	4 Prestige points
<i>Red</i>	5 Prestige points

The GD determines which Seed corresponds to each discovery according to its depth, difficulty and importance.

Understanding a minor cultural document might generate a Green Seed; reconstructing a complex tradition or discovering relevant information about an ancient order might manifest as a Blue or Silver Seed; an exceptional discovery about Numinia or a contribution that significantly expands its imaginary might produce a Golden or Red Seed.

The colour does not measure only how much the character knows. It expresses how much their relationship with Numinia has changed as a consequence of knowing it.

Seeds and Prestige

Each Seed obtained increases the character's Prestige according to its value.

However, Seeds and Prestige are not exactly the same thing. Prestige represents the cultural baggage accumulated by the character throughout their whole trajectory: everything they have come to understand, discover and contribute to Numinia. For this reason, once acquired, Prestige is never lost.

The Seeds represent something different: they are the part of that knowledge that still retains a potential for transformation.

A character can consume them to turn what they have learned into personal growth. When they do so, the Seeds disappear, but the Prestige they produced remains: the knowledge may have been assimilated and transformed into ability, but having acquired it remains part of the character's history.

Using the Seeds

The Seeds of Knowledge can be consumed to improve the character. To meet a cost, Seeds of different colours can be combined until the necessary value is reached. Below is the Prestige Table, which indicates the points needed to establish the different improvements on the PC Sheet.

TABLA 6.2

IMPROVEMENT	COST
<i>Raise a Competence by one level</i>	50 points
<i>Raise a Special Aptitude by one level</i>	100 points
<i>Raise a Characteristic by one level</i>	200 points
<i>Learn a new Competence</i>	500 points
<i>Learn a new Special Aptitude</i>	1000 points

There are therefore two different quantities worth recording. Total Prestige gathers all the knowledge accumulated over the character's trajectory; the value of the available Seeds indicates how much of that knowledge still remains available to be transformed into new abilities.

The role of the GD

The Seed system turns the GD into something more than the person in charge of handing out rewards. Their function consists in sowing opportunities to get to know Numinia.

A forgotten inscription, an apparently trivial custom, a conversation with a Chronicler, a historical contradiction or a document found in an archive can acquire as much importance as an obstacle overcome during an adventure.

The GD must encourage curiosity, offer possibilities for investigation and recognise those occasions on which the players do not merely travel through Numinia, but try to understand it.

Because Numinia is not only the place where adventures happen. Getting to know it is also part of the adventure.

PRISM CELLS

If the Seeds of Knowledge materialise what a character has come to understand, the Prism Cells express something more intimate: that with which they have begun to resonate.

They are small, spherical, watery nodes in which the energy of the Prism condenses around a factional affinity. This means that there are four types of Prism Cells, each associated with one of the Factions of Numinia. They appear linked to challenges, rites, events and interpretive actions related to a particular faction, following the rhythms of the Cycle of the Prism. Likewise, each type of Cell has a special symbolism.

A Cell does not certify that the character has learned something about a faction. It records that, at some significant moment, their way of acting or of interpreting the world has coincided with it.

Collecting a Cell means that Numinia has recognised that resonance.

Morphology of the Cells

The Prism Cells have a circular shape and a luminous surface crossed by regular pulsations. At their centre appears the engraved emblem of the corresponding faction, turned into a small shining core around which the light seems to refract.

Each class displays the colour associated with its faction:

TABLA 6.3

FACTION	COLOUR
<i>Hermeticists</i>	Pink
<i>Heirs of Eleusis</i>	Violet
<i>Stellar Circle</i>	Brown
<i>Neo-Atlantists</i>	Yellow

These colours are deliberately different from those corresponding to the Guilds. A character's initial training and the affinities they develop over the course of their existence need not lead them down the same path.

Furthermore, it points to an essential fact: a PC can only use Cells that belong to their own Faction, whatever use they put them to.

Nature and function

The Prism Cells are fungible, accumulable Tokens. Those belonging to the same faction have no individual identity: what matters is not which specific Cell the character keeps, but how many manifestations of that affinity they have gathered.

Each Cell increases the degree of connection with the corresponding faction and serves as a measure of the character's recognition, experience and affinity within it. Their accumulation can provide progressive access to content, abilities, relationships or narrative possibilities linked to that factional sphere.

The Prism Cells are fungible, accumulable and consumable Tokens. Those belonging to the same faction have no individual identity: each one represents a unit of resonance that the character has established with that particular current of the Prism.

Unlike the Prestige associated with the Seeds of Knowledge, the Cells do not constitute a permanent record. They can be spent. When this happens, the symbolic energy they contain is released and the Cell disappears, transforming the accumulated affinity into an immediate effect.

In this way, the Cells introduce a constant decision between keeping resonance or using it. Accumulating them provides a larger reserve for future situations; consuming them allows one to intervene in present circumstances that might otherwise be much harder to alter.

A Prism Cell can be used in three ways.

Removing States

Cells can be used to remove States affecting the PC ¹⁶.

By consuming the necessary Cells, the character releases the resonance contained within them to restore the balance altered by the State. The Cells used disappear and the corresponding State ceases to affect the character.

This function turns the Cells into a reserve for recovery, but not into a conventional form of healing. The character is not repairing an amount of damage: they are drawing on their bond with certain currents of Numinia to rid themselves of an alteration that has clung to them.

Raising the degree of a Roll

After learning the result of a Roll, the player may consume Prism Cells to raise its result by one or more degrees.

Each Cell consumed allows the result to rise one degree:

Critical Failure → Failure → Success → Total Success

Therefore, turning a Critical Failure into a Failure requires one Cell; turning it directly into a Success requires two; and transforming it into a Total Success demands three. In the same way, a Failure can be turned into a Success with one Cell or into a Total Success with two.

The Cells do not modify the dice obtained, nor do they require the Roll to be repeated. They act directly on its final degree, once the result is known.

This ability expresses their nature with particular clarity: the character consumes part of the resonance accumulated with the Prism to alter the immediate outcome of an action. It does not change what they tried to do; it changes the extent to which Numinia allows that intention to come to fruition.

Currency on the Black Market

There is a third use of the Cells, rather less orthodox and, as tends to happen with less orthodox things, someone has found a way to turn it into a business.

The Prism Cells can be used as currency on the Numinia Black Market, especially to acquire goods that do not circulate through ordinary channels.

Among them are the Residues, objects originating from past technologies that have been left outside the current systems of production and exchange; the Rarities, objects whose eccentric or anomalous properties have caused their circulation to be forbidden; and other goods, artefacts or services which, because of their origin, nature or restrictions, normally remain beyond the reach of the PCs.

Their clandestine value does not come solely from their scarcity. A Cell contains a tangible portion of resonance with the Prism and therefore possesses properties that certain merchants, collectors and clandestine operators consider far more interesting than any conventional monetary unit.

16 · For more information on how to remove States with Prism Cells, see the section on PC States in Chapter 4, *Game System* .

The price of whatever can be acquired with Cells will depend on its nature and availability, and will be determined by the GD.

Spending affinity

The three possibilities share the same principle: using a Cell means consuming it.

A Cell used to remove a State, modify the degree of a Roll or carry out an exchange disappears from the character's reserve. The affinity it represented has been converted into something else: recovery, opportunity or acquisition.

This profoundly distinguishes the Prism Cells from the Seeds of Knowledge. The knowledge acquired leaves a permanent mark in the form of Prestige, even if the Seeds are later used; the Cells, on the other hand, represent an available resonance, a relationship with the Prism that can be accumulated but also exhausted through use.

The player must therefore decide when it is worth consuming them. A Cell spent today to turn a Failure into a Success may be the one that tomorrow would have removed a State; three Cells used to achieve a Total Success might have served to acquire a hard-to-find Rarity.

Thus the Cells not only record a relationship with Numinia: they allow part of that accumulated relationship to be sacrificed in order to intervene in it.

There is a phrase from the original document that now acquires even more meaning: «*To collect it is not to take: it is to resonate*». I would add to it, as a complementary mechanical principle:

To collect a Cell is to accumulate resonance. To spend it is to turn that resonance into possibility.

The Prism and affinity

The Cells express one of the fundamental principles of Numinian knowledge: no single gaze, by itself, exhausts what it contemplates.

The same light, passing through a prism, produces different colours. In the same way, the Factions articulate different perspectives on Numinia, and each Cell records the character's approach towards one of them.

Thus, although a PC may accumulate Prism Cells from different Factions, they can only use those belonging to their own Faction, and this is what represents their relationship with Numinia. They are free to do whatever they wish with the Cells of other Factions: give them away, exchange them, sell them...

That is why their meaning does not lie solely in accumulating them. A collection of Cells also constitutes a kind of ideological cartography of the character: it allows one to observe which interpretations they have frequented, which they have reinforced, and what relationships they have established with the different ways of contemplating the city.

The Seeds and the Cells end up describing two complementary dimensions of a single trajectory. Prestige tells how much you have come to know Numinia; the Prism Cells show which Numinia you are looking at.

RARITIES AND ANOMALIES

Not everything that deserves a place in the Inventory was created to become a Relic.

Numinia is built upon successive layers of knowledge, technology and experimentation. Some prospered; others were abandoned. There are machines that stopped being manufactured because better ones appeared, instruments belonging to technical systems

that have since vanished, and prototypes whose workings never came to be incorporated into the ordinary life of the city. Many of them still exist.

These objects may be found in forgotten depots, institutional storehouses, old closed museums, disused reserves and buildings that kept part of their contents after losing their original function. In the periphery they also turn up among ruins, sealed chambers and abandoned settlements, where a patient labour of domestic archaeology can prove considerably more profitable than certain university studies, and considerably worse for one's clothes.

Others come from less innocent places: clandestine laboratories, cancelled research programmes, restricted facilities or experiments that never received authorisation to leave their test chambers.

All of them are grouped into two great categories: Residues and Proscribed.

Residues are old technologies that have fallen out of use. They belong to earlier stages of Numinia's technical development and preserve a characteristic materiality: precision mechanisms, valves, lenses, cylinders, needles, diaphragms, coils, pressure chambers and complex assemblies of metal, glass and minerals. They are not necessarily inferior to present-day technologies. Some performed extraordinarily well functions that later ceased to be considered necessary.

The Proscribed, by contrast, are experimental technologies. Some were prototypes; others come from secret or forbidden research; a few perhaps worked too well. Their ordinary circulation is restricted precisely because their properties prove eccentric, unpredictable or difficult to fit within the technological norms of the city.

Residues and Proscribed can be acquired in the Black Market ¹⁷—especially when someone possesses enough Prism Cells to make commercial morality flexible—, but they do not depend on it. They can be found during an adventure, recovered from a facility, discovered while exploring the periphery, received as payment or constitute in themselves the object of an investigation.

For the purposes of the Inventory, both count as Relics. A PC can carry a maximum of three objects among Relics, Residues and Proscribed, in any combination. The rest must remain in their Reserve.

¹⁷ · For the workings and prices of the Black Market, see the annex to Chapter 5, *Geography and Culture of Numinia*

Like Relics, each one possesses a Property associated with a Competence and a Risk Factor. Their difference is not mechanical, but historical and technological: a Relic has a singular and symbolic character; a Residue is the survival of a displaced technology; a Proscribed object is the vestige of a technology that perhaps should never have left the laboratory.

RESIDUES

BRONZE LUNG Description A small portable respirator composed of a dark leather mask, two cylindrical copper filters and a folding bellows that slowly contracts as one breathes. It was used by explorers and by workers in facilities where the air could become saturated with particles from old industrial processes. **Property** Pneumatic purge (*Advanced Forging*) The user activates the filters and breathes through the mechanism for a few minutes. The system extracts interferences and residues incorporated into their manifestation, allowing them to remove the *Contaminated* state. **Risk Factor** Return of impurities If a Critical Failure is obtained, the saturated filters expel part of their contents and aggravate the exposure, possibly creating a new State.

CONVERGENCE DIAPHRAGM Description A pair of old spectacles with an articulated frame and six small superimposed lenses. By means of tiny cogwheels, the user can shift each lens until several slightly different images of the same surroundings coincide, achieving a point of perceptual convergence. **Property** Perceptual convergence (*Decoding*) The user calibrates the lenses until the different perceptions interfering with their judgement are set in order, allowing them to remove the *Confused* state. **Risk Factor** Cognitive parallax If a Critical Failure is obtained, the images stop coinciding and the user begins to attribute the wrong depth and position to everything they observe, possibly creating another State.

FARADAY REGULATOR Description A wide belt of hardened leather run through with copper coils and small ceramic regulators. It was formerly used by operators who worked near high-powered engines to discharge the tensions accumulated in the body after a day's work. **Property** Somatic stabilisation (*Cryptology*) The coils redistribute physical tensions and temporarily correct misalignments between movement, balance and bodily response, removing the *Destabilised* state.

Risk Factor Reflex discharge If a Critical Failure is obtained, the accumulated energy is released abruptly through the user's musculature.

MERIDIAN CHRONOMETER Description A mechanical pocket watch with three concentric dials and an independent hand that turns in the opposite direction to the others. It once served to synchronise work crews labouring in facilities subject to small temporal deviations. **Property** Phase readjustment (*Chronomancy*) For a few moments, the user matches their breathing and movements to the hands of the device, recovering their correspondence with immediate time and removing the *Desynchronised* state. **Risk Factor** Lost second If a Critical Failure is obtained, the watch establishes an incorrect reference and the user loses the correspondence between intention and movement, possibly creating another State.

POCKET ANCHOR Description A heavy brass cylinder the size of a fist, fitted with three retractable legs and a plumb bob of black crystal. The old surveyors used it to fix stable references during measurements carried out in regions affected by anomalies of the Veil. **Property** Local reference (*Virtual Architecture*) When deployed on a firm surface, it

establishes a stable point in relation to which the user can rebuild their immediate relationship with the surroundings, allowing them to remove the *Unanchored* state. **Risk Factor** False reference If a Critical Failure is obtained, the device fixes as stable a relationship that is not, and disorients the user even further, possibly creating another State.

VIGIL ACCUMULATOR Description A small metal flask containing two chambers separated by a mica membrane. When its lever is worked, both substances mix and produce an acrid vapour that is inhaled through a short tube. It was common among watchmen, machinists and workers on long shifts. **Property** Reactivation (*Advanced Forging*). The vapour simultaneously stimulates bodily drive and attention, removing the *Exhausted* state. **Risk Factor** Deferred exhaustion If a Critical Failure is obtained, the organism responds with an excessive activation followed by a deep dejection, possibly creating another State.

PENUMBRA SEXTANT Description A navigation instrument made up of a bronze arc, a blackened mirror and a movable lens. It does not use stars: it compares shadows. It was used to find one's bearings in zones where landmarks frequently disappeared, since the Ocean of Lúnacar hides great shifting areas. **Property** Threshold triangulation (*Virtual Architecture*). The user can determine their position and direction in relation to three visible references, even when the surroundings present spatial alterations or lack an evident orientation. **Risk Factor** False meridian If a Critical Failure is obtained, the instrument establishes an orientation that is perfectly consistent and completely wrong.

RESCUE PHONOGRAPH Description A small portable phonograph with a folding horn and interchangeable wax cylinders. The old exploration teams recorded instructions, names, routes and messages on them before entering places where they might suffer alterations of memory, in order to keep a record of their own memory. **Property** External memory (*Cryptology*). It allows a brief sequence of information to be recorded beforehand and played back later as a reliable reference. The recording does not return lost memories, but it can provide the character with information they chose to entrust to the device before losing it for whatever reason. **Risk Factor** Crossed groove If a Critical Failure is obtained, the cylinder mixes fragments of different recordings and it becomes impossible to determine which belong to the current record.

UNIVERSAL PRESSURE WRENCH Description A heavy steel tool with articulated jaws, small pressure gauges and a pneumatic chamber housed in the handle. It was designed as a safeguard for the maintenance and safety of pipes, boilers and mechanisms belonging to incompatible systems. **Property** Mechanical adjustment (*Defensive Networks*). The wrench can temporarily adapt itself to a joint, valve, lock or physical mechanism in order to open it, close it, release pressure or restore its basic functioning, even if its original system is unknown. **Risk Factor** Overpressure If a Critical Failure is obtained, the mechanism being worked on violently releases the accumulated tension, possibly destroying the very fitting being worked on.

COLD SALTS LANTERN **Description** A cylindrical copper lantern whose reservoir contains a mixture of luminescent salts. It produces a bluish, even, heatless light that passes through mists and vapours better than modern sources of ordinary lighting. **Property** Residual contrast (Luminous Projection) When it illuminates a surface, it makes recent physical traces visible for a few minutes: footprints, fluids, scuffs, displacements and residues that would normally go unnoticed. **Risk Factor** Saturation If a Critical Failure is obtained, the luminescence reacts with too many residues simultaneously and covers the surroundings with hostile signals.

PROSCRIBED

COHERENCE MIRROR **Description** A small oval mirror whose surface does not return a continuous image. The reflection appears divided into several sections that react with a slight delay to the observer's movements. It comes from an experimental programme intended to study the continuity of identity under intense exposure to the Veil. **Property** Specular reintegration (Decoding) The user must hold their gaze upon their reflection until all of their images act simultaneously once more. When they succeed, they remove the *Fragmented* state. **Risk Factor** Autonomous reflection If a Critical Failure is rolled, one of the images stops imitating the user and begins to perform gestures of its own, possibly creating another State.

WHITE VOID CHAMBER **Description** A device the size of a canteen, formed by a ceramic capsule and a circular opening surrounded by luminous indicators. When applied to an area of the body, for a few seconds it generates a void that absorbs not matter, but interference. **Property** Contamination extraction (Technomancy) The Chamber separates from the user a foreign presence or residue recently incorporated into their manifestation, allowing them to remove the *Contaminated* state. **Risk Factor** Excessive extraction If a Critical Failure is rolled, the device fails to distinguish correctly between interference and the user's own structure and also extracts something belonging to the user, possibly creating another State.

ARIADNE'S DIADEM **Description** An incomplete hoop of black ceramic threaded with luminous filaments that converge upon the temples. It was designed to order simultaneously large quantities of contradictory information during experiments in collective interpretation. **Property** Cognitive hierarchisation (Neural Vision) The Diadem separates signal, memory, inference and noise, making it possible to remove the *Confused* state or to analyse an especially complex accumulation of information. **Risk Factor** Spurious certainty If a Critical Failure is rolled, the apparatus orders the information perfectly around a false premise that the user perceives as beyond doubt, possibly creating another State.

ANCHORING VECTOR **Description** Three triangular pieces of white metal that float around the bearer when activated. They were developed to create mobile references in experiments in which the subject had to keep their fixation to the surroundings while these changed around them. **Property** Contextual fixation (Virtual Architecture) The three vectors

reconstruct a spatial reference around the user and can remove the *Unanchored* state. They can also be used to keep stable, for a few minutes, the relationship between the bearer and a specific point in space. **Risk Factor** Erroneous fixation If a Critical Failure is rolled, the vectors take a moving or unstable element as their reference and set the user adrift, possibly creating another State.

CAUSALITY METRONOME **Description** A small cubic device from which emerges a luminous needle that oscillates without producing any sound. Its cadence does not measure seconds, but the separation between intention, action and consequence. The records end abruptly after the seventh trial. **Property** Operational synchrony (*Chronomancy*) The user adjusts their action to the pulse of the apparatus, removing the *Desynchronised* state or synchronising, for a brief sequence, two processes that would normally operate at different rhythms. **Risk Factor** Causal anticipation If a Critical Failure is rolled, a consequence linked to the action begins to manifest before the action has finished taking place, possibly creating another State.

MORPHEUS MEMBRANE **Description** A transparent film kept in an airtight case. When spread over the skin it adheres without glue and slowly reproduces the user's breathing rhythm. It was created during research into induced rest and accelerated cognitive recovery.

Property Condensed repose (*Neural Vision*) For a few minutes the Membrane induces a state of deep repose capable of removing *Exhausted*. The user remains conscious, but perceives time as if they had slept for several hours. **Risk Factor** Invasive sleep If a Critical Failure is rolled, the rest opens the user's perception to dreamlike images that continue to interfere even after the membrane has been removed, possibly creating another State.

GALVANI ORTHOSKELETON **Description** A folding frame of metal filaments that fits over the back, arms and legs. Small impulses run through the joints and correct each movement a few fractions of a second after it begins. It was never approved for ordinary use: some users claimed that, over time, the apparatus began to anticipate them. **Property** Motor correction (*Advanced Forging*) The frame compensates for postural misalignments, tremors and irregular bodily responses, making it possible to remove the *Destabilised* state. It can also stabilise extremely delicate movements for a brief period. **Risk Factor** Anticipated movement If a Critical Failure is rolled, the orthoskeleton performs the action the user intended to carry out before they have finished deciding upon it, causing spasms and possibly creating another State.

PORTABLE THRESHOLD **Description** Two small columns of dark metal, some thirty centimetres tall, which, placed facing each other, generate an almost transparent surface between them. It was conceived as a prototype for isolating samples without resorting to physical chambers. **Property** Local isolation (*Defensive Networks*) By deploying both pieces, the user creates for a few minutes a border that reduces the interaction between the two sides: gases, particles, certain emissions and other environmental influences find it difficult to pass through. **Risk Factor** Enclosure inversion If a Critical Failure is rolled, the system

misinterprets which side it must isolate and encloses the very phenomenon it was meant to keep out.

SOMATIC ECHO CARTRIDGE Description A transparent cylinder filled with reddish filaments suspended in a conductive gel. When connected to the skin, for a few seconds it records the user's bodily pattern through their DNA and keeps an extremely brief functional copy, which can later be used as a reference.

Property Restitution pattern (Decoding) Once recorded, the pattern can be activated during a later scene to return the body to the physical disposition it presented at the moment of the reading, correcting displacements, forced postures or recent bodily alterations that the fiction allows to be restored. **Risk Factor** Incomplete restitution If a Critical Failure is rolled, only part of the recorded pattern imposes itself upon the current state, provoking a discordance between the two configurations.

INTERFERENCE EYE Description An experimental monocle of black glass mounted on a metal structure that fastens directly around the eye socket. When activated, the world partially loses its colour and certain alterations appear surrounded by lines of intense luminosity. **Property** Interference reading (*Luminous Projection*) For a few minutes the Eye makes it possible to distinguish which elements of a scene belong to its ordinary configuration and which constitute intrusions, contaminations, superimpositions or later alterations. It does not explain their nature: it only allows one to recognise what was not there. **Risk Factor** False intruder If a Critical Failure is rolled, the device classifies a legitimate element of the scene as interference, and the user perceives it as foreign for as long as the device remains active.

FRAGMENT 3: THE LAP

The Personal Akashic Reader, better known by its acronym LAP, is the everyday device for accessing the akashic network of Numinia. Every citizen has one and usually wears it on the wrist, built into a small structure resembling a watch or bracelet.

The LAP is one of the fundamental interfaces between the individual and the city's informational infrastructure. Through it one can consult documentation, identify citizens, interpret nodes associated with places or objects, communicate with other users and access numerous basic utilities. In functional terms, it occupies in Numinian life a place similar to that of a personal device permanently connected to a great information network.

But the analogy has its limits. The LAP does not access the Akasha directly in all its depth, nor does it turn its user into the depositary of every existing piece of knowledge. It connects to the akashic network, that is, to the organised web of information that Numinia has recorded, structured and made available to its citizens. The city may be a great living archive, but not all of its documents are public, nor has everything that exists been correctly documented.

For this reason, the LAP is an extraordinary tool for consultation, but it does not replace investigation.

MORPHOLOGY AND INTERFACE

The LAP usually takes the form of a light device fastened to the wrist. There are numerous aesthetic and cultural variations, but all of them share a similar functional architecture.

It can be activated by touching its surface or by a brief command. When this happens it deploys a visual interface on the device itself, in a small suspended projection or through layers of augmented reality integrated into the user's field of vision.

The interface responds to context. A documentary query may take the form of pages, diagrams or information windows; a map may be overlaid directly upon the streets; scanning a citizen emblem deploys an identification card; and certain cultural spaces allow the LAP to incorporate information about whatever the user is contemplating.

The device can be switched off or left in standby. In that state it stops actively exchanging information with the network.

ACCESS TO INFORMATION

The most common function of the LAP is to consult the official or authorised information available on the akashic network.

A character can use it to look up data on districts, institutions, documented historical events, public figures, species, Guilds, Factions, regulations, known technologies, cultural works, locations and any other content to which access is ordinary.

The GD should not demand a roll simply to consult public and easily locatable information.

If a PC uses their LAP to ask who runs an institution, where a well-known building is located or what the official function of a particular organisation is, the information can be provided directly, provided it forms part of the accessible records.

The roll comes in when the problem is not finding an entry, but investigating: locating a not very evident relationship between documents, distinguishing relevant information among numerous results, recovering a badly catalogued file or interpreting data whose importance is not immediately apparent.

This distinction is important for the development of adventures:

the LAP finds information; the PCs still have to understand it.

THE LAP DOES NOT KNOW EVERYTHING

The existence of the LAP should not become a reason for any unknown to be solvable through a search.

The network only contains what has been recorded and made available to its users.

The LAP may therefore run into several limitations:

- Information that does not exist or was never documented
- Information restricted by an institution
- Deleted, damaged or incomplete files
- Knowledge reserved for certain Guilds, Factions or access levels
- Events too recent to have been recorded
- Elements belonging to the periphery or to little-explored areas
- Data whose very existence is unknown
- Information deliberately hidden or falsified

When this happens, the LAP should show the limit clearly: no results, restricted access, incomplete record, source unavailable or any equivalent indication.

It is best not to use the mysterious «no results» every time, for it would end up seeming that Numinia's entire informational infrastructure had been designed by a particularly spiteful librarian.

Reading citizen emblems

Many citizens of Numinia wear an identifying emblem associated with their position within the social structure.

The LAP can scan these emblems and display the individual's basic authorised information.

It normally includes:

Name Guild Faction Species Position

This is why relevant NPCs may appear in the modules accompanied by a LAP Card.

The scan does not reveal thoughts, private history, full capabilities or confidential information. Nor does it replace interaction with the NPC. Knowing that someone is a

Hermeticist Exegete and holds the Position of Archivist makes it possible to understand their place in Numinia; it does not automatically explain what they are plotting while they smile with suspicious serenity.

When an individual has no emblem, has it deactivated or has some system of concealment, the LAP will not provide that information.

Reading sigil nodes

Numerous objects, buildings, monuments and infrastructures have **sigil nodes** connected to the network.

The LAP can interpret them and display the associated contextual information: identification of the object, public function, recorded provenance, access rules, basic instructions, historical references or any other content that those responsible for it have linked to the node.

In a museum, for example, the user could look at a piece and immediately consult its official record. In an institution, a node can identify a department and explain its functions. In a piece of public infrastructure, it can display instructions for use or safety warnings.

Once again, the node **provides recorded information about the thing**, not necessarily the whole truth about the thing.

A display case may claim that it contains an artefact from the Golden Age.

That does not prevent the PCs from discovering later that someone modified the record.

AUGMENTED REALITY

In numerous spaces of Numinia, the LAP can overlay information upon the surroundings.

Museums and monuments can display reconstructions, texts, dates or images; institutions can indicate departments and services; public thoroughfares can deploy routes and names; some cultural spaces incorporate specific layers of information for visitors.

This function makes Numinia's very geography navigable without forcing citizens to memorise every street, building and statue, a civilising virtue that the Cartographers of the Wind tolerate with admirable resignation.

AKASHIC SEARCH ENGINE

The LAP includes a search engine covering the accessible information on the network.

Players may use it freely to make ordinary queries during an adventure.

The GD should respond following three simple categories:

Common information: it appears directly.

Specialised but accessible information: it may require time, a specific search or, when the situation justifies it, an appropriate Roll.

Restricted, non-existent or secret information: it does not appear through an ordinary query.

This distinction makes it possible to keep the LAP as a genuinely useful tool without turning it into the natural adversary of every mystery.

LAP AND RUMOUIROLOGY

The akashic network does not contain only institutional documentation.

There are also forums, discussion groups, community channels, personal publications and other informal spaces where citizens exchange theories, experiences and accounts that lack official recognition.

In certain circumstances, these spaces can be used to investigate the Rumourology of an element.

This does not mean that all Rumourology can be found through the LAP.

Some rumours belong exclusively to a particular community, to an oral tradition, to a neighbourhood, to a profession or to groups that maintain no public activity on the network. Others may have been erased, may be found in restricted channels or may never have been put into writing at all.

For this reason, it is up to the GD to decide whether the element being investigated has enough presence in the forums and informal channels for its Rumourology to be traced through the LAP.

When it is possible, the player must make the corresponding **Inquire** Roll, just as if they were investigating the rumour through any other source.

The difference will lie in the kind of material recovered.

A forum may preserve:

- Anonymous testimonies
- Contradictory experiences

- Captures or records of uncertain provenance
- Speculative theories
- Old debates
- Publications subsequently deleted
- Distorted versions of a known event

A Success does not turn those publications into established facts. It allows the rumour to be better classified, in accordance with the rules of Rumourology.

The LAP does not transform rumour into document.

It only makes it possible to find where the city is talking.

DYNAMIC CARTOGRAPHY

The device incorporates up-to-date cartography of the districts and known locations of Numinia.

It can calculate routes, indicate public access points and represent the basic geophysical information available on the network.

This function depends, naturally, on the quality of the existing cartography. Little-explored peripheral areas, spaces affected by alterations of the Veil and certain restricted locations may appear incomplete, displaced or simply absent.

The LAP can tell you where the map ends.

It does not guarantee that the path ends there.

COMMUNICATION

The LAP makes it possible to send and receive personal communications to and from other registered citizens.

It has two usual systems:

Messaging, for brief and immediate exchanges.

Akashic mail, intended for formal communications, lengthy documents and messages that require preservation or registration.

These communications may depend on the state of the network, on the restrictions applied to the user and on the conditions of the place where they happen to be. Not even within the four districts is communication infallible.

INTERFACTIONAL CHANNEL

The members of a Faction may have access to an interfactional channel, an encrypted communication network intended for the internal exchange of authorised information among the members of the same Faction.

The content and privileges of these channels depend on the citizen's affiliation and access level. Belonging to a Faction does not mean being able to consult all of its archives or to attend, even digitally, all of its conversations.

The channel facilitates belonging.

It does not grant corporate omniscience, a small mercy without which no institution would survive a week.

Basic programs

Every LAP incorporates various utilities in everyday use: clock, timer, calculator, compass, note management, data logging and other equivalent tools.

These applications do not usually require any mechanics unless an extraordinary situation affects them.

DEPENDENCE ON THE AKASHIC NETWORK

The main technical limitation of the LAP, as has already been said, is its dependence on the akashic network.

In places where the connection is weak, suffers interference or has been deliberately blocked, some or all of its functions may be restricted; this is more usual in the peripheral areas of Numinia, though not in all of them.

This may happen in certain peripheral regions, protected facilities, spaces affected by anomalies of the Veil or areas where communication systems have suffered damage.

The GD should treat this limitation as a circumstance of the fiction, not as an arbitrary device to stop the players from consulting something inconvenient.

If the LAP stops working, there must be a reason within the world.

The LAP within the adventure

The LAP is part of every citizen's ordinary equipment and does not take up a Relic, Residue or Proscribed slot in the Inventory. Nor is it a weapon, nor does it need to be chosen as part of the starting equipment.

It should be assumed that every PC owns one unless the fiction expressly establishes otherwise.

For the GD, its existence has an especially important consequence: Numinia's public information should not be artificially turned into an obstacle.

If the PCs want to know what any citizen could reasonably look up in a few seconds, let them do so.

The true spaces of investigation begin where official information ends: in the incomplete, the contradictory, the hidden, the unrecorded and whatever the city does not yet know how to interpret.

In this sense, the LAP does not reduce the possibilities for adventure.

It delimits them.

It lets the players know quickly what Numinia knows, so that they can devote their curiosity to something rather more interesting: what it does not know yet.

CHAPTER SEVEN

BUILDING THE ADVENTURE

BUILDING THE ADVENTURE

The heartbeat of the board

«In the half-light of the Agora, a group of citizens gathered around a circle traced in a dust of symbols. There was neither master nor spectator: each of them brought a fragment of story, an object torn from the memory of the city. A broken mask. A question never answered. An unfinished melody.

When they placed them at the centre, the lines on the ground began to spread like luminous veins. Streets, rivers, whole squares rose from that geometry, but none of them was fixed: they quivered, as if awaiting the weight of a decision.

–Listen– murmured the Pythia, her eyes rolled back–. It is not the world that tells the story. It is the story that gives shape to the world.

The visions intertwined: a port that existed only when someone remembered it, a river that ran backwards, a temple where every mural changed according to who looked at it. They were possibilities, not certainties. Rumours of futures that could be written or could fade away.

The players looked at one another. No one held absolute control. Every gesture, every word added a layer to the nascent weave. A Guardian raised his spear, and the crack in a wall became a door. An Alchemist named a metal that did not exist, and at once a blazing forge appeared at the edge of the square. A Spectral whispered a verse, and the sky answered with an omen.

The die spun upon the stone, but it did not fall in silence: its echo multiplied the options, opening paths that forked beyond imagination.

There was no single director, no predetermined script. Only a chorus of voices that, as they intertwined, invented the impossible. Thus did Numinia rise once more: not out of obedience, but out of shared creation.

For every story begins with a convulsion of fantasy.

For in Numinia adventure is not discovered, but built.»

In a traditional roleplaying game, preparing an adventure module usually consists of establishing in advance a good part of its narrative structure: an initial situation, the events that brought it about, the NPCs involved and their motivations, the places the characters will be able to explore, the conflicts they will meet and the pieces of information that will allow them to understand what has happened. Although the players' decisions may alter the planned route, the GD usually has an underlying plot that they know before the game begins: they know what has happened, why it has happened and what relationships exist between its different elements. The adventure consists, to a large extent, in allowing the PCs to come into contact with that prepared structure and decide how to find their way within it.

And although this structure has brought those of us who love roleplaying enormous rewards for more than thirty years, in Numinia adventures are not built on those premises, as linear sequences or as prewritten plots that the players must follow step by step. The cosmos of the Veil –the force that sustains, connects and distorts the reality of the city– does not readily admit straight lines or closed structures either: it manifests itself through resonances, correspondences, folds of meaning and relationships that are not always evident. The structure of an adventure must answer to that same nature. The GD does not prepare a story for the players to act out and simply find their way through, but a narrative space capable of producing different stories depending on what happens during the game.

This conception draws on an essential influence from the system *Carved from Brindlewood* (CfB), by Jason Cordova, and especially from its proposal of «emergent mystery». In CfB, a mystery does not necessarily contain a true solution that the GD knows in advance and that the players must correctly reconstruct. The investigation provides clues and relationships from which the players themselves work out a coherent explanation. The truth, therefore, does not remain hidden behind the adventure waiting to be discovered: it emerges during play. It is a puzzle not yet assembled, one that admits different ways of being put together.

Numinia adopts this principle, but broadens its scope. An adventure need not be articulated around a mystery, but around a conflict understood in its broadest sense: an inexplicable disappearance, a dispute between factions, an anomaly of the Veil, an expedition, a threat, a political event, a social transformation, a creature, an intimate problem or any situation capable of setting the PCs in motion. For this reason, Numinia does not work exclusively with clues, but with Pieces of Conflict: pieces of information, clues, events, images, testimonies, symbols, objects, contradictions or any other meaningful element that can be incorporated into the interpretation of what is happening. The preceding template already establishes this function of the Pieces as elements that the players gather and later relate to one another in order to build an overall interpretation.

The starting point of that process is called the Root. The Root is the fundamental proposition of the adventure: what is happening when play begins and what justifies the characters'

intervention. But it does not contain the definitive explanation of what has happened, nor does it prescribe where the story must go. A good Root establishes a situation charged with potential and with the capacity to generate possibilities without determining which of them will end up being developed. It is, in this sense, an essentially semiotic structure: it proposes signs, tensions and relationships meaningful enough to admit multiple interpretations and multiple drifts.

That is why building a Numinia adventure does not consist of developing in advance a causal chain of the kind *this has happened for this reason, the characters will discover that and finally they will have to do this other thing*. Doing so would mean deciding the story before the players have been able to take part in its creation. The Root must be firm in what it presents and extraordinarily flexible in what it means. The GD knows the initial situation, its elements, its forces and its possibilities; they do not yet need to know the story that will explain all of it.

That story will be built during the game. The players will continually contribute new elements through their decisions, their questions, their interpretations and the various mechanics of collaborative creation. A Heterocosmic Roll can introduce an object, a bond or a property that did not exist until then; the system expressly establishes that these creations come to shape the adventure and that Numinia reacts to them. The Functions of the Tale can make unexpected events emerge; collective creation can alter the course of the journey; a question asked by the GD can lead a player to define an aspect of the context that no one had foreseen. Even a spontaneous contribution made during a conversation can open up an extraordinary possibility.

No coherent contribution should fall into the void. This does not mean that every idea voiced by a player immediately becomes an absolute truth, nor that all of them must carry identical weight. It means that the GD listens to contributions as narrative material and determines what resonance they acquire within the adventure. One idea may simply become a detail of the setting; another may reappear several scenes later as a cross-cutting storyline; a third may transform a Piece of Conflict, introduce a new NPC or alter the relationships between two factions. And, occasionally, a contribution will be so fertile and so well connected to what has happened that it will completely change the direction of the adventure, to the point of forcing a reinterpretation of the Root itself.

Therein lies one of the GD's fundamental tasks in Numinia: to integrate without submitting, to guide without imposing. Collaborative creation does not mean that any declaration by the players can arbitrarily modify the world. Every contribution must respect the coherence of Numinia, the information already established and the limits proper to the situation. Creative freedom works within a context, precisely because a context without limits does not generate meaningful possibilities: it generates noise. The GD guards those limits, but deliberately leaves open whatever has not yet been defined.

This form of collaborative creation requires the player to maintain a flexible relationship with their own role during the game. At certain moments they will act strictly from the perspective of their PC: they will decide what the PC does, says, interprets or how they react

to what they perceive. At others, they will have to leave that perspective momentarily and observe the scene as a player, attending to the narrative context from outside the character. The questions of the dynamic we know as Dialogic Resonance make this shift especially visible: when the GD asks «what tells you that this place is dangerous?» or «what object is that delegate absent-mindedly fiddling with?», they are not necessarily asking what the PC knows, but inviting the player to complete a still-open part of the fiction. Once the contribution has been made, it is incorporated into the context and the player returns to their character's gaze, and the character may relate to it as to any other element of the world. Stepping in and out of the PC intermittently is not, therefore, a break in the roleplaying, but one of the conditions of shared authorship in Numinia: while the player inhabits the world as a PC, they help to give it shape from their personal position.

This way of playing demands a different kind of preparation. The GD prepares elements, relationships, possibilities and tensions, but avoids preparing conclusions. They design NPCs with interests, places open to exploration, Pieces of Conflict capable of taking on different meanings and events that can be set in motion when the fiction needs them. They then organise these materials by means of Phases, large narrative blocks that make it possible to control the pace and function of each moment of the adventure without determining the specific scenes that must take place. Phases are states of the narration, not chapters of a previously written plot: they serve to order creative chaos without taming it. This modular function already constitutes the central principle of the Numinia Adventure Template.

In this way, the adventure arises from the dialogue between the prepared and the emergent. The GD introduces the Root; the players observe it, question it and begin to modify it; the Pieces of Conflict provide material with which to interpret it; the narrative mechanics introduce new alterations; the Phases organise the resulting movement; and the PCs' decisions determine which possibilities gain importance and which are left behind. The final result does not belong entirely to the GD or to the players. It belongs to the relationship that has been established between them during play.

The resources we present in this chapter are the tools needed to direct that process. In the coming sections we shall see how to build a sufficiently fertile Root, how to devise and combine the Phases, how to manage the Pieces of Conflict, how to offer information without predetermining interpretations, how to use Rumourology and questions about the context, how to encourage collaborative creation and, no less important, how to set its limits. Because directing Numinia does not consist of knowing in advance what story is going to be told.

It consists of carefully preparing the conditions for one to appear that no one had foreseen.

FRAGMENT 1: CREATING THE ROOT

Every Numinia adventure begins with a Root. The Root is the fundamental proposition on which the module is built: it establishes what is happening when the adventure begins, why

that event requires the PCs' intervention and what initial tension sets the story in motion. It is not a summary of the plot, nor does it contain a secret explanation of the events. It is a situation defined enough to be played from and open enough to admit developments that the GD does not yet know.

This difference is essential. In a conventional adventure, the GD might prepare the premise that several citizens have disappeared because a clandestine organisation is experimenting on them in an abandoned facility, and then distribute the clues needed for the players to discover that truth. In Numinia, that formulation contains too much. If the GD already knows who is causing the disappearances, where the missing are, what the culprit hopes to achieve and what the causal relationship is between all those elements, they have not built a Root: they have built a solution. The players' participation may modify later events, but a fundamental part of the adventure's meaning will already have been decided before it begins.

The Root must stop sooner. It might establish, for example, that citizens are disappearing in the Vitruvian District and that, several days later, some of their personal belongings reappear arranged in public places following an apparently deliberate pattern. That is something that is happening. It can be investigated, observed and interpreted, but it does not yet explain anything. Have the citizens been kidnapped? Have they disappeared of their own accord? Do the objects constitute a message? Is someone placing them there? Is there an anomaly of the Veil? Is there some relationship between the missing? The Root does not answer these questions because the adventure does not yet need those answers. It needs to produce the conditions for them to appear.

THE ROOT ESTABLISHES FACTS, NOT EXPLANATIONS

To build a Root, the GD must distinguish between founding facts and open interpretations. Founding facts are those circumstances that must be true for the adventure to exist: something has disappeared, a faction asks for help, an anomaly is producing a certain phenomenon, two institutions are locked in conflict, an expedition has not returned or an impossible object has appeared where it should not be. These facts constitute the firm ground on which the game will begin and need not remain in doubt.

What must remain open is the meaning of those facts and the deep relationships that exist between them. Who is responsible, why it is happening, what a particular figure is after, what relationship exists between two events, what the true nature of an anomaly is or what consequences intervening in it will have are questions that, whenever they constitute fertile material for the adventure, should not be settled in the Root. The Pieces of Conflict, the PCs' decisions and the various forms of collaborative creation will later provide materials with which to build those relationships. The system already allows for the Pieces to be clues, symbols, events or anomalies, and for the players to later articulate them into a coherent interpretation.

Therefore, a Root does not have to be vague in order to be open. In fact, exactly the opposite should be the case. «*Something strange is happening in the Ouroboros District*» offers very little to play with. We do not know who is affected, what is happening or what makes the situation extraordinary. By contrast, «*for the past seven nights, everyone who walks down a certain street in the Old Quarter dreams of exactly the same room, although each of them remembers that there was a different object inside*» is much more concrete and, at the same time, much more open. It defines the phenomenon precisely and leaves its meaning intact.

The openness of a Root does not depend on the amount of information it leaves out, but on the number of interpretations that the information it contains allows.

A TENSION THAT DEMANDS MOVEMENT

Nor should the Root merely present a curiosity. It must contain an active tension, something that makes it reasonable for the PCs to intervene and that allows the situation to evolve if they do not. A statue that has begun to change colour may be intriguing; a statue that changes colour every time a name disappears from the civil registers already contains a relationship capable of setting the adventure in motion. The tension may be dangerous, political, intimate, social, metaphysical or even seemingly trivial, but it must introduce some form of imbalance.

This does not mean that the GD must prepare what will happen if the players do not follow a certain path. It is enough for the Root to contain forces at work. NPCs want things, institutions react, phenomena go on occurring and conflicts generate consequences.

The players do not arrive at a motionless stage set that patiently awaits their investigation; they arrive at a situation that was already under way before they appeared and that will go on transforming after their arrival.

THE TEST OF QUESTIONS

There is a simple way to check whether a Root is open enough: ask questions about it. A good Root should immediately provoke several relevant questions whose answers the GD has not yet decided. It is not a matter of ignoring information needed to direct the game, but of identifying those aspects whose discovery may legitimately belong to play.

Let us take the disappearance of citizens whose belongings reappear arranged in public spaces. The Root generates questions on its own: what relationship exists between the missing? Who places the objects? What does their arrangement mean? Why do precisely those objects reappear? Where are their owners? If the GD can answer all of them in advance and those answers form a coherent causal explanation, they have probably gone too far: behind the Root, once again, a plot lies hidden waiting to be discovered. If, on the other hand, the situation does not provoke any concrete question, the Root is probably too vague to generate adventure.

There is, therefore, an especially useful test: the GD must know clearly what is happening, but not necessarily what it means.

THE ROOT AS A GENERATIVE STRUCTURE

The function of the Root is not to remain intact throughout the whole adventure, but to generate fiction. From it will spring the first scenes, the Pieces of Conflict, the Dialogic Resonances and the characters' possibilities for action. Some relationships will appear because the module has prepared them; others will be born from the PCs' actions, from a Heterocosmic Roll, from an unexpected interpretation or from an especially fertile answer to a Resonance. Numinia's modular structure exists precisely to allow those materials to alter the course without «breaking» the adventure.

This implies that the Root possesses factual stability but interpretive plasticity. If the adventure begins because nine citizens have disappeared, it is not advisable to decide arbitrarily halfway through the session that they never disappeared simply because a more attractive idea has come up. What has happened is already part of the shared world. What can indeed be radically transformed is our understanding of those disappearances. A contribution from the players may turn them into something the GD had never imagined when writing the module, provided that the new interpretation is compatible with the established facts and finds sufficient support in what has happened during the game.

A moment may even come when the accumulated contributions force a reinterpretation of the Root itself. This does not mean that the adventure has escaped the GD's control. It means that the Root has fulfilled its function correctly: instead of leading the players towards a predetermined story, it has produced enough narrative material for a new story to appear.

WHAT A ROOT SHOULD CONTAIN

A Root should be able to answer four questions clearly:

1. What is happening? The concrete facts that make up the initial situation.
2. Where does it happen, and whom does it affect? The context of Numinia on which the conflict acts.
3. What tension does it introduce? Whatever turns the situation into a problem, anomaly or imbalance capable of generating adventure.
4. Why can the PCs intervene? The circumstance that brings them into contact with the conflict, without yet determining what they will have to do with it.

And it should avoid answering four others in advance:

1. What is the true explanation of everything that has happened?
2. Who is necessarily responsible?
3. What interpretation must the players reach?
4. How must the conflict be resolved?

The difference between the two lists is practically the difference between preparing a situation and writing a plot.

A well-built Root is not, therefore, the first stretch of a road whose destination the GD knows. It is a system of coordinates from which several paths may set out, including some that did not exist when the session began. It must contain enough substance to withstand the players' questions and enough indeterminacy to surprise even the one who wrote it.

The GD plants the Root.

The table discovers what kind of tree was growing beneath it.

FOUNDING FACTS AND POTENTIAL PROPOSALS

The Root may contain something more than the founding facts of the Starting Conflict. The GD may also prepare NPCs, places, events, objects, relationships or images that bear some possible connection to the conflict and that may be incorporated into the adventure if they find the right moment. These potential proposals do not constitute facts of the fiction until they appear during play: they are materials available for the GD to introduce, transform or discard according to the direction the adventure takes.

Nor should a potential proposal be completely defined. In fact, it tends to be more fertile when it combines, as will be better explained in the next section, on Dialogic Resonance, *arbitrary elements* and *open elements*. The GD may establish that there is a Game Master who knows something important about the disappearances, without yet deciding what exactly they know, why they know it, what their intentions are or what position they hold with respect to the Starting Conflict. If they do finally appear, some of those elements may be established directly and others may become new Spaces of Indeterminacy: «*The Game Master receives you as though they had been waiting for you for several days. What detail of the room makes you think they knew exactly when you would arrive?*». A proposal prepared by the GD thus becomes material for a new intervention by the players.

This makes it possible to prepare a rich Root without turning it into a covert plot. The GD may imagine numerous possibilities around the Starting Conflict: characters who might intervene, places to which the investigation might lead, events liable to be precipitated, significant objects or relationships still uncertain. Preparing a possibility does not oblige one to turn it into an event. Its function is to provide the GD with materials with which to

respond nimbly to the development of the fiction, not to establish a list of contents the adventure must work through.

And, without doubt, all these proposals must be prepared to promote narrative, not to offer answers.

LEARNING TO LET GO

Directing an adventure built in this way demands a particular kind of flexibility: the GD must be willing to abandon their own proposals. During preparation, magnificent ideas will appear, promising characters, tempting revelations and relationships that seem destined to produce memorable scenes. Some will reach the table. Many others will not. As the players incorporate their own proposals, establish relationships between the Pieces of Conflict and, through their decisions, transform the direction of the adventure, part of the prepared material will cease to fit the fiction that is emerging. When this happens, the GD should not force its appearance merely because it had been planned.

This renunciation is an essential part of collaborative creation. What is prepared belongs to the GD; what is played belongs to the table. As long as a proposal remains only in their notes, it does not yet constitute a truth about Numinia. An NPC who never appeared did not secretly take part in the events; a conspiracy that never came to be incorporated into the fiction was not happening behind the scenes; a revelation that was prepared but never spoken is not a truth the players failed to discover. They are possibilities that never came to materialise, and they can vanish without leaving any narrative debt.

The criterion for keeping a proposal should not be how much enthusiasm it aroused during preparation, but how much sense it retains within the adventure that is actually taking place. If the players' contributions open a more fertile direction, some of the GD's ideas can be adapted to it; others will have to be profoundly modified, and others, quite simply, abandoned. Bringing them back by force would mean privileging a private fiction over the shared fiction. The GD does not direct in order to prove that their forecasts were good: they direct in order to recognise which of all the available possibilities are producing play.

This does not make wasted preparation lost time. A discarded proposal has already fulfilled a function by allowing the GD to understand the possibilities of the Root and to arrive at the table with enough materials to react. They may even keep it for another adventure, provided they do not try to slip it surreptitiously into a place where it no longer belongs. The preparation of a Numinia adventure must be abundant in possibilities and austere in commitments.

That is why a good Root may contain much more than will finally appear. Its richness is not measured by the quantity of content the players manage to discover, but by the number of directions it makes possible. The Starting Conflict will remain the core for as long as the

fiction sustains it; around it, characters, events, relationships and meanings may appear, transform or disappear as the adventure finds its own shape.

And the GD will have to acquire a virtue that is difficult for any creator: learning to live with their unrevealed secrets.

FRAGMENT 2: DIALOGIC RESONANCE

Dialogic Resonance is a dynamic of collaborative creation through which the GD puts to one or more players a directed question about some element of the fiction whose meaning or manifestation still remains open. The question always starts from a previously established context and contains a premise concrete enough to guide the answer, but leaves one of its aspects undetermined so that it is the players who complete it.

Thus, the GD does not ask «*what is in the Ministerial Hall?*», but «*what tells you that danger can be sensed in the Ministerial Hall?*». The existence of the Hall, the presence of the PCs and the sense of danger already belong to the fiction; whatever manifests that danger remains open. The player's answer completes that space of indeterminacy and becomes part of the shared context.

The Resonance is dialogic because meaning comes neither exclusively from the GD nor from the player, but from the relationship between the two: the GD delimits a field of possibilities through the question, and the player introduces an interpretation that modifies the fiction. That new reality may afterwards be taken up, reinterpreted or developed by any of the participants, so that the narration advances through a succession of shared meanings and not through the revelation of previously established contents.

THE SPACE OF INDETERMINACY

The question that activates a Dialogic Resonance opens what we shall call a Space of Indeterminacy: a part of the fiction that the module and the GD deliberately leave unspecified so that it can be completed during play. However, this is not an empty space for the player to fill as they please –if we set out to play with empty spaces so that our freedom is not curtailed, it is too late when we discover that the void is, by definition, a barren territory in which nothing bears fruit, for there is nothing in it to play with, and that is tragic–. The very question of the Dialogic Resonance, then, already contains a proposal: it establishes certain conditions, relationships or meanings and leaves open only that which can manifest them. In «*what tells you that danger can be sensed in the Ministerial Hall?*», for example, the danger already exists as a condition of the scene; what is undetermined is its sign. The player might perceive that all the clocks have stopped, notice that the officials speak without looking at one another, or discover a dark stain that someone has tried to hide beneath a rug. The possibilities are countless, but no answer starts from nothing: all of them are born from the field of meaning the question has opened.

This establishes a fundamental difference between indeterminacy and arbitrariness. A question such as «*what is here?*» can offer so much freedom that, paradoxically, it gives the player hardly anything to work with. Dialogic Resonance proceeds the other way round: the more suggestive the premise contained in the question, the greater the number of meaningful paths that can arise from it.

The GD does not decide the answer, but does prepare the ground on which it can grow. A good Dialogic Resonance therefore establishes fertile limits: it determines enough to stimulate the imagination and leaves enough undetermined for the player's contribution to be truly their own, authentically free.

THE RULE AS A FIELD OF POSSIBILITIES

This principle expresses a conception of the rules of any game that, moreover, runs through Numinia in its entirety: a rule does not exist solely to determine what a player cannot do; it exists, above all, to show them within which field they can act. Absolute freedom has no relief: if anything is equally possible at any moment, no decision meets resistance, direction or meaning. No decision has value, then, nor any way of unfolding.

Just as a game needs a board, some pieces or some conditions for play to exist at all, shared creation needs structures capable of turning an unlimited possibility into a set of meaningful possibilities.

The rules thus make us a gift of an unploughed field. But a fertile field. They do not tell the player which furrow to open or what they will find at the end of the land; they do something far more important: they hand them a terrain on which their decisions can leave a mark. Fertile limitation does not reduce creation; it provokes it. A Dialogic Resonance does not say *invent anything*, because that absolute freedom abandons the player before the tragedy of the void; nor does it say *this is exactly what happens*, because then nothing is left to create. It says, instead: *this is happening; tell me how it manifests*. Between arbitrariness and prescription appears the space proper to play.

For this reason, the Space of Indeterminacy must be designed. The GD can introduce it spontaneously during the session, but a module can also point out those places especially fertile for a Dialogic Resonance: a gesture whose meaning is not specified, an anomaly whose appearance remains open, a relationship that still lacks a cause, an incomplete image or a circumstance of which we know only the consequences. They are not omissions of the module. They are places the module has decided not to close because another voice will have to intervene to complete them.

The adventure is not simply unfinished: it is prepared to be finished by playing.

THE ANSWER AS PROPOSAL

When a player answers a Dialogic Resonance, their answer immediately ceases to be a possibility and becomes a proposal incorporated into the fiction. This distinction is essential. The GD does not ask a question in order to hear ideas they can afterwards ignore while carrying on with the adventure they had planned. If they have deliberately ceded a Space of Indeterminacy, they take on the commitment to accept whatever the players introduce into it, provided it respects the limits set by the question itself and does not contradict elements already consolidated in the world or the adventure. Collaborative creation can only exist if the participants trust that what they contribute has consequences.

There is, therefore, a responsibility of the GD towards the player's proposal. It does not consist in always granting them the interpretation that most benefits them, nor in giving each answer an outsized importance. It consists in recognising it, incorporating it and allowing it to find its place in the fiction. An answer can be small without being irrelevant. The object the Cyanite delegate was fiddling with may never again decide the course of the conflict, but from that instant that object exists, characterises the delegate and forms part of the shared memory of the scene. And perhaps three Phases later someone will remember that he was turning a tiny bone key between his fingers. Good stories have the dreadful habit of remembering good details.

The magnitude of that incorporation will depend on the narrative power of the proposal and on the relationships it establishes with the rest of the adventure. Some answers will remain as meaningful details, enriching a place, a character or a situation. Others will find later resonances and become transversal stories that run through several Phases without necessarily displacing the main conflict. And some, through their capacity to connect Pieces of Conflict, shed light on earlier events or open especially fertile possibilities, may become main paths of the adventure, to the point of altering its direction or transforming the interpretation of the Root itself.

The GD need not decide immediately to which of these categories a contribution belongs: they can let it breathe and observe what relationships it produces during play.

This also means that integrating is not the same as rewarding the most spectacular notion. A simple contribution can acquire enormous importance if it finds fertile relationships with what happens afterwards; an extraordinarily showy idea may remain simply a magnificent detail if it establishes no other connection. The GD does not judge answers by their extravagance, but listens for their capacity to produce meaning. Numinia already establishes that the players' creation modifies the adventure and that the world reacts to what they introduce; Dialogic Resonance extends that same principle to the ordinary construction of context.

In this way a small pact is established between GD and players: the GD offers a structure that deserves to be interpreted, and the players respond with contributions that deserve to be taken seriously. Neither party possesses the fiction on its own. One proposes the

conditions; the others explore their possibilities; and whatever arises from the encounter modifies the conditions that follow.

Dialogic Resonance does not ask the player what they want to exist.

It asks them what they can discover within that which we have not yet decided.

And I believe this last opposition is particularly important. It prevents the mechanic from being perceived as a capricious surrender of narrative authority. The player does not receive the GD's hat for a few seconds: they receive a space designed for their authorship.

That difference, small in appearance, is practically the whole philosophy of the mechanic.

HOW TO FORMULATE A DIALOGIC RESONANCE

A Dialogic Resonance is built by combining an *arbitrary element* and an *open element*. The arbitrary element is a condition the GD introduces as true and which the player must not decide: it gives the question direction and delimits the field of creation. The open element is whatever the question deliberately leaves undetermined and which it falls to the player to specify. The simplest formula is, therefore: «This is so; what makes it so?», although it can take many other forms. In «*what tells you that danger can be sensed in the Ministerial Hall?*», the fact that there is some manifestation of danger is the arbitrary element; what that manifestation is constitutes the open element. In «*what is the Cyanite delegate fiddling with in his hand?*», the GD arbitrarily establishes that the delegate is absent-mindedly handling some object, but leaves it to the player to decide which one. Arbitrary does not mean capricious or unjustified here: it simply means withheld from the player's decision in order to provide a concrete point from which to create.

The proportion between the two elements determines the quality of the question. If the arbitrary element is missing, the void appears; if the open element is missing, creation disappears. Asking «*what is in this room?*» offers a field so unlimited that it provides hardly any materials to think with; asking «*why is there a bloodstained key on the table?*» has already determined the object, its state and its relevance, and only allows a rather narrow causal relationship to be completed. A good Resonance must sit between the two extremes: it affirms something specific enough to awaken associations, but leaves open a variable broad enough to admit genuinely different answers. The GD can check this very simply before formulating it: they must be able to point out precisely what they are affirming and what they are handing over to the player. If they cannot tell the two apart, the question is probably not yet well built.

Before formulating a Dialogic Resonance, the GD must be able to answer two questions: «What am I establishing?» and «What am I letting the player establish?».

RESOURCES FOR ENRICHING A RESONANCE

The structure of a Dialogic Resonance is always the same, but what it asks about can come from very different places. The GD need not confine themselves to filling in the immediate context of a scene: they can use the question to establish relationships with the PCs, recover earlier elements of the adventure or set two seemingly unrelated aspects of the fiction in dialogue with each other. The following resources are not additional rules, but suggestions that may prove useful: ways of choosing the arbitrary and open elements of the question with greater intention.

Introducing the PC's intimacy. The question can give some element of the setting a personal relationship with one of the characters: *«What object from your childhood do you find in the filing cabinet?»*, *«What is there in this woman's voice that reminds you of someone you once knew?»*. The player does not merely complete the world, but introduces something of their PC's biography or sensibility. It is best to use this resource on aspects that have not yet been established: the Resonance may widen the character's intimacy, but it should not rewrite it.

Recovering what has already been played. A question can force a look back and give a new function to something that appeared earlier: *«What does the manual explain about the use of the anemochronous clocks that appeared during the Presentation Phase?»*, *«What detail of this symbol do you recognise from the one you saw in the antiquarian's house?»*. This resource is especially fertile because it turns continuity into creation: an element that seemed incidental can retrospectively acquire an unexpected importance.

Relating two distant elements. The GD can place in the same question two aspects of the adventure that until then had no relationship: *«What detail of the guards' uniform reminds you of the artefact you found at the Ascending Falls of Kirelya?»*. The player determines the link, but the question proposes that some link exists. It is an especially powerful tool for producing emergent connections between Pieces of Conflict.

Asking about a consequence, not a cause. Instead of asking the player to explain why something happens, they can first be shown its effect: *«What has stopped working in the square since that light appeared?»*, *«What do the inhabitants of the neighbourhood do to avoid passing in front of that building?»*. Consequences are usually easier to imagine than explanations and, moreover, they preserve the mystery: we know that something is happening, but we do not yet know why.

Asking about the clue, not the truth. If the adventure contains an important uncertainty, it is preferable to ask about what allows it to be interpreted rather than about its definitive explanation. *«What do you find in the office that makes you suspect the minister was expecting the attack?»* is more fertile than *«why did the minister know they were going to attack him?»*. The first introduces a new Piece of Conflict; the second runs the risk of resolving what ought to remain open for now.

Introducing an anomaly. The arbitrary element can consist in stating that something does not fit and leaving the nature of that irregularity open: *«There is something impossible about the layout of these rooms. What is it?»*, *«One of the portraits should not be here. What does it depict?»*. The anomaly immediately provides direction and interest without determining its meaning.

Giving the context a voice. Not every contribution has to take material form in objects or events. A Resonance can ask about customs, prejudices, rumours, superstitions or collective interpretations: *«What do the inhabitants of the Old Quarter say must never be done after midnight in this street?»*. In this way, the players can help to build not only the physical space of Numinia, but also the culture through which its inhabitants interpret it.

And we shall make one last, particularly important recommendation: ask about what the GD is willing not to control. A Dialogic Resonance should not be used to steer the player surreptitiously towards an answer the GD already has in mind. If they need the delegate to be carrying a key, they should say that the delegate is carrying a key; they should not ask *«what small, toothed metal object capable of opening a lock is the delegate carrying?»* and then feign exquisite surprise at the answer.

When the GD opens a Space of Indeterminacy, they must do so because they want to discover what will be in it.

This last rule almost deserves to be highlighted, because it perfectly seals the pact we have been hinting at and defining: do not ask what you have already decided the answer to. The Resonance then ceases to be a technique for coaxing «the right answer» out of the player and truly becomes a tool of shared discovery. That is where it begins to become deliciously dangerous.

FRAGMENT 3: THE PIECES OF CONFLICT

The Pieces of Conflict are significant elements that appear during the adventure and bear some potential relationship to the Starting Conflict. They can be objects, documents, testimonies, images, symbols or any other material and tangible manifestation capable of acquiring relevance within the fiction. The PCs find, provoke or recognise them as the adventure unfolds and, later on, they will be able to relate them to one another in order to formulate their own interpretations of what is happening.

But a Piece of Conflict is not a clue in the traditional sense. A clue usually points to a truth that already exists: the footprint belongs to the murderer, the letter proves a blackmail, the key opens a particular door. Its function is to allow the players to reconstruct correctly a relationship that the author of the adventure has established beforehand. A Piece works differently. It has relevance without yet having a closed meaning. When it appears, we know that it matters; we do not necessarily know why yet.

That is why the best Pieces have something of the anomaly, the find or the oddity about them. They demand attention. A business card from an establishment that vanished decades ago, a photograph from which someone has been carefully erased, a recording that contains thirteen seconds of silence at the same point every time it is played, or a statue found in a place where it manifestly does not belong are all good material for a Piece. Not because they conceal a solution the GD has decided in advance, but because they seem to demand an explanation.

The Piece provides a frame of meaning, not its resolution. It may contain perfectly determined facts –the card belongs to a specific bar; the photograph was taken on a particular date; the recording comes from a certain machine–, but the relationships that make those facts part of the Conflict remain open. The players thus have something solid to think about without the module having done the thinking for them.

PREGENERATED PIECES AND EMERGENT PIECES

The GD can include some Pieces of Conflict while preparing the adventure. These pregenerated Pieces form part of the Root's set of possibilities and provide significant material that may appear when the fiction allows them to be introduced. As with potential proposals, preparing them does not oblige one to use them. A Piece that ceases to be pertinent can be transformed, held in reserve or disappear from the adventure without the players having lost anything: what never entered the fiction never became part of it.

But many Pieces will arise during play itself. A decision by the PCs, a Dialogic Resonance, a Heterocosmic Roll, an unexpected conversation or an interpretation by the players can create the conditions for the GD to introduce an element they had never prepared. These emergent Pieces have exactly the same value as the pregenerated ones. Their legitimacy does not depend on having been written before the session began, but on their arising coherently from what is happening.

Let us imagine that the PCs are questioning an agent of the Summa Archive. During the scene, one of the players decides that their PC will try to steal his wallet. Nothing in the preparation contemplated this possibility, but the action succeeds. The GD could simply list a few trivial belongings; they can also recognise that the player has just opened a new Space of Indeterminacy. Among the objects there appears a card from an old café in the Corridor of Memory, closed for years, in front of whose façade the first of the individuals under investigation disappeared. The card has just become a Piece of Conflict.

Note where it comes from: the player has produced the opportunity; the GD has responded with a proposal. The Piece thus also works as a narrative reward. The player's initiative does not merely earn an immediate advantage: it makes the world reveal a new surface on which to act.

And, significantly, the GD does not yet need to know why the agent has that card.

A PIECE SHOULD OPEN MORE THAN IT CLOSES

A good Piece of Conflict does not merely provide information: it produces new possibilities of play. The café card establishes several things, but it immediately opens as many others. What will the group find if they visit the abandoned establishment? Why does the agent keep that card? What relationship is there between the café and the first disappearance? Does the agent know of that relationship? Is he investigating it, taking part in it, or is he caught up in something he does not understand either?

None of these questions needs an answer at the moment the Piece appears. If the players decide to investigate them, the answers can emerge through new scenes, Resonances, actions by the PCs and new Pieces of Conflict. A Piece can engender other Pieces. Investigation thus does not consist in following a chain of clues designed in advance, but in expanding a network of relationships whose meaning is built up as play goes on.

This gives the GD a working criterion for recognising a fertile Piece: after introducing it, they should be able to formulate several interesting questions about it that they do not yet know how to answer. If the object merely confirms something the GD had already decided, it is probably functioning as a traditional clue. If, on the contrary, its appearance opens up relationships, suspicions and possible lines of action, it is doing the proper work of a Piece of Conflict.

The Pieces, therefore, do not form a chain:

Piece → Piece → Piece → Solution

They form a constellation. Each new element can relate to several earlier ones, alter the interpretation of what was already known or make relevant something that until then seemed secondary. The more Pieces the players gather, the more they have not only information at their disposal, but more possible relationships with which to build meaning.

INVESTIGATING UNTIL THERE IS ENOUGH WORLD

The Pieces also have a mechanical function. The players need to gather at least three Pieces of Conflict before they can leave the Investigation Phase and move on to the Action Phase. The minimum guarantees that the adventure has produced enough significant material so that the players do not have to act upon a practically empty conflict. Three Pieces already make it possible to compare, relate, suspect and begin to formulate an interpretation.

However, three is a threshold, not a goal. The players can keep investigating and gather more Pieces before moving on. Doing so widens the available constellation of meanings and will later have mechanical consequences: the more pertinent Pieces they have managed to gather and articulate, the better their chances in the Prism Rolls of the Resolution Phase. Investigation thus presents a genuine decision. The players can act as soon as they have

enough material to do so, or keep exploring the Conflict in search of new relationships that will later strengthen their interpretation.

The GD, for their part, should not turn this possibility into an invitation to accumulate Pieces indefinitely. The fiction must keep breathing: events evolve, NPCs act and the Conflict may transform. Investigating further provides possibilities, but it also means remaining longer inside a situation that will not necessarily wait motionless.

THE DIRECTION PIECE

Among the Pieces of Conflict there must be at least one that fulfils a particular function: providing the players with a concrete direction from which they can tackle the Starting Conflict directly. We could call it the Direction Piece. Unlike the others, its practical function must be unmistakable, even if its meaning remains open.

Let us return to the abandoned café. The PCs decide to investigate it and find in the back room an old computer containing an encrypted file. After managing to translate it, they discover that it is a report of the Summa Archive recording several waves of disappearances that took place over numerous tetrads. The document repeatedly mentions a secret laboratory located somewhere on the Hesiod Moor and establishes that there is a deep relationship between that place and the disappearances.

The direction is unmistakable: there is something on the Hesiod Moor that deserves to be investigated directly. The players now have a concrete path towards the Action Phase.

But the interpretation remains open.

The report does not necessarily establish that the Summa Archive is responsible for the disappearances. Nor does it state that the victims have been taken to the laboratory, that they are being experimented on there, or even that they are still alive. Perhaps the Archive was investigating the phenomenon; perhaps it was trying to contain it; perhaps someone forged the document; perhaps the laboratory does not receive the disappeared, but something they leave behind when they disappear. The Piece closes the uncertainty about where the group can act, but it does not close the uncertainty about what the thing they will find means.

This distinction is fundamental. The Direction Piece is not «the right clue», nor does it reveal the solution to the conflict. It is a door visible enough for the players to be able to decide to go through it.

WHEN TO OFFER A DIRECTION

Nor should the Direction Piece appear in obedience to a rigid counter. There is no special virtue in introducing it as exactly the third, fourth or fifth Piece. The GD must observe, all

together, the pace of the narration, the number of Pieces gathered and the fertility of the relationships the players are building.

If the players have barely begun to understand the Conflict, introducing an unmistakable direction too early can rush the adventure before it has produced enough narrative material. If, on the contrary, they have spent a long time accumulating elements without finding any concrete possibility of intervention, artificially prolonging the Investigation can turn openness into paralysis.

There is one particularly useful indicator: the Direction Piece should appear when the players already have things to think about, but need a place –material, social, political, symbolic– on which to act.

Sometimes it will be a pregenerated Piece that the GD finds the right moment to introduce. At other times it will arise emergently, precisely because one of the players' actions has created a direction much more interesting than the one prepared. Like any other proposal of the GD, the planned Direction Piece can be abandoned if the fiction has produced a better one.

Once they have obtained it, the players decide what to do with it. They may consider that they have enough elements and move on to the Action Phase, or keep investigating to gather new Pieces, test their suspicions and widen the constellation before confronting the Conflict directly. The direction exists; the urgency of following it belongs to the players.

THE PRINCIPLE OF THE PIECES

The Pieces of Conflict make it possible, in short, to replace an architecture of discovery with an architecture of meaning-making. The GD does not hand out fragments of a broken truth in the hope that the players will reassemble it correctly. They introduce significant objects, strange events, incomplete documents, suspicious behaviour and potential relationships that lend resistance and matter to the imagination.

That is why a Piece must satisfy three conditions:

1. It must be concrete. Something has really appeared in the fiction and the players can relate to it.
2. It must be relevant. The way it is presented makes it possible to understand that it bears some potential relationship to the Starting Conflict.
3. It must be open. The exact nature of that relationship is not decided beforehand and admits different interpretations.

If concreteness is lacking, the Piece is an abstraction. If relevance is lacking, it is mere decoration. If openness is lacking, it is a clue.

And the Pieces of Conflict are not there to prove that the GD knew the answer. They are there so that, when an answer finally appears, it seems to have been waiting the whole adventure to be discovered.

FRAGMENT 4: RUMOUROLOGY

In Numinia, knowledge rarely takes the reassuring form of a definitive truth. The city keeps archives, institutions, libraries and specialists devoted to preserving and organising knowledge, but it is also a cultural organism subject to memory, interpretation and the alterations of the Veil. One and the same event can survive as a document for some, a warning for others and an absurd legend for those who arrived late to the conversation.

Among these strata circulates Rumourology: the body of tales, fragmentary memories, testimonies, hypotheses, superstitions and symbolic associations through which the inhabitants of Numinia try to explain what they know only incompletely.

Rumours do not constitute systematic knowledge. Nor are they necessarily false. A rumour can preserve the distorted shape of a true fact, mix up different events, express the interests of those who pass it on or offer a mistaken interpretation of something that really happened. Others are false from beginning to end and, as befits good falsehoods, can prove extraordinarily informative about those who chose to believe them.

Rumourology is, therefore, the informal memory of Numinia: what the city believes it remembers when nobody can produce a document convincing enough to end the argument.

RUMOUROLOGY AS AN ADVENTURE RESOURCE

Rumourology is an optional resource for building adventures. Not every adventure needs to use it, nor should the GD turn every anomaly into the object of rumours. It is especially fertile when an element has become important enough that it is worth discovering not only *what it is*, but what Numinia thinks about it.

Unlike the Dialogic Resonance, Rumourology is not primarily a tool of collaborative creation. The players can bring it into play through their investigations and decide which elements they wish to look into, but it falls fundamentally to the GD to provide the rumours. Its purpose is to broaden the cultural context of the adventure, introduce new relationships and offer material that the players can accept, suspect, compare, reinterpret or turn into new lines of investigation.

A rumour can be pregenerated in the Root, prepared as a possibility that the GD will introduce if they find an appropriate moment. Like any other element of the Root, it is not immutable: it can be modified to incorporate events and proposals that have arisen during the game.

It can also be emergent. If the players attach importance to an element the GD had never foreseen, the GD can create on the spot one or several rumours expressing how that element has been perceived by different sectors of Numinia. The city thus acquires memory around what the players have decided to make significant.

FROM DETAIL TO CULTURAL OBJECT

Not every element of the fiction possesses Rumourology. For something to be investigated in this way it must have become culturised: it must have stopped functioning as an isolated detail and acquired a recognisable presence within the imaginary of Numinia.

Culturisation may come about because an element appears repeatedly, because different characters seem to know of it, because its presence is discovered in different places, or because the PCs themselves establish a sufficiently meaningful relationship with it. At that moment it ceases to be merely *something that has happened in this scene* and becomes *something about which Numinia may have something to say*.

Let us imagine that a PC notices, in a room of the Prytaneum, a generative abstract painting whose forms produce in them a strange feeling of familiarity. The fact, in itself, may be no more than a detail. Later, in the Hyperborean Tavern, they discover that one of the customers wears a shirt printed with an extraordinarily similar pattern. The repetition establishes a relationship. The motif has begun to become culturised.

The PCs could then investigate its Rumourology and discover, for example:

LECTURA

«The patterns first appeared several tetrads ago in the dreams of some Oneiromancers of the Solomon District.»

Or perhaps:

LECTURA

«There is a superstition that whoever reproduces one of those drawings from memory ends up adding a figure that was not in the original.»

Neither of the two rumours explains what the patterns really are. Both do something more useful for the adventure: they grant them a past, relationships and possibilities.

INVESTIGATING RUMOUROLOGY

When the players want to find out what is said about a culturised element, they must explain how they gain access to that stratum of collective memory. They may question inhabitants connected with the matter, consult archives and publications, look through private collections, turn to cultural institutions, explore places linked to the phenomenon, or resort to any procedure consistent with the fiction.

Not all sources provide the same kind of rumours. An archive may preserve old versions; a tavern, tales deformed by decades of oral transmission; an institution, official interpretations; a clandestine market, self-interested versions that nobody would admit to in public. Choosing where to ask is therefore part of the investigation.

In game terms, investigating Rumourology is resolved by means of an Inquire Roll, in accordance with the rules for Action Rolls. The GD determines how many rumours the source can provide according to its richness and relevance. Questioning an NPC tangentially connected with the matter may yield a single rumour; consulting a relevant documentary collection, two; gaining access to an especially rich archive could provide several.

The number should not become a rigid tariff. The fundamental question is much simpler: how many interesting versions can this source reasonably contain?

RESULTS OF THE ROLL

The degree obtained in the Inquire Roll determines not only access to the Rumourology but also how much context the PC obtains with which to interpret it.

Critical Failure The PC obtains no relevant rumour. The investigation does not grant access to any significant cultural information about the element being investigated.

Failure The PC obtains an unclassified rumour. They discover what is said, but lack sufficient elements to assess the origin or plausibility of that version.

Success The PC obtains a classified rumour. As well as learning it, they receive an indication of its possible truth or falsehood.

Total Success The PC obtains a classified and commented rumour. As well as roughly assessing its reliability, they gain access to information about its origin, deformation, context or relationship with other elements.

The gradation is important: a better result does not automatically turn the rumour into truth; it allows a better understanding of what kind of rumour it is. Rumourology studies the

circulation of knowledge; it does not grant omniscience. Numinia would be a far less interesting place if a good roll were enough to put an end to a good doubt.

CLASSIFYING A RUMOUR

When the result allows it to be classified, the GD adds a brief indication to guide the players as to its status. The classification is not a certificate of truth, but an assessment of its plausibility, origin or degree of deformation.

Some possible classifications are:

- Probably true.
- Partially true, but biased.
- Based on a real fact, but distorted.
- Probably false.
- Unknown origin.
- Absolutely plausible.
- Dangerously close to the truth.
- As hard to prove as to refute.

The GD may create other classifications when the context requires it. In fact, slightly interpretative formulations tend to prove more evocative than a mathematical scale of reliability. «Probably true» informs; «nobody has managed to prove it, although three institutions have tried to erase it» begins to provoke adventures.

COMMENTING ON A RUMOUR

With a Total Success, the rumour also incorporates a comment. This must not reveal the solution of the Conflict, nor definitively explain what the PCs are investigating. Its function is to provide a second level of reading: to explain who upholds that version, where it appeared, why it might have become deformed, or what relationship it bears to other known elements.

For example:

Rumour: *The clocks of the Corridor of Memory stop for a few seconds before someone disappears.*

Classification: *Based on a real fact, but distorted.*

Comment: *The earliest versions did not speak of all the clocks, but only of the old anemochronic clocks. The generalisation appeared much later.*

The comment does not resolve the rumour. It refines it. And, in refining it, it may offer a new direction for the investigation.

BUILDING GOOD RUMOURS

A fruitful rumour should contain something concrete enough to be usable and something uncertain enough to need interpretation. Saying «strange things are told about that building» provides scarcely any game material. Saying «the neighbours insist that on some nights the lift arrives at a floor that does not appear on the panel» immediately offers something to observe, check, connect or pursue.

It is also advisable that rumours should not be mere variations of true or false about one and the same statement. Different rumours may focus on different aspects of the phenomenon and produce a contradictory cultural image.

Suppose the PCs are investigating the laboratory on Hesiod Moor mentioned in a Piece of Conflict. The GD could have the following rumours to hand:

Rumour: *The laboratory was closed down thirty tetrads ago after all its researchers disappeared on the same night.* Classification: *Partially true, but biased.*

Rumour: *Supplies still arrive at the laboratory once every cycle, although nobody admits to sending them.* Classification: *Probably true.*

Rumour: *The laboratory is not abandoned: it simply stopped being in the same place.* Classification: *As hard to prove as to refute.*

Rumour: *Those who have disappeared in recent years share a trait that the laboratory's researchers were trying to reproduce artificially.* Classification: *Unknown origin.*

Observe that all four rumours could coexist. None obliges the GD to decide yet which one explains the Conflict. Instead, each provides a different way of relating to it.

RUMOURS AND PIECES OF CONFLICT

A Rumour is not anything like a Piece of Conflict. It is worth keeping this distinction clean.

The rumour belongs to the cultural context: it expresses something that is said, remembered, suspected or interpreted. The Piece is a concrete manifestation that has acquired relevance within the Conflict. Nevertheless, investigating a rumour may lead to the discovery of a Piece, just as a Piece may acquire a new dimension when the PCs investigate its Rumourology.

If the characters hear that «the anemochronic clocks stop before a disappearance», they possess a rumour. If they later find in the laboratory an anemochronic clock stopped at exactly the hour at which one of the individuals they are investigating disappeared, that object may become a Piece of Conflict.

In this way, Rumourology does not replace the Pieces: it surrounds them with culture.

PREGENERATED RUMOURS AND EMERGENT RUMOURS

When building the Root, the GD may prepare a few rumours related to its NPCs, places, phenomena and potential Pieces. It is advisable to write them as flexible material, not as covert expositions of a truth that the players must reconstruct.

A pregenerated rumour may change during the adventure. If the players have established through their actions that a certain NPC has an unexpected relationship with the Conflict, a rumour prepared about another matter may shift towards that NPC. If an initially secondary Piece becomes the centre of their investigations, rumours may appear that were never written down.

The GD may also create entirely new rumours on the fly. A simple formula consists in asking oneself:

LECTURA

What version would Numinia have built about this if it had spent a long time trying to explain it to itself without ever quite succeeding?

The answer does not have to be correct. It has to be culturally plausible and narratively fertile.

THE CITY AS A LIVING ARCHIVE

Rumourology allows Numinia to possess something that no GD's encyclopaedia could ever fully prepare: social memory.

Events do not exist only when the PCs reach them. They have been observed, misinterpreted, feared, trivialised, turned into jokes, debated by specialists, exploited politically and deformed by people who knew someone who claims to have spoken with someone who was there. The city has been telling itself about itself for a long time.

That is why rumours are not second-class information. They are cultural objects: testimonies of the relationship that Numinia maintains with whatever it does not yet understand.

And, within an emergent adventure, they possess an additional virtue. They allow the GD to introduce history without necessarily introducing an answer. They add a past without closing off the future; context without imposing interpretation; paths without pointing out which one must be walked.

Dialogic Resonance asks the players what the world may mean. The Pieces of Conflict provide them with things whose meaning they will have to construct. Rumourology adds a third voice, deliciously indiscreet: what the world itself has long been saying about them.

And a city that talks about itself, naturally, also lies from time to time. Otherwise, why would we have invented plazas?

FRAGMENT 5: THE HERMENEUTIC ACTION

Numinia is full of things that seem to want to say something.

A face appears repeatedly in photographs taken decades apart. A creature always leaves three perfectly aligned stones behind after it disappears. An NPC speaks using only verbs in the future tense. In an abandoned plaza, a chair remains turned towards a wall on which there is nothing. A sculpture changes its posture every time someone utters a certain name.

These elements are not necessarily Pieces of Conflict or Rumours. Their fundamental characteristic is a different one: they carry an evident symbolic charge and a meaning still undetermined.

We shall call these elements Symbolic Figures.

A Symbolic Figure may be an object, an image, an event, a behaviour, a person, a spatial arrangement, a phrase, or any other manifestation singular enough to provoke the impression that its immediate appearance does not exhaust what it means.

The GD may introduce them in pregenerated form as part of the possibilities of the Root, or make them appear during the session out of the events and contributions of the players. As with other open elements of the adventure, their meaning must not be decided beforehand.

The Figure does not conceal a correct interpretation. It is a structure waiting to be interpreted.

INTERPRETATION

When the PCs come across a Symbolic Figure, the GD proposes a Hermeneutic Action. The players must interpret what they are contemplating from the perspective of their PCs.

But there is one fundamental condition: a PC does not interpret freely from any possible system. Their gaze is conditioned by their Position.

Here the Position works as an Interpretation Factor: it gives the player a concrete procedure through which to translate the Figure into meaning. The Game Master looks for an enigma; the Oneiromancer recognises an image of the unconscious; the Armonaut finds a trope; other PCs will use the systems of interpretation proper to their respective Positions.

This does not mean that two characters with the same Position have to reach the same conclusion. It means that they share an interpretative grammar, not a dictionary of answers.

Two Armonauts may see completely different metaphors in one and the same image. What they share is the decision to read it metaphorically.

INTERPRETING MODIFIES WHAT IS INTERPRETED

The decisive particularity of the Hermeneutic Action is that its result is not limited to describing what the PC thinks.

The interpretation becomes part of the narrative nature of the Figure and, therefore, modifies or gives new dimension to its role in the story.

If an Oneiromancer interprets a flooded room as the representation of a repressed memory, that reading is not confined to the character's psychology. The GD will begin to integrate that relationship into the adventure. Perhaps the water will later respond to memories; perhaps another Piece of Conflict will reproduce the same image; perhaps we shall discover that someone connected with the Conflict is trying to forget something. The interpretation draws reality towards itself.

This does not mean that any passing notion immediately becomes an absolute truth. Just as happens with the anchors of confrontations, the interpretation must rest on what has been shown and must not contradict the fiction already established. But, within those limits, the GD takes on the commitment to make the proposed reading produce consequences.

Hermeneutics does not find out what the Figure meant. It decides what it begins to mean.

MULTIPLE INTERPRETATIONS

One and the same Figure may be interpreted by several PCs.

In fact, this is where one of the mechanic's most fertile possibilities appears.

Let us imagine a room in which there is a table laid for thirteen diners, but twelve of the chairs are covered in ash and one remains completely clean.

The Game Master could interpret the arrangement as a riddle: *there are thirteen positions and a single exception; the key lies in working out which rule allows that chair to be occupied.*

The Oneiromancer could interpret the twelve covered chairs as extinguished identities and the thirteenth as the persistence of a self that refuses to disappear.

The Armonaut could read the scene as a synecdoche: the table represents a whole community, and the empty chair, that which has survived its disappearance.

No reading has to invalidate the others.

The system of confrontations already establishes that two coherent interpretations may represent different angles of the same structure. The Hermeneutic Action carries that principle into the narrative heart of the adventure: the GD looks for a meaning capable of establishing relationships between the different readings.

Perhaps, then, the twelve chairs correspond to twelve missing individuals, and the clean one to a person who was supposed to disappear but managed to avoid it. For the Game Master there is a rule and an exception; for the Oneiromancer, an identity that resists being erased; for the Armonaut, an individual who represents the survival of the whole.

All three interpretations have taken part in the creation of what the image ends up being.

HERMENEUTIC SYNTHESIS

When several characters perform a Hermeneutic Action on the same Figure, the GD should not simply choose the «best» interpretation. Their function is to seek a hermeneutic synthesis: a relationship that allows the greatest possible number of readings to manifest themselves simultaneously.

This does not require joining them together artificially. Some may acquire greater importance than others; one may determine the fundamental nature of the Figure while another becomes a secondary consequence or a cross-cutting story. What matters is that the pertinent interpretations leave their mark.

Here the same principle that governs collaborative creation comes into play once again: a proposal received seriously deserves a serious answer.

Interpretation is not an exam whose solution the GD knows. It is a proposal addressed to the world. And Numinia answers.

THE POSITION AS A LENS

The Hermeneutic Action turns each Position into an epistemological lens. The player does not simply receive the instruction to «interpret in keeping with their character», a formula as generous as it is useless. Each Position has a concrete procedure that allows work to begin.

Taking the Positions already established and their profiles –the Game Master oriented towards the enigma, the Armonaut towards rhetoric, the Ethnarch towards cultural patterns, the Archivist towards historical memory, the Hermeneut towards semiotics, etc.–, they can be organised as follows.

TABLA 7.1

POSITION	HERMENEUTIC LENS	INTERPRETATION PROCEDURE
<i>Guardian of the Gates</i>	Liminal	Interprets the element as something that lies on the frontier between two dimensions of meaning, a form on the threshold.
<i>Pythia</i>	Oracular	Interprets through oracular chants, as predictions or prophecies, with a meaningfully cryptic formula.
<i>Ambassador</i>	Pragmatic	Interprets from pragmatism, understanding the figures as norms, as structural rules, natural laws or signs.
<i>Game Master</i>	Ludic	Turns the element into a riddle, puzzle or other game dynamic, and looks for the meaning that emerges on solving it.
<i>Legionary of the Threshold</i>	Strategic	Interprets the element as a configuration of forces: starting from dialectical thinking, makes a reading of two forces in conflict.
<i>Armonaut</i>	Tropic	Translates it by means of metaphors, allegories and rhetorical figures, asking what else the thing it observes represents.
<i>Whisperer of Machines</i>	Systemic	Interprets the element as an algorithm, a mathematical formula or a code routine; looks for what function it fulfils within a larger structure.
<i>Runner of the Veil</i>	Topological	Interprets it as path, position or transit: where it comes from, where it leads, what it connects and what invisible route it suggests.

POSITION	HERMENEUTIC LENS	INTERPRETATION PROCEDURE
<i>Archivist</i>	Stratigraphic	Looks for the temporal layers of the element: what it represents of the past, what its historical reference is, what role it occupies in the archives.
<i>Hermeneut</i>	Semiotic	Analyses relationships between sign and meaning, linguistic structures of sense, and also the secondary readings (the subtext).

TABLA 7.2

POSITION	HERMENEUTIC LENS	INTERPRETATION PROCEDURE
<i>Mediator of the Prism</i>	Perspectivist	Projects the element into several simultaneous readings and looks for what changes when it is contemplated from different positions.
<i>Cartographer of the Wind</i>	Cartographic	Reads everything as part of a map. It may be the map of an ecosystem, of a territory, of a sociocultural context. It is an X on the whole.
<i>Ethnarch</i>	Cultural	Interprets it as the expression of a collective practice: rite, taboo, custom, myth, procedure or shared memory.
<i>Anacharchid</i>	Incongruous	Looks for the relationship between apparently incompatible elements; interprets from contradiction and paradox, using antithesis and oxymoron.
<i>Oneiromancer</i>	Oneiric	Treats the element as an image of the unconscious and interprets it through symbolic associations, transferences and correspondences of the dream.

These lenses do not add a roll, nor do they automatically grant a mechanical advantage. They are procedures for producing interpretation.

Example: *the PCs face the image of an immense sea at night, but it is a sea of black stone, where the waves are rugged reliefs of the terrain.*

Guardian of the Gates: «The sea is the passage from one period to another, a space of transit».

Pythia: «A sea of black stone will devour us when we face the path that calls us».

Ambassador: «The sea of black stone signals that a hard and austere crossing awaits us».

Game Master: «*Mar de Piedra*, "Sea of Stone", is an anagram of *Pedir a madre*, "Ask mother". It is a summons».

Legionary of the Threshold: «A nucleus between opposing forces, there where neither prevails».

Armonaut: «The sea of black stone is a metaphor for death and mourning».

Whisperer of Machines: «An iterative algorithm; the swell calculates the distance to the conflict».

Runner of the Veil: «The sea of stone is a safe point in an unstable territory».

Archivist: «In our search, we will find something that comes from the Dark Age».

Hermeneut: «The sea of stone is the idea of the immutable; something eternal surrounds us».

Mediator of the Prism: «It is stone for the one who dives in, it is sea for the one who watches».

Cartographer of the Wind: «It represents some geographical area of the periphery of Numinia».

Ethnarch: «A sea of stone is the representation of a powerful and silent god».

Anacharchid: «In the sea of stone, what is motionless travels and what moves remains».

Oneiromancer: «The sea of stone represents a mother of rigid and censorious character».

INSTRUMENTS OF INTERPRETATION

Whenever possible, the Hermeneutic Action can rely on a real instrument of interpretation. This prevents the lens of each Position from being reduced to an abstract indication and gives the player something concrete to play with.

A Game Master might have a deck of Tarot cards to hand and draw a spread for each interpretation, or own an anagram generator, or turn elements of the Figure into the pieces of a small puzzle; the Oneiromancer might turn to repertoires of symbols or a dictionary of dream interpretation; the Armonaut might carry a repertoire of rhetorical figures or a collection of metaphors, and search for the one they deem capable of explaining what they are contemplating.

The tool does not contain «the answer». It produces fertile constraints, in the same way that rules provide a field on which to play.

If a card drawn by the Game Master in a Tarot spread is *The Tower*, this does not mean that the Figure «is The Tower». It means that the player must discover what relationship they can build between the Figure and whatever that card allows them to think.

Thus, Hermeneutics upholds the fundamental principle we have been using throughout the chapter: the system does not provide solutions; it provides structures that make it possible to create solutions with resistance.

AN IMPORTANT DIFFERENCE: ICON, INDEX AND LEGISIGN

The Hermeneutic Action starts from a fundamental idea: one and the same Symbolic Figure can produce meaning through very different relationships. As an operational reference, Numinia adopts three forms of relationship, drawing on what semiotics, following the theories of Peirce, regards as the three traditional types of sign: icon, index and legisign. This classification is used here as a tool of interpretation, and not as a strict reproduction of the categories of classical semiotics ¹⁸.

In the icon, the sign refers to what it signifies through some form of resemblance. A silhouette can represent a mountain because it reproduces its shape; an image of darkness can evoke death because it shares with it certain culturally recognisable qualities. This logic is especially important for the interpretation of the Armonaut, whose rhetorical lens establishes figurative relationships between the Figure and another reality. Metaphor finds meaning by transferring properties from one term to another on a basis of resemblance or analogy.

¹⁸ · Strictly speaking, Peirce calls the last type of sign a *symbol*, and points out its character as a legisign; in Numinia we shall use *legisign* directly, reserving the word *symbol* for its broader sense within the Hermeneutic Action, since throughout the theoretical history of interpretation the term *symbol* has acquired a greater dimension of meaning.

In the index, on the other hand, meaning arises from a relationship of contiguity, connection or consequence. Smoke indicates fire not because it resembles it, but because a physical relationship exists between the two; a footprint signals someone's passing because it is the effect of their presence. This relationship is especially fertile for those Hermeneutic Lenses that read a Figure as the trace, consequence, provenance or manifestation of something else, such as the Ambassador.

The legisign, as it will be used operationally in this section, makes it possible to address relationships whose meaning depends on a code, a convention or a learned system rather than on an immediate resemblance or material connection. Its interest for the Hermeneutic Action appears above all in the interpretation of the Oneiromancer: the images of the unconscious need not resemble what they express. A house can become a body, water a birth, or a closed door a prohibition, through deep associations whose logic comes from psychic, cultural and personal experience. The relationship may seem arbitrary from the outside, but it is not without motivation for whoever produces it.

This makes it possible to draw an essential distinction between metaphor and unconscious image. When the Armonaut interprets the *Sea of Black Stone* as an image of death and mourning, they build an analogical relationship: darkness, stillness and desolate expanse allow resemblances to be recognised between the two realities. When the Oneiromancer interprets that same sea as a rigid, censorious mother, the operation is different: they do not claim that a mother resembles a sea of stone, but establish a chain of associations –sea, origin, mother; stone, rigidity; black, prohibition or repression– whose meaning emerges from an unconscious logic.

WHEN TO INTRODUCE A HERMENEUTIC FIGURE

The Hermeneutic Action possesses considerable narrative power and, precisely for that reason, should not be used constantly.

A Dialogic Resonance can fill in details of context relatively often. Rumourology can expand numerous culturalised elements. A Hermeneutic Figure, on the other hand, can profoundly alter the meaning of an adventure, because the players intervene directly in the nature of a symbolically charged element.

The GD should reserve it for moments when the fiction can bear a major fork.

It is especially appropriate when a central image of the Conflict appears, when a Piece holds exceptional symbolic content, after a Turbulence Phase, in the face of an especially significant anomaly, or when the adventure needs to open up a new field of interpretations. The GD can have these Symbolic Figures prepared in the Root, which gives them the chance to reflect carefully on their role in the adventure or to discard one, should the need arise.

Before introducing it, the GD should ask themselves a very simple question:

«Am I willing to let the players' interpretation change what this means and, with it, potentially change the adventure?»

If the answer is no, the conclusion is clear: it should not be presented as a Symbolic Figure.

THE DUTY OF CONSEQUENCE

Once a Hermeneutic Action has been activated, the GD takes on the same commitment as with any other Space of Indeterminacy: they must allow interpretations to have consequences.

Not necessarily immediate ones. Nor necessarily literal ones.

An interpretation may reappear transformed into a Piece of Conflict; alter the attitude of an NPC; retrospectively explain an event; generate a cross-cutting story; suggest a new location;

alter a future Symbolic Figure; or end up taking part in the overall interpretation of the Conflict during the Resolution.

The former adventure scheme already establishes that the players' theories may use Pieces, events and earlier contributions, and that the world responds to that interpretation instead of revealing a «hidden truth». Hermeneutics allows that construction to begin long before the Resolution.

Each Hermeneutic Action lays down layers of meaning.

And when the players finally look upon the complete adventure, part of what will seem to have been there from the very beginning will in fact have been born from the way they chose to look at it.

FRAGMENT 6: MANAGING THE PHASES

The Phases should not be understood as chapters that the GD writes before the adventure begins. They are narrative regimes: moments in which the purpose of the game, the rhythm of the narration and, above all, the distribution of initiative between the GD and the players change. The question the GD should ask when preparing a Phase is therefore not «*what is going to happen here?*», but «what must be able to happen here, and what do I need to lay out so that the players can bring it about?»

This difference is fundamental. Preparing an Investigation Phase does not consist of writing a succession of scenes —first they will visit the Archive, then they will question the witness and finally they will discover the laboratory—, because nothing guarantees that the players will want to do any of those things. It consists of laying out possibilities: places, NPCs, Pieces of Conflict, Symbolic Figures, potential events, tensions, Dialogic Resonance questions and any other element that can be incorporated when the fiction finds the right moment. Some will appear; others will be transformed on coming into contact with the players' proposals; many will never be used at all.

For this reason, managing the Phases requires attending simultaneously to three variables: authority, rhythm and content. Authority determines who holds the greater initiative at each moment to produce the fiction. Rhythm determines how long a situation should be prolonged before its capacity to produce meaning begins to run dry. Content determines which elements it is advisable to introduce, recover or leave in suspense. All three variables change from one Phase to another.

This produces a kind of breathing of the adventure. The GD initially takes the voice, cedes it little by little, lets the players expand the fiction, gathers it back to put in order what has been produced, hands it over again during the action and finally regains considerable control when the conflict enters Resolution. There is, therefore, no constant distribution of

authority. Directing Numinia also consists of knowing when to speak, when to ask, when to intervene and when to have the exquisite courtesy to keep quiet.

The transitions between Phases are part of that breathing. The GD can always simply announce «*the Investigation Phase begins*», but, whenever possible, it is preferable to make the change visible through the fiction itself. An event, an arrival, a decision, a journey or even a change of scene can naturally alter the narrative regime of the game. The seams exist; there is no need to show them off every time.

PRESENTATION PHASE: DELIVERING THE CONFLICT

In the Presentation, the GD clearly holds the main voice. It is the moment closest to traditional narration and may take on a certain literary quality: an opening sequence built carefully enough to present the immediate world of the adventure, establish its tone and bring the Starting Conflict into view. The GD should have no qualms about describing, arranging events, playing NPCs and steering the players' attention for a while. This is the entrance gate, and someone must have the kindness to open it. The GD approaches this Phase as though the players were reading –or listening to– the first chapter of a novel.

But holding the main voice does not mean monopolising it. The Presentation must already begin to show what kind of game Numinia is. One or two instances of Dialogic Resonance make it possible to open small Spaces of Indeterminacy within a predominantly directed sequence: *What detail of the Ministerial Hall makes you think someone has left the place in a hurry?*, *Why do you immediately recognise the individual waiting by the door?* The GD establishes the situation; the players begin to contaminate it delightfully with their own contributions.

It is wise to be especially careful with the amount of information. The Presentation should offer enough material to speculate on, but not so much as to conclude. The established facts should be clear; their relationships, not necessarily. If three Numinids have disappeared, an agent of the Summa Archive has come to the scene and the same Veil anomaly has been recorded in all three disappearances, those facts can be perfectly well established. What they mean together must remain open.

Its duration should be relatively short. The danger of an overlong Presentation is that it turns into a lecture by the GD on the marvellous adventure they have prepared while everyone else politely contemplates their enthusiasm. When the players know the conflict, possess several significant pieces of information and have enough material to formulate initial interpretations, the Presentation has fulfilled its function.

The transition can be brought about by a small event that closes the exposition: the NPC who summoned them leaves, an unexpected message arrives, they are handed an object related to the conflict, or they are simply left alone after receiving the commission. The world stops speaking to them. Now it is their turn to speak about it.

DELIBERATION PHASE: LISTENING TO THE FIRST HYPOTHESES

The Deliberation reverses the previous relationship. The GD cedes the initiative to the players. The PCs provide the situation from which the conversation takes place, but it is the players who must partly step out of them in order to observe the adventure from the outside and formulate their Starting Hypotheses.

This distinction must be explicit. The GD can place the PCs arguing around a table in the Hyperborean Tavern, but when they ask *what do you think is going on?* they must make it clear whether they are addressing the character or the player. The difference may seem small until it stops being so. It is one thing for a Legionary to suspect the Summa Archive because experience has taught them to distrust certain institutions; it is another for their player to propose that the Archive is concealing a clandestine investigation because they consider that narrative possibility fertile.

The Starting Hypotheses do not require consensus. On the contrary: divergence is valuable. One player may suspect that the disappearances are the result of an experiment; another, that the disappeared share some piece of knowledge; a third, that someone is trying to move them out of Numinia. The GD must listen to the hypotheses like someone receiving seeds, not like someone marking an exam. None is automatically confirmed, but all of them offer materials that may later become details, cross-cutting stories, Pieces of Conflict or even central elements of the adventure.

The GD should stimulate the debate without steering its conclusions. They may recall a forgotten detail, point out a contradiction or ask a player what leads them to uphold a given hypothesis, but they must not surreptitiously lead the conversation towards what they had imagined in the Root.

The Deliberation should be brief, though not hurried. Each player needs time to formulate a consistent hypothesis and test it against the others. When arguments begin to repeat themselves, the positions are clear and the conversation stops producing new possibilities, the Phase has come to its end.

Then a single question is enough to return the players to their PCs and open the next Phase:

LECTURA

Very well. Where do you begin to investigate?

INVESTIGATION PHASE: ADMINISTERING THE EXPANSION

The Investigation is normally the longest Phase of the adventure, and the one in which emergent creation reaches its greatest breadth. It should not be understood exclusively in a detective sense. To investigate here means to increase the group's capacity to understand and face the Conflict: exploring places, questioning NPCs, seeking information, obtaining resources, testing hypotheses, exposing themselves to events, interpreting Symbolic Figures or discovering possibilities for action that did not exist before.

The GD's position changes radically. They no longer lead the players through a sequence, but administer the consequences of their decisions. The players choose where to go, what to investigate, whom to speak to and which elements they consider relevant. The GD provides resistance, response and continuity.

This does not mean adopting a notarial passivity. An Investigation needs events. Things must happen. An NPC may lie, a facility may suffer an anomaly, someone may follow the PCs, a creature may appear, a faction may intervene, an interpretation may produce unexpected consequences. There may be confrontations, Action Rolls, Heterocosmic Rolls and scenes of great intensity. Freedom of initiative does not in any way mean an absence of dramatic pressure.

Here several of the tools described earlier find their natural territory. Dialogic Resonance makes it possible to build spaces and situations; Rumourology expands elements that have acquired a cultural dimension; the Hermeneutic Action turns certain Symbolic Figures into engines of meaning; and the Heterocosmic allows the players to introduce realities capable of considerably altering the investigation. The GD's task consists of relating these contributions, recovering some of them later on and allowing others to disappear when they are no longer fertile.

But the main instrument for regulating the length of this Phase is the Pieces of Conflict. The GD must learn to recognise three different moments: when an emergent contribution deserves to become a Piece; when it is advisable to introduce one of the Pieces prepared in the Root; and when the moment has come to present the Direction Piece.

They should not hand them out according to a calendar. A Piece appears when a scene has produced something that deserves to acquire structural weight. If a player spontaneously steals an agent's wallet and the GD places inside it the card of an abandoned café connected to a disappearance, the player's own action has created the occasion for a Piece to be born. At another moment, an investigation that is beginning to lose direction may be the perfect occasion to bring back a pre-generated Piece.

The Direction Piece requires even greater judgement. Introduced too early, it impoverishes the Investigation by providing a path when possibilities have barely begun to open up; too late, it turns freedom into drift. It should appear when the adventure has already produced enough meaning for a direction to feel stimulating rather than restrictive.

Its appearance normally signals that the Investigation can end, but it does not compel it to. The players may want to keep looking for Pieces, test another hypothesis or settle some pending question. The GD should allow them to do so as long as the investigation keeps producing relevant content. When the scenes begin to repeat information, decisions no longer open new possibilities or the energy at the table starts to flag, the GD is entitled to bring about the transition.

The Investigation should be broad; not interminable. Even the most exquisite mystery ends up bearing a certain resemblance to an administrative meeting when it is investigated for too long.

REFLECTION PHASE: TURNING POSSIBILITIES INTO A DIRECTION

Reflection constitutes a second contraction of the rhythm. After the expansion of the Investigation, the players need to pause, observe what they have gathered and decide what it means to them. Its structure is reminiscent of the Deliberation, but there is one fundamental difference: now they must reach a shared interpretation.

The GD should create that space of rest within the fiction. The PCs may return to their lodgings, take shelter after a pursuit, occupy a safe room in the installation they are exploring or gather somewhere they can examine everything they have discovered. The stillness of the scene should deliberately contrast with the preceding activity.

Once that frame is established, the players take control again. They set out the Pieces they have obtained, recover their Starting Hypotheses –which may have changed radically–, incorporate everything that happened during the Investigation and build a common theory about the Conflict. Unlike in the Deliberation, this time it is not enough to keep several possibilities alive: they must decide which one to adopt.

Consensus does not mean discovering «the correct answer». It means choosing which interpretation they will turn into a principle of action.

Let us imagine that the Pieces make it possible to argue that the missing are being taken to a laboratory on the Hesiodic Moor, but there are several possible explanations: the Summa Archive is carrying out experiments on them; it is trying to protect them from some anomaly; or an infiltrated faction is using abandoned installations of the Archive. The players do not need to prove which one is true. They need to decide what they believe and what they will do because they believe it.

From this a concrete objective must emerge: to enter the laboratory and free the missing; to infiltrate it in order to identify those responsible; to destroy the installation; to negotiate with those who occupy it; or any other direction coherent with the theory they have built.

The GD should intervene little. They may put information in order, recall forgotten Pieces or ask the players to pin down a contradiction, but not resolve it for them. When there is an

agreed theory and an objective that can be acted upon, the Reflection is over.

And then the adventure expands once more, but no longer in every direction.

ACTION PHASE: ACCELERATING WITHOUT CLOSING

In the Action, the players retain a good part of the initiative they held during the Investigation, but the pressure of time changes radically. They are no longer slowly broadening their understanding of the Conflict: they are acting upon it. The narration must gain speed, risk and a growing sense of irreversibility.

The GD once again occupies a paradoxical position: they cede creative authority while increasing their control over the rhythm. The players decide how to act; the GD makes sure that whatever they act upon responds with energy.

Scenes should begin closer to their point of tension and end sooner. Irrelevant journeys can be compressed. Consequences must produce new situations quickly. If the PCs secretly enter a laboratory, there is no need to play out every corridor unless one of them holds a meaningful decision. What matters is the door they should not be able to open, the researcher who recognises them, the chamber where they find something incompatible with their theory, the alarm that has just gone off.

Collaborative creation does not disappear just because the fiction accelerates. On the contrary: the players' contributions must go on transforming the adventure. An intervention of the Heterocosmic, an unexpected interpretation or a particularly fertile decision may modify the setting of the Action as much as they previously modified the Investigation. The GD must not protect the climax they had imagined from the very players who are, precisely, creating it.

Dialogic Resonance takes on an especially intense form here through the Crossroads, a dynamic explained in the following fragment. Questions no longer merely broaden the context: they may force the swift determination of elements that alter a situation in motion.

Before beginning this Phase, the GD should be clear about which conditions indicate that the action has reached its end. It may be a single objective or several: reaching the heart of the laboratory, freeing certain captives, activating a mechanism, getting to an NPC, surviving a collapse. These conditions may be known to the players when the nature of the situation advises it, or remain implicit when that proves more effective narratively.

The Action is designed for a medium duration: more developed than the Presentation, Deliberation or Reflection, but more concentrated than the Investigation. It is not measured by the number of scenes but by the density of events. If the Investigation widens, the Action compresses.

And when the group has reached the point where it is no longer trying to reach the heart of the Conflict but confronting its definitive consequences, the Resolution should appear almost without needing to be announced.

RESOLUTION PHASE: HANDING THE ADVENTURE OVER TO THE PRISM

In the Resolution, the GD recovers a clearly leading position, but not in order to impose an outcome. Their function consists in presenting the decisive situations and administering the consequences of the Prism Rolls. The feeling sought is a peculiar one: after having built, interpreted and actively steered a good part of the adventure, the players reach a point at which what they have set in motion begins to respond of its own accord.

The Phase should be shorter than the Action and heighten the sense of vertigo even further. It is not advisable to introduce extensive new lines of investigation or secondary conflicts here. Everything must tend towards consequence.

The four Resolution situations must correspond to the characters of the Heterocosmic operators: alethic, deontic, epistemic and axiological. The GD should not present them as four mechanical boxes to be ceremoniously ticked off. They must search within the outcome for the fictional moment in which each question becomes pertinent: what can or cannot come to happen; which rule, obligation or prohibition comes into play; what can come to be known; and what value is acquired by what is taking place.

The main difficulty in directing lies precisely in the moment of introducing each Prism Roll. If it appears before the fiction has truly posed its question, it will feel artificial; if it appears after the scene has already resolved it narratively, it will be redundant. The roll must happen when the question exists and its answer can still transform the outcome.

Here it is essential to remember that Prism Rolls do not decide whether the players «win» or «lose» the adventure. They determine by which path its consequences materialise. An unfavourable result may produce a painful, costly or deeply uncomfortable reality; a favourable one may bring the story closer to the group's intentions. Neither invalidates what has been played. The adventure is not an exam whose mark is revealed at the end.

The GD must, moreover, allow the results to genuinely modify the situation. It is not advisable to decide beforehand what the outcome will be and use the Rolls to colour it in. Each result must close some possibilities and open others, so that the second Roll takes place already within the reality transformed by the first, the third within the consequences of the previous ones, and so on. The Resolution is cumulative.

Hence its particular feeling of loss of control. The players have built the theory, chosen the path and carried out their action; now they watch how the consequences link together and how Numinia responds to everything they have done.

The GD once again takes the lead voice, but there is a fundamental difference with respect to the Presentation. At the beginning they narrated possibilities still intact; now they narrate the consequences of a story that belongs to everyone.

FRAGMENT 7: OTHER NARRATIVE RESOURCES

In addition to the fundamental structures of collaborative creation, the GD may turn to other narrative resources intended to intervene at specific moments of the adventure: when a consequence needs to acquire meaning, when several proposals call out for an unexpected relationship, or when the fiction offers an especially fertile opportunity to return part of its authorship to the players. These resources are not obligatory steps, nor should they be incorporated systematically; they are tools of opportunity, procedures the GD can introduce when circumstances make them fruitful for opening new possibilities without interrupting the course of the narration. As always in Numinia, they are best used to cultivate the ground, not to decide in advance what must grow in it.

THE CROSSROADS

The Crossroads is a special form of Dialogic Resonance that is especially well suited to the Action Phase. Unlike an ordinary Resonance, it does not open a question for the players to complete freely; instead it presents three possible interpretations of an element that has already acquired relevance within the adventure.

The three options must be plausible given what has happened up to that moment and, above all, they must be equally compromising. A Crossroads does not pose one correct answer, one wrong one and a third especially prudent one. Nor does it offer a favourable option, a neutral one and a harmful one. It presents three different ways of complicating the fiction, each capable of leading the story somewhere different.

The players do not choose which consequence they would rather suffer. They choose what kind of truth has just entered the adventure.

Let us suppose that the PCs have entered a collective dream to find an Oneiromancer who went astray there many years ago. The dream is being interfered with by an ancient security protocol associated with the Veil and created to protect the memory of Numinia. Within the dream space, that protocol manifests as Elizabeth, a girl of about ten who seems entirely unaware of her true nature.

During the Action Phase, one of the PCs tries to stop the structure of the dream from breaking down by means of a Competence Roll and obtains an unfavourable result. The GD decides that the consequence will not simply be that «the dream becomes more unstable». Elizabeth has already acquired enough importance to become the centre of a Crossroads:

What is really happening with Elizabeth?

1. Elizabeth is completely mad.
2. Elizabeth is lying.
3. Elizabeth is irreversibly broken.

Any of the three answers introduces a significant difficulty, but none of them produces the same adventure.

If she is mad, the protocol goes on trying to fulfil its function through a distorted perception of what it must protect. If she is lying, one must ask what Elizabeth really knows and why she hides her nature. If she is broken, the problem is no longer only understanding her: there is a security structure of Numinia's memory whose deterioration perhaps cannot be reversed.

The GD does not need to have decided beforehand which of these possibilities was true. Whichever one the players choose becomes true, and from that moment on the GD must integrate it with the same seriousness as any other contribution consolidated during the adventure.

The Crossroads as consequence

The Crossroads works especially well when it appears linked to a series of Rolls during the Action Phase.

The Action usually contains situations in which the PCs must maintain a condition while they try to achieve their main objective: containing an anomaly, preventing a structure from collapsing, keeping a connection alive, stabilising a mechanism, protecting someone, keeping an access open or preventing an external force from finally prevailing.

The GD can articulate this pressure through successive Characteristic Rolls or, preferably when the fiction allows it, through Competence Rolls supported by some object, system or resource present in the scene. Competences are particularly suitable because they oblige the player to explain how they use their specialised knowledge to face the challenge.

For example, while several PCs travel through the collective dream in search of the Oneiromancer, another may use a device to keep their connection with the outside world stable. While the group crosses an installation that is collapsing, someone must keep its cooling system running. While they try to close a fracture in the Veil, another PC preserves the geometry of the space through Virtual Architecture.

These rolls are not necessarily confrontations, nor do they form a task independent of the Phase's objective. They are lines of containment: actions that prevent the environment from deteriorating while the characters try to complete what they have really come to do.

When one of these Rolls yields a Failure result, the GD sets a Crossroads in motion instead of unilaterally imposing its meaning. The Crossroads need not be directly related to the action that produced the failed roll. On the other hand, a Critical Failure with consequences does not rule out the appearance of the Crossroads.

The Critical Failure determines that something has become complicated.

The Crossroads allows the players to determine what that complication means.

Thus chance keeps its function –something has gone wrong–, but authorship of the consequence is once again shared around the table.

How to build a Crossroads

To prepare a Crossroads, the GD must always start from an element already charged with meaning. It may be an NPC, a Piece of Conflict, a place, an organisation, an object, a Symbolic Figure or any other aspect the players have learnt to recognise as relevant. The Crossroads is not the right moment to introduce three possibilities about an element nobody remembers: it must act on something whose transformation matters.

Next, the GD formulates three complete statements about that element. Not three actions the characters could carry out, but three different ways of understanding what has just happened.

The options must meet three conditions: they must be compatible with the known fiction; they must produce clearly different narrative consequences; and none may be manifestly more comfortable or desirable than the others. A good test consists in asking oneself: «If the players choose any of the three, am I sincerely interested in discovering what adventure arises from it?» If an option is there only so that nobody chooses it, the Crossroads is badly built.

For example, if an ancient device of the Summa Archive that is guiding the PCs begins to behave inexplicably, the GD could pose:

The device is leading you to the wrong place because...

1. Someone is modifying its signal from outside
2. It is following an old version of the map
3. It considers that your true destination is not the one you believe.

All three options are problematic. All three generate different questions. None of them amounts simply to «the apparatus is malfunctioning».

That is a Crossroads.

Choosing and moving on

The choice should be made relatively quickly. The Crossroads belongs especially to a Phase whose energy depends on movement; if each appearance produces twenty minutes of metaphysical deliberation, it will end up moving at roughly the speed of a land-registry procedure.

The GD may address the decision to the player whose action triggered the Crossroads, or to the whole group when the consequence clearly affects everyone. What matters is that it is made explicit who has the authority to choose before the options are presented.

Once the choice has been made, the GD should not immediately explain all its consequences. It is enough to make visible the first manifestation of the new reality and continue the Action.

The players have chosen that Elizabeth is lying.

The GD smiles, describes how the girl stops crying for an instant, looks straight at the PC and says:

—You shouldn't remember my name.

And the scene continues.

The Crossroads does not serve to halt the Action and explain it.

It serves to make the Action change direction while it is still running.

THE COUNTERPOINT

During an adventure, two contributions from the players will often appear that seem hard to reconcile: two Starting Hypotheses, two interpretations of a situation, two consequences created through the Heterocosmic, or even two details introduced at very different moments.

The usual procedure might consist in choosing one and abandoning the other. The Counterpoint occasionally invites the opposite: to assume that both are true and ask the players to discover the relationship that allows them to coexist.

This is not a Hermeneutic Synthesis, since it does not necessarily operate on a Symbolic Figure or on the lenses of the Positions. It is a broader narrative tool intended to recover scattered contributions and make them enter into dialogue.

Let us imagine that during the adventure one player established that the agent of the Summa Archive seems to be protecting the missing, while another maintained that this

same agent is hiding information about the laboratory on the Hesiode Moor. Later on, the GD may bring back both proposals:

«We now know that both things are true: the agent is protecting the missing and is deliberately hiding information about the laboratory. What is the relationship between the two?»

The question does not ask the players to choose one explanation over another. It requires them to build a third relationship capable of containing the previous two.

Perhaps the agent hides the laboratory precisely because the missing are protected there. Perhaps they are protecting some of the missing from those who control the installation. Perhaps they are trying to prevent the Archive from discovering that certain individuals were never abducted.

Once again, there is no foreseen answer.

The Counterpoint has an especially interesting virtue: it rewards narrative memory. It makes old contributions, even apparently incompatible ones, return and acquire a new function. In a game which establishes that actions and creations constantly reorganise the world, this recovery of scattered elements fits very naturally with the general logic of Numinia.

I would not use it as often as Dialogic Resonance. The Counterpoint works best when two elements already carry enough weight for joining them to be surprising. Using it constantly would produce a fiction where absolutely everything is related to absolutely everything, and even the Veil has the right to rest on the odd Sunday.

FRAGMENT 8: IMBALANCE OF THE GEARWORK, AN ANOMALY

The Imbalance of the Gearwork is an exception within the ordinary architecture of the Phases. It belongs to none of them and, at the same time, it can burst into any of them when the accumulation of Heterocosmic Rolls has advanced the Resonance Marker far enough and, through it, the Plot Clock. When the clock reaches its limit, the adventure is momentarily interrupted and Numinia responds to everything the players have introduced into the world through a reorganisation of the Veil.

For the GD, this means something very concrete: the Imbalance must not be treated as a complication added to the Phase in progress, but as a self-contained mini-adventure embedded within it.

The main narration is suspended. Space dissolves, the PCs are transported to another time, to another state of the same place or to an alternative echo of reality, and for one complete

scene they must pass through a situation with its own beginning, development and closure. When the fold ends, they return to the main adventure and the Phase continues from the point at which it had been interrupted, though no longer under exactly the same conditions.

The Imbalance does not destroy the continuity of the adventure: it folds it in order to return it transformed. Its purpose must be to reveal, recontextualise or significantly distort some of the elements that were already present in the Conflict. The Game System establishes precisely that the leap may lead to the past, to the future or to an alternative version of the same space, and that it must provide a relevant new perspective before the Refitting.

AN UNEXPECTED ADVENTURE, NOT AN IMPROVISED ONE

The Imbalance is unpredictable as to when it will appear, but that does not oblige the GD to face it completely empty-handed.

During the preparation of the Root, the GD should develop a few potential proposals for an Imbalance: images of the Dark Age related to the Conflict, future versions of certain places, alternative scenes of important NPCs, events that could be shown from another point of view or strange conditions capable of reconfiguring a location. As with any other potential proposal, these materials should not be written as closed scenes nor committed to in advance. They are adaptable pieces the GD may use if, when the Imbalance arrives, they still make sense.

The GD might prepare, for example, the possibility of showing the laboratory on Hesiodic Moor during an earlier era; but if, when the Imbalance is triggered, the laboratory has barely acquired any relevance and the players have made the old café in the Corridor of Memory the core of the adventure, it would be preferable to abandon that idea and build the fold around the café.

The principle is the same one that governs all preparation in Numinia: prepare possibilities, not obligations.

The Imbalance must respond to the adventure that is happening, not to the adventure the GD imagined before starting.

CHOOSING WHAT IT SHOULD RECONTEXTUALISE

When the Plot Clock reaches its limit, the GD should quickly observe which elements have acquired the greatest density during the session and choose one of them as the centre of gravity of the Imbalance.

The best candidates are usually elements that have already generated questions: a Piece of Conflict whose relationship is not yet understood, an NPC whose motivations remain open, a Symbolic Figure interpreted in different ways, a place that has appeared repeatedly, a

Heterocosmic creation that has acquired unexpected relevance or a hypothesis of the players that still lacks sufficient support.

The Imbalance should not introduce a completely unrelated story. Its strength comes from making something known appear in an impossible light.

If the players have found the card from the abandoned café, for example, the fold could carry them to that same establishment several tetrads earlier, when it was still open. There they do not need to discover «the truth» about the disappearances. It would be enough for them to observe that the same group of customers always occupies the same tables, that a young agent of the Summa Archive comes in every night at a set hour or that on the wall hangs a painting whose motif the PCs have already found elsewhere.

The Imbalance must not resolve the Conflict.

It must make it impossible to interpret it exactly as before.

BUILDING THE MINI-ADVENTURE

Although it lasts a single scene, the Imbalance needs a recognisable structure. The GD can organise it through three very simple movements:

Entry: the PCs discover where —or when— they have been transported and what extraordinary condition governs the place.

Tension: a situation arises that demands intervening, deciding, interpreting or confronting something. It is not enough to wander passively through a vision. The players must do something within the fold.

Closure: an action, discovery or event brings the scene to an end and provokes the Refitting.

This structure allows the Imbalance to have an entity of its own without becoming a second complete adventure. It should feel intense, strange and concentrated.

For example, the PCs may appear in a future version of the Prytaneum, completely abandoned. They discover that all its entrances are sealed except one and that, beyond it, someone is pronouncing the names of the disappeared. To reach the hall they must decide what to do about an anomaly blocking the way; inside they find a known NPC, aged by many decades, who refuses to explain how they got there but hands them a significant phrase or object. As soon as they receive it, the space comes undone and they return to the present.

They do not need to know whether they have beheld a real future, a possibility or a resonance. What matters is that the adventure now has a new layer of meaning.

Do not turn the Imbalance into a definitive revelation

There is a considerable temptation: to use the Imbalance as permission to explain what had until then been kept open. Precisely because it allows the past, the future or alternative realities to be shown, the GD might feel that the moment has come to reveal «what really happened».

It is best to resist.

The Imbalance must provide relevant information, not a canonical solution. It can show an event from the past, but its relationship with the present may remain uncertain. It can reveal a future consequence, but without establishing that it is inevitable. It can show an alternative version of the Conflict, but without declaring that this version is truer than the current one.

This is especially important in an adventure based on emergent mystery. If the GD uses the fold to reveal the true explanation, they retrospectively destroy the space of interpretation the players were building.

It is far more fertile to show the players something indisputable whose meaning remains open to dispute.

PRESERVING SHARED AUTHORSHIP WITHIN THE FOLD

Because of its spectacular nature, the Imbalance may seem an occasion for the GD to take back the narration entirely. The GD should not do so.

Although the GD has a stronger presence in establishing the new time, space and condition of the scene, the mini-adventure still belongs to the same system of collaborative creation. It may contain Dialogic Resonances, players' decisions, hermeneutic interpretations and actions capable of transforming what the GD had prepared.

In fact, the unstable nature of the fold makes it an especially fitting space for Resonance:

LECTURA

You recognise this building, although you have never seen it like this. What detail proves that it belongs to an earlier era?

Among all the people in the room there is one you know should not be here. Who is it?

Something in this future proves that your current theory was incomplete. What is it?

As always, the question contains an assertion and a Space of Indeterminacy. The Imbalance does not suspend the rules of shared creation; it subjects them to extraordinary pressure.

WHAT MUST CHANGE ON RETURNING

The Refitting should not simply return the PCs to the same narrative state they were in before the fold. If nothing has changed, the Imbalance will have been a beautiful decorative interlude and little more.

At least one significant residue must survive: a piece of information, an intuition, a behaviour, a perception, a new relationship between elements or a minor alteration of the context. The earlier material of the System already establishes precisely that the return must produce a new perspective capable of recontextualising the adventure.

That residue may even become a Piece of Conflict if it has sufficient concreteness, relevance and openness. It may also modify an existing Piece, transform a hypothesis, introduce a new cross-cutting story or alter the meaning of a Symbolic Figure already interpreted.

What matters is that the players can say:

LECTURA

After that, we can no longer understand this in the same way.

That is the true consequence of the Imbalance.

THE IMBALANCE WITHIN EACH PHASE

Although it can occur whenever the Plot Clock reaches its limit, not all Phases offer the same likelihood nor demand the same way of handling it.

Most commonly it will appear during the Investigation Phase. It is the longest Phase, the one in which the players use the Heterocosmic most freely and where the most emergent material accumulates. Here the Imbalance can act as a powerful recontextualisation: altering a hypothesis, producing a new Piece, recovering a forgotten element or opening an unexpected direction.

It is also especially natural during the Action Phase. In that case, the GD must make sure the mini-adventure retains the energy of the Phase. The fold should not become a long contemplative rest, but should intensify the vertigo: the PCs may appear before a future version of what they are trying to prevent, relive an antecedent of the present confrontation

or pass through an impossible variant of the same space. On returning, the Action continues, but the decisions made within the Imbalance may have altered its meaning.

In the Resolution Phase it is much less likely. The Heterocosmic becomes riskier as the adventure accumulates Resonance, but the very nature of the Resolution considerably reduces the opportunities for new Heterocosmic Rolls: the GD is by now steering the consequences of a fiction that has been largely built. What was not created before now has very little room to appear.

If, exceptionally, the Imbalance occurs here, it must be extraordinarily concise and directly linked to the denouement. It is not advisable to use it to open a new plotline when the adventure is closing its possibilities. Its function should be to recontextualise the Resolution in progress, not to replace it.

In Presentation, Deliberation or Reflection, its appearance is practically impossible, both because of the brevity of those Phases and because of the very nature of these Phases, which do not lend themselves to Heterocosmic Rolls.

MANAGING THE PACE

The Imbalance interrupts the Phase, but it must not break the overall pace of the adventure.

During Investigation it can afford to breathe a little more and form a scene with relatively ample development. During Action it must be sharper. During Resolution, if it appears, almost lightning-fast.

The GD should measure its duration by a very simple question:

LECTURA

Has the mini-adventure already produced the recontextualisation it needed?

When the answer is yes, the GD must close it.

It is not necessary to explain everything that appears in the fold or to exhaust its possibilities. In fact, leaving some element not understood reinforces its character. The Imbalance works best when it seems to contain more world than the scene has had time to show.

RETURNING TO THE PHASE

Once the Refitting has taken place, the GD immediately returns attention to the Phase that had been suspended.

It is advisable to briefly recall the last situation before the fold and point out what has changed:

LECTURA

«You are back in the back room of the café. The computer is still on. Only a few seconds have passed. But now you recognise the symbol blinking beside the encrypted file: it is the same one you have just seen chiselled above the door of the laboratory, many tetrads in the future.»

And the Investigation goes on.

A new Phase does not begin simply because an Imbalance has occurred. The fold works as an insertion within the main structure, a small adventure born of the accumulation of play that afterwards settles back upon it.

In that sense, the Imbalance is perhaps the most radical expression of one of the central principles of Numinia: the players' freedom not only modifies the story; it can force the world itself to reorganise in order to contain it.

And the GD must not fear that interruption.

The GD must receive it for what it is: the moment when the adventure, saturated with everything the table has created, needs to dream itself for a few minutes before it can go on.

ANNEX: ADVICE FOR THE GD

The Modular Template is not a rigid index but a narrative organism, a way of structuring adventures that dialogues with the fractal, symbolic and poetic nature of Numinia. Each Phase is a chamber that holds possibilities, and each adventure is a unique journey that arises from the encounter between what the GD prepares and what the players reveal.

In Numinia, truth is not pursued: it is built. A path is not followed: it is traced. A conflict is not resolved: it is interpreted.

The Root is the tool that allows all of this to happen with coherence and depth.

In Numinia, the GD is neither an all-powerful narrator nor a secret scriptwriter: the GD is a facilitator, a person who sustains the fiction so that the players can explore and transform it. Think of your role as that of a correspondent of the world: you present scenes, give voice to the inhabitants of the city, embody the dilemmas and propose challenges. The rest will be decided by the players through their actions and contributions.

ESSENTIAL ADVICE

1. Prepare little, listen a lot

You do not need to write a novel beforehand. Arrive with an initial idea —a mystery, a conflict, a strange place— and let the players complete the picture. The story is built by everyone together.

2. Ask questions, return consequences

When in doubt, do not settle it yourself: ask the table. “What does this neighbourhood look like from inside?” “What rumour is going around among the inhabitants?” The answers create living material. Then return those ideas in the form of tangible consequences.

3. Think in scenes, not in closed plots

Design open situations: a disputed archive, a corrupted relic, a district at war. Do not decide the ending: let the choices of the players themselves determine the ultimate truth.

4. Bring everything to life

Give personality to every element: a square that whispers, an archive that defends itself, an NPC with an unshakeable passion. The more vivid the details, the easier it will be for the players to interact.

5. Embrace failure

In Numinia, failing does not stop the story, but opens new paths. If an action does not go well, turn the consequence into an unexpected twist that expands the adventure.

6. Support the players' voice

Every contribution enriches the cosmos of the story and of Numinia. Encourage the players to invent districts, factions, rituals. Do not correct: adapt, and make those ideas have real consequences.

7. Play to discover

Do not come with the story already written: your role is to discover it together with everyone else. Let yourself be surprised. If you already know the ending, you are preventing Numinia

from breathing.

IMMEDIATE RESOURCES

- Use tension clocks: draw a circle divided into segments and mark them off when a danger advances. Visual and easy to follow.
- Create hidden agendas: give NPCs simple goals («protect their neighbourhood», «gain power», «discover the truth») and let them act accordingly.
- Reuse ideas from the table: if someone describes a symbol, make it reappear later as a key.
- Always keep an open question for the players: it is the best seed of story.

GD PRINCIPLES

In *Powered by the Apocalypse* (PbtA) games, the GD does not merely prepare a story, but acts according to an agenda and a set of play principles. This means there is no need to memorise complex rules or invent perfect plots: it is enough to remember a few clear guidelines that indicate how to play the role and what decisions to make at each moment.

Numinia adopts that same philosophy. Your principles as GD are practical reminders: simple phrases that condense how to facilitate the session. They are not rigid rules, but compasses. Their purpose is to help you always keep the spirit of the game: the shared creation of a cosmos in constant transformation.

The GD principles in Numinia

- Ask questions, never give all the answers.

Let the players complete the fiction. A city is richer if it is described by every voice together.

- Leave gaps: the city is completed by the players' voice.

Do not try to define everything in advance: gaps are spaces for the tale to grow at the table.

- Bring everything to life: neighbourhoods, objects and factions have a will of their own.

Numinia is not a passive setting: every element reacts and pushes the story.

- Play to discover, not to impose.

The ending is not written. Be as surprised as the players: that is the essence of shared narration.

- Turn every failure into an opportunity for transformation.

A mistake does not stop the story: it opens it towards new paths, dilemmas and twists.

- Make the world react: every action generates consequences.

The cosmos always responds to what the characters do. Every decision leaves a mark.

- Think in scenes, not in closed plots.

Create tense, open situations. Do not prepare outcomes: let the choices determine the course.

- Be a fan of the characters: show their virtues and put their weaknesses to the test.

The interest lies not in defeating the players, but in seeing how their characters shine when they face the conflict.

- Bring the strange into the everyday: the impossible is part of Numinia.

Remember that this alternative world is ruled by different laws: let the fantastic emerge in any corner.

- Value every contribution: each idea from the table is a narrative seed.

When a player adds a detail, make it important. Reincorporate it, transform it, give it weight in the story.

This list is not a script to follow step by step, but a framework for action. When you do not know what to do, return to these principles: they will remind you how to keep the session alive, even in unforeseen moments.

MODULE

THE BROKEN MIRROR

MODULE FOR THE NUMINIA ROLEPLAYING GAME

Approximate duration: 2–3 sessions.
Difficulty: medium.

Main setting: Ouroboros District, with journeys to Solomon and Vitruvian.

Starting Conflict: the collective memory of Numinia is suffering ever deeper alterations. The researcher Drusa Malter found a possible link between these anomalies and a Splintered Mirror kept in a forgotten storehouse; afterwards she disappeared without any record of her leaving.

THE ROOT

In recent weeks, the Ouroboros District has been the scene of alterations increasingly difficult to explain as mere anomalies of the Veil. Some residents remember streets that the maps deny ever existed; certain libraries show empty spaces where their inventories insist books ought to be kept; old popular songs lose verses that everyone recognises as missing, although no one manages to remember what they said.

Then greater contradictions appear. Marriages of which only one of the spouses retains any memory. Laws cited in official documents that do not appear in any legislative register. Buildings whose name changes according to the person looking at them. It does not seem that Numinia is simply forgetting its past: it seems to be remembering it in several incompatible ways.

The researcher Drusa Malter began to study these anomalies and detected a common resonance among several of their focal points. Her investigation ended up leading her to an old storehouse of the Museum of Arts and Relics, connected to its premises by the so-called Möbius Corridor.

There she found a Splintered Mirror.

Its surface does not only give back the reflection of whoever contemplates it, but incomplete scenes, impossible memories and alternative versions of known events.

Drusa disappeared shortly afterwards.

The records certify only her entry. No camera, document or system attests that she left the storehouse. Her last communications contain interference, fragments of observations and a word that does not appear in any official source accessible through the LAP: *trakmósis*.

The Concordia Council then summons the PCs.

FOUNDING FACTS

Drusa investigated the memory anomalies and located the Splintered Mirror. She entered the storehouse and there is no record of her leaving. *Trakmósis* was the last intelligible word of her communications. The alterations continue to spread and the Mirror bears some relation to them. To reach the storehouse one must pass through the Möbius Corridor.

These facts must not be modified.

SPACES OF INDETERMINACY

The GD must not decide before play whether the Mirror causes the anomalies or concentrates them; who fractured it; whether it was ever whole; what *trakmósis* means; what exactly Drusa's state is; whether any faction or institution bears responsibility; nor what ontological relationship the Mirror has with akashic memory.

Nor must they decide what should finally be done with it.

POTENTIAL PROPOSALS

The Mirror might redistribute memory instead of destroying it. The fracture might have been deliberate. *Trakmósis* might designate an inversion between form, subject and memory. Drusa might have become integrated into the phenomenon, accidentally or willingly. The Mirror might contain futures as well as the past. It might even turn out that Numinian memory is stable precisely because it was always fragmented.

All of them are possibilities. None yet deserves the privilege of being true.

THE PIECES OF CONFLICT

All the Pregenerated Pieces of this adventure are physical objects that the PCs can pick up and carry. Some may appear in different places if the fiction demands it, and new Pieces may arise from the players' actions.

THE REPEATED TESTIMONY

Five small acoustic capsules. Each contains the recording of a different person uttering, in separate circumstances:

LECTURA

«The reflection learns the name before the face.»

None of the witnesses remembers having learnt the phrase.

THE APHASIC SEED

A black seed the size of a finger. On its surface there ought to be a natural botanical glyph, but there is a perfectly defined hollow instead. When someone tries to name it repeatedly, a common word becomes momentarily inaccessible.

THE ACCESS PASS

A rigid card from the Summa Archive. It bears Drusa Malter's identification and a fragment that is still recoverable:

«—ned by akashic fracture. Level: restricted.»

It grants access to certain rooms of Aleph.

THE COUNTERMANUAL OF MORPHOLOGY

A small handmade book, with no recognised author. A handwritten note asserts:

«The prefix trak- indicates possession of the spirit by the form.»

Nothing guarantees that the assertion is true.

THE FLAYED TONGUE

A sculptural fragment made of petrified phonemes. Part of the piece has been torn away, leaving perceptible voids where there ought to be sounds.

It has a note attached:

«If it cannot be pronounced, does it exist?»

THE MNEMONIC SHARD

A fragment of crystal. When looked at against a light source, for a few seconds it reflects a place other than the one where it is.

Which place it shows can be determined through Dialogic Resonance.

THE SPIRAL ARCHIVE — DIRECTION PIECE

A physical sheet of paper, yellowed and folded several times, which appears in the Chamber of Phonosemantic Dissociation. On it there is a hand-drawn spiral diagram and notes by Drusa.

Once examined, it provides an unmistakable direction: it identifies the old Museum of Arts and Relics, the access to the Möbius Corridor and a concrete sequence that allows one to pass through its first fold without immediately returning to the beginning.

The document does not explain what they will find there or what the Corridor means, but it removes all doubt about where the Action must continue and how to begin to penetrate it.

This is the Direction Piece. Its appearance signals that the Investigation can conclude, although the players may go on gathering Pieces if they wish.

PRESENTATION PHASE

The Presentation should work as an extended narration, with little dialogued roleplaying of the NPCs. The Resonances periodically interrupt the reading and allow the players to begin to populate the adventure.

In the inner levels of the Prytaneum there is a room that barely appears on the ordinary routes of the LAPs. The Veiled Chamber is not exactly hidden; it features in certain records and its entrances satisfy every bureaucratic regulation imaginable. Simply put, most citizens lack sufficient motive, authorisation or foolishness to enter.

On crossing the threshold, the air acquires a peculiar density. The room rises beneath a vault of gentle arches, supported by columns of aged bronze and decorated with dull gold. The walls are covered with shelves full of treatises, minutes and parchments whose classification seems to answer to neither date, author nor subject. The small plaques on the shelves

mention categories such as *responsibility, moral debt, impossible precedent* or *agreement necessary despite its evident bad taste*.

A round table occupies the centre. Four people wait around it. Their emblems allow the LAP to identify them immediately.

COUNCILLOR THALIA MNEMÓSINE

Name: Thalia Mnemósine **Guild:** Procurators **Faction:** Heirs of Eleusis **Species:** Humanita
Position: Ludarch

The **Ludarch** is a Position specialised in interpreting cultural norms, rituals and social structures through the logic of play. Thalia carries a rosary made of small tokens inscribed with verses and moves them between her fingers when she needs to put her thoughts in order.

COUNCILLOR SEVERIN LOGOTENOS

Name: Severin Logotenos **Guild:** Procurators **Faction:** Hermeticists **Species:** Cyanite
Position: Archivist

His fingers show stains of digital ink that reappear shortly after they are cleaned.

COUNCILLOR IBERA LUX

Name: Ibera Lux **Guild:** Procurators **Faction:** Neo-Atlantists **Species:** Spectral **Position:**
Armonaut

She dresses asymmetrically and wears small jewels made from recovered crystalline fragments.

COUNCILLOR VARRO KALLIS

Name: Varro Kallis **Guild:** Procurators **Faction:** Stellar Circle **Species:** Biomechanical
Position: Legionary of the Threshold

He wears a mechanical watch of antique design whose ticking can barely be heard until the silence of the Chamber becomes too deep.

Dialogic Resonance: the Veiled Chamber

LECTURA

What shows that the meeting had begun long before your arrival?

What element is especially striking in such a solemn space?

What indicates that someone or something is watching from the upper galleries?

What object or image reminds you of something important in your life?

What detail lets you anticipate that the meeting will end worse than it begins?

The answers are woven in without being explained yet.

The Council then sets out the problem. The four delegates accept that the anomalies are real, that Drusa disappeared during her investigation and that the Mirror must be reached. Their agreement, however, ends exactly there.

Thalia considers that a structure capable of deforming collective memory poses a threat to the cultural continuity of Numinia, and she argues for its destruction or definitive closure.

Severin demands that it be studied: to destroy a manifestation that might offer knowledge about akashic memory would be, in his eyes, an intellectual barbarity perfectly unworthy of a civilised society.

Ibera maintains that, if the Mirror proves that memory can be recomposed, perhaps limiting oneself to restoring the past would be a premature renunciation of its possibilities.

Varro demands that they first stop the anomalies, stabilise the object and argue afterwards about metaphysics, politics or any other activity that proves more comfortable once the city has stopped forgetting its own streets.

Dialogic Resonance: the delegates

Which councillor arouses your distrust, and why?

Who makes a significant gesture when Drusa is mentioned?

What small object does one of the delegates handle and put away on noticing that they are being watched?

What discreet message does one of the delegates whisper to a PC?

What indicates that the hostility among these four did not begin with the Mirror?

Do not automatically turn any answer into a conspiracy. They are proposals.

The Council then presents Drusa Malter's file.

DRUSA MALTER

Name: Drusa Malter **Guild:** Alchemists **Faction:** Neo-Atlantists

Species: of mixed heritage, Humanita/Spectral **Position:** Morphologist of Artefacts and Relics

The Morphologist studies how physical, linguistic and symbolic forms modify whatever they contain. Drusa specialised in artefacts whose structure alters memory or interpretation.

Her record still responds to the LAP.

Her status appears as ACTIVE.

Her location: NOT AVAILABLE.

The recovered records show that Drusa first investigated apparently unconnected anomalies. She discovered language phenomena in the Hyperglottic Gardens, documentary variations in the Summa Archive and emotional dissociations in the Sensory Cubicle. Later she concluded that all of them seemed to resonate with a common focal point located in the old Museum of Arts and Relics.

Her last coherent message points out that the Mirror does not seem to be merely losing memory, but might be redistributing it. Then comes static. Finally, a word:

trakmósis.

An ordinary query through the LAP produces no recognised entry.

If the PCs deliberately search in informal spaces, the GD may enable Rumourology.

Rumourology of *trakmósis*

«Trak- appears in some apocryphal texts associated with possession.» Classification: Unknown origin. Comment: The references point to one another and none preserves an earlier verifiable source.

«Mósis was an ancient root related to ritual transformation.» Classification: Probably false. Comment: The known examples appear only in modern glossaries of dubious provenance.

«The complete word appeared years ago on a forum devoted to errors of the Veil and was deleted shortly afterwards.» Classification: As hard to prove as to refute. Comment: Only

partial screenshots survive, and their metadata do not match one another.

The Presentation ends when the Prytaneum itself manifests an anomaly. Some text in the Chamber changes for a few seconds; one of the LAPs receives an impossible notification; a shadow reproduces a gesture before its owner makes it; or some word spoken at the meeting momentarily loses its meaning.

Use several Resonance questions to pin it down.

Finally, the official register of those attending the meeting is updated.

To the names of the four councillors and the PCs another is added:

DRUSA MALTER — PRESENT.

Drusa is not there.

DELIBERATION PHASE

The PCs have a few minutes alone before leaving the Prytaneum.

The GD now addresses the players directly. Each of them must formulate a Starting Hypothesis about what is happening, what function they believe the Mirror has, what may have happened to Drusa and what relationship they imagine between the anomalies. The Hypothesis may refer to just one of these questions, or encompass them all.

They do not need to agree. The GD notes down the most fertile proposals and will later use them as narrative material, without automatically confirming them.

When all the hypotheses have been set out, ask where their PCs begin to investigate.

INVESTIGATION PHASE

The three main spaces are available from the start and can be visited in any order. Not all of them are compulsory, and the GD should accept other reasonable routes proposed by the players.

The appearance of the Spiral Archive will finally provide the clear direction towards the Action Phase.

THE HYPERGLOTTIC GARDENS

The Gardens stretch out like damp terraces over an old part of Ouroboros. Their botany combines plant forms and phonetic structures: there are flowers whose movements produce soundless words, roots capable of sustaining sequences of prayers and plants whose colour modifies the emotional charge of whatever seems to be uttered around them.

The recent alteration has not turned the plants into talking creatures. It has done something more unsettling: some of them are producing words that do not belong to their repertoire, future expressions or memories of individuals who never touched them.

ELYA THARON

Name: Elya Tharon **Guild:** Alchemists **Faction:** Heirs of Eleusis **Species:** Humanita **Position:** Botanical Hierophant

The Botanical Hierophant interprets plant cycles as cultural and ritual systems.

Elya knows that one of the roots has uttered her own name, and she fears that the Garden is no longer reproducing language, but reading memory.

BERUN MAEL

Name: Berun Mael **Guild:** Sentinels **Faction:** Heirs of Eleusis **Species:** Humanita **Position:** Root Cantor

The **Root Cantor** interprets subterranean vibrations and patterns produced by plants through resonance. Berun uses vibration gloves to «listen» to roots through touch.

He has heard Drusa's name in the Winter Hall since before her disappearance became public.

Lorkin Serva

Name: Lorkin Serva **Guild:** Exegetes **Faction:** Hermeticists **Species:** Cyanite **Position:** Phonetic Curator

He has tried to transcribe in secret certain patterns produced by the Garden, and he believes he recognises a labyrinthine structure in them.

THE STAINED-GLASS TERRACE

The Stained-Glass Terrace remains restricted. There the plants show a phonetic misalignment capable of producing confusion of memories and of verbal identity.

On entering, pose several Resonances: a flower produces a familiar word with a different meaning; another generates an expression that one of the PCs will utter later; a plant represents through colour a memory of the PC; another reacts to Drusa's name; a fifth produces an expression that belongs to no language.

The answers can later feed the interpretation of *trakmósis*.

WINTER HALL

The Praying Roots of the Winter Hall generate ancient prayers. Among them appear modern words: Prytaneum. Mirror. Fracture. Drusa.

Berun has written down a phrase that the Praying Roots have repeated insistently:

«The reflection learns the name before the face.»

This phrase triggers a Hermeneutic Action. The different Lenses should produce different readings, and the GD will afterwards seek a meaning capable of containing several of them.

That meaning will affect how the reflections behave later on.

GESTATION ROOM

The ancient coral creeper reproduces, in fragments:

«...the reflection does not sleep...» And then: «...the reflection is not one...»

At a certain moment the plant undergoes a violent expansion. The branches invade the space while phonemes and words seem to acquire material consistency. The PCs can escape, contain it, intervene in its structure or use any appropriate Competence.

A Failure may cause Confused or Destabilised; an especially deep Critical Failure may produce Unanchored if a PC temporarily loses their semantic relationship with the surroundings. The current States replace the old losses of Energy or Threshold as the consequence of this kind of conflict.

After the crisis, an unknown figure, like a faceless shadow, flees among the paths.

PREMISES OF THE SUMMA ARCHIVE

The Summa Archive has an official tradition of research into peripheral and anomalous phenomena; its Aleph Section deals precisely with inexplicable objects, temporal echoes, causal ruptures and emergent symbols.

The premises the PCs visit are chambers in which documents, concepts and artefacts are treated almost as organisms liable to suffer alterations.

NALIA VOR

Name: Nalia Vor **Guild:** Exegetes **Faction:** Hermeticists **Species:** Cyanite **Position:** Critical Documentalist

She is convinced she heard Drusa's voice in an empty room after her disappearance.

SENN DARVIK

Name: Senn Darvik **Guild:** Exegetes **Faction:** Hermeticists **Species:** Humanita **Position:** Aetiologist

The Aetiologist investigates how concepts originate, are transmitted and are transformed.

Senn believes that the Mirror behaves like a parasitic organism with respect to meaning.

ARHEN KAST

Name: Arhen Kast **Guild:** Procurators **Faction:** Stellar Circle **Species:** Cyanite **Position:** Keeper of Seals

She was present when Drusa accessed certain rooms and is hiding part of the circumstances.

HALL OF CONCEPTS

Several entries have changed.

Conclave: «state of structural doubt».

Oral memory: «unreliable resource in the process of dissolution».

Mirror: «surface that rewrites the observer».

Activate Resonance by asking about other altered words, definitions that seem to refer to the PCs, terms that have changed category or words that the system insists never existed.

DRUSA'S CHAMBER

The small workroom preserves a notebook with torn-out pages, remains of crystal and several analysis tools.

A note says:

«It is not you who is broken. It is the world that remembers for you that is broken.»

Activate Hermeneutics.

Among her personal effects there is also a small fragment of crystal.

ALEPH SECTION LIBRARY

It can only be entered with an Access Pass.

The loss of coherence increases as the PCs advance. The signs lose words. Some books keep their content but forget their title. The LAPs reboot for a few seconds and all of them display at the same time:

DRUSA DID NOT DISAPPEAR. SHE WAS RECLASSIFIED.

An unregistered volume appears among other treatises.

Rumourology of the Countermanual

«The Countermanual was written by several authors who claimed to be one single person.»
Classification: Based on a real fact, but distorted. Comment: There are several handwritings, although every known edition attributes the work to a single, non-existent author.

«The Hermeticists tried to withdraw all its copies.» Classification: Partly true, but biased.
Comment: There was a withdrawal order, although the official reasons were methodological errors and not ideological censorship.

«Trak- does not mean possession; it indicates an exchange between form and subject.»
Classification: Dangerously close to the truth.

Comment: The statement appears in a single marginal note whose ink is much more recent than the volume.

SENSORY CUBICLE

The Cubicle is a research complex where language is translated into sensory experiences. Words can smell, have texture, produce flavours or provoke thermal responses.

Lately those relationships have been failing.

JOREN MALD

Name: Joren Mald **Guild:** Exegetes **Faction:** Neo-Atlantists **Species:** Biomechanical **Position:** Technical Synaesthete

The Technical Synaesthete analyses systematic correspondences between language and perception.

Joren has lost the ability to experience the sensory correlate of the word *I*.

IRVENA SEUR

Name: Irvana Seur **Guild:** Alchemists **Faction:** Neo-Atlantists **Species:** Humanita **Position:** Sensory Translator

She perceives emotional traces related to Drusa.

ROHAN 'KEL

Name: Rohan 'Kel **Guild:** Sentinels **Faction:** Stellar Circle **Species:** Biomechanical **Position:** Semantic Director

He keeps an emotional spectrogram of Drusa and believes the Mirror might be entering a new phase of activity.

FRACTURED GUSTATORY BOOTH

The session begins with Dialogic Resonance:

What does desire taste of?

What does freedom taste of?

What does prison taste of?

What does the insurgent taste of?

What does the enigma taste of?

The answers become part of how the Cubicle works during the adventure.

Afterwards, the booths begin to project other people's memories. Keep the original images: the fall from a horse the PC never rode, a blow in a corridor that does not exist, a public humiliation they never suffered, a leg trapped on a bridge never crossed, or the guilt of having signed a document they never saw.

A Failure may cause Confused. A Critical Failure that lets the memory seriously contest the PC's identity may cause Fragmented.

CHAMBER OF PHONOSEMANTIC DISSOCIATION

A phoneme *ka* floats like a luminous shape, severed from all meaning. Elsewhere in the room, the meaning of «reflection» moves across the floor like a shadow that has no object.

This situation can become a Symbolic Figure: a sound without meaning and a meaning without sound.

The Hermeneutic Action can deeply influence how *trakmósis* is conceived afterwards.

During the destabilisation a folded sheet falls behind a console.

DIRECTION PIECE: THE SPIRAL ARCHIVE

When it is unfolded, it reveals handwritten notes by Drusa, a depiction of the old Museum of Arts and Relics and the diagram of the Möbius Corridor.

The sheet includes a clear instruction:

«Lower access. Closed heritage gallery. Do not follow the apparent geometry. At the first return, pass through the third frame before it repeats its image.»

The PCs now know where they must go and how to begin crossing the Corridor.

They do not know what they will find.

That difference is exactly what we need.

REFLECTION PHASE

Before heading to the Museum, try to create a place of rest. It may be the Hyperborean Tavern, a safe room in the Prytaneum, a room in the Cubicle itself or some space chosen by the players.

The players gather all their physical Pieces and relate them to one another.

Now they must agree on a theory.

What does the Mirror do? What happened to Drusa? What does *trakmósis* mean? Why are language, memory, perception and documentation failing in different ways? What do they intend to achieve when they reach the depository?

The theory must end in a concrete objective.

ACTION PHASE

THE MÖBIUS CORRIDOR

SERANUS VEXILL

Name: Seranus Vexill **Guild:** Alchemists **Faction:** Stellar Circle **Species:** Humanita **Position:** Liminal Curator

The Liminal Curator administers heritage objects and spaces whose physical permanence is not completely stable.

Seranus accompanies the PCs as far as the gate that separates the old premises.

He does not go in.

ENTRANCE TO THE CORRIDOR

The gate opens with a metallic groan and the corridor appears beyond it as an architecture that has forgotten the elementary courtesy of occupying a single position.

The floor runs straight for a few metres and then seems to curve without really changing direction. Some paintings reappear on the opposite wall before they have been left behind. The lights breathe with a slow cadence, and each dimming slightly alters the images hanging there.

A city hangs upside down from an empty sky. A reddish sun burns in the middle of a star-filled night. A river of incandescent sand runs through a town built beside a riverbed that never carried water. Further on, a crowd parades with the same face repeated; two shadows confront each other while their owners remain motionless; a banquet awaits diners represented only by dark hollows.

The paintings do not seem mistaken.

They seem to be arguing about what they remember.

The Spiral Archive makes it possible to get past the first fold. After that, the Corridor is open to interpretation.

THE PAINTINGS AND HERMENEUTICS

The paintings are Symbolic Figures. There is no longer any intended «correct» answer.

The GD can select the images that prove most fertile according to the PCs' Positions.

The interpretation must produce spatial consequences. A reading by a Runner of the Veil may reveal a way of passing through; an Ambassador's pragmatic interpretation may turn an image into a rule that governs that stretch; a Legionary may find an opposition of forces that explains the architecture; an Anacharchid may formulate a paradox that becomes literally true.

In this way, the Hermeneutic Action builds the Corridor while the PCs cross it.

CONTAINMENT SITUATIONS

The Corridor must keep a fast pace. Use Competence or Characteristic Rolls when the actions require them.

In the Paint Swell, one of the paintings spills over into the passage and the brushstrokes try to alter the PCs' faces.

In the Echoic Chamber, the characters hear their movements a few seconds before making them and may end up Desynchronised.

In The door that did not know it was a door, a stretch of wall has no function until the players find a way to establish what condition can truly turn it into an entrance.

There is no independent Distortion Clock. Failures directly alter the conditions of the scene.

OPTIONAL CONFRONTATION

The Umbrilego of the absent painting

Read or paraphrase the following narration before the players declare anchors.

The Corridor ends in a narrower gallery, lit only by the small lamps placed above each painting. The paintings are spaced at regular intervals, and they all have different frames: blackened wood, bronze, stone, dark glass. Halfway along the wall there is one that contains nothing.

It is not a blank canvas. Nor does it seem that the painting has been removed.

Inside the frame there is a grey surface that the eye cannot manage to recognise as wall. After looking at it for several seconds it becomes difficult to remember what one expected to find there. The absence seems to occupy a space of its own, as if the corridor had perfectly preserved the place of something after losing whatever was meant to fill it.

The painting immediately to the left shows a procession. The one on the right depicts a crowned figure before an empty throne.

When one of the PCs tries to wonder which image ought to exist between the two, the sounds of the corridor go out.

They do not diminish. They vanish.

Then a black fibre appears on the lower edge of the empty frame. It slides slowly across the wood and divides into several moist filaments. Others emerge from the top and begin to feel the neighbouring paintings with delicate, almost tactile movements. The mass that follows does not seem to pass through the wall. It seems to unfold from a depth that the frame had concealed until then.

First come four long, soft limbs that fold in an arachnoid manner without showing clear joints. Then a semi-translucent body made of taut membranes and fibrous tissues, glistening with an oily moisture that never quite comes away from its surface. At several points small protuberances form, swell and disappear like organs that had not yet decided on their function.

The head occupies the centre of the mass. It is a dark vegetal bulb, covered with nervous roots and large, whitish, pupilless eyes. None of them seems really to be looking at the PCs.

The creature moves towards the painting of the procession. It rests one of its limbs on the frame. Then it shifts towards the empty space. It extends the limb. It stops. It draws it back. It moves towards the coronation. It touches it. And it begins again.

Procession. Void. Coronation. Procession. Void. Coronation.

The third repetition produces a change. In the painting of the procession a face disappears. In the coronation the function of the crown ceases to be recognisable: it remains visible, but for a few seconds it looks like a completely unknown object.

When any of the PCs tries to name what is missing, reconstruct the painting or explain the sequence, the whitish eyes turn towards them all at once. The roots of the skull give off bluish flashes and the creature abandons the ritual to approach with a speed that bears no relation to the clumsiness of its earlier movements.

If the PC stops interpreting, the creature halts. It returns to the frame. Procession. Void. Coronation.

Around it other meanings begin to degrade. A sword is still painted in a nearby picture, but one of the characters does not remember what it is used for. A bridge keeps its shape and material, but for an instant no one can manage to think of it as something meant for crossing. A human figure loses the name that accompanied it on its label, and a few seconds later it is hard to remember that it ever had one.

The creature does not seem to be guarding the non-existent painting.

It seems to need it to go on not existing.

The present nature of the Umbrilego fits this behaviour exactly: it manifests around a contradiction, reacts to attempts to recover meaning and repeats an incomplete pattern derived from that absence.

Pregenerated anchors for the GD

Original contradiction: the frame keeps the position of a painting whose meaning has disappeared.

Attraction to meaning: any attempt to reconstruct what is absent awakens the immediate reaction of the Umbrilego.

Incomplete ritual: procession → void → coronation.

These are only the anticipated anchors. The players may infer others if they are supported by the scene.

If the roll fails, do not repeat the combat. Make the contradiction change: the Umbrilego may move the absence to another painting; one of the PCs may temporarily be depicted within the frame; the frame may begin to erase a Piece of Conflict from the group's memory; or the creature may induce a State. A failure transforms the conflict and forces it to be reinterpreted.

CROSSROADS OF THE CORRIDOR AND THE DEPOSITORY

The following Crossroads are deliberately designed so that no option is harmless. They are not three shades of the same problem; they are three realities capable of changing the course of the adventure.

It is not necessary to use them all.

Crossroads I — The absent painting

If a failure turns the empty frame into a central element, ask what its absence really represents:

1. The painting contained a fundamental event in the history of Numinia that was deliberately erased.
2. The painting depicts a future event whose disappearance is preventing it from ever happening.
3. The painting depicted one of the people present, and that person is also beginning to be erased from the records of Numinia.

All three consequences must begin to manifest immediately.

Crossroads II — Drusa's voice

When Drusa seems to communicate from the Corridor:

1. The voice really belongs to Drusa, but she is trying to prevent the PCs from reaching her.
2. The voice does not belong to Drusa: something inside the Mirror has learned to reproduce it and is deliberately leading the group.
3. The voice is a future memory of one of the PCs, who at some point will utter exactly the words they now attribute to Drusa.

Any of the three redefines the relationship with whatever awaits at the end.

Crossroads III — Drusa Malter

This one should be activated only when Drusa's nature has taken on enough importance.

1. Drusa is an artificial intelligence that had for years sustained a fully recognised civic identity without almost anyone knowing.
2. Drusa is an impostor, a member of the Commune of the Invisible Light sent to create chaos and uncover secrets of the Council of Delegates.
3. Drusa is in an irreversible coma, and what seems to be interacting with the PCs is an autonomous structure formed by her memories.

Crossroads IV — The Mirror

In the face of a failure during the Action:

1. The Mirror is fragmenting the memory of Numinia to prevent a single false memory from replacing all the others.
2. The Mirror is trying to put itself back together and uses the citizens' memories as material to complete the parts it is missing.
3. The Mirror is not bound to the memory of Numinia: Numinia is bound to the Mirror, and destroying it could eliminate part of the city's historical continuity.

From that moment on, the GD must make the consequences of the chosen option visible.

Crossroads V — *Trakmósis*

When the word becomes an operative element:

1. Trakmósis means that a form can completely appropriate the identity of whatever it contains.
2. Trakmósis designates the process by which two identities exchange their memories until neither can prove which was the original.
3. Trakmósis does not describe a process: it is the name of an entity or intelligence whose presence is expressed through the fractures of the Mirror.

Do not afterwards turn the choice into a mere linguistic fact. It must alter the fiction.

Crossroads VI — Adaptable to a Piece created by the players

Choose an especially important emergent Piece and present three severe consequences:

1. The Piece was deliberately introduced by Drusa to manipulate the PCs' investigation.
2. The Piece did not exist before the adventure began: the PCs' own contributions made it manifest physically and it is now altering the Conflict.
3. The Piece belongs to another version of the history of Numinia, and its presence is progressively replacing the object that occupied its place in this version.

These crossroads may be used freely whenever, with regard to the Containment Situations or the interpretations of the paintings, the players obtain a failure in any of the rolls.

THE FORGOTTEN REPOSITORY

After getting through the Corridor, the PCs reach a large heritage chamber where covered display cases, ancient sculptures, uncatalogued artefacts and exhibition furniture pile up, left there by institutions that have long since disappeared.

In the centre stands the Mirror.

Its surface is dark and crossed by numerous cracks that give off pale glints. None seems to have exactly the same depth. Some are material fractures; others seem to open onto spaces that continue far beyond the glass.

The reflections do not match.

One of the PCs appears older. Another carries an object they do not possess. A third is not reflected in one of the shards. Some surfaces show the repository itself, but with the display cases in different positions.

Dialogic Resonance: the reflections

Ask what the reflection of a PC possesses that the original does not; what scar another one bears; what appears in the place of a PC missing from a shard; what action a reflection performs that its original would never perform; and what known location appears transformed in the background of one of the fragments.

Bring these answers back later.

At some distance from the Mirror stands a translucent structure of superimposed sentences.

Inside it remains Drusa.

Her emblem still responds to the LAP.

Status: ACTIVE.

Location: UNCLASSIFIABLE.

THE SCARS OF THE MIRROR

Keep the Triads of the original module, because they are one of its best ideas.

The Mirror reflects impossible historical scenes. Each one comes with three words.

There is no longer a score of 2 to 6 dice awarded for creativity. The players produce a collective interpretation and must then actually intervene in the scene, using their competences through their Relics, Weapons, Proscribed, Residues or any other resource that occurs to them (Special aptitudes, for example).

They must stabilise three Scars. Some of the available triads are:

Void–Oath–Ash

Scene: An army appears marching towards a river that flows not with water but with burning ash. The soldiers advance, but as they cross it they dissolve into smoke, as if their existence had not been confirmed.

Spectre–Silence–Shadows

Scene: A coronation is held in an empty hall, with no audience, a king kneeling before an unoccupied throne. The crown floats in the air, surrounded by shadows that seem to whisper, though no one makes a single sound.

Fire–Pact–Star

Scene: In a night camp, leaders of several factions meet beneath an incandescent star burning too close to the horizon. They greet one another, but the fire consumes the sky, leaving the pact incomplete.

Door–Blood–Mirror

Scene: A citadel shows its walls open, as if a gigantic door had collapsed. On the ground, a pool of blood reflects a different landscape, as if the liquid mirror led to another version of the place.

Light-Vengeance-Pact

Scene: A hero perched on a wall receives a torch from the hands of an ally. On raising it, he discovers that all those who follow him are watching him with hatred. The light darkens like a spilled liquid.

Betrayal–Snow–Awakening

Scene: In a village, the inhabitants ring soundless bells while the snow falls backwards, towards the sky. The peasants sleep standing up, frozen, and when they open their eyes they do not seem to recognise the place.

Return–Shadows–Heavens

Scene: A sacred temple is packed, but the faithful have no faces and weep black tears. The altars shine with contradictory symbols, as if they worshipped several gods at once.

Jewel-Failure-Sword

Scene: A king is crowned with a diadem of rusted iron, but when he touches it, it crumbles to dust. The wind carries the metallic ash until it forms a crown in the air, which spins like a storm halo.

Exodus-Rain-Night

Scene: Warriors sunk to the waist in a quagmire join hands beneath a gigantic moon that fills almost the whole sky. They swear loyalty, but the moon shatters into pieces like broken glass, falling upon them.

Past–Mission–Ambush

Scene: A stone bridge stretches over an infinite void. A knight brandishes a gleaming sword, but his shadow separates from his body and wields another weapon, trying to run through his own reflection.

Flight-Flame-Silence

Scene: A queen burns in flames, but does not scream. The fire lights up a hall where all the nobles keep silent, motionless as statues. The crown melts and drips incandescent metal onto the steps of the throne.

War–Lie–Choice

Scene: Two generals seal the peace beneath torrential rain. The water falls so hard that the ground becomes a mirror reflecting another scene: the same generals, but cutting each other's throats.

For example, in Void–Oath–Ash, an army crosses a river of burning ash and its soldiers disappear one by one. The players may interpret it as an oath that demands renouncing one's identity, as a collective memory of a war that never existed, or in any other coherent way. They must then perform an action that makes that reading material.

The interpretation opens a reality. The action tries to sustain it.

A failed roll: with each failure a new breach opens, and the PCs keep advancing towards another scene, until they manage to piece three scenes back together.

If 12 breaches open, the Mirror collapses and traps the PCs in a false memory.

THE TYPOGRAPHIC SPHINX

Each time one of the rolls to stabilise a scar yields a Critical Failure, a Typographic Sphinx comes to life. A creature with a face of glyphs that come undone. A paper body that crackles as it moves. A voice that sounds like a page being torn.

It poses a riddle.

- Correct answer: it nods with an approving whisper.

- Failure:

`o` A PC temporarily loses a memory

`o` They receive a State.

Possible riddles for the Typographic Sphinx:

- What goes up and down but never moves? Answer: A staircase
- What is always coming but never arrives? Answer: The future / Tomorrow
- What would you fill a wineskin with to make it weigh less? Answer: Holes
- What cannot be named without being destroyed? Answer: Silence

FREEING DRUSA

After the last Scars of the Mirror, the space contracts until it once again takes on the shape of the Forgotten Repository. Yet something has changed. The display cases seem farther away and the Mirror now fills almost the entire back wall, as if the chamber had been built around it and not the other way round.

A few metres from its surface, Drusa Malter remains suspended.

She is not, strictly speaking, shut inside a sarcophagus. At first glance she seems surrounded by a translucent structure of smoked glass, but when the PCs draw near they discover that the surface has no continuous matter. It is made of superimposed sentences, hundreds of lines of writing that cross in different directions and, seen from afar, produce the appearance of a solid casing.

The sentences do not stay still.

Some rise from the floor and pass through the structure from bottom to top; others are born directly in the cracks of the Mirror and advance towards Drusa like long written filaments. There are sequences that circle around her body, others that slip beneath her clothes and reappear on the opposite side, as if they did not recognise the difference between surface and depth.

Not all of them can be read from left to right.

One says:

DRUSA MALTER IS THE SUBJECT CONTAINED IN THIS FILE.

But as the eye runs along it, the words begin to shift until they read:

THIS FILE IS THE SUBJECT CONTAINED IN DRUSA MALTER.

A few seconds later it returns to its previous state.

Another sentence seems to begin with its last word. If someone tries to follow it in reverse, the text turns again and places the end out of reach once more. It never allows anyone to establish with certainty where it begins.

In others, the problem is not the order but the reference.

SHE MUST REMAIN HERE FOR AS LONG AS SHE GOES ON BEING HER.

When it is spoken aloud, one of the pronouns darkens. Then another. Finally, each *she* seems to point to something different: first Drusa, then the Mirror, then the sentence itself.

The LAP continues to detect Drusa's emblem.

When scanned, it shows:

NAME: DRUSA MALTER STATUS: ACTIVE LOCATION: UNCLASSIFIABLE

But the result does not remain stable.

If a PC repeats the scan, the field for the Position changes for a few seconds to FILE OBJECT. In another reading it shows WITNESS. In another, HOST.

Then it goes back to showing her ordinary record.

When someone says *Drusa Malter* aloud, several lines of the prison react at once. The name disappears from the text and is replaced by different expressions:

SUBJECT. FILE. WITNESS. OBJECT. HOST.

Each substitution produces a slight physical alteration in Drusa. When *subject* appears, she opens her eyes for an instant. With *file*, her skin takes on a faint transparency and small lines of writing can be made out beneath it. With *object*, her body becomes completely motionless. With *host*, something dark seems to move behind her reflection in the Mirror, though not inside her body.

The sequence never occurs exactly the same way twice.

There is, however, one regularity: the more the PCs insist on naming her as a person, the stronger the prison's reaction.

They may also notice that the sentences do not surround the whole body with the same density. Around the chest, the writing forms a kind of knot made of several intertwining clauses. Each comes from a different crack in the Mirror. When one of those cracks gives off a glint, the corresponding sentence tightens and Drusa's body shifts several centimetres towards the glass.

The others put her back in her position.

It is as if several forces were correcting one another to keep her in exactly the same place.

On the floor beneath her there is a circle made of repeated words:

RECORD — IDENTITY — CONTAINMENT — RECORD — IDENTITY — CONTAINMENT

One of the words always appears incomplete.

It is never the same one.

When someone tries to complete the missing word, the others immediately rearrange themselves to open another gap.

The prison seems to need a lack.

Each time the PCs try to approach Drusa physically, another reaction arises. The outer lines shift towards the intruder and begin to write over whatever they touch. They cause no wound, but they do momentarily alter its classification. A bracelet may appear on the LAP as a *document*. A Relic may become, for several seconds, a *testimony*. One of the weapons may be registered as a *pending incident*.

If a line reaches a PC's skin, their name disappears for an instant from their own LAP interface.

Then it returns.

This does not look like an attack.

It looks like an administrative procedure carried out by a diseased grammar.

At some point, Drusa moves her lips.

She makes no sound.

Yet a new sentence appears on the surface of the prison:

DO NOT READ WHAT IT SAYS ABOUT ME.

The line lasts barely a few seconds.

Then another sentence crosses it and replaces *me* with:

HER.

Next, a third adds:

SHE IS NOT A PERSON.

And a fourth corrects:

A PERSON IS NOT HER.

The Mirror answers with a pulse of light.

The lines tighten again.

Drusa rises a few centimetres.

Then the PCs may notice something else: all the sentences seem to try to describe her, classify her or define her relationship with the place, but none describes what Drusa was doing when she became trapped.

There is a subject. There is a status. There is a function. There is belonging. But there is no action.

It is as if the prison could preserve what Drusa is, or what it considers her to be, but had completely lost the verb that connected her to the world.

And even so, at the bottom of the structure, almost hidden between two superimposed lines, a fragment appears for an instant that seems different from the rest.

It is not a definition.

It is an incomplete action:

DRUSA _____ THE MIRROR.

The space between the two words remains empty.

When one of the PCs tries to complete it, the whole prison reacts.

The sentences stop moving for a second.

The LAP loses its connection.

The Mirror darkens.

And Drusa opens her eyes.

Only for an instant.

Then the entire structure violently activates again.

Now there is no longer any doubt that this is not a passive prison.

It is defending an interpretation of Drusa.

And any attempt to free her demands first disputing that interpretation.

Objective of the confrontation

The players must declare what they intend to achieve. The most obvious aim will be to free Drusa without destroying her identity, but they may attempt other things: recovering her consciousness even if the body remains trapped, breaking the link with the Mirror, modifying her classification, or extracting only some part of her memory.

The objective changes the way in which they will have to intervene on the anchors.

Possible pregenerated anchors

Identity reclassification. The prison holds Drusa by continually changing her category between subject, file, object, host and witness. Her inability to keep a single condition seems to prevent her from fully recovering her status as a person.

Syntactic inversion. The sentences swap subject and object, beginning and end, container and contents. The structure seems to sustain itself through these inversions and reacts when someone tries to fix a stable reading.

Specular dependence. Several lines are born directly from the cracks of the Mirror and tighten when it emits pulses. Drusa seems physically held up by different bonds that come from those fractures.

Verbal void. The structure can define who Drusa is but not what she was doing. The sentence DRUSA _____ THE MIRROR constitutes a persistent absence that produces an extraordinary reaction when someone tries to complete it.

Necessary defect. The circle on the floor always keeps one incomplete word; when one is restored, another loses part of itself. The prison seems to require a permanent lack in order to hold together.

Contagious classification. The sentences can extend the same process to the PCs and their objects, temporarily changing their status. The prison does not only contain: it tries to integrate everything that intervenes on it into its own system of categories.

These anchors are possible readings, not mandatory solutions. The players might interpret, for example, that the true anchor is not the reclassification itself but the prison's inability to recognise an action; that the cracks of the Mirror compete with one another and that opposition keeps Drusa suspended; or that the circle does not need a missing word, but the continuous act of losing one. If the interpretation starts from something described, explains an observable behaviour and does not contradict the scene, it can be brought into play.

Transformations in the face of Critical Failure

A Critical Failure should not merely prevent the liberation. The confrontation changes.

The prison may complete DRUSA _____ THE MIRROR with an unfavourable word and turn it into a provisional truth: *belongs to*, *contains*, *obeys*, *replaces*. It may erase Drusa's name from every LAP and turn the recovery of her identity into the new objective. It may classify one of the PCs as HOST, partially incorporating them into the structure. It may also separate one of Drusa's memories and materialise it as an independent figure claiming to be the real researcher.

If the Critical Failure directly compromises the PC's coherence, Unanchored or Fragmented would be especially fitting consequences, depending on the nature of the intervention; the current system provides precisely these two States for losses of contextual fixation or ruptures of internal continuity.

IMBALANCE OF THE GEARWORK

If the Plot Clock reaches four during Investigation or Action, suspend the Phase and use a brief mini-adventure.

The PCs appear in a version of Numinia where they remember having accepted another mission related to the same conflict.

Use Resonance to establish what mission it was, who occupied Drusa's place, what different relationship they had with one of the councillors, what important Piece never existed in this version, and what event shows that this alternative memory contains something that could be true.

When a significant recontextualisation occurs, the Veil heals and they return.

Do not hand them a solution. Hand them a new way of fearing the ones they already had.

RESOLUTION PHASE

THE RETURN TO THE COUNCIL

After the Action, the PCs return to the Veiled Chamber with whatever is left of the Mirror, with Drusa or her resulting condition, and with the theory they have built.

The four Prism Rolls replace the old Balance of the Council. Each one poses a specific question and, when necessary, alters the next.

Alethic Roll: the existence of the Mirror

LECTURA

Can the Mirror go on existing as a stable structure without keeping the memory fracture active?

On a Success, the Mirror acquires enough stability to remain as an object or enclave. On a Critical Failure, it cannot keep a single form: it splits, dematerialises or begins to transfer its properties to other supports.

If it succeeds, the Deontic Roll will decide what must be done with it. If it fails, it will decide what must be saved from that which is ceasing to exist.

Deontic Roll: the norm

If the Mirror remains, the PCs must propose:

What rule should govern it: closure, shared study, institutional custody, limited access or conditional future destruction?

On a Success, the norm comes close to what the PCs intended. On a Critical Failure, a serious restriction appears, an institutional appropriation, or a condition that contradicts part of their objectives.

If the Mirror is disappearing, the PCs must decide what should be preserved: a fragment, a memory, a Piece, Drusa, a record or any relevant element. On a Success they preserve it; on a Critical Failure they can only keep it by sacrificing something else of similar importance.

Epistemic Roll: what can be known

LECTURA

What will Numinia retain as knowledge of what happened?

On a Success, the PCs' memories remain coherent and there is at least one piece of external evidence supporting their account. On a Critical Failure, knowledge fragments: the players determine one thing that remains undoubtedly true and the GD establishes another that is left open again, contradictory or impossible to prove.

The result alters the final assessment. If there was a Success, Numinia will be able to judge on relatively firm facts. If there was a Critical Failure, it will judge on accounts, testimonies and rumours.

Axiological Roll: the meaning of the Mirror

LECTURA

What value does the Broken Mirror acquire for Numinia?

If the Epistemic Roll was a Success and this Roll is also a Success, the interpretation defended by the PCs becomes the predominant cultural framework: historical wound, exceptional archive, warning, dangerous technology, heritage, plural memory, or whatever meaning has been born from the adventure.

If the Epistemic was a Success but the Axiological fails, the facts are known but their assessment deeply divides the city.

If the Epistemic failed and the Axiological is a Success, the PCs' version becomes the most influential account even though it cannot be fully proven.

If both fail, the Mirror definitively enters the Rumourology of Numinia.

EPILOGUE

The Veiled Chamber apparently keeps the same appearance as at the beginning.

Now bring back several contributions from the initial Resonance. The object one of the councillors was toying with, the presence in the upper gallery, the detail that foreshadowed a disaster, or whatever reminded a PC of an episode from their life should reappear, transformed in some way.

If Drusa is there, her LAP record must reflect the consequences of the adventure.

If she is not, it may be far more unsettling for her to keep appearing as:

DRUSA MALTER — PRESENT.

Before the end, one of the PCs may search for *trakmósis* on their LAP again.

This time there is an entry.

Do not write it.

Ask the players:

«After everything that has happened, what definition does Numinia now show for the word *trakmósis*?»

The answer becomes part of the world.

SEEDS OF KNOWLEDGE

In this adventure, some moments especially favourable for the appearance of Seeds of Knowledge are:

- The study of the Möbius Corridor, its spatial alterations and the rules that govern its behaviour may produce Green Seeds, of lesser value.
- Understanding the Mirror, its Scars, or the relationships between identity, memory and representation may bring about Golden Seeds, of considerable value.
- Discoveries concerning Drusa, her history and what truly happened to her may generate Silver Seeds, when they broaden knowledge about individuals, societies and human relationships.
- The interpretation of documents, testimonies, remains of the past or events that make it possible to reconstruct forgotten facts may provide Blue Seeds.

PRISM CELLS

The appearance of Prism Cells should be far more exceptional. Cells are not an abstract reward that appears automatically after a good Roll: they are real treasures of Numinia, found by chance along the PCs' path.

The GD may introduce one in recognition of an especially creative intervention, an extraordinarily well-executed solution, or an exploration that has led the characters to an unexpected place. The reward must always be woven into the fiction: perhaps the action reveals a hidden cavity, opens an old compartment, gives access to an area that had been sealed for decades, or catches the prismatic gleam among the remains of a structure.

Decode Surroundings Rolls are particularly suited to this. When they are made in places where it is plausible to find vestiges, abandoned repositories, forgotten chambers or ancient accumulations of objects, the GD may include a Prism Cell among the discoveries. An especially fertile Success may reveal what no one was looking for.

It is best to keep them scarce. Finding a Cell should retain something of a fortunate accident, almost a small archaeology of chance. The Prism, after all, has the dreadful habit of hiding its treasures precisely where no one had the courtesy to look for them.

ANNEX

CHARACTER SHEET

Jugador

DATOS IDENTIFICATIVOS

TABLA 1

Nombre	Umbral
Especie	Desequilibrio
Posición	
Gremio	Aliento del Velo
Rama	
Casa	Estado
Facción	Puntos Prestigio
Distrito	

CARACTERÍSTICAS

- Fuerza *****
- Movimiento *****
- Tamaño *****
- Constitución *****

- **Inteligencia** ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨
- **Sabiduría** ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨
- **Percepción** ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨
- **Carisma** ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨

COMPETENCIAS

- **Tecnomancia** ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨
- **Forja Avanz.** ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨
- **Arq. Virtual** ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨
- **Redes Defens.** ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨
- **Cronomancia** ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨
- **Criptología** ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨
- **Descodificación** ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨
- **Visión Neural** ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨
- **Proy. Lumínica** ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨ ✨

APTITUDES ESPECIALES

-
-

RELIQUIAS Y OBJETOS

- ' '
- ' '

TESOROS

- '
- '

GLOSSARY

Academias

Cada Escuela Ontológica está asociada a una Academia, que actúa como su manifestación práctica e institucional: centros vivos de debate, archivo y aprendizaje colectivo, «el corazón palpitante del conocimiento plural». Por encima de todas se sitúa la Academia Lemuria, en Vitruvian, «la Academia global de Numinia», hogar de los Eruditos. Fuente: Capítulo 5, «Las Academias de Numinia».

Acción Hermenéutica

Acción que el DJ propone cuando los PJ encuentran una Figura Simbólica: los jugadores la interpretan desde la perspectiva de sus personajes, con la Posición como lente hermenéutica. Su rasgo decisivo es que «interpretar modifica lo interpretado»: la lectura pasa a formar parte de la naturaleza narrativa de la Figura y el DJ se compromete a que produzca consecuencias. Fuente: Capítulo 7, «Fragmento 5: La Acción Hermenéutica».

Akasha (Registros Akáshicos)

«La gran memoria universal que alberga los vestigios de todo lo que fue y todo lo que será»: un plano vibracional de memoria universal donde todo lo acontecido queda grabado como inscripción energética. Holberins proyectó allí la imagen residual de Numinia tras el incendio de 1920, y los Oráculos la hallaron en 2020 al conectarse con los Registros Akáshicos. Fuente: Capítulo 2, «El Renacimiento» y «El Aliento del Velo».

Aliento del Velo

Dimensión activa del Velo, «la respiración latente de la ciudad olvidada», activada por los Oráculos en 2020. Como atributo del personaje, «representa la conexión íntima del personaje con los planos superiores, especialmente con el Akasha»: sus puntos equivalen a la Percepción, bonifican las tiradas de Características psíquicas y sostienen la Sanación; a 0 puntos el personaje entra en «vacío akáshico». Fuente: Capítulo 2, «El Aliento del Velo»; Capítulo 3, «Aliento del Velo: La exhalación de lo eterno».

Anclaje

«Un anclaje es una pieza del rompecabezas del enfrentamiento. Es una condición que sostiene la presencia, la capacidad de acción o la amenaza del contendiente». Se distinguen anclajes fijos (expresan la identidad del contendiente) y anclajes variables (dependen de la escena); «intervenir un anclaje es interpretarlo», y cada anclaje intervenido aporta 1D6 a la reserva de enfrentamiento. Fuente: Capítulo 4, «Contendientes y anclajes» y «Anclajes fijos y anclajes variables».

Archivo Summa

Institución científica y exploratoria —«El Archivo»— fundada por decreto del Consejo de Concordia con aval de los Oráculos, de sede itinerante. Su función es el estudio sistemático de las Zonas Periféricas: «busca conocer lo que hay más allá, pero también contener y comprender lo que pueda representar una amenaza o una revelación para

la ciudad». Alberga la Sección Aleph, división restringida que investiga fenómenos insólitos. Fuente: Capítulo 5, «El Archivo Summa».

Armas

En Numinia un arma «no es una simple herramienta para producir daño»: carece de valores de ataque o daño y, en cambio, amplía las formas en que un personaje puede intervenir en el enfrentamiento (se define por Descripción, Intervención y Efecto). Por su «poder agitador» sobre el Velo, un PJ solo puede llevar consigo un arma. Fuente: Capítulo 6, «Armas» (Fragmento 2: El Inventario).

Bestiario

Las criaturas de Numinia «son más que biología alterada o algoritmos hostiles»: cada una nace de una tensión no resuelta del mundo, y «vencerlas implica, muchas veces, más comprender que herir». Recoge, entre otras: Desgarraformas (la sombra del progreso, resentimiento de lo natural frente a lo fabricado), Umbrílegos (entidades liminales de pensamiento extraviado), Depredadores del Eco (residuos del tiempo que acuden a una invocación psíquica), Dragones de Voluta (custodios de lo que permanece), Thámakar (la impaciencia que fuerza los procesos a concluir), Guardianes de Crisálida (custodios encadenados a un núcleo etérico) y Ostramires (antiguos ciudadanos transformados por la transfiguración semiótica). Fuente: Capítulo 6, «Fragmento 1: El Bestiario».

Cámara de Palimpsestos

Organismo de mayor rango entre los Exégetas, oculto en la Biblioteca Atlantis, dedicado a restaurar los artilugios leximórficos (textos codificados cuyo contenido fluctúa y se degrada). Su misión es «preservar lo mutable, restaurando el contenido en decadencia sin romper el flujo natural de su transformación»; para la Cámara, «cada texto es una criatura. Y cada restauración, un acto de reencarnación». Fuente: Capítulo 5, «La Cámara de Palimpsestos».

Características

«Las Características son los rasgos fundamentales del personaje. Se dividen en dos grupos: físicas y psíquicas, y determinan su capacidad para realizar acciones en el juego». Son ocho: Fuerza, Movimiento, Tamaño y Constitución (físicas); Inteligencia, Sabiduría, Percepción y Carisma (psíquicas). Cada punto equivale a un D6 en las acciones relacionadas; el jugador reparte 16 puntos. Fuente: Capítulo 3, «Las Características del Personaje».

Células del Prisma

«Nodos vivos, tanto físicos como espirituales, en los que la luz del Prisma se condensa para interactuar con las Facciones»; existen cuatro grupos, uno por Facción, y un PJ solo puede usar las de la suya. Como token de un solo uso sirven para tres cosas: eliminar Estados, elevar el grado de una Tirada o pagar en el Mercado Negro. Fuente: Capítulo 2, «Las Células del Prisma»; Capítulo 6, «Tokens».

Ciclos del Velo

En Numinia el tiempo no se mide por meses sino por ciclos lunares de 29 días exactos (a causa del ajuste lunar de los Cronotecarios), en años de 13 ciclos y 377 días. Cada ciclo tiene nombre simbólico y tres momentos clave (Nadir, Kairós y Crepúsculo del

Velo); «el calendario númino, así, no persigue la exactitud, sino la resonancia». Fuente: Capítulo 5, «Ciclos del Velo y el Tiempo Circular».

Competencias

«Las Competencias son habilidades específicas que el personaje ha desarrollado a través de su Especie, gremio y facción», y «se usan exclusivamente para manejar reliquias, armas y otros artefactos». Son nueve, en tres categorías: Ingeniería y Construcción, Seguridad y Protección, y Comunicación y Conexión; se reciben 6 puntos por Gremio, 6 por Facción y 6 por Especie. Fuente: Capítulo 3, «Las Competencias: Especialización y Destrezas».

Comuna de la Luz Invisible

Organización clandestina y descentralizada que opera «en las fisuras del tejido urbano, legal y simbólico de Numinia», sin líderes visibles. «La Comuna protege a quienes el sistema ha olvidado o reprimido»: anomalías biológicas, inteligencias exiliadas, ciudadanos sin registro; se dice que su lema es «Lo que no puede verse, no puede ser dominado». Fuente: Capítulo 5, «Comuna de la Luz Invisible».

Consejo de Concordia

El único órgano superior que vincula a todos los distritos: «No dicta leyes, pero articula acuerdos comunes, garantiza la transparencia y resuelve conflictos entre distritos». Es un órgano deliberativo y filosófico de cincuenta delegados cambiantes, suscrito al Decálogo de Valores de Numinia; «No gobierna, pero recuerda. No impone, pero ilumina». Fuente: Capítulo 5, «El Consejo de Concordia».

Contrapunto

Herramienta narrativa que, ante dos aportaciones de los jugadores difíciles de conciliar, invita a suponer que ambas son ciertas y a descubrir «la relación que permite que coexistan», construyendo una tercera relación capaz de contener las dos anteriores. «Premia la memoria narrativa» y debe usarse con menos frecuencia que la Resonancia Dialógica. Fuente: Capítulo 7, «El Contrapunto».

Cronotecarios

«Estudiosos del tiempo fractal» de la Edad Oscura, que concebían el tiempo como estructura sometida a bifurcaciones, recurrencias y alteraciones. Junto a los Ingenieros Negros modificaron el ciclo lunar a 29 días exactos (el «Acto que Rompió los Cielos»), origen del calendario númino y de las tormentas del Océano de Lúnacar. Fuente: Capítulo 2, «Los Cronotecarios».

Decálogo Fundacional

Decálogo común acuñado a partir de las formaciones de gobierno de Numinia; entre sus diez principios: la sabiduría es colectiva, la descentralización es armonía, «El dato es sagrado; la privacidad, inviolable», la tecnología es medio y no fin, y «El juego es la vía hacia lo numinoso». El Consejo de Concordia se suscribe a él. Fuente: Capítulo 5, «Decálogo Fundacional de Numinia».

Desequilibrio

«Cuando el Umbral llega a 0 puntos (temporalmente), el personaje entra en Desequilibrio. Este es un estado crítico en el que se manifiesta el colapso emocional, simbólico o espiritual del personaje». Es «el lado oscuro de la Posición»: cada Posición define un efecto narrativo y mecánico propio para este estado. Fuente: Capítulo 3,

«Umbral: El límite entre el orden y el colapso» y «Fragmento 3: Definiendo la Posición».

Desequilibrio del Engranaje

Reacción sistémica que ocurre cuando el Reloj de Trama alcanza su cuarta hora: «el modo en que la ciudad reajusta sus leyes internas para seguir existiendo». La aventura se interrumpe y se abre una miniaventura autoconclusiva en el pasado, el futuro o un eco alternativo del lugar; «no destruye la continuidad de la aventura: la pliega para devolverla transformada». Fuente: Capítulo 4, «Desequilibrio del engranaje»; Capítulo 7, «Fragmento 8: Desequilibrio del Engranaje, una anomalía».

Director de Juego (DJ)

La «figura guía» que estructura los escenarios, el mundo y sus desafíos: «no es un juez ni un enemigo, sino un narrador y un guía» que pone obstáculos, describe escenarios y encarna a los personajes del mundo. El manual precisa que «el DJ no es un narrador todopoderoso ni un guionista secreto: es un facilitador», guiado por principios como «Haz preguntas, nunca des todas las respuestas» y «Juega para descubrir, no para imponer». Fuente: Capítulo 1, «Cómo se juega a Numinia»; Capítulo 7, «Anexo: Consejos para el DJ».

Distrito

La ciudad se divide en cuatro grandes distritos circulares, suspendidos entre 40 y 130 metros del suelo y anclados al Velo, cada uno vinculado a una facción y a un campo de desarrollo: Vitruvian, «El templo del conocimiento» (Hermetistas); Ouroboros, «El Laberinto del juego» (Herederos de Eleusis); Solomon, «El Engranaje del Orden» (Círculo Estelar); y Sycamore, «El Lienzo de la Imaginación» (Neo-Atlantes). Los distritos son «la manifestación territorial y funcional» de lo que gremios y facciones representan. Fuente: Capítulo 5, «Los cuatro distritos».

Encrucijada

«Modalidad especial de Resonancia Dialógica» propia de la Fase de Acción: presenta tres interpretaciones posibles de un elemento ya relevante, todas plausibles e igualmente comprometidas. «Los jugadores no eligen qué consecuencia prefieren sufrir. Eligen qué clase de verdad acaba de entrar en la aventura»; suele activarse como consecuencia de un Fallo en tiradas de contención. Fuente: Capítulo 7, «La Encrucijada».

Enfrentamiento

En Numinia «un enfrentamiento no es una categoría separada del resto de conflictos»: la diferencia es que el obstáculo tiene agencia, es un contendiente. No se resuelve con tiradas sucesivas de ataque, sino «como un rompecabezas narrativo: declarando un objetivo y resolviendo los puntos del conflicto», interviniendo anclajes para construir una única reserva de dados colectiva. Fuente: Capítulo 4, «El enfrentamiento como conflicto».

Escuelas Ontológicas

En Numinia no existen universidades: el saber se cultiva en Escuelas Ontológicas, «donde el saber se despliega según los grandes campos del desarrollo humano y no según disciplinas cerradas». Son seis ejes de investigación abiertos y transversales (Materia Invisible, Formas Emergentes, Tiempo Fractal, Lenguajes Primordiales,

Simbiosis Extendida y Umbral Anímico), con el lema «Donde el saber no se divide, sino que se transforma». Fuente: Capítulo 5, «Las Escuelas Ontológicas de Numinia».

Espacio de Indeterminación

Parte de la ficción que el módulo y el DJ dejan deliberadamente sin concretar para que pueda completarse durante el juego. No es un vacío arbitrario: la pregunta que lo abre contiene ya una propuesta con «límites fértiles», que determina lo suficiente para estimular la imaginación y deja indeterminado lo suficiente para que la aportación sea del jugador. Fuente: Capítulo 7, «El Espacio de Indeterminación».

Especie

«La Especie de un personaje no es una simple característica biológica, sino una configuración esencial de su identidad»: cada una representa un campo de fuerza, un modo de pensamiento y un propósito. Son cinco linajes cristalizados al final de la Edad Oscura en torno a cinco fuerzas: Biomecánicos, «Los Maestros del Progreso» (Tecnología); Humanitas, «Los Custodios del Significado» (Cultura); Reptilianos, «Los Guardianes de la Tradición» (Naturaleza); Cyanitas, «Los Arquitectos del Orden Social» (Conocimiento); y Espectrales, «Los Visionarios del Más Allá» (Éter). Fuente: Capítulo 3, «Fragmento 2: Determinar la Especie»; Capítulo 2, «El Nacimiento de las Cinco Especies».

Espejo Roto, El

Módulo para el juego de rol Numinia (2–3 sesiones, dificultad media, ámbito principal el Distrito Ouroboros). Su Conflicto de Partida: la memoria colectiva de Numinia sufre alteraciones cada vez más profundas; la investigadora Drusa Malter halló una posible relación con un Espejo Astillado conservado en un depósito olvidado y después desapareció sin dejar constancia de su salida. Fuente: Módulo EL ESPEJO ROTO, «La Raíz».

Estados del PJ

Sistema que sustituye a los puntos de vida: «la existencia de los PJS no se mide por puntos de vida o de energía»; los Estados «representan, entonces, las repercusiones de conflictos mal resueltos». La tabla recoge Confundido, Desestabilizado, Desanclado, Desincronizado, Fragmentado, Extenuado, Contaminado, Colapsado y Aletargado; el estado sin daño es Incólume y la disolución final, Disuelto. Fuente: Capítulo 4, «Fragmento 6: Estados del PJ».

Estructura en fases

Organización de cada aventura en «estados de la narración, no capítulos de un argumento previamente escrito», que «no son compartimentos estancos: pueden solaparse, acortarse o expandirse según las necesidades de la historia». Las fases son Presentación, Deliberación, Investigación, Reflexión, Acción y Resolución; en cada una cambia el propósito, el ritmo y la distribución de la iniciativa entre el DJ y los jugadores. Fuente: Capítulo 4, «Fragmento 2: Estructura en fases»; Capítulo 7, «Fragmento 6: Gestionar las Fases».

Facción

«Si el gremio define la vocación de un personaje, la facción representa su visión del mundo»: su comunidad de ideales y su ámbito de influencia, cada una ligada a un distrito y un campo de desarrollo. Son cuatro: Hermetistas, «guardianes de la

sabiduría y la erudición» (Educación); Herederos de Eleusis, para quienes «el aprendizaje y el progreso surgen de la experimentación lúdica» (Proyección narrativa); Círculo Estelar, «los arquitectos del orden, los legisladores de la comunidad» (Organización); y Neo-Atlantes, que «ven la creatividad como el motor de Numinia» (Arte). Fuente: Capítulo 3, «La Facción: El Espíritu de la Ciudad».

Figura Simbólica

Elemento con «una carga simbólica evidente y un significado todavía indeterminado»: objeto, imagen, acontecimiento, persona o frase «suficientemente singular para provocar la impresión de que su apariencia inmediata no agota aquello que significa». «La Figura no oculta una interpretación correcta. Es una estructura esperando ser interpretada» mediante la Acción Hermenéutica. Fuente: Capítulo 7, «Fragmento 5: La Acción Hermenéutica» y «Cuándo introducir una Figura Hermenéutica».

Gremio

Los gremios representan la vocación de cada ciudadano: «su sendero dentro de la ciudad, su área de especialización y el núcleo de sus habilidades», organizados en jerarquía vertical (cuatro Gremios, dos Ramas por Gremio, dos Casas por Rama) según la Teoría del Nivel Básico. Son cuatro: Alquimistas, «Mentes creativas, científicas y artísticas»; Exégetas, «Aquellos que viven por las letras, la historia y la fantasía»; Procuradores, «Las mentes pragmáticas de Numinia»; y Centinelas, «moderadores, custodios y pacificadores». Fuente: Capítulo 3, «El Gremio: El Oficio del Personaje».

Grieta de Inversión

Fractura vertical de profundidad desconocida en el Subvalle de Neuma, «como una herida entre mundos, donde el Velo parece haber perdido su continuidad». Por ella aparecen objetos e información sin procedencia (los Vestigios Exógenos), pero nunca la ha atravesado un ser vivo: «La Grieta transmite vestigios, no viajeros». Fuente: Capítulo 5, «La Grieta de Inversión: una excentricidad interdimensional».

Hechos fundacionales

«Aquellas circunstancias que deben ser ciertas para que la aventura exista»: el terreno firme sobre el que comienza la partida, que no debe modificarse. Lo que permanece abierto no son los hechos, sino su significado y sus relaciones profundas. Fuente: Capítulo 7, «Hechos fundacionales y propuestas potenciales».

Heterocósmica

Teoría de Lubomír Doležel, «la ciencia de los mundos de ficción»: toda narración abre un mundo posible con leyes internas y coherencia propias. Sus dimensiones se articulan mediante cuatro operadores lógicos: aléticos (lo posible), deónticos (lo permitido/prohibido), epistémicos (lo que se conoce) y axiológicos (lo valioso), que el juego usa para describir lo creado en la Tirada de Heterocósmica. Fuente: Capítulo 4, «Fragmento 4: Tirada de Heterocósmica».

Holberins

Fundador del Centro de Investigación Sigma y «padre fundador de la ciudad de Numinia»; apodo del único de los Cinco Iniciados cuyo nombre prevaleció. «Un científico visionario, un alquimista del conocimiento» que, previendo el desastre de 1920, «logró alterar los flujos del tiempo para proyectar una imagen residual de la

ciudad» en los Registros Akáshicos. Fuente: Capítulo 1, «Una ciudad escrita entre vapor y código»; Capítulo 2, «La Caída».

Khepris

Entidades inspiradas en el dios egipcio Khepri «que encarnan la esencia misma de la transformación y el renacer», «guardianes de la memoria perdida y conductores de las almas a través del velo del tiempo». Surgieron del campo de energía generado por la maquinaria de Holberins enterrada cerca de la tumba de Petosiris; en 2020 los Oráculos hallaron allí «una sorprendente colonia de 55 Khepris», los Primordiales. Fuente: Capítulo 2, «Fragmento 2: Génesis de los Khepris».

LAP (Lector Akáshico Personal)

«El Lector Akáshico Personal, más conocido por sus siglas LAP, es el dispositivo de acceso cotidiano a la red akáshica de Numinia», portado habitualmente en la muñeca: documentación, identificación por emblemas, realidad aumentada, buscador akáshico, cartografía dinámica y mensajería. Tiene límites: «el LAP encuentra información; los PJS todavía tienen que comprenderla», «no sustituye a la investigación», y depende de la red akáshica, restringida en periferias, instalaciones protegidas y anomalías del Velo. Fuente: Capítulo 6, «Fragmento 3: El LAP».

Legión del Umbral

«La muralla invisible que se alza cuando Numinia tiembla»: fuerza de élite «nacida no para la guerra, sino para impedirla», que no patrulla las calles y solo se activa cuando el velo de la paz se desgarrar. Cada miembro ha superado un severo Test de Serenidad; su lema: «No somos la luz ni la sombra; somos el filo que las separa». Fuente: Capítulo 5, «La Legión del Umbral».

Marcador de Resonancia

Contador colectivo que regula la creación mediante Tiradas de Heterocósmica: cada tirada añade 1 nodo al Marcador y, «al llegar a 4, dispara una Tirada de Evento» y se reinicia a 0. Existe porque «remover demasiado el engranaje de Numinia puede provocar perturbaciones serias». Fuente: Capítulo 4, «Tirada de Heterocósmica».

Mercado Negro

Comercio clandestino de la Calle de los Misterios, en el Barrio Viejo de Ouroboros: «el lugar donde todo aquello que Numinia pierde, prohíbe, olvida o no sabe muy bien dónde guardar termina adquiriendo un precio». Allí circulan Reliquias, Armas, Residuos y Proscritos, y su moneda preferida son las Células del Prisma: «El Mercado Negro no consume únicamente recursos: consume posibilidades». Fuente: Capítulo 5, Anexo «El Mercado Negro de Numinia».

Mestizaje

Las Especies no son compartimentos estancos: «Los mestizos son individuos que combinan la herencia genética de dos o más especies, manifestando características híbridas» (primera generación 50/50; segunda, dos especies principales al 35/35 más secundarias). El mestizaje «no solo es genético, sino también cultural y simbólico». Fuente: Capítulo 3, «La Singularidad del mestizaje en Numinia».

Nivel Delta

La capa inferior estructural de Numinia, red de zonas sumergidas, criptocámaras y plataformas colapsadas bajo los distritos: «No es un sótano: es una sedimentación de

versiones antiguas de la ciudad». Oculta los errores fundacionales y tecnologías precósmicas; su nombre procede del signo (Δ) con que los antiguos ingenieros marcaban la desviación de una estructura respecto a su modelo. Fuente: Capítulo 5, «Nivel Delta: Fundación Sepultada de la ciudad-estado».

Numinia

Ciudad-estado del saber imaginada a principios del siglo XX por Holberins y los Cinco Iniciados «como un juego: un gran tablero donde el pensamiento se moviera en libertad»; arrasada por el fuego en 1920, resurge en el siglo XXI «como una ciudad entre planos», steampunk en su arquitectura de hierro, cristal y vapor, cyberpunk en sus redes de datos. Es «un gran tablero de juego, proyectado en el plano sutil a través de la imaginación de todos sus ciudadanos». Fuente: Capítulo 1, «Una ciudad escrita entre vapor y código».

Océano de Lúnacar

Mar perpetuamente crepuscular que rodea por completo las tierras de Numinia; se supone que «se expande en el Akasha de manera infinita», pues nadie que haya intentado alcanzar el otro lado ha vuelto para contarle. Sus reflejos iridiscentes no responden a la luz solar «sino a las fluctuaciones del pensamiento colectivo». Fuente: Capítulo 5, «El Océano de Lúnacar».

Ofrenda de Gloria

Una vez por partida, si el personaje conserva todos sus puntos iniciales de Aliento del Velo, puede convertir automáticamente en Éxito Total cualquier tirada fallida a cambio de perder temporalmente todos esos puntos. Debe describirse como «un momento de resonancia, profecía o transfiguración... una grieta fugaz en la linealidad del mundo». Fuente: Capítulo 3, «Aliento del Velo: La exhalación de lo eterno».

Oráculos

Grupo de cinco investigadores que en 2020 reconocieron la fórmula de Athanasius, abrieron una brecha espacio-temporal en Tuna el-Yebel y hallaron en los Registros Akáshicos la imagen residual de Numinia, dando lugar «al renacimiento de la ciudad». Como conciencia fundacional, «no gobiernan, no dictan leyes, no participan de los conflictos internos de los distritos»: su función es activar, inspirar y preservar los fundamentos de la ciudad. Fuente: Capítulo 2, «El Renacimiento»; Capítulo 5, «Los Oráculos, Arquitectos del Equilibrio».

Organismos Gremiales

Organismos autónomos erigidos por cada gremio, «verdaderos corazones funcionales de la ciudad», no subordinados al poder político ni a los distritos. Son cuatro: el Tesaurum Verba (Exégetas), la Fábrica de la Segunda Naturaleza (Alquimistas), la Mesa del Juramento Vivo (Procuradores) y el Vigía de las Esquirlas (Centinelas). Fuente: Capítulo 5, «Organismos Gremiales de Numinia».

Pieza de Dirección

Entre las Piezas del Conflicto «debe existir al menos una que cumpla una función particular: proporcionar a los jugadores una dirección concreta desde la que puedan abordar directamente el Conflicto de Partida». «Cierra la incertidumbre sobre dónde puede actuar el grupo, pero no cierra la incertidumbre sobre qué significa aquello que

encontrará»; su aparición señala que la Investigación puede terminar. Fuente: Capítulo 7, «La Pieza de Dirección».

Piezas del Conflicto

«Elementos significativos que aparecen durante la aventura y que guardan alguna relación potencial con el Conflicto de Partida»: objetos, documentos, testimonios o símbolos que los PJ relacionan entre sí para formular interpretaciones. A diferencia de la pista tradicional, una Pieza «posee relevancia sin poseer todavía un significado cerrado»; se necesitan al menos tres para abandonar la Fase de Investigación, y cada una equivale a 1D6 en la Tirada de Prisma final. Fuente: Capítulo 7, «Fragmento 3: Las Piezas del Conflicto»; Capítulo 4, «Fase de Investigación».

PJ y PNJ

El manual emplea las siglas PJ (y PJS) para los personajes que interpretan los jugadores y PNJ (y PNJS) para los personajes del mundo, sin desarrollarlos formalmente. Los roles se describen en el Capítulo 1: cada jugador «interpreta un personaje –un habitante de esta ciudad fantástica en reconstrucción– y lo hace avanzar, hablar, decidir y actuar como si fuera él», mientras el DJ «encarna a los personajes del mundo». Fuente: Capítulo 1, «Cómo se juega a Numinia».

Posición

«La Posición es la función estable y genérica que un personaje asume en Numinia. No se trata de un rol efímero o una tarea circunstancial, sino de un lugar dentro del sistema». Hay quince (Guardián de las Puertas, Pitia, Embajador, Maestro de Juego, Legionario del Umbral, Armonauta, Susurrador de Máquinas, Corredor del Velo, Archivista, Hermeneuta, Mediador del Prisma, Cartógrafo del Viento, Oniromante, Anacárquide y Etnarca); cada una otorga +1 a una Característica, seis aptitudes especiales (se eligen dos), los puntos iniciales de Umbral e Iniciativa y un efecto propio de Desequilibrio. Fuente: Capítulo 3, «Fragmento 3: Definiendo la Posición».

Prisma

«El Prisma no es un objeto ni una doctrina: es la ley viva de la refracción». Donde el Velo guarda y el Umbral manifiesta, el Prisma despliega: «No crea verdades: multiplica perspectivas», descomponiendo cada escena en trayectorias posibles y permitiendo que cada gremio y facción proyecte su ángulo de mundo. Fuente: Capítulo 2, «La fuerza del Prisma».

Propuestas potenciales

PNJ, lugares, acontecimientos, objetos o relaciones preparados por el DJ con conexión posible con el conflicto, que «no constituyen hechos de la ficción hasta que aparecen durante el juego»: materiales para introducir, transformar o descartar. El principio es «preparar posibilidades, no obligaciones». Fuente: Capítulo 7, «Hechos fundacionales y propuestas potenciales».

Proscriptos

«Los Proscriptos, por el contrario, son tecnologías experimentales. Algunos fueron prototipos; otras proceden de investigaciones secretas o prohibidas; unos pocos quizá funcionaron demasiado bien». Su circulación está restringida por sus propiedades «excéntricas, imprevisibles o difíciles de integrar en las normas tecnológicas de la ciudad». Fuente: Capítulo 6, «Rarezas y Anomalías» y «Proscriptos».

Puntos de Prestigio

«El Prestigio representa el grado en que un personaje se integra en el tejido cultural de Numinia»: una forma de experiencia cultural, pues el progreso depende «fundamentalmente, de lo que conoce y lo que comprende». Se incrementa consumiendo Semillas del Conocimiento según su valor y, «una vez adquirido, el Prestigio no se pierde». Fuente: Capítulo 3, «Prestigio y cultura viva»; Capítulo 6, «Tokens».

Raíz

La proposición fundamental sobre la que se construye el módulo: establece qué está ocurriendo al comenzar la aventura, a quién afecta, qué tensión introduce y por qué intervienen los PJ; «no constituye un resumen del argumento ni contiene una explicación secreta de los acontecimientos». Debe ser «firme en aquello que presenta y extraordinariamente flexible en aquello que significa». Fuente: Capítulo 7, «Fragmento 1: Crear la Raíz».

Rarezas y Anomalías

Categoría del Inventario que agrupa objetos de capas tecnológicas pasadas que «no fueron creados para convertirse en Reliquia»: máquinas desplazadas, instrumentos de sistemas desaparecidos y prototipos nunca incorporados a la vida ordinaria. «Todos ellos se agrupan en dos grandes categorías: Residuos y Proscriptos», que a efectos de Inventario cuentan como Reliquias. Fuente: Capítulo 6, «Rarezas y Anomalías».

Red akáshica

El entramado organizado de información que Numinia ha registrado, estructurado y puesto a disposición de sus ciudadanos, al que se accede mediante el LAP; contiene tanto documentación institucional como espacios informales (foros, canales comunitarios). Es distinta del Akasha profundo: «El LAP no accede directamente al Akasha en toda su profundidad». Fuente: Capítulo 6, «Fragmento 3: El LAP».

Reliquia

Las reliquias «no son herramientas. Son ecos fosilizados del tiempo simbólico»: cada una es «una forma encapsulada de decisión» que «no se usan: se invocan. No se activan: se interpretan». Cada Reliquia tiene una Propiedad articulada con una Competencia (cuya reserva de dados se usa en la Tirada de Instrumento) y un Factor de Riesgo; no pueden portarse más de tres a la vez. Fuente: Capítulo 6, «Reliquias» (Fragmento 2: El Inventario).

Reloj de Trama

Contador colectivo que «marca el pulso del mundo narrativo»: cada Tirada de Evento avanza una hora en él, en un ciclo de cuatro horas. Al llegar a la cuarta hora se activa el Desequilibrio del Engranaje y, cuando este se cierra, el Velo «cicatriz» y el reloj se reinicia desde 0. Fuente: Capítulo 4, «Tirada de Evento» y «Desequilibrio del engranaje».

Residuos

«Los Residuos son tecnologías antiguas que han quedado fuera de uso», pertenecientes a etapas anteriores del desarrollo técnico de Numinia, con materialidad de válvulas, lentes, bobinas y engranajes. «No son necesariamente

inferiores a las tecnologías actuales»: un Residuo es «la supervivencia de una tecnología desplazada». Fuente: Capítulo 6, «Rarezas y Anomalías» y «Residuos».

Resonancia Dialógica

Dinámica de creación colaborativa en la que el DJ formula «una pregunta dirigida sobre algún elemento de la ficción cuyo significado o manifestación todavía permanece abierto». Combina un elemento arbitrario (condición que el DJ introduce como verdadera) y un elemento abierto (lo que el jugador concreta): «Esto es así; ¿qué hace que sea así?»; es dialógica porque el significado nace de la relación entre ambos. Fuente: Capítulo 7, «Fragmento 2: Resonancia Dialógica».

Río Virelai

El único gran río que atraviesa por completo Numinia: nace en los Manantiales Resonantes de Heliconte, traza una espiral irregular a través de los distritos y desemboca en el Océano de Lúnacar por el Delta de Doxa. Su nombre procede de una antigua forma poética: «el Virelai fluye como un estribillo, repitiendo y reescribiendo su curso a través de la historia». Fuente: Capítulo 5, «El Río Virelai».

Rumorología

«El conjunto de relatos, recuerdos fragmentarios, testimonios, hipótesis, supersticiones y asociaciones simbólicas mediante los cuales los habitantes de Numinia intentan explicar aquello que conocen de manera incompleta»: la memoria informal de la ciudad. Se investiga con una Tirada de Indagar sobre elementos que se hayan «culturizado»; los rumores no son necesariamente falsos, y «la Rumorología no sustituye a las Piezas: las rodea de cultura». Fuente: Capítulo 7, «Fragmento 4: Rumorología».

Semillas del Conocimiento

«Manifestaciones físicas del vínculo que se establece entre un personaje y Numinia mediante el descubrimiento, la investigación y la creación»: vainas geodésicas luminiscentes en cinco clases (de 1 a 5 puntos de Prestigio) que el DJ concede «cuando considera que ha existido un verdadero acto de conocimiento». «Numinia recompensa la curiosidad ejercida, no la información recibida pasivamente». Fuente: Capítulo 6, «Semillas del Conocimiento» (Tokens); Capítulo 3, «Prestigio y cultura viva».

Sesión Cero

El primer paso del juego: «Antes de que se abran los portales del juego, los jugadores se reúnen con el Director de Juego (DJ) para construir juntos el alma de la partida». Sirve para crear los personajes, descubrir sus historias, entender su relación con el mundo y «tejer los primeros hilos del relato común que vivirán». Fuente: Capítulo 1, «Cómo se juega a Numinia».

Tirada de Acción

Tirada que se activa cuando el personaje «intenta ejecutar una maniobra concreta que conlleva un riesgo o una consecuencia significativa». Se lanza una reserva de D6 igual a la Característica asociada más la reserva de Umbral (físicas) o de Aliento del Velo (psíquicas); cada 6 es un éxito y cada 1 un fallo, con grados de Éxito total, Éxito, Fallo o Fracaso. Fuente: Capítulo 4, «Tiradas de Acción» (Fragmento 3).

Tirada de Evento

«La segunda de las Tiradas Narrativas de Numinia», disparada al llenarse el Marcador de Resonancia: «no mide el éxito o el fracaso de la acción (...) sino que expresa qué tipo de reacción provoca». Se tira 1D20 sobre una tabla que recoge «las 20 funciones más relevantes de las 31 detectadas por Propp» convertidas en Eventos jugables; cada Tirada de Evento avanza una hora en el Reloj de Trama. Fuente: Capítulo 4, «Fragmento 5: Tirada de Evento».

Tirada de Heterocósmica

Tirada Narrativa que «se activa cuando un jugador imagina y materializa algo nuevo en escena», bajo el principio «si lo nombras, puede existir; si existe, tendrá precio». Se tira 2D6: el resultado determina el grado de éxito y cuántas características tendrá lo creado (de 2 a 4), expresadas según los operadores lógicos de Doležel con polaridad positiva o negativa; cada tirada añade 1 nodo al Marcador de Resonancia. Fuente: Capítulo 4, «Tirada de Heterocósmica» (Fragmento 4).

Tirada de Instrumento

Tirada que representa «el uso de artefactos, que en el mundo de Numinia toman el nombre de Reliquias», resuelta con la reserva de D6 de la Competencia necesaria para usar dicha Reliquia. Solo pueden emplearse Competencias asociadas al Gremio, Facción o Especie del PJ, y «dependen enteramente del contexto narrativo». Fuente: Capítulo 4, «Tiradas de Instrumento» (Fragmento 3).

Tirada de Prisma

Tirada de la Fase de Resolución con la que los PJ deshacen cada nudo o Punto Operativo del cierre de la aventura: su reserva se forma con las Piezas del Conflicto halladas (cada Pieza equivale a 1D6). Por convención hay cuatro Puntos Operativos, que «deberían responder a cada uno de los cuatro operadores lógicos» de la Heterocósmica; el fallo no impide resolver, «solo hará las cosas más difíciles». Fuente: Capítulo 4, «Fase de Resolución» (Fragmento 2).

Tiradas de Movimiento

Categoría general con la que se resuelven las acciones y los desafíos, que comprende las Tiradas de Acción y las Tiradas de Instrumento. Siguen la lógica del Sistema D6 adaptada a un sistema de éxitos: se lanzan tantos D6 como puntos de la aptitud correspondiente, «cada 6 obtenido es un éxito» y «cada 1 obtenido es un fallo». Fuente: Capítulo 4, «Fragmento 3: Tiradas de Movimiento».

Tokens

«Los Tokens son objetos primotécnicos que materializan aspectos de la relación entre un individuo y Numinia»; «No representan riqueza. Representan vínculo», y obtener uno es siempre una forma de reconocimiento de la ciudad. Existen dos grandes clases: las Semillas del Conocimiento (responden al conocimiento) y las Células del Prisma (responden a la afinidad faccional). Fuente: Capítulo 6, «Tokens» (Fragmento 2: El Inventario).

Tres grandes fuerzas

«Tres grandes fuerzas son las que actúan como motor de Numinia, articulando su dinámica y su morfología: el Velo, el Umbral y el Prisma». Viven «tanto fusionadas como enfrentadas»: la condición sobrenatural del Velo, la materialización física del

Umbral y la potencia refractaria del Prisma, que las permea. Fuente: Capítulo 2, «Fragmento 5: Las tres grandes fuerzas de Numinia».

Umbral

Como fuerza cósmica, «el Umbral es la fuerza de Numinia que actúa como antagonista del Velo»: la materialización de las energías físicas; «no separa dos mundos: es el punto exacto donde el mundo toma cuerpo». Como atributo del personaje, «representa el estado psicoemocional del personaje y su capacidad para mantenerse equilibrado»: una reserva de D6 que bonifica las tiradas de Características físicas y cuyo agotamiento activa el Desequilibrio. Fuente: Capítulo 2, «Las fronteras del Umbral»; Capítulo 3, «Umbral: El límite entre el orden y el colapso».

Variaciones lingüísticas

Las tres categorías lingüísticas de Numinia, variaciones «de un idioma común, el numínido»: el Dialecto, determinado por la Especie; el Sociolecto, determinado por el Distrito y su Facción; y el Lingo, la jerga de los Gremios. Para los PJ juegan «un papel anecdótico»: son modelos de expresión, no una exigencia mecánica. Fuente: Capítulo 5, «Fragmento 4: Dialectos y sociolectos de Numinia».

Velo

«El Velo no es un lugar. No es, exactamente, una dimensión ni una frontera. Es la membrana translúcida entre lo visible y lo no manifestado»: el eco consciente del mundo, un campo espiritual y simbólico donde resuenan decisiones no tomadas, recuerdos no vividos y destinos por revelarse. Nace míticamente como «la piel viva del desajuste» tras el ajuste lunar de los Cronotecarios. _Fuente: Capítulo 2, «El Aliento del Velo» (Fragmento 5)._ ---

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«Y a nuestras familias, por aguantarnos.»

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Authors: Christian Märtens (80 %) · Pablo Fernández-Maqueira Martínez (20 %)

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